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No connection

Lesson-01

DEFINITIONS AND GUIDING PRINCIPLES OF BILINGUALISM

Topic No. 001-006

Introduction; Definitions of Bilingualism; Issues with Definitions of Bilingualism; Language Behaviour-Functionalist; Language Behaviour Similarities; Language Literacy and Bilingualism Approach

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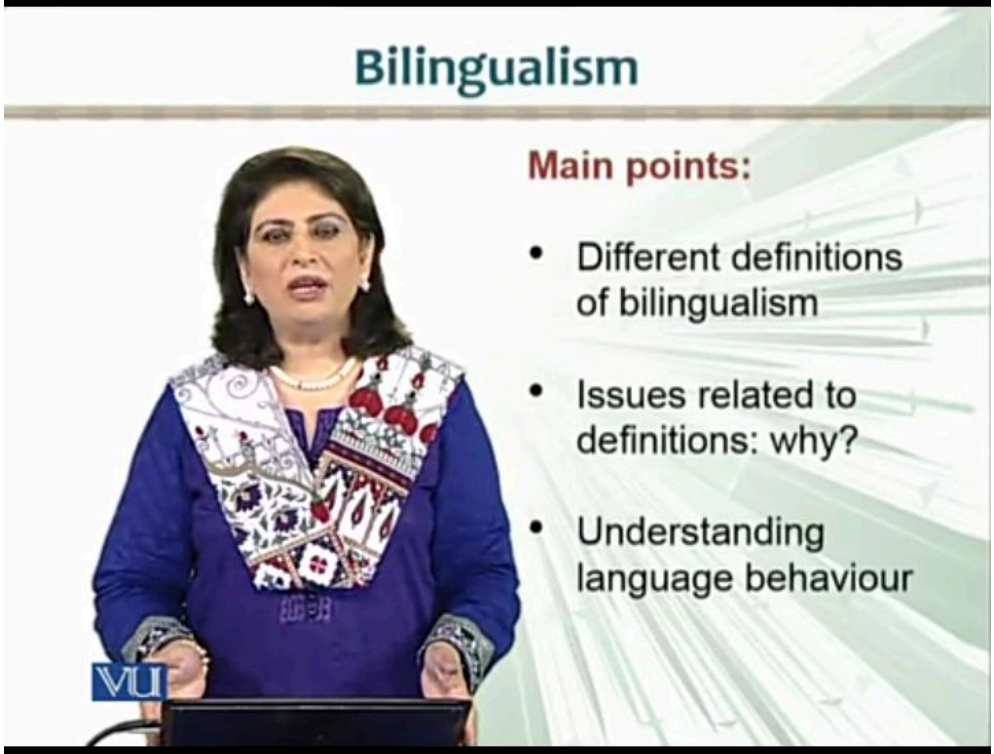
Although the study of language can be conducted at several levels of analysis, the nature of language behavior like that of other complex human behaviors remains the same regardless of the level of analysis



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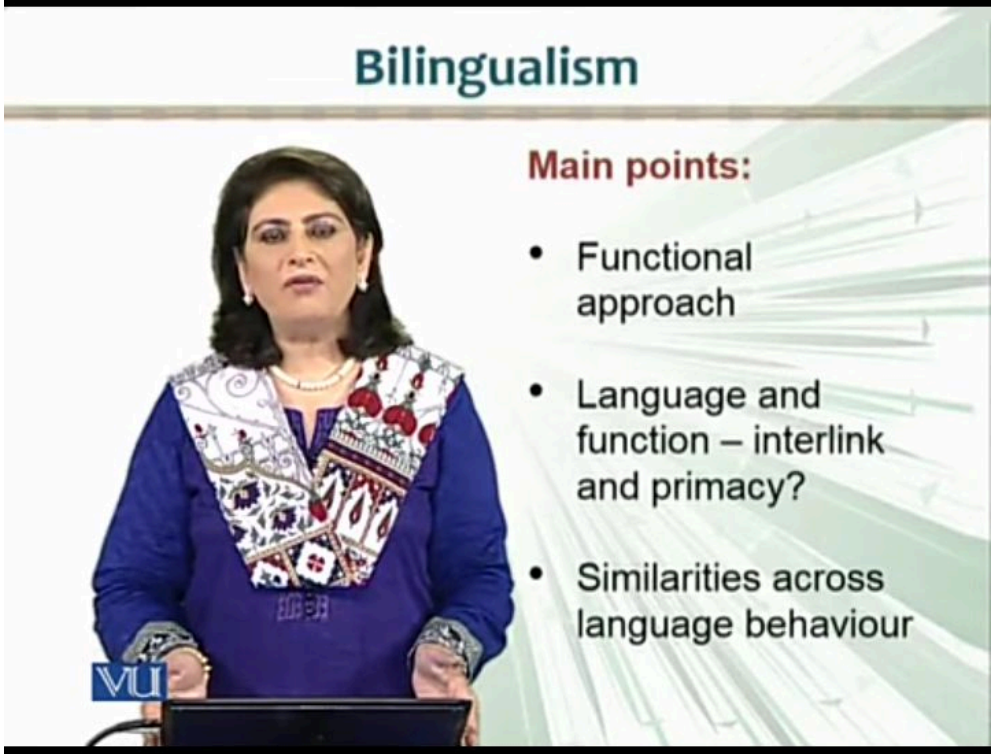

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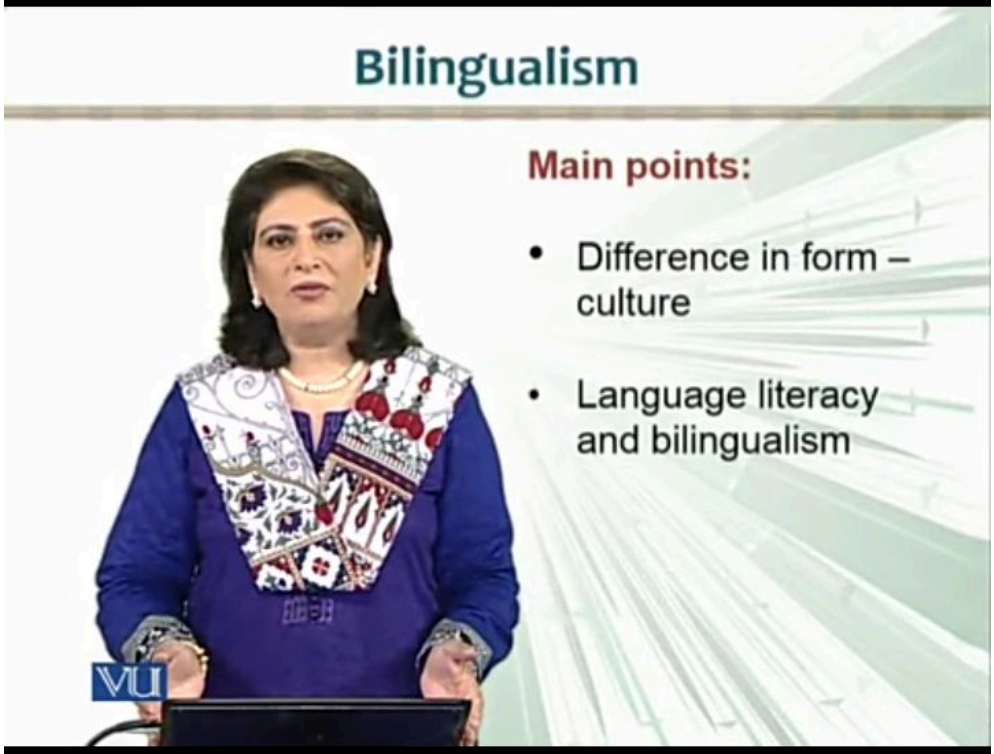

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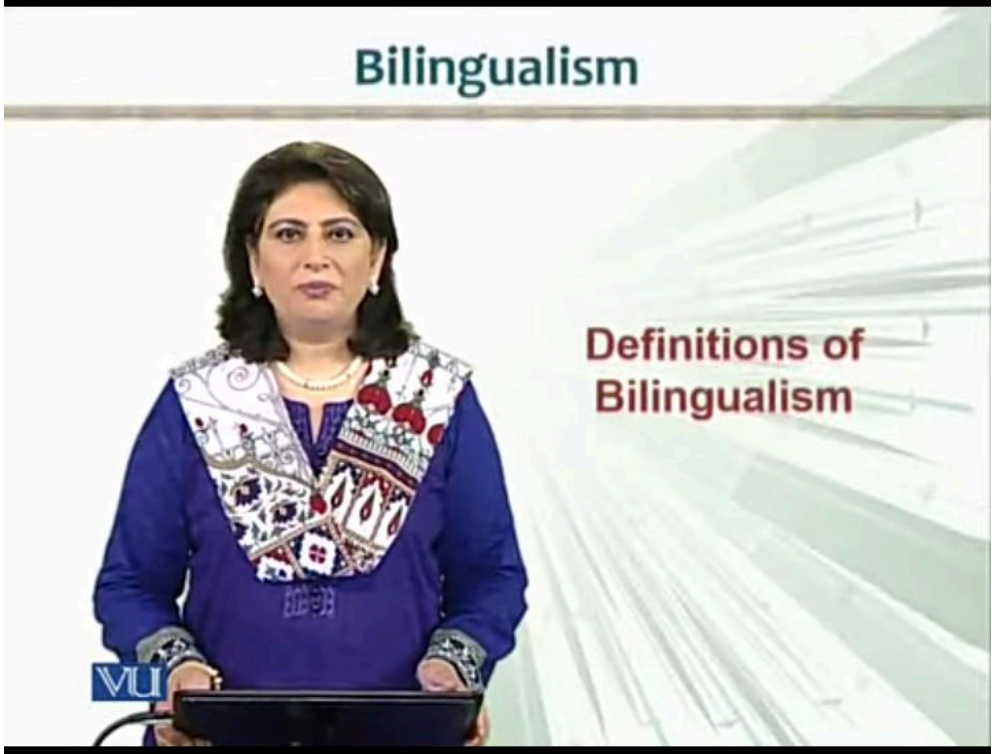

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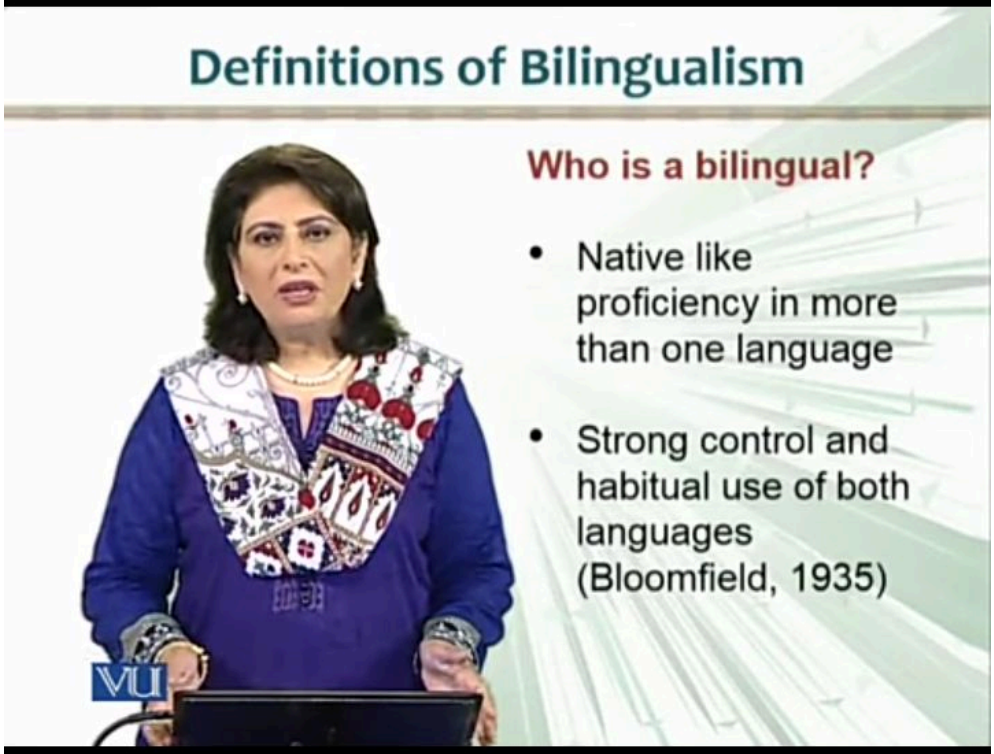

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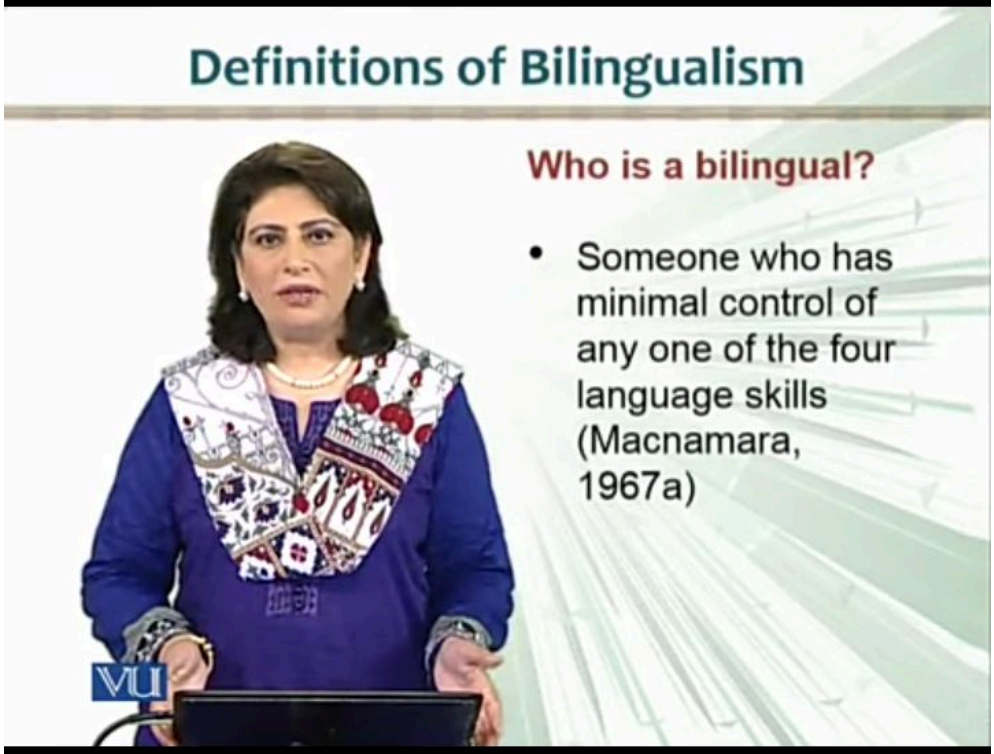

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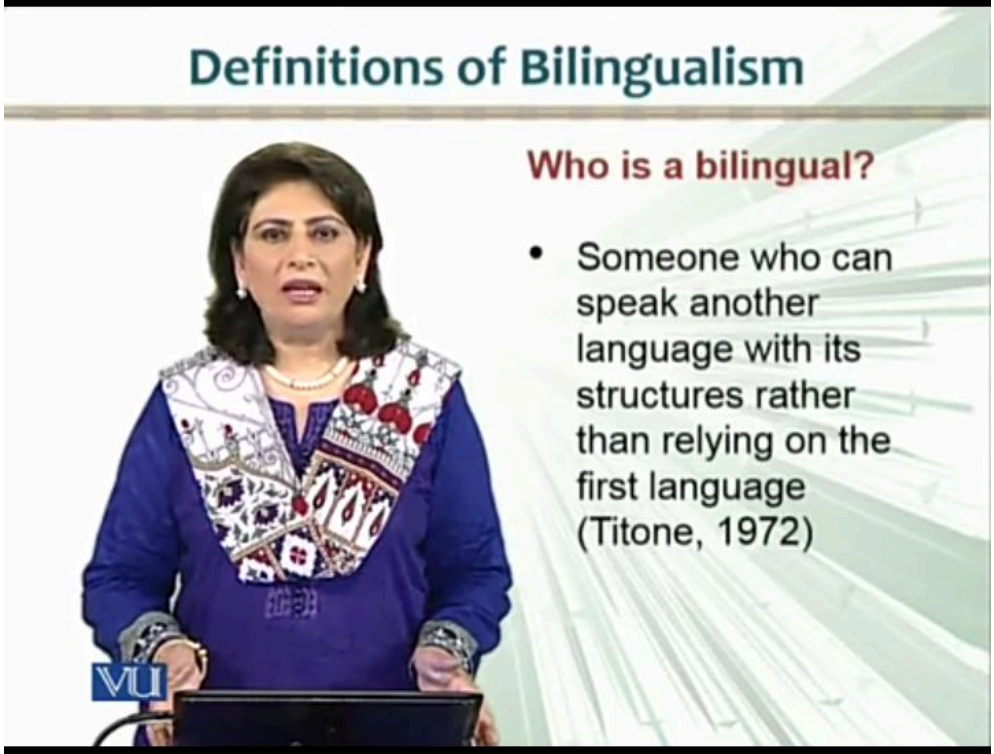

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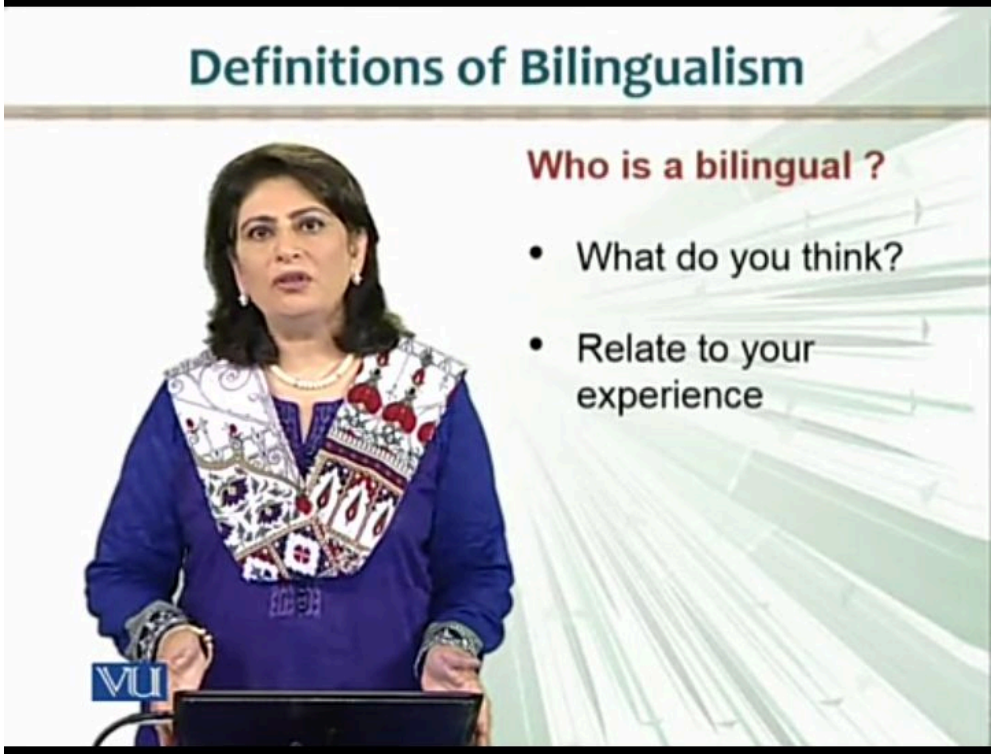

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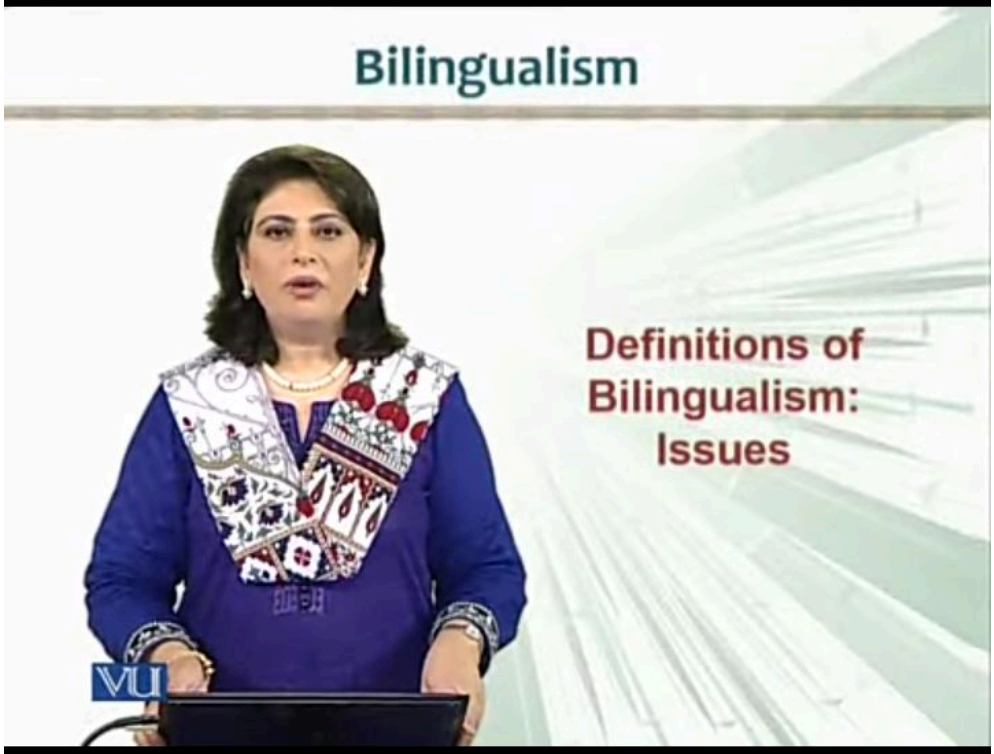

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(1) There is a constant interaction between the dynamics of language behavior at the societal level and language behavior at the individual level.

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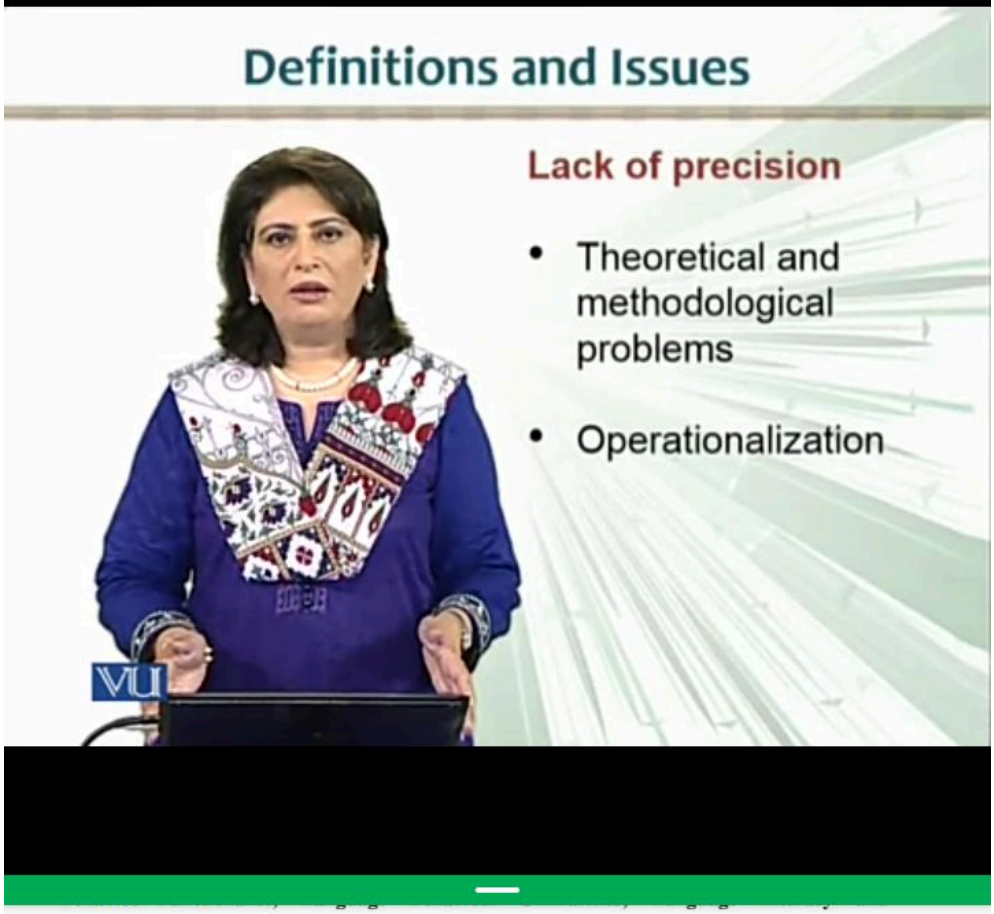

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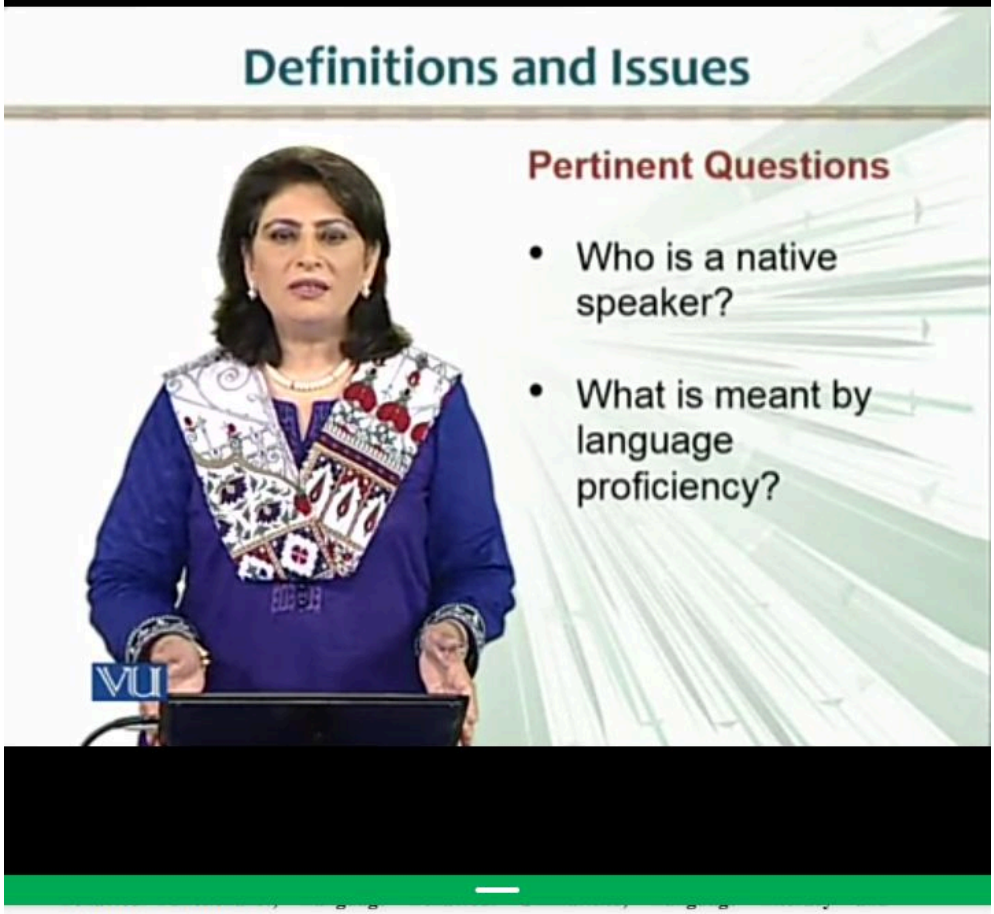

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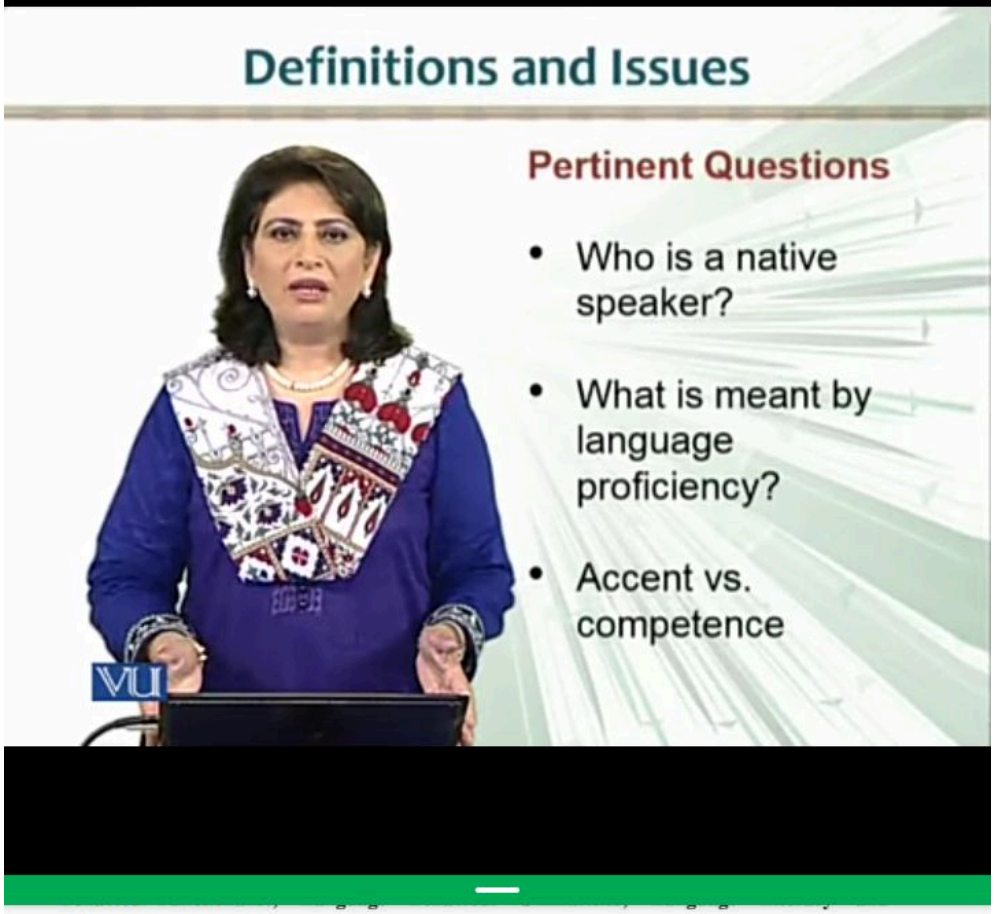

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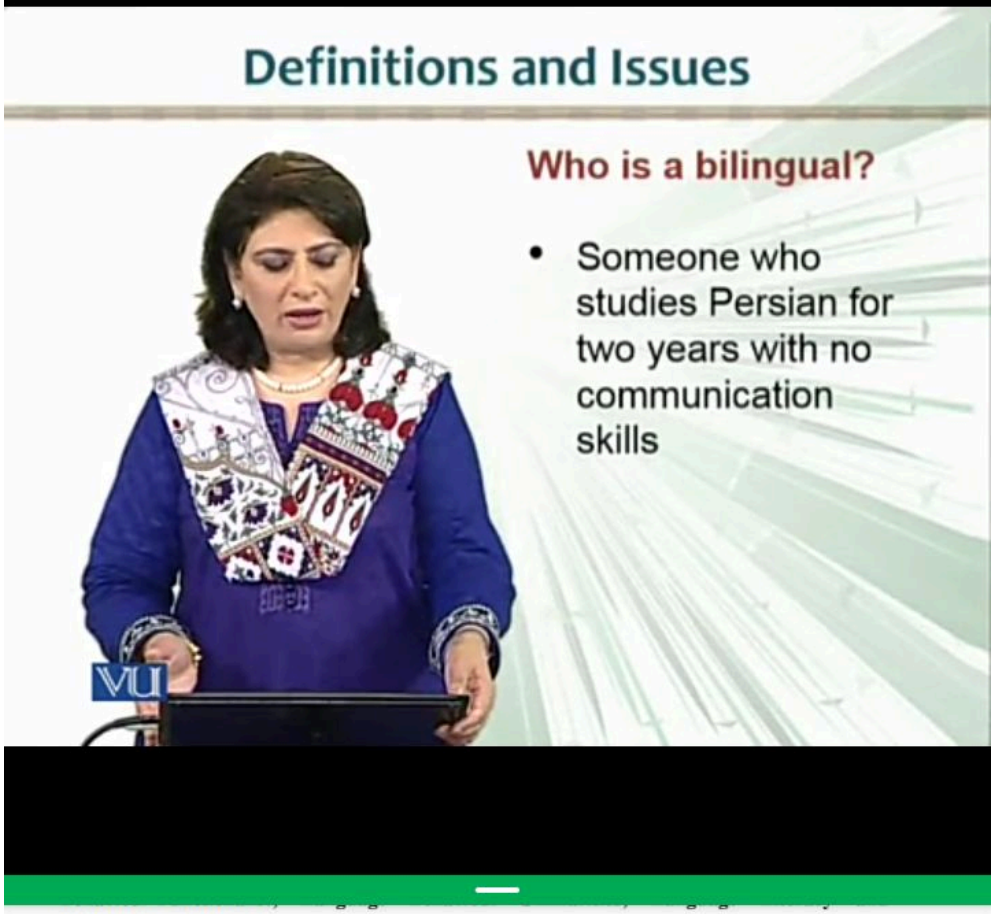

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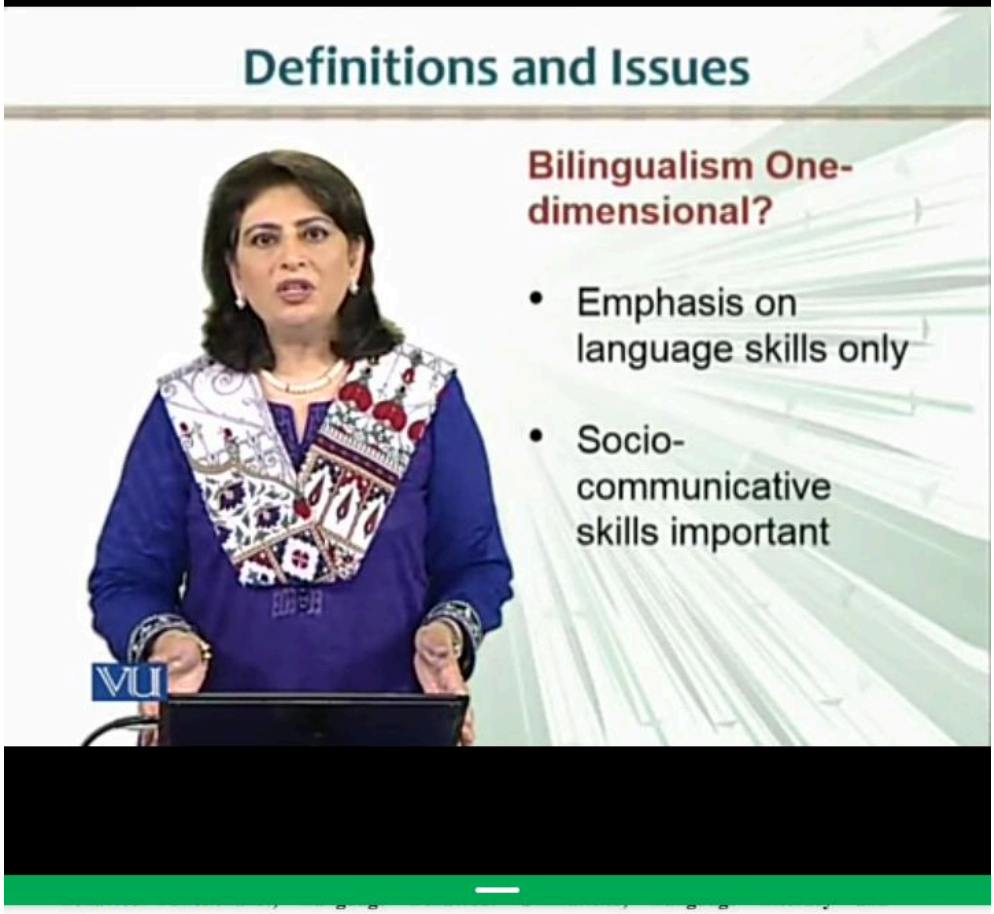

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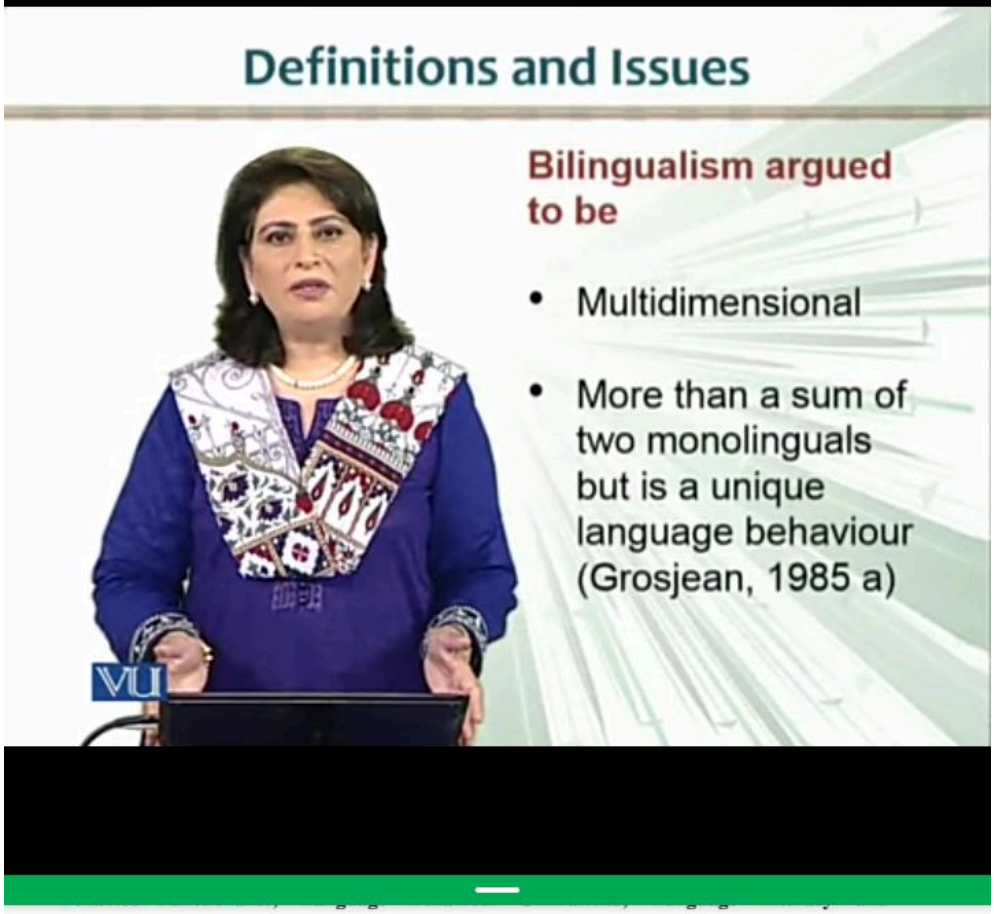

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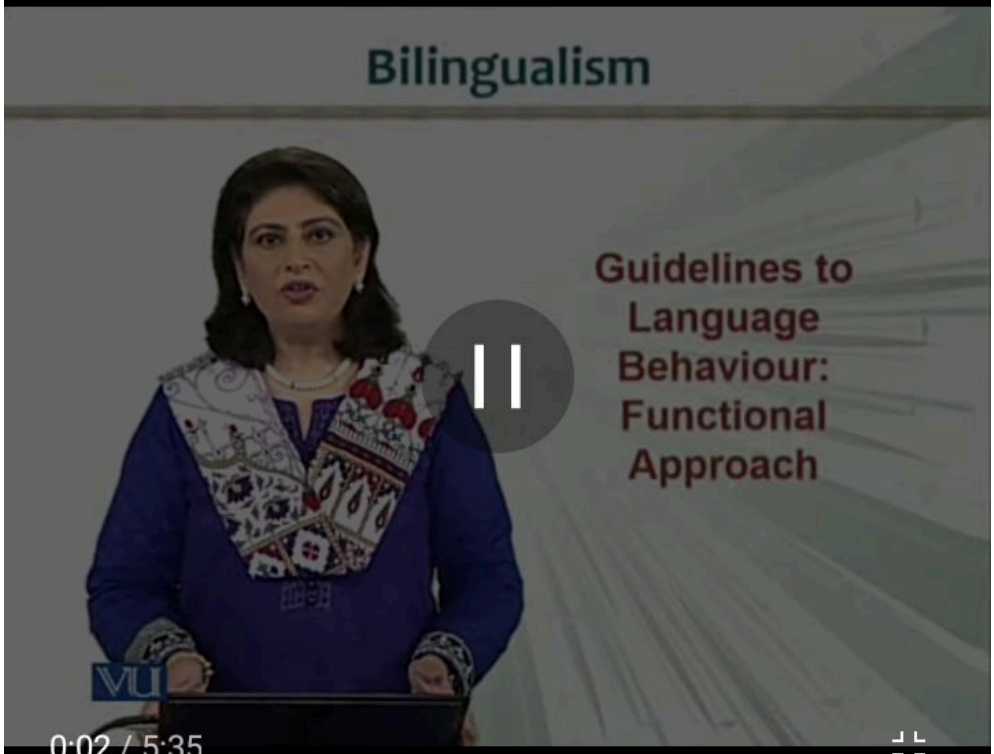

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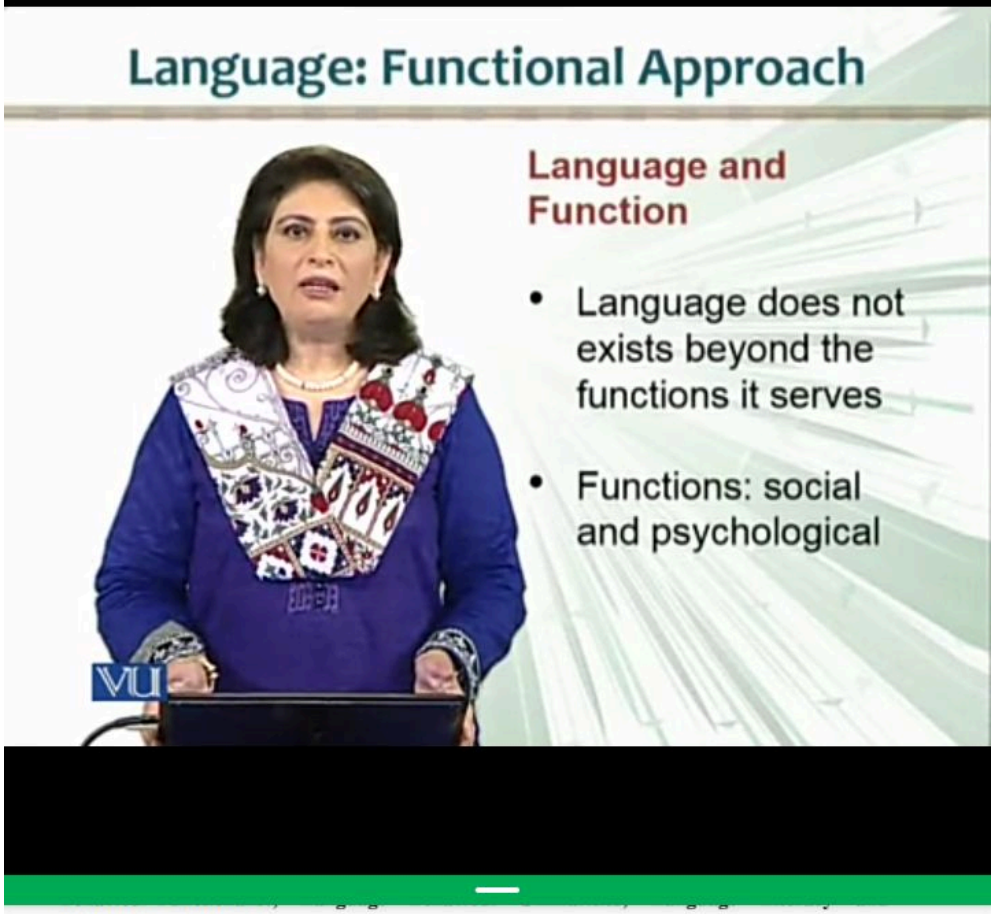

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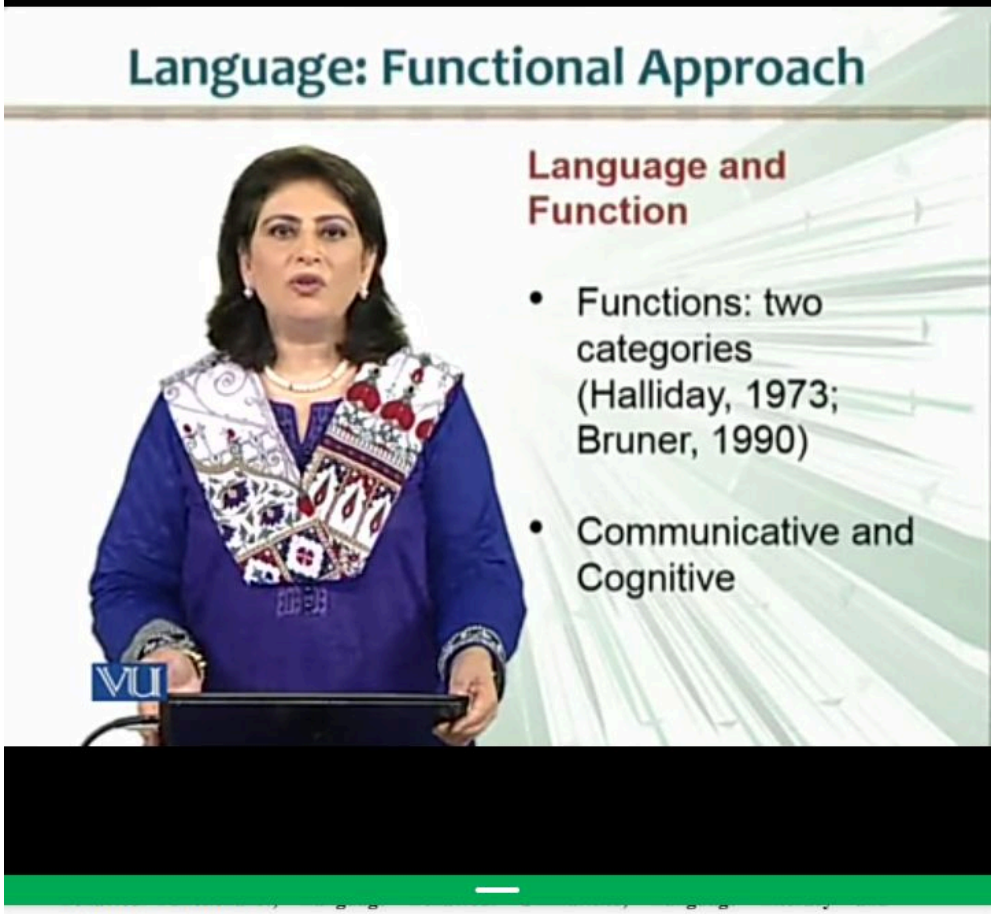

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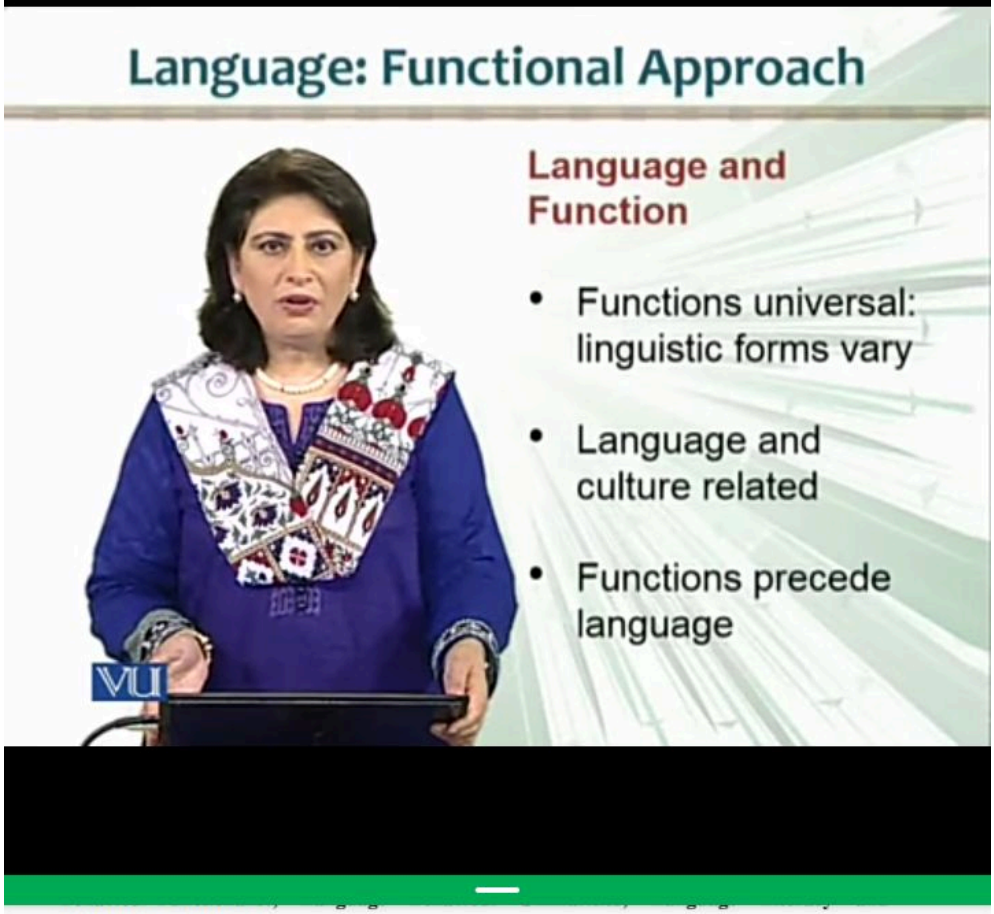

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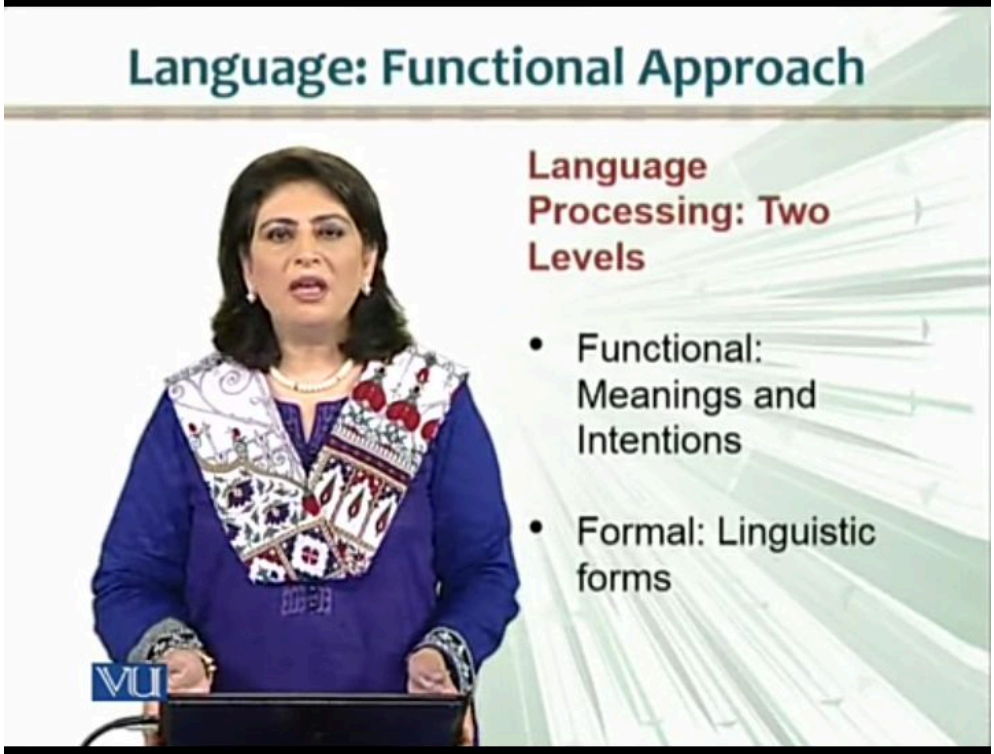

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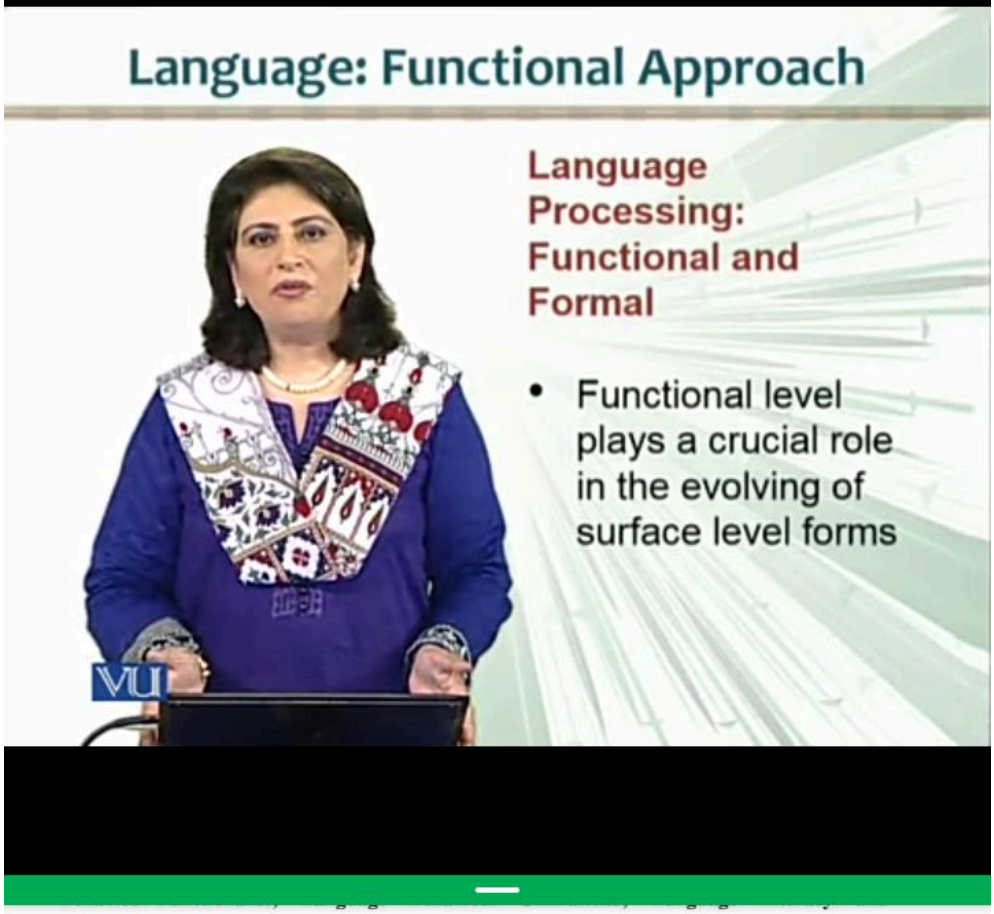

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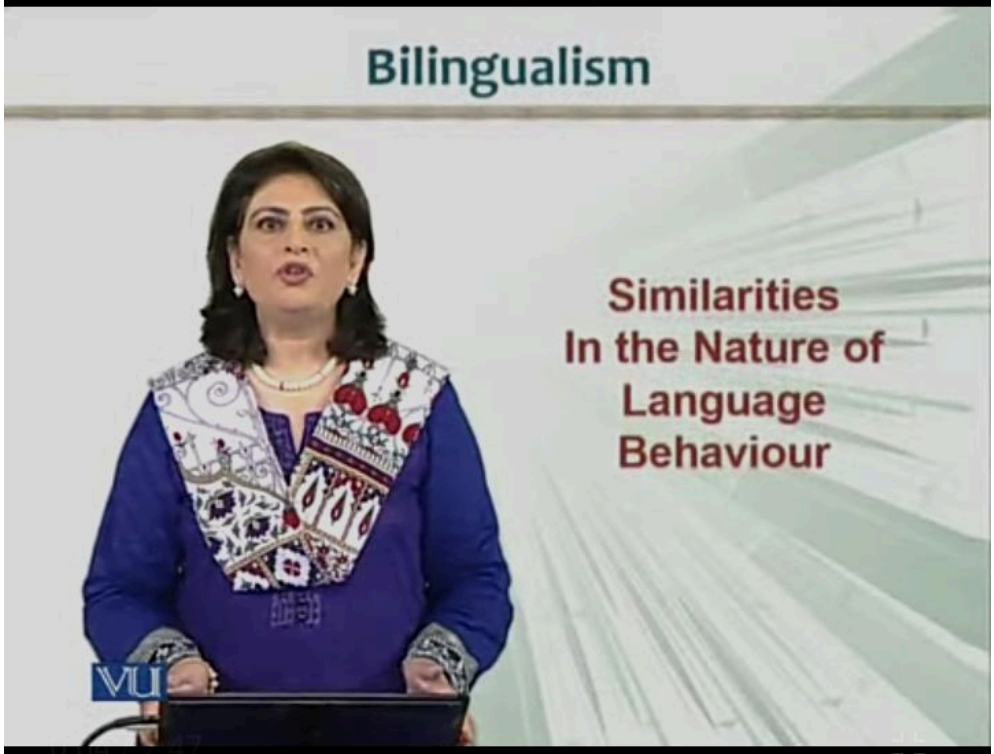

No connection

(4) Self-regulation is a characteristic of all higher-order behaviors and therefore of language behavior. By this we mean that a behavior is not a mere response to stimuli but that it takes into account past experiences; furthermore, it does not follow a pattern of trial and error but is an evaluative response calling upon the individual's cognitive and emotional functioning adapted to a given situation.

(5) Finally, one concept central to this dynamic interaction between the societal level and the individual level is valorization. By valorization we mean the attribution of certain positive values to language as a functional tool, which will facilitate the fulfilment of communicative and cognitive functioning at all societal and individual levels.

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Language and Literacy

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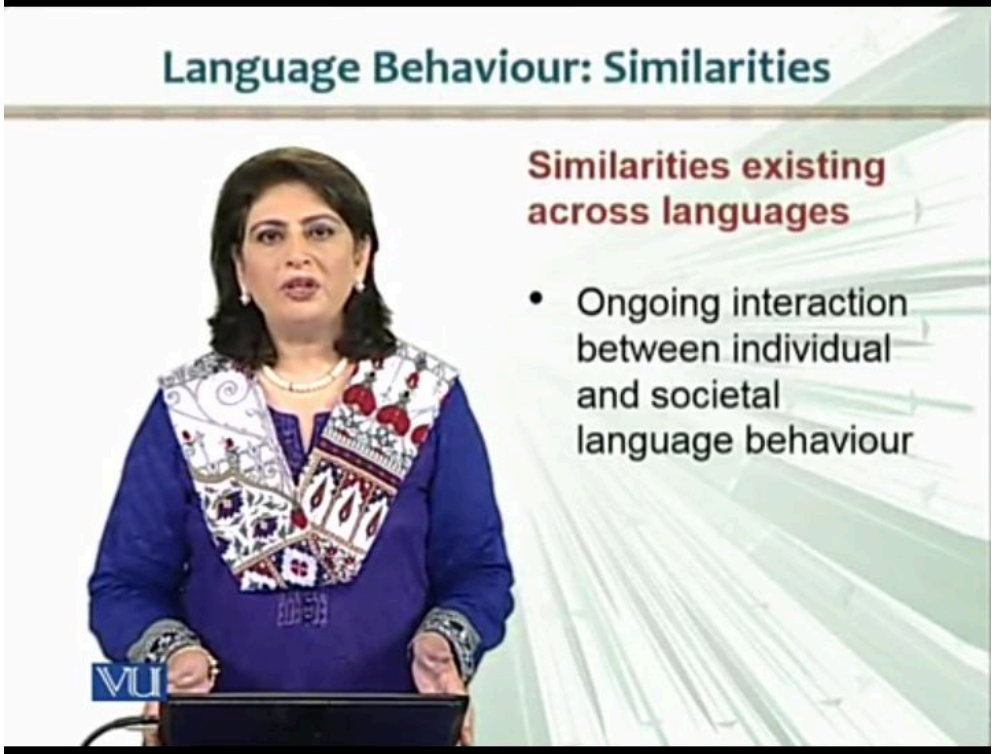

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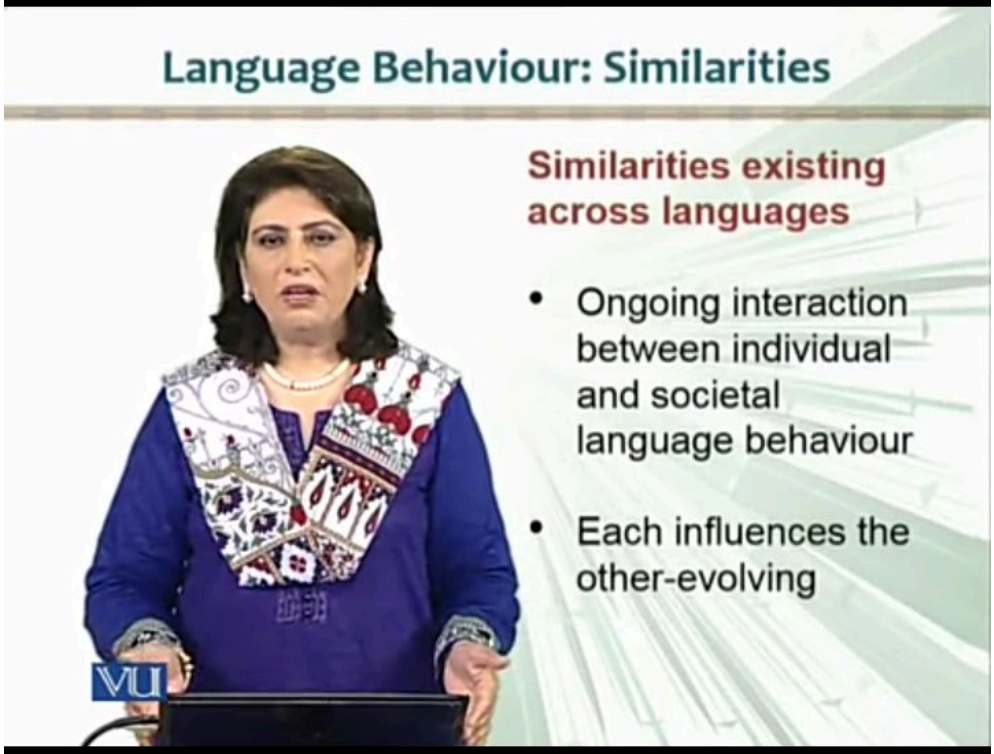

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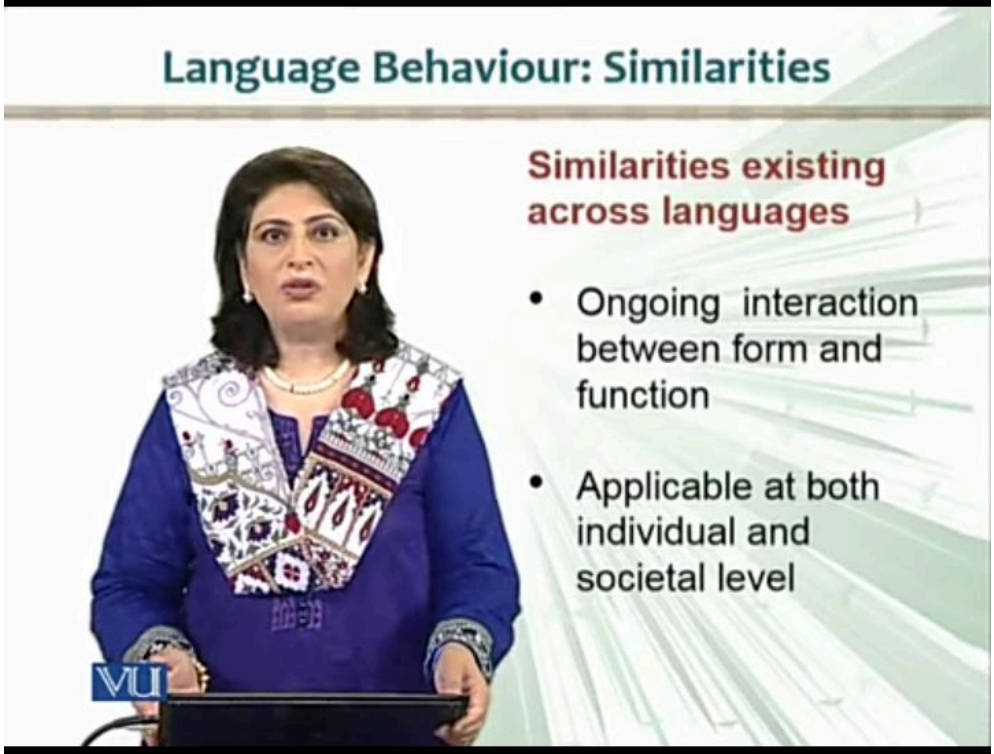

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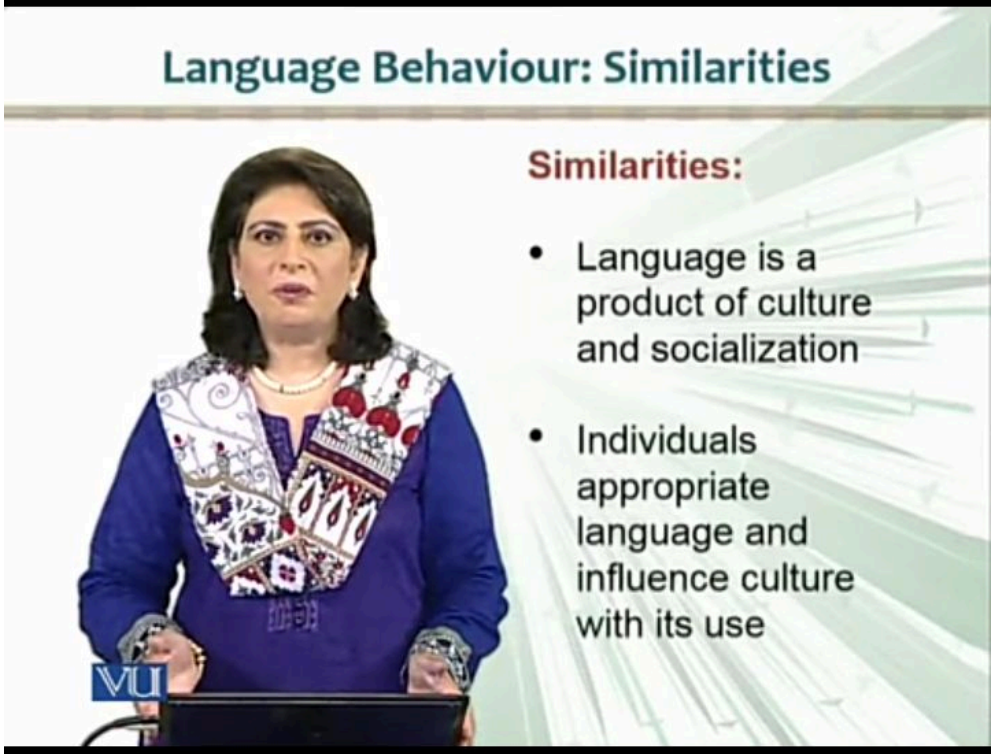

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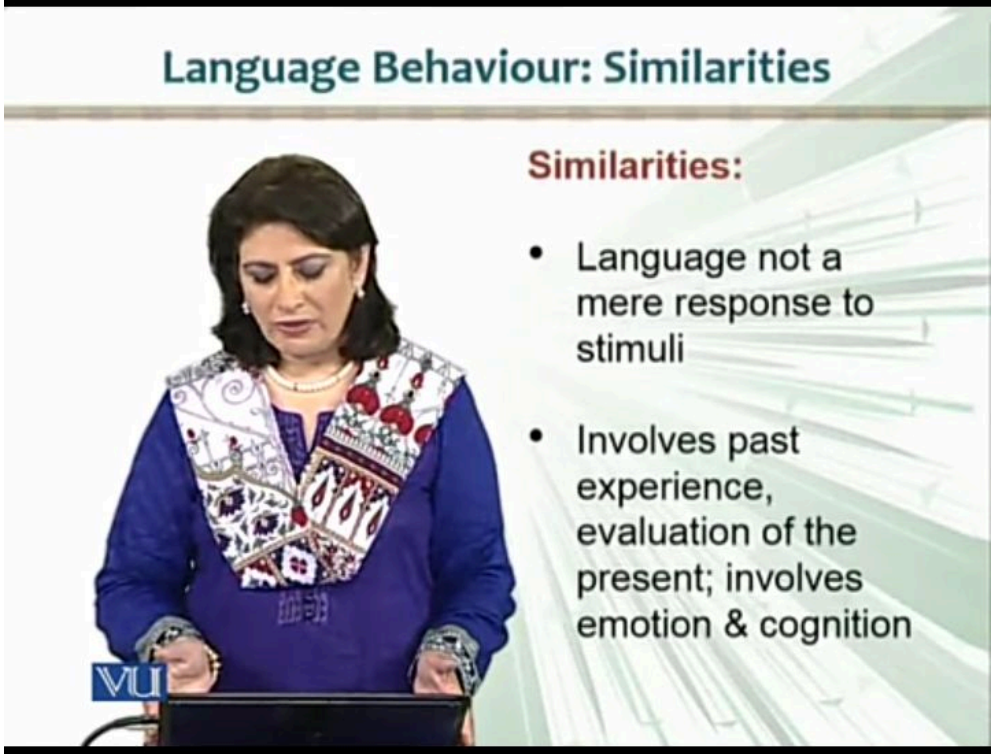

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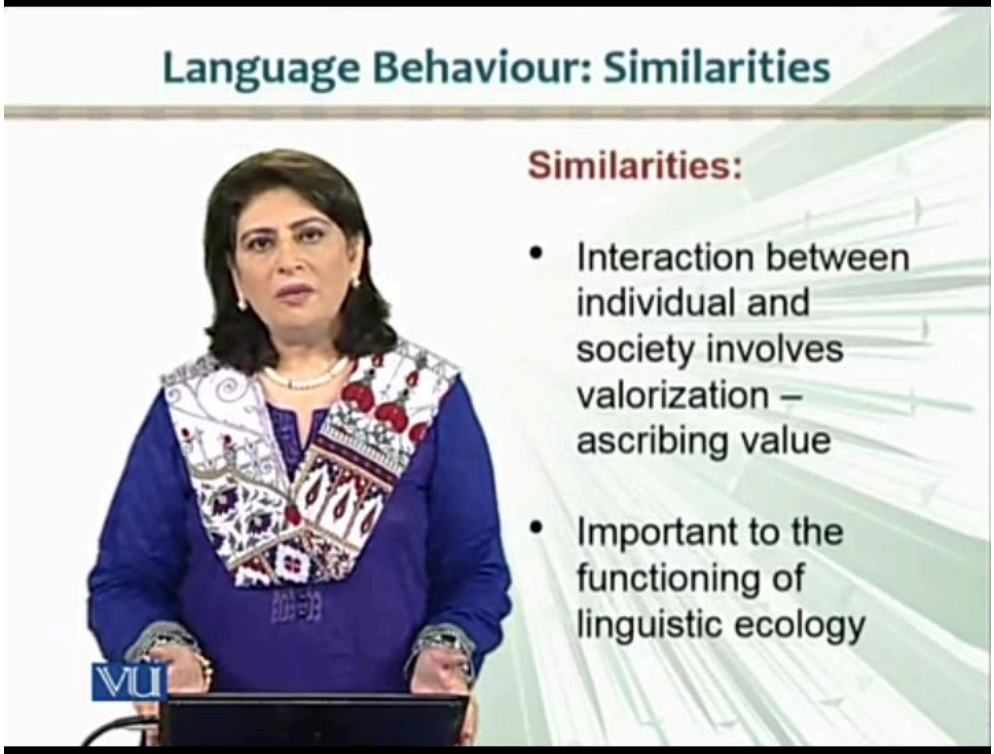

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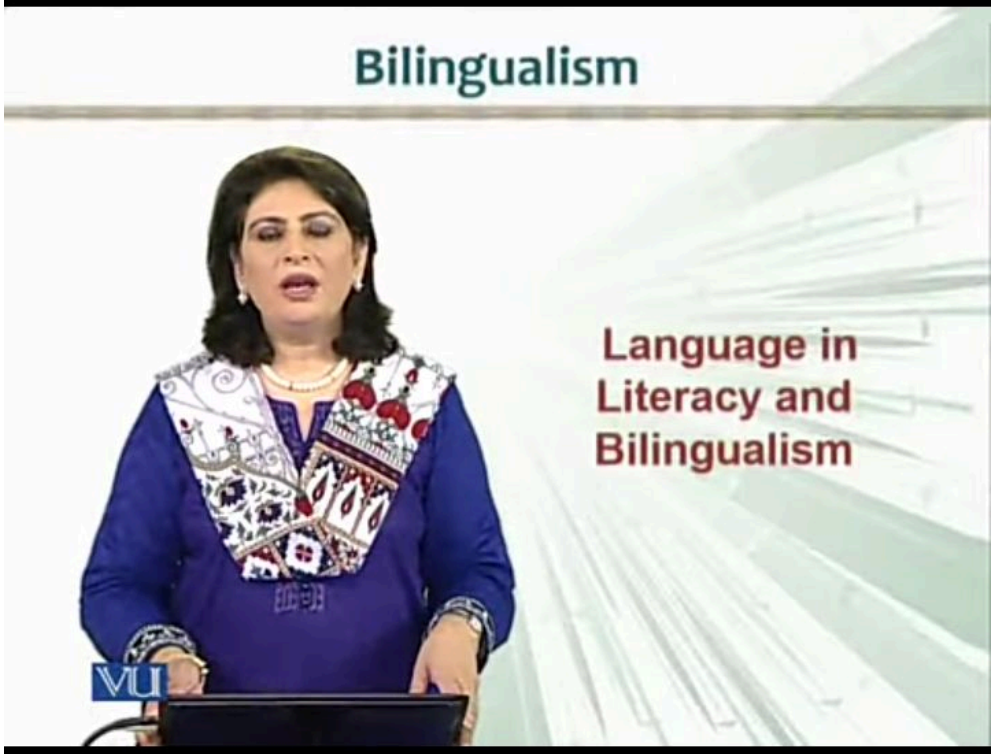

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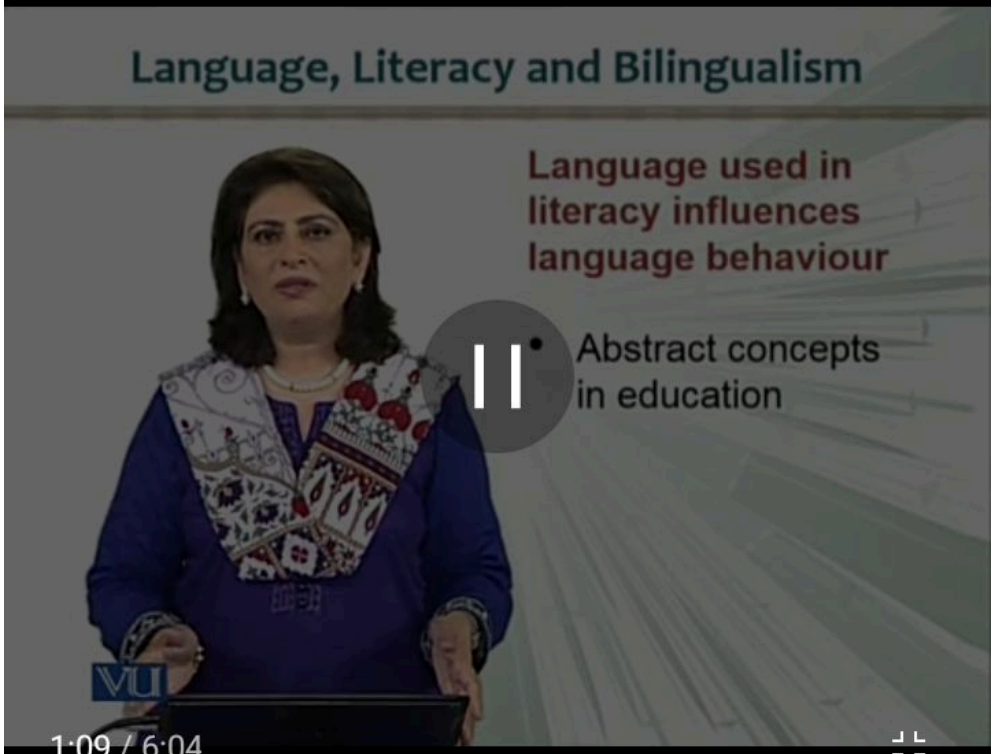

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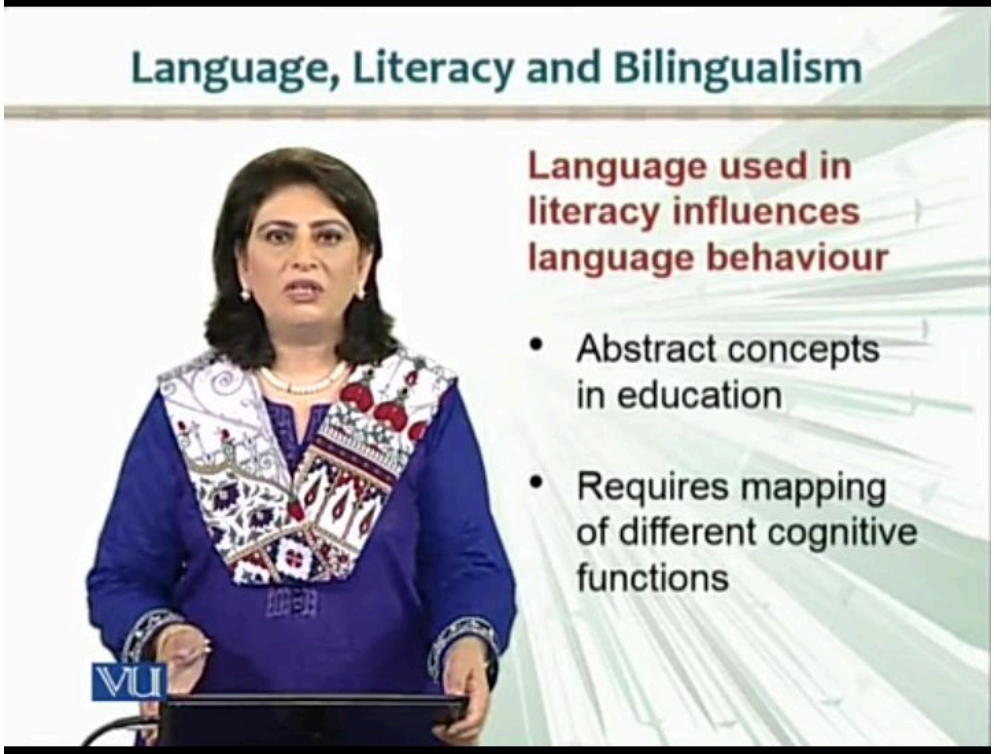

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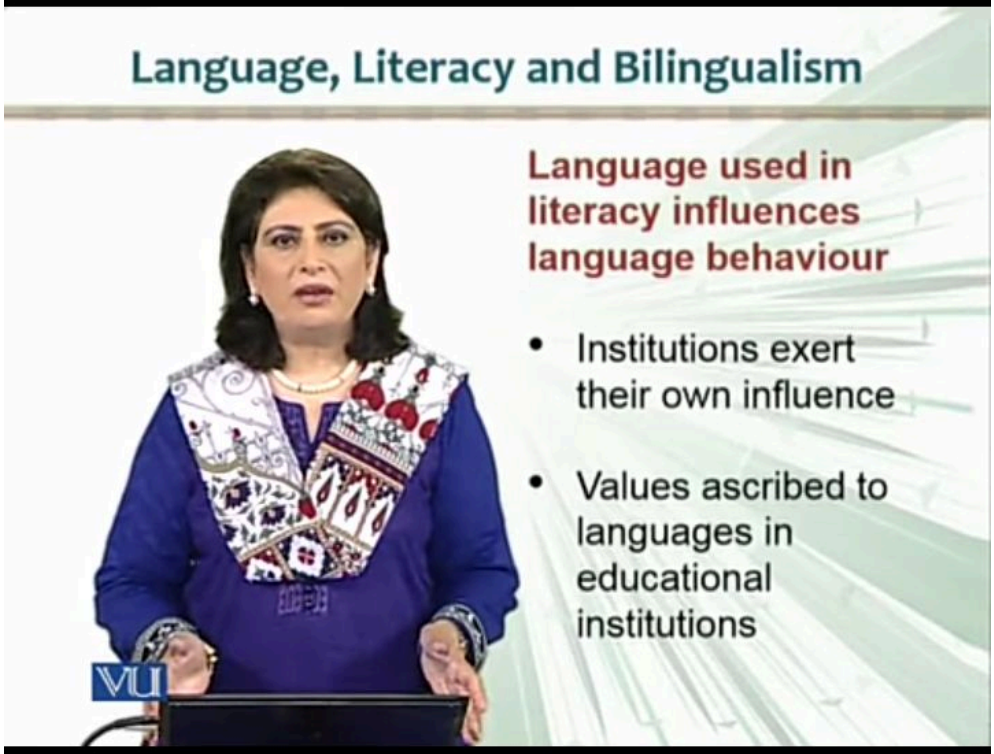

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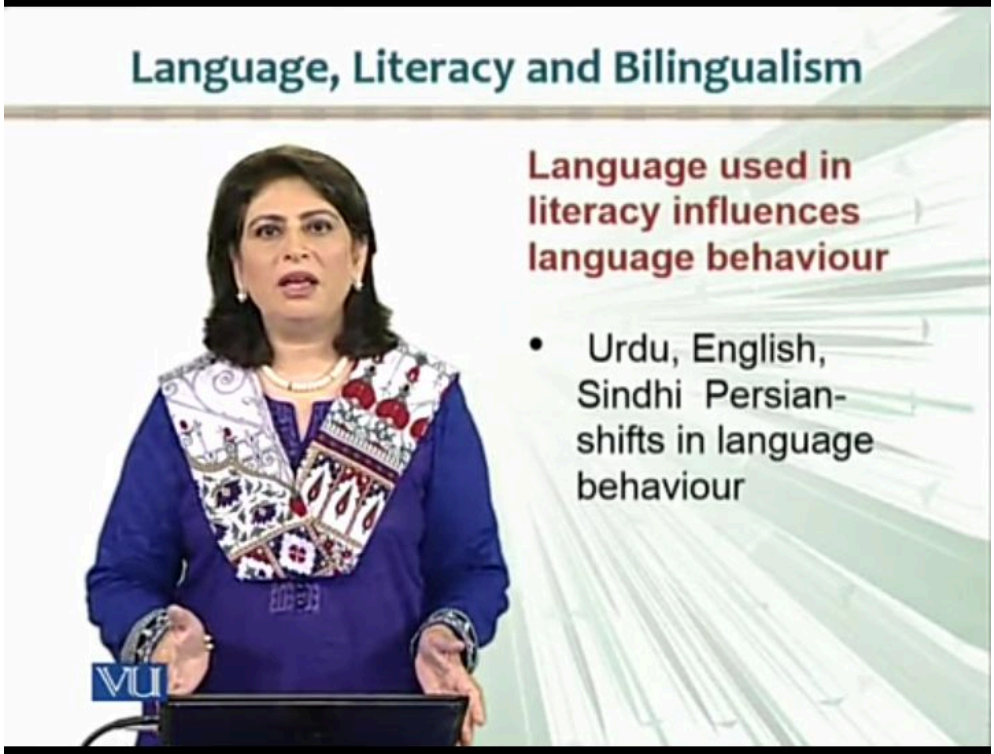

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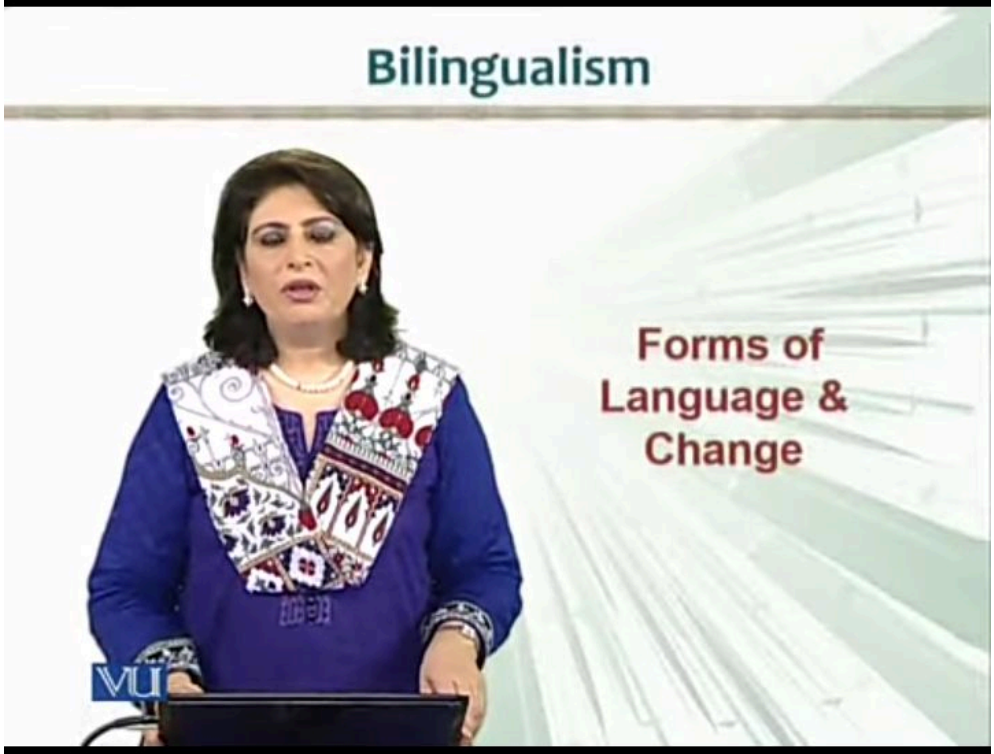

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Topic No 007-011

Language Change; Self-Regulation of Individual Behaviour; Language Change in Society; Development Aspects of Language Behaviour

Language Change

Language is never static but changes over time. Pidginsation is an example in this regard which is developed for the purpose of minimal communication between individuals/ groups speaking mutually unintelligible vernaculars. In the pidginisation process, limited and simplified linguistic forms are developed. As the need for communication or function increases in the society, new forms are created by the speakers. Gradually these new forms serve extended functions until pidgin evolves into a creole (form) as it becomes the mother tongue of the next generation, and thereby serves new functions. The forms of language undergo constant changes due to social changes, emergence of new technologies and contact with other languages. New forms apply to old functions, as when a new expression is used by teenagers; in the same way old forms apply to new functions, as for example; the English word *save* in using a computer; or new forms can be developed for new functions (e.g. new terminology).

Self-regulation

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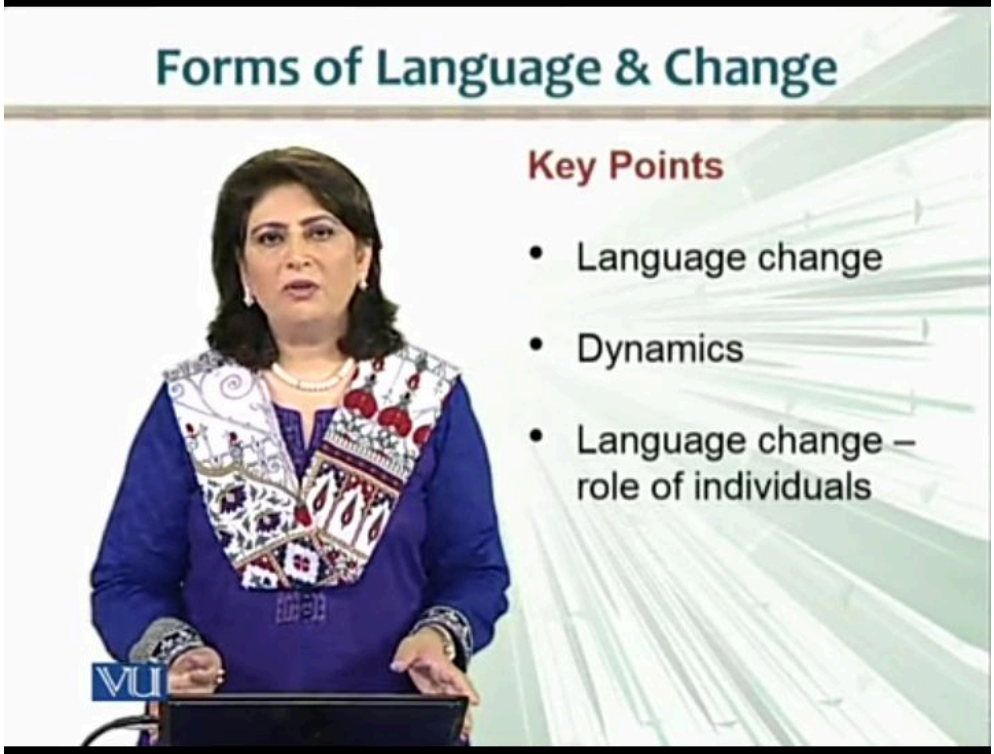

Topic No 007-011

Language Change; Self-Regulation of Individual Behaviour; Language Change in Society; Development Aspects of Language Behaviour

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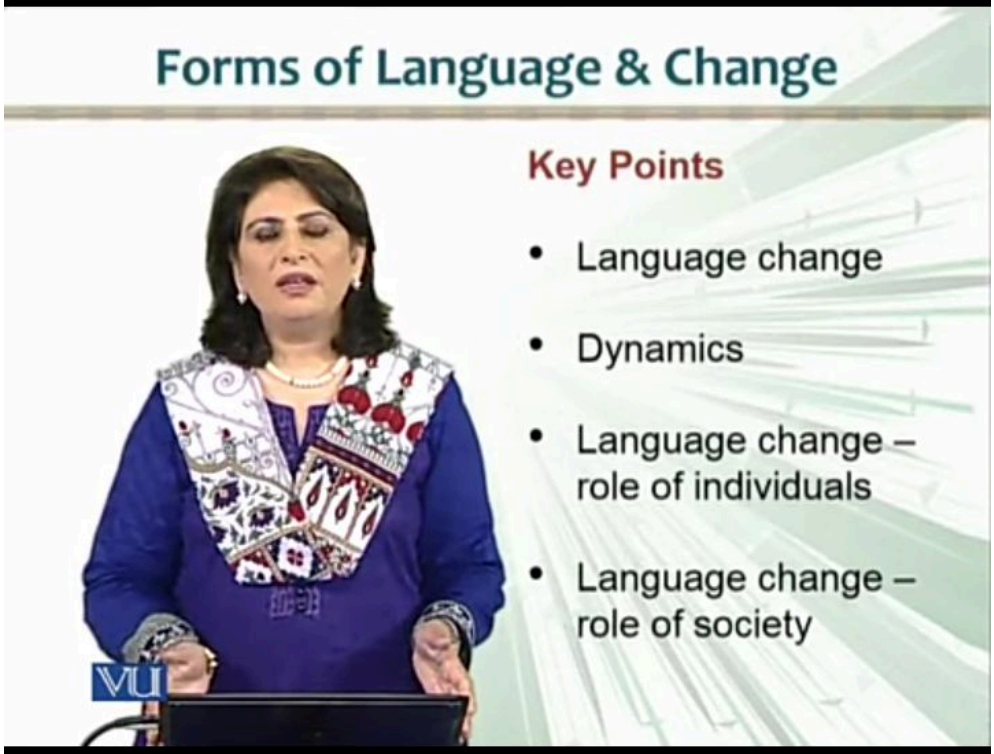

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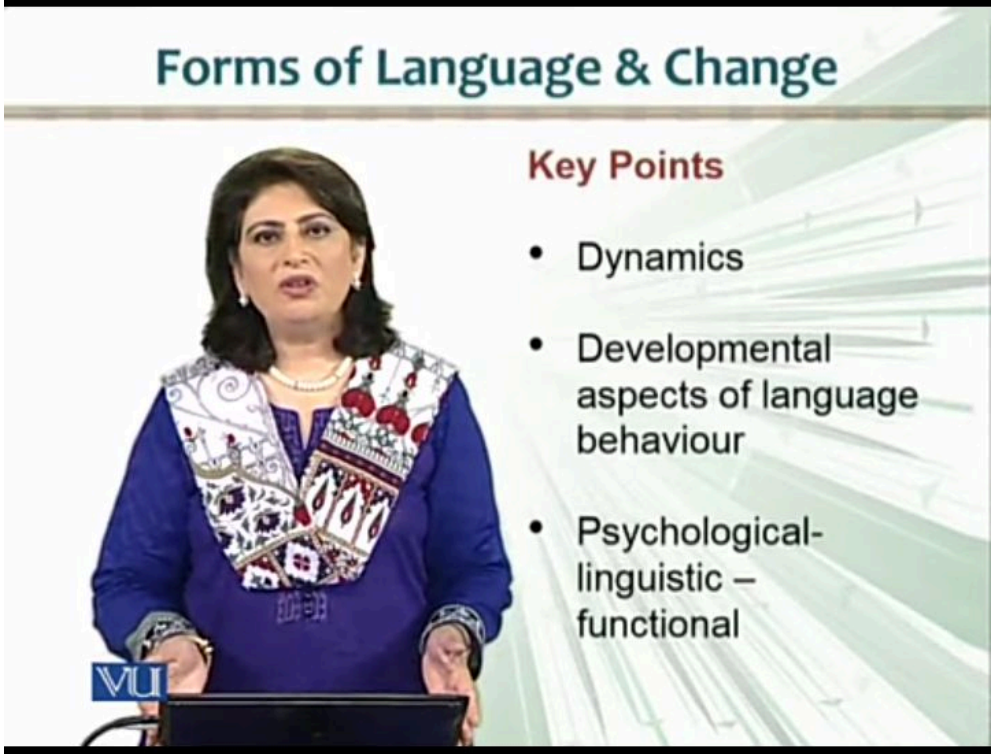

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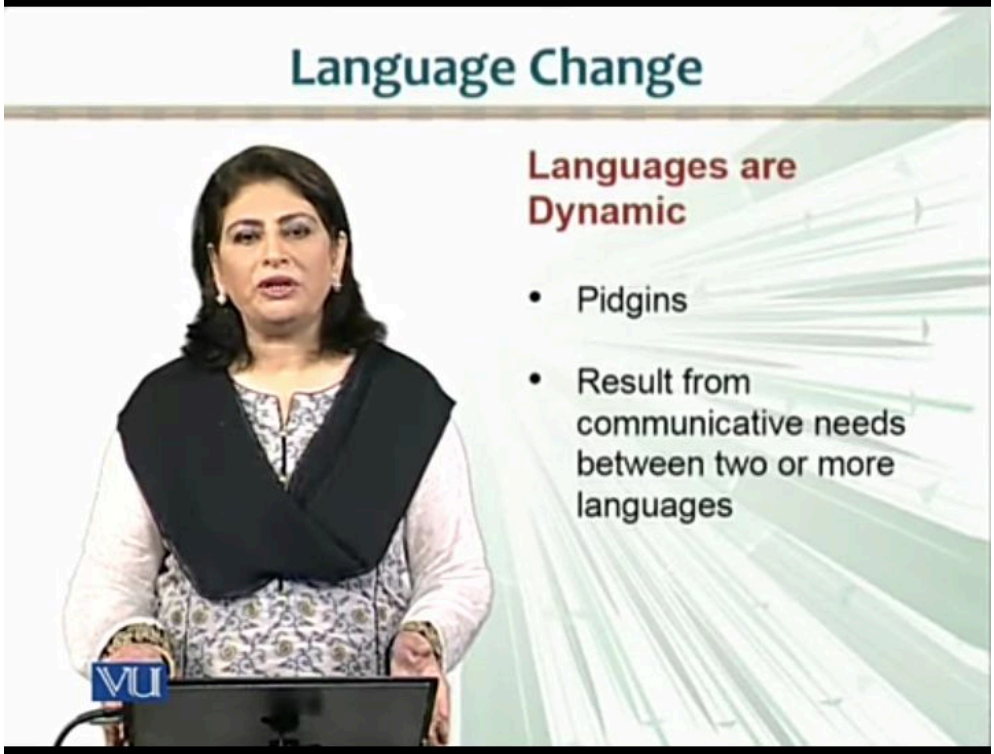

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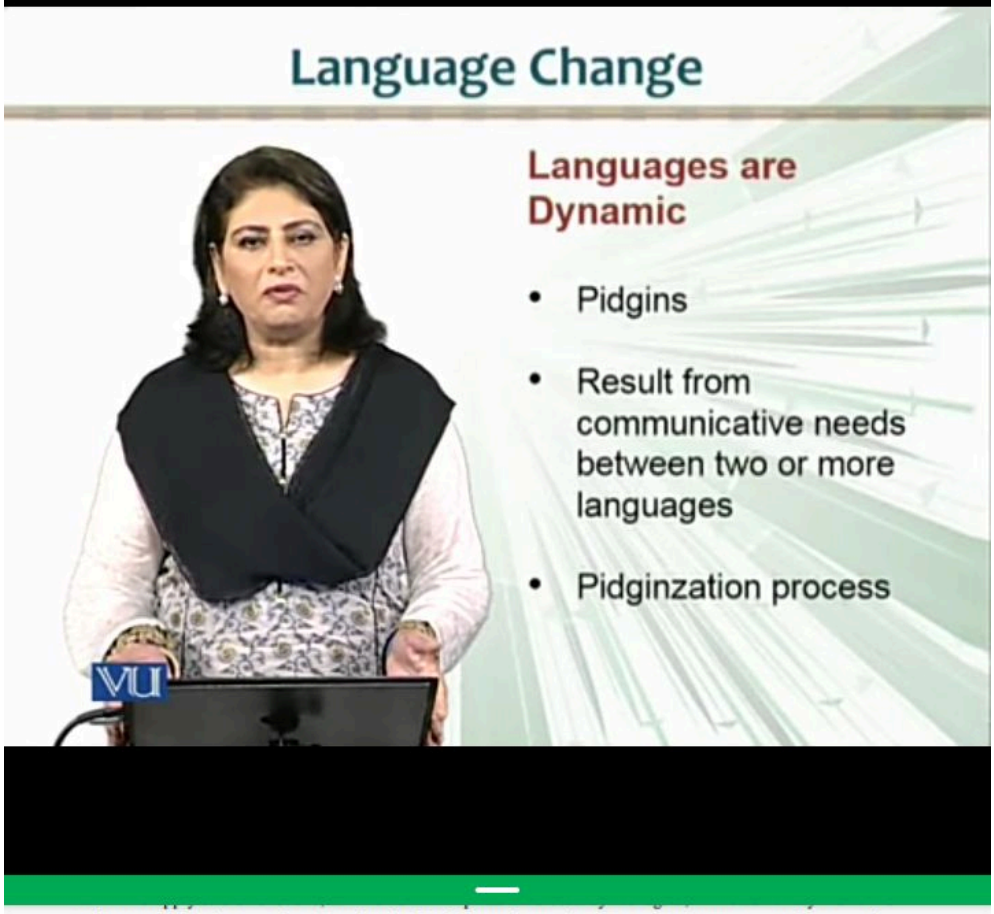

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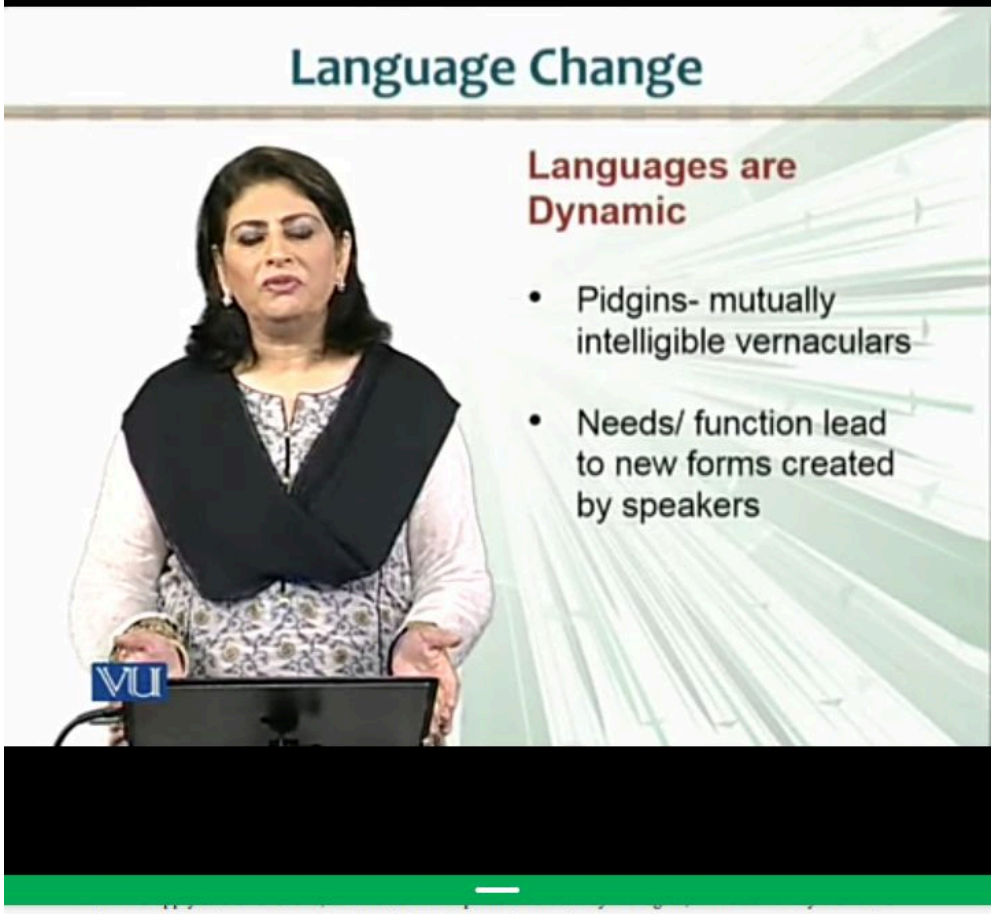

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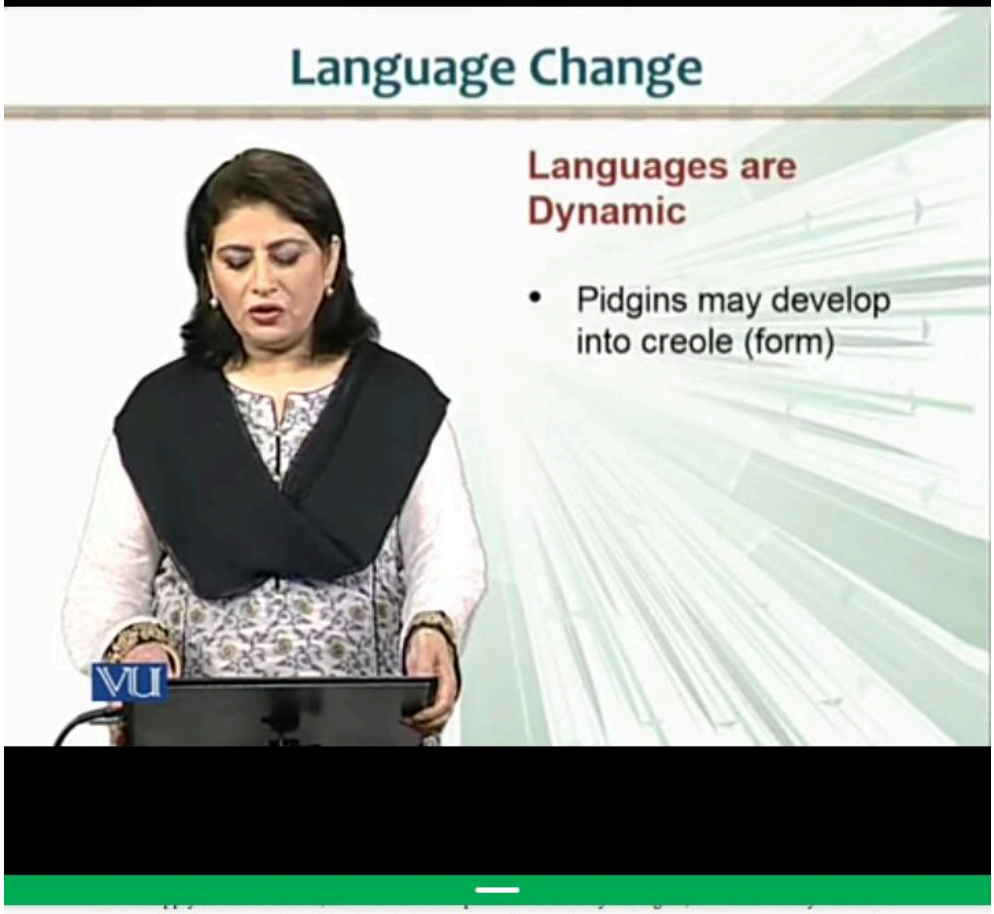

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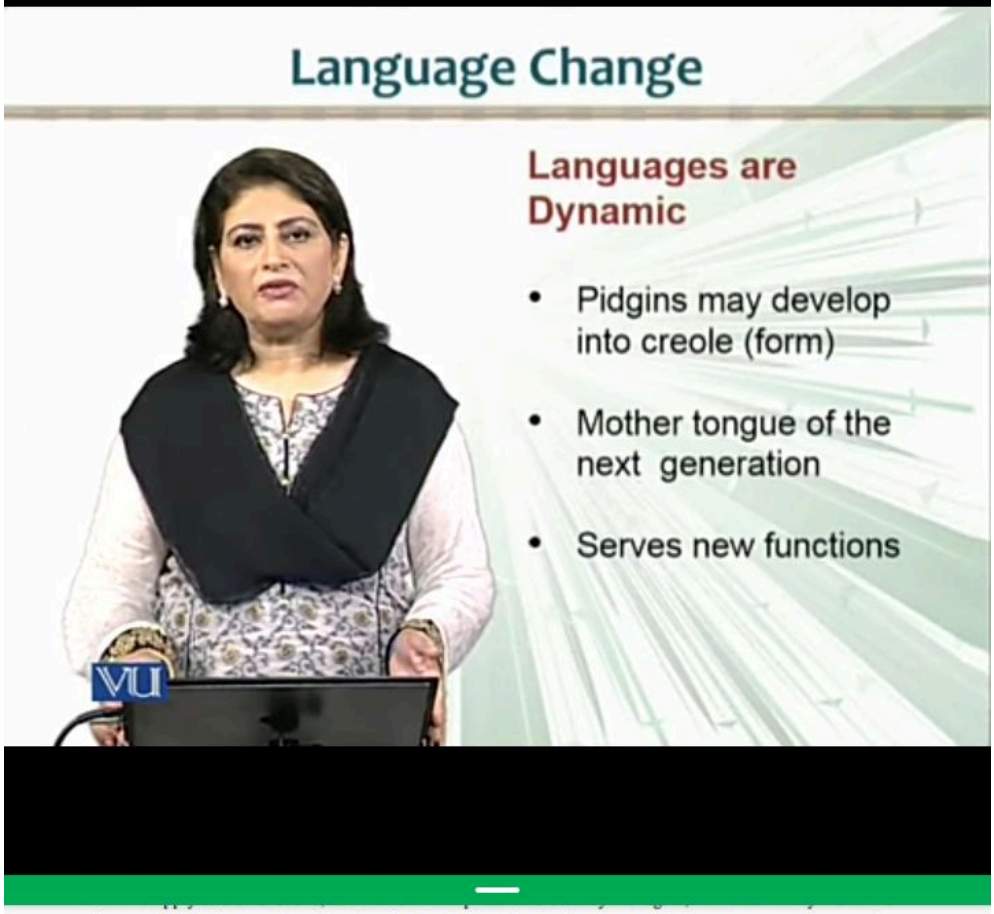

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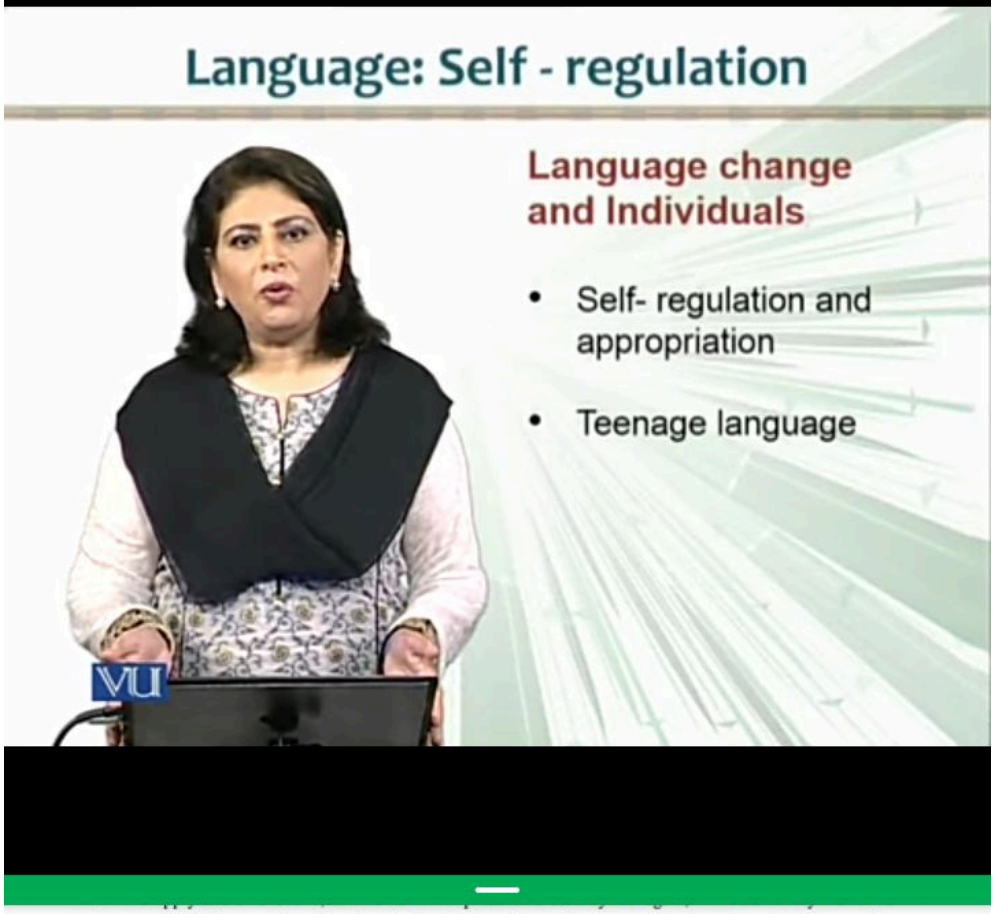

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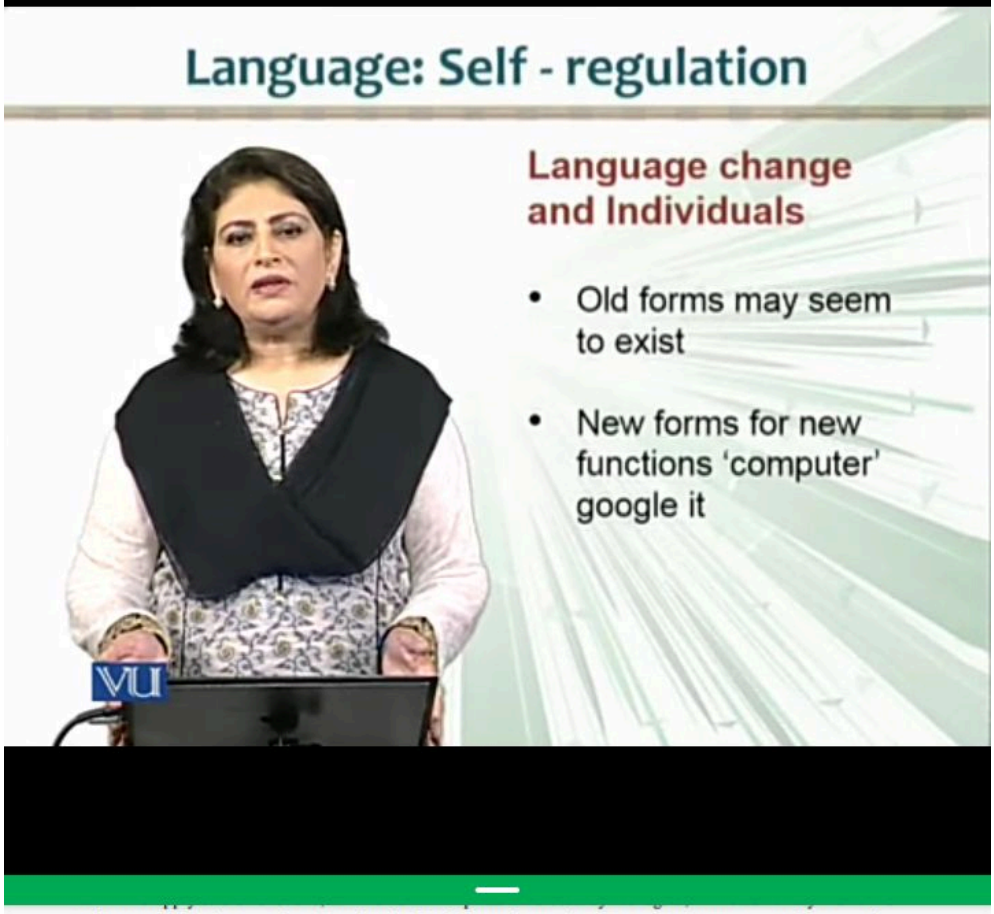

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At the individual level, higher-order behavior is self-regulated. The individual takes into account the feedback mechanisms and readjusts behavior, similar mechanisms occur also at a collective level, for example, in the process of pidginisation.

Language Valorization

Certain functions are valorized more than others, e.g. the cognitive function in school. If different varieties of language, e.g. accents, are present in the society, one variety may be valued to the detriment of others. A similar situation happens in the case of multilingual societies. One or more languages will be highly valued, while others will be devalorized. At the individual level a similar mechanism operates. To the extent that the adults around the child value the use of language for certain functions. The extreme importance of valorization is evidenced at all societal and individual levels. At the societal level, if a minority language is not valorized and used as a tool for education, language attrition and language shift are likely to occur. At individual level, the positive valorization of a language will trigger off a motivational process for learning and using those aspects of language.

To sum up language behavior, we will focus on different societal and individual levels: societal (institutions, groups and social classes), social networks and interpersonal relations, individual (developmental, socio-affective, cognitive and neuropsychological processes as well as language behavior). At each of these levels, language behavior is dynamic: there are constant interactions amongst the determining factors within and between the different levels.

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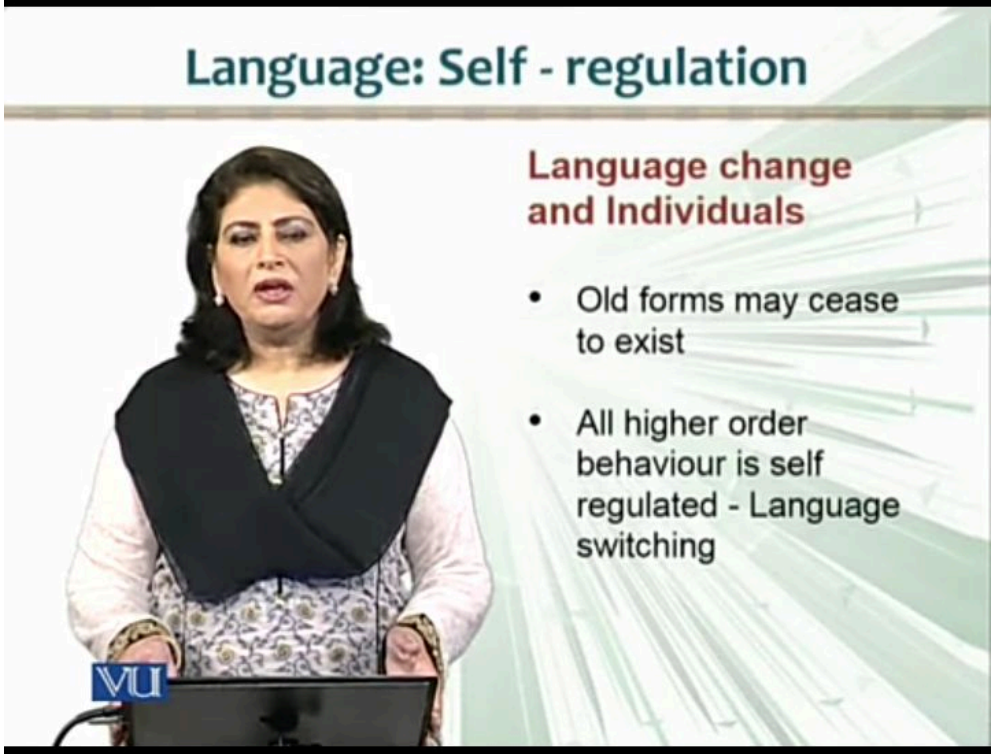

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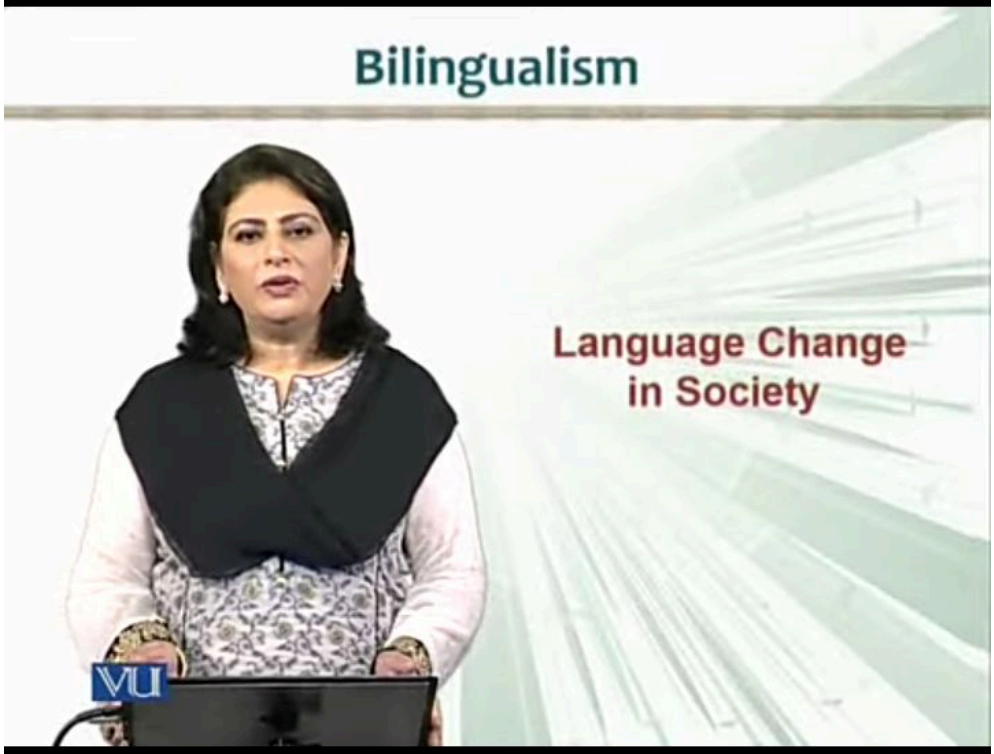

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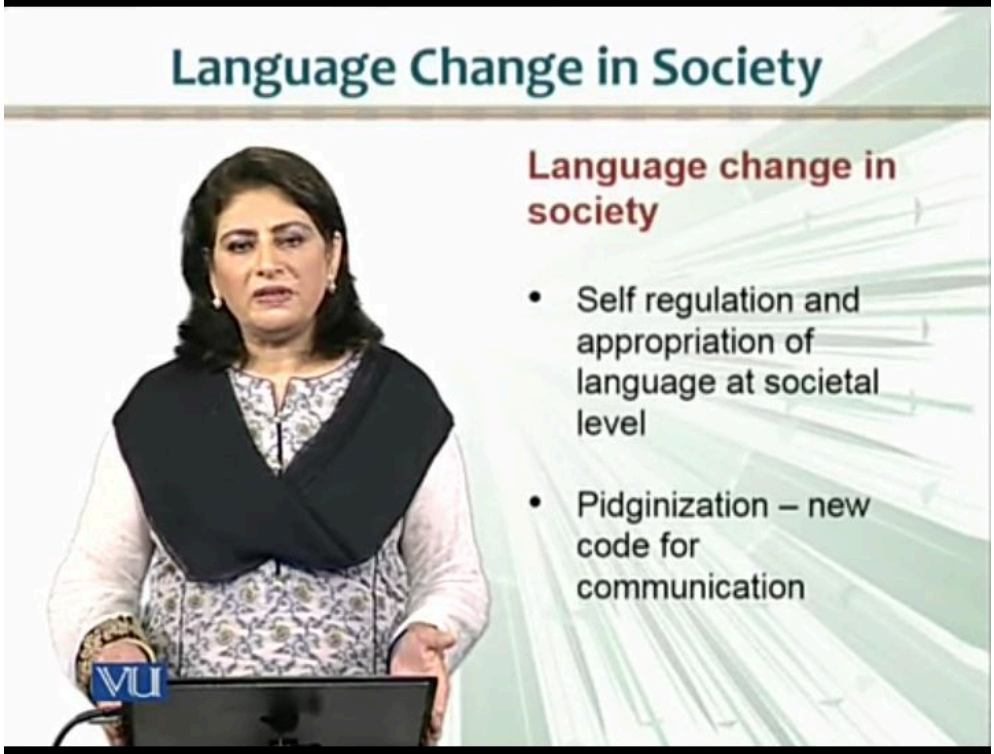

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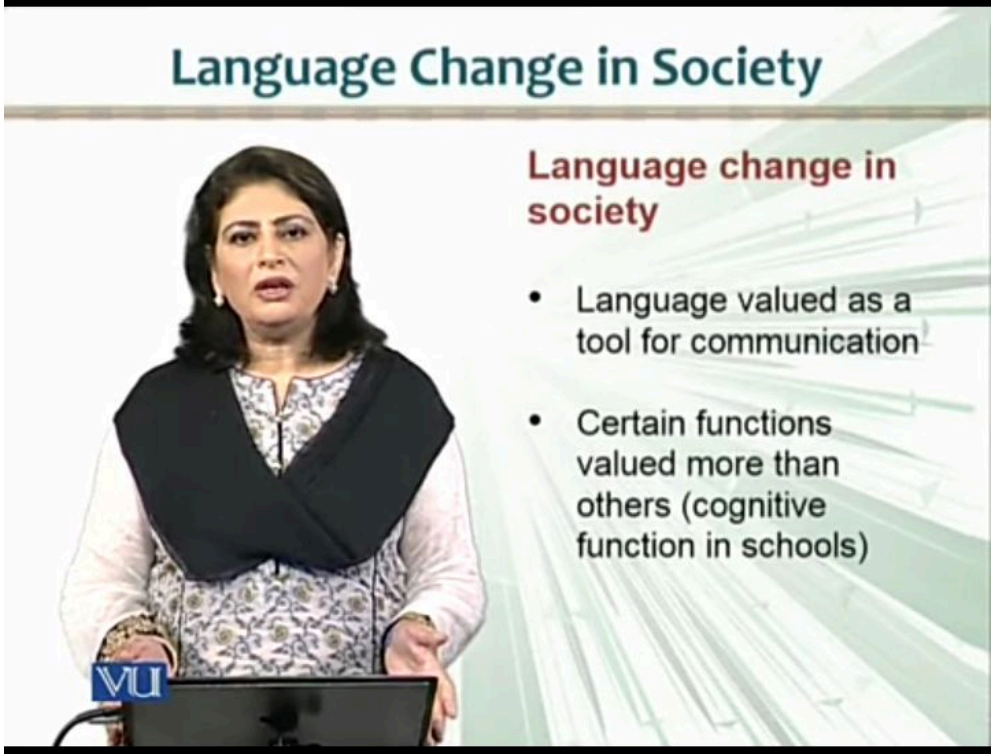

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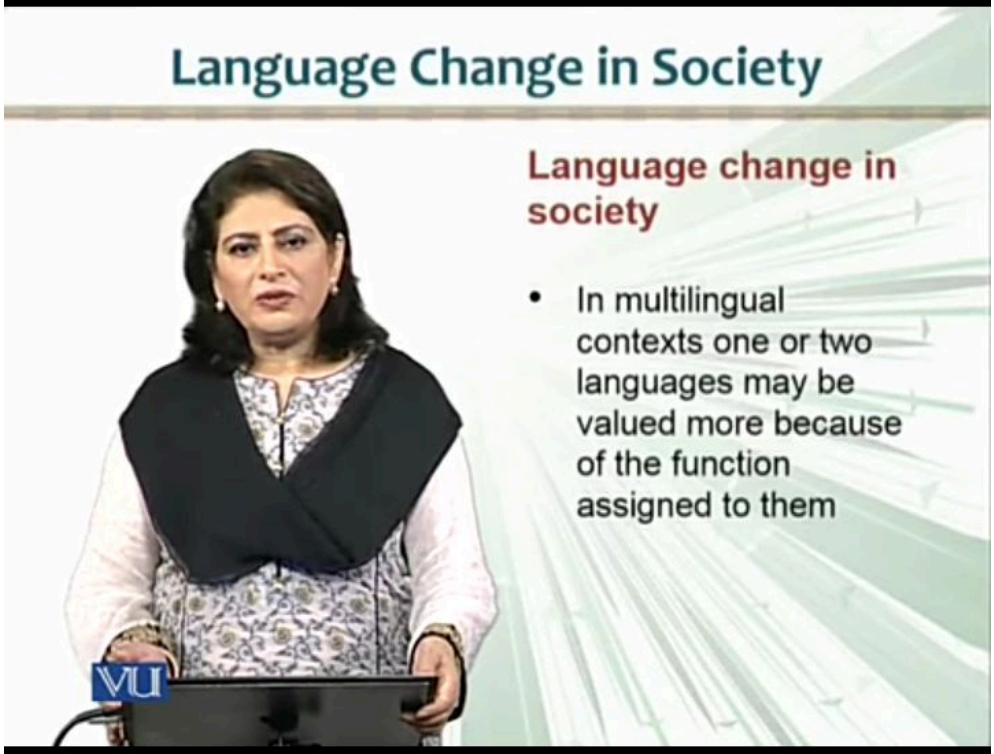

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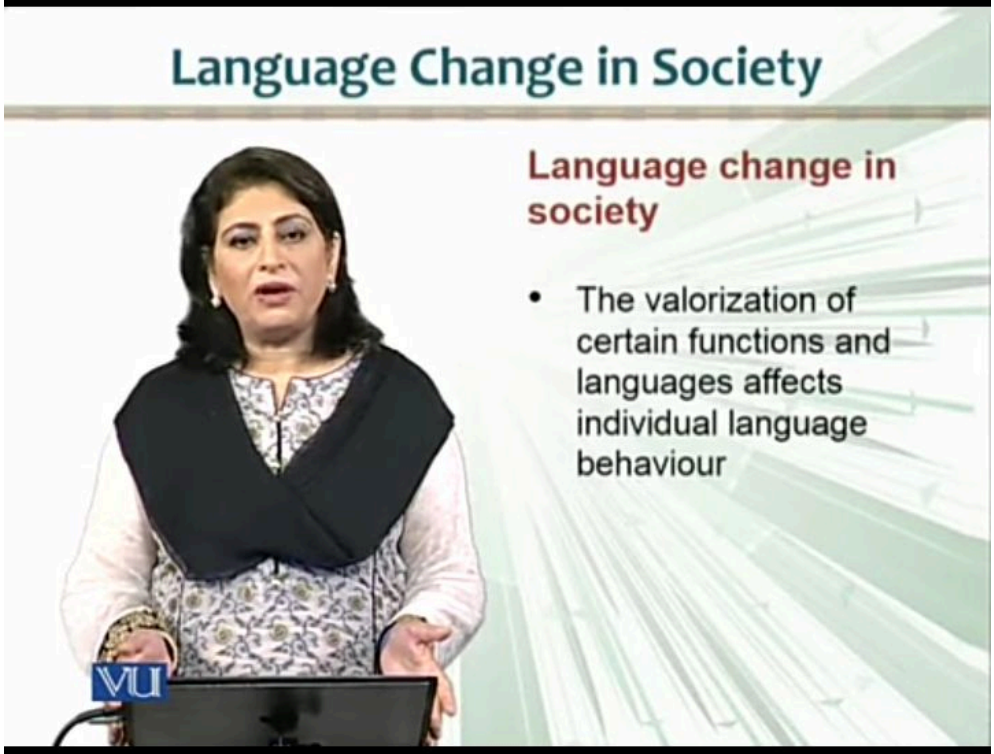

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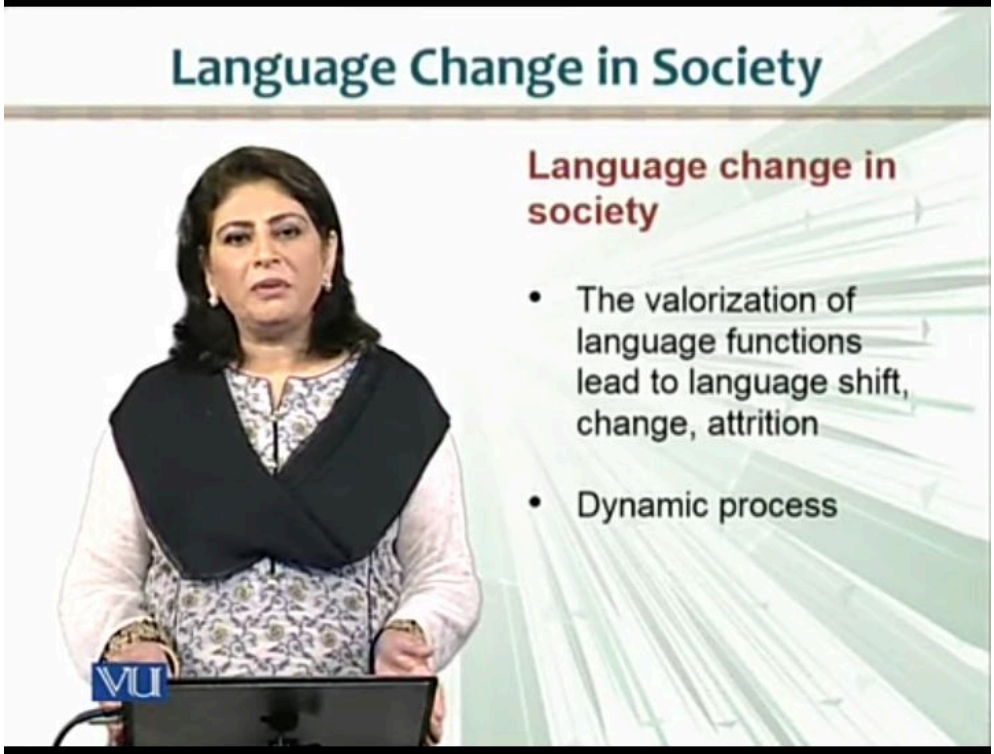

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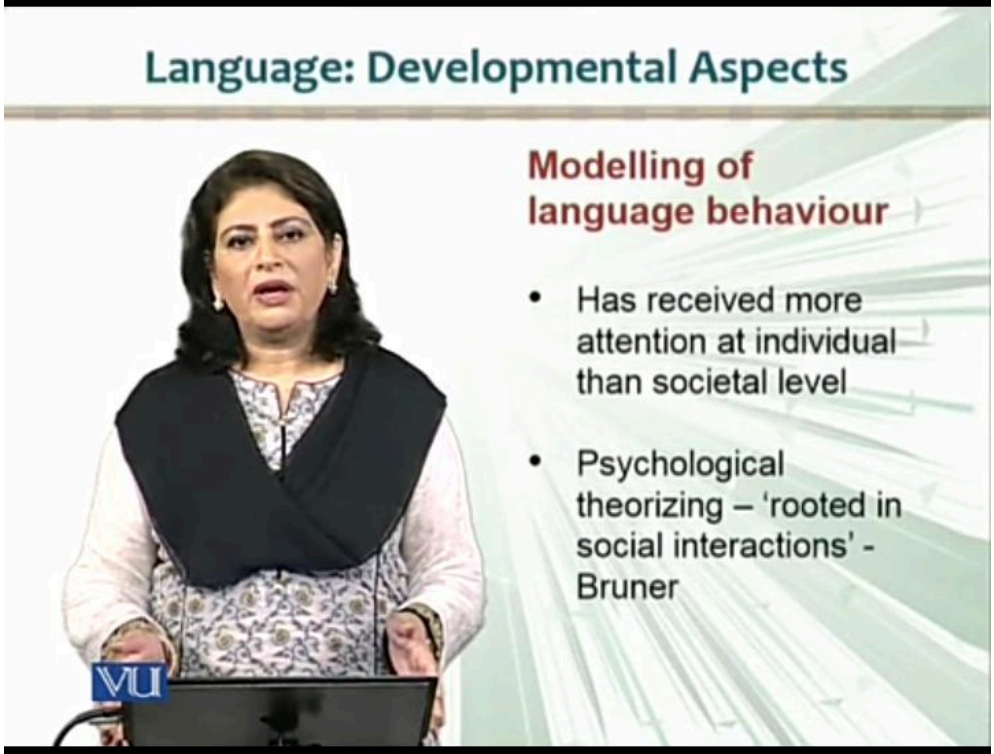

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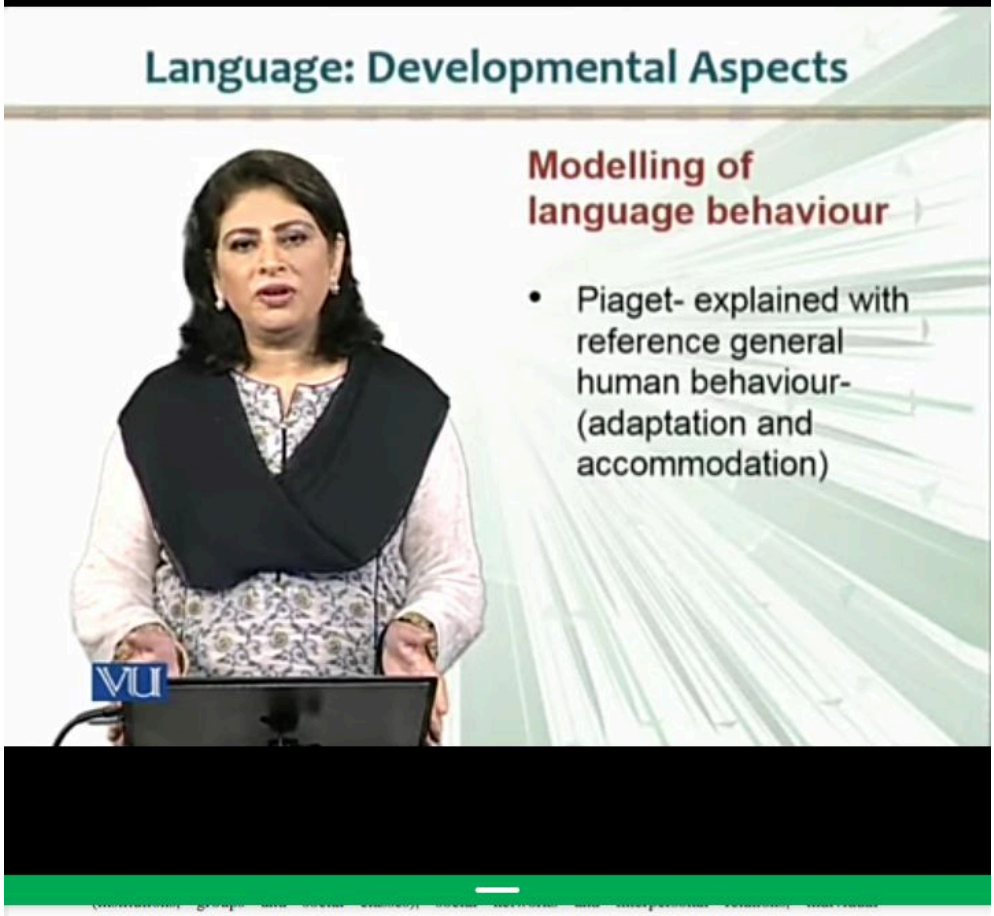

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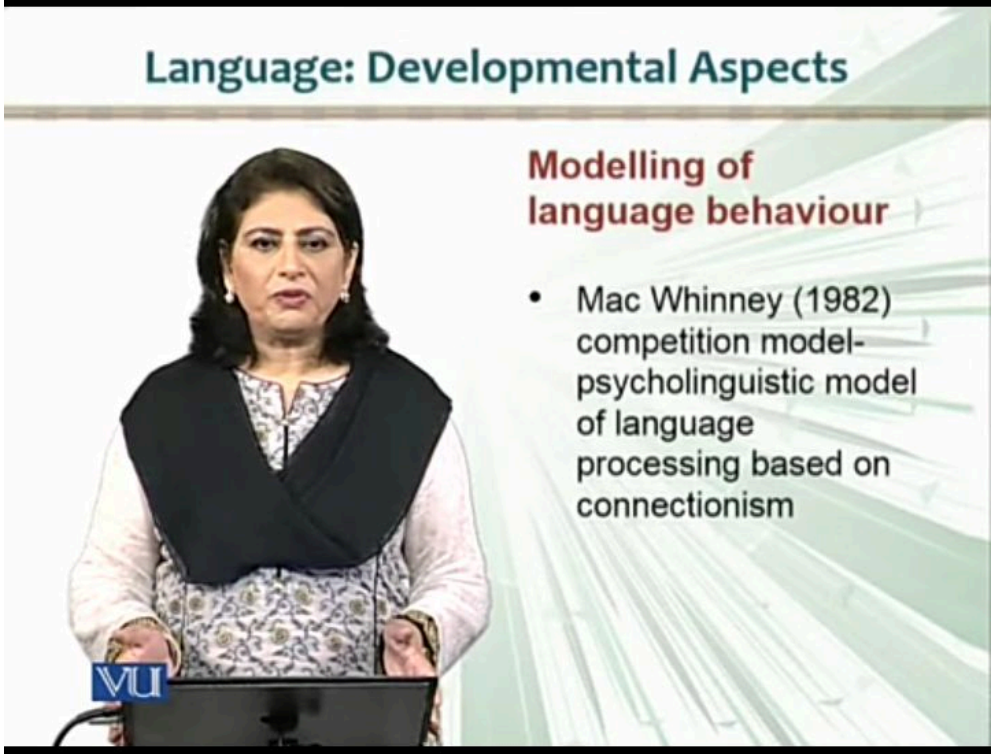

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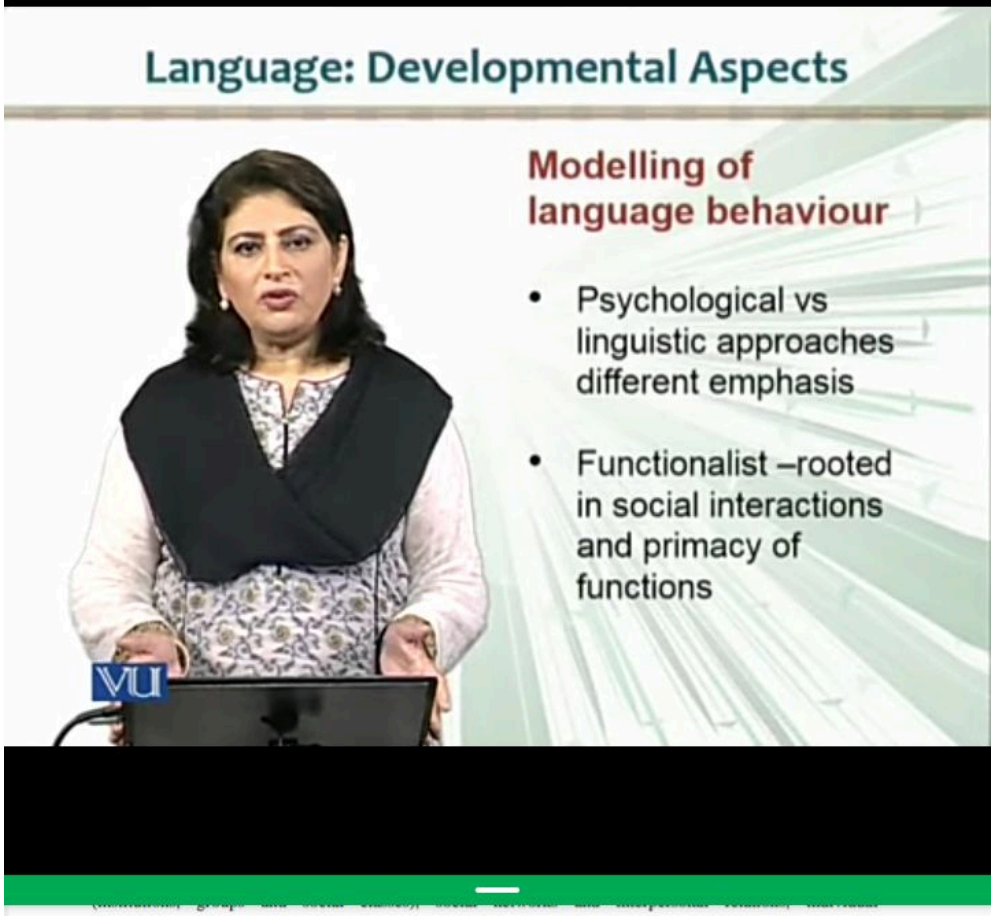

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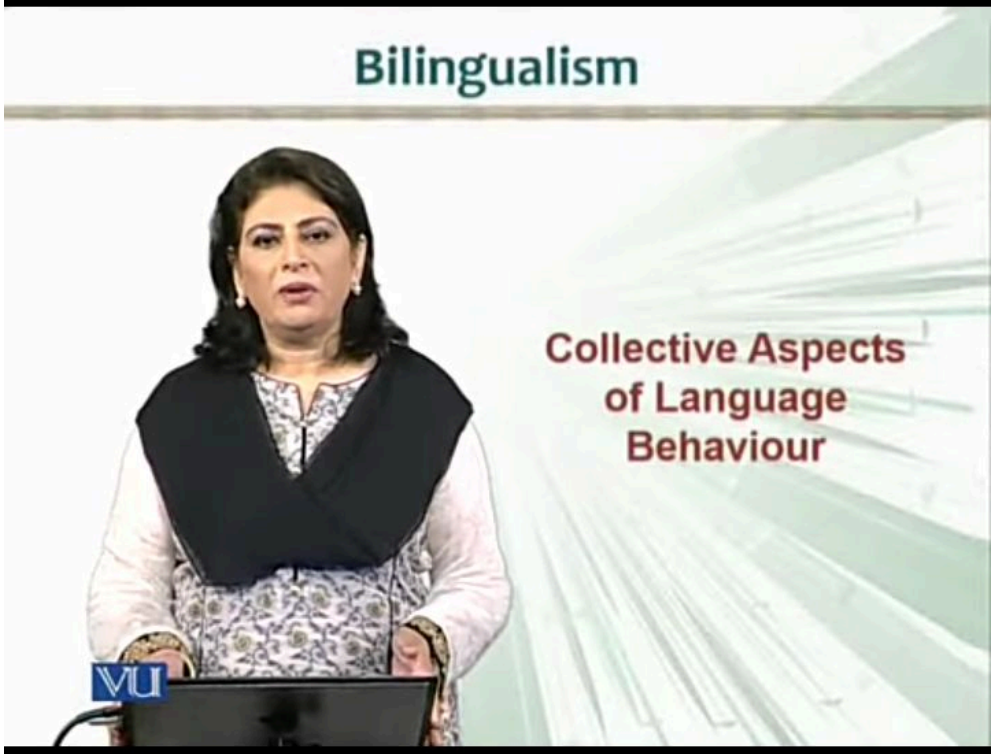

Language-Collective Aspects: Monolingual Situation; Bilingual Situation; Assumption; Social and Psychological Realities

Monolingual Situation

Even in monolingual situation, in addition to its communicative and cognitive functions, language has a social function. By this we mean that any utterance carries a social meaning in that, it reflects the position of its speaker in the power relations in the society which confers a particular social value to this utterance. It can be said that the whole social structure is present in every language interaction and that every interaction is mapped onto the social structure. Languages and varieties of language (accents, dialects, sociolects, and codes) have a recognized value on the linguistic market (Bourdieu, 1982) and can be placed on a hierarchical scale. Variations in discourse (i.e. in language behavior) are a result of the interplay between the ob... forces of the market and the way in which the individual perceives, evaluates and responds

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Different language varieties and their values are learned in particular markets. The s... networks influence the individual's language behaviour and group solidarity can lead to the ... local, non-standard norms, and resistance to linguistic change; whereas a loose and simplex network can lead to change in language (Milroy, 1980).

Bilingual Situation

When two or more languages are in contact, their relative functional use and relative valorization is very important. A state of functional equilibrium may also exist. In the case of diglossia, different use of each language is determined at the societal level. In that case we have a predictable form—function mapping. However, if the equilibrium is disrupted at one level, it will disrupt the equilibrium at all other levels. A change in the relative use of the two languages in the social networks, e.g. when the individual has a new network because of a job change, will inevitably provoke a change in the language behaviour of the individual. A change in the use of two languages at the societal level, for example, introducing a compulsory language of schooling, will bring about a change in the use of language in the social network, hence in the interpersonal interactions and the language behaviour of the individual. When enough individuals start changing their language behaviour (e.g. using French instead of English), this will in turn modify language use.

Language shift is defined as the change from the use of one language to the use of another language across generations; language attrition is a shift occurring within one individual. In both cases, it refers to the loss of functions, forms and language skills. The shift is complete when parents of one generation cease to transmit their language to their children and when the latter are no longer motivated to acquire an active competence in that language. Language behaviour is based on the following five principles:

(1) There is a constant interaction between the societal and the individual dynamics of language.

(2) There are complex mapping processes between the form of language behaviour and the functions it serves.

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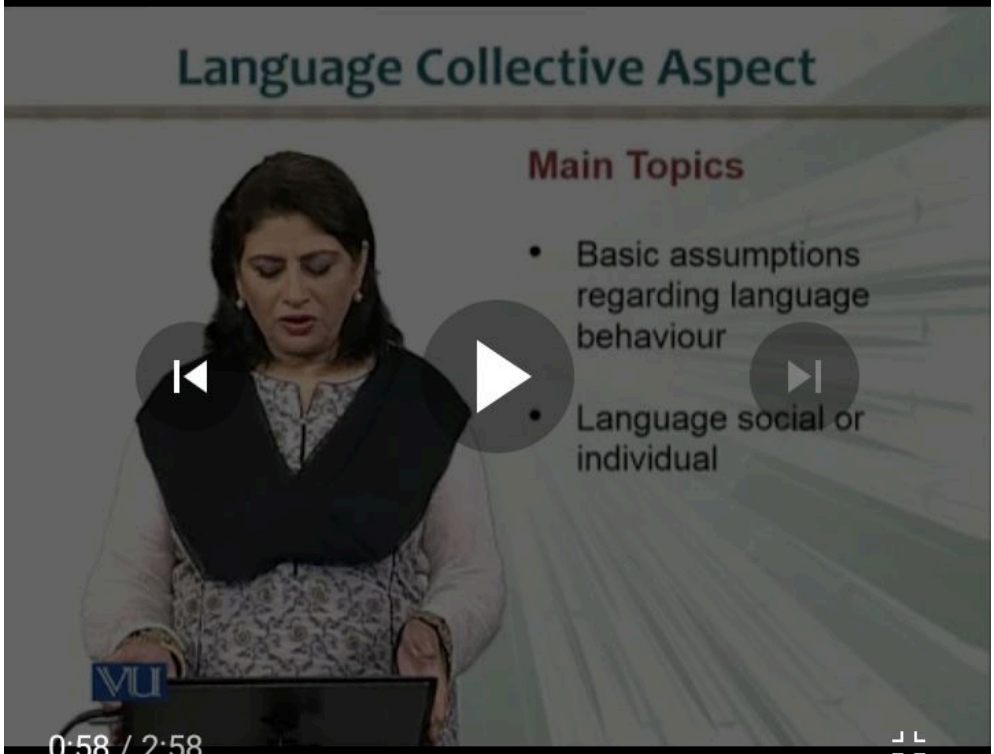

ENG512 Handouts...

Monolingual Situation

Even in monolingual situation, in addition to its communicative and cognitive functions, language has a social function. By this we mean that any utterance carries a social meaning in that, it reflects the position of its speaker in the power relations in the society which confers a particular social value to this utterance. It can be said that the whole social structure is present in every language interaction and that every interaction is mapped onto the social structure. Languages and varieties of language (accents, dialects, sociolects, and codes) have a recognized value on the linguistic market (Bourdieu, 1982) and can be placed on a hierarchical scale. Variations in discourse (i.e. in language behavior) are a result of the interplay between the objective dynamic forces of the market and the way in which the individual perceives, evaluates and responds to these forces.

Different language varieties and their values are learned in particular markets. The structures of social networks influence the individual's language behaviour and group solidarity can lead to the maintenance of local, non-standard norms, and resistance to linguistic change; whereas a loose and simplex network can lead to change in language (Milroy, 1980).

Bilingual Situation

When two or more languages are in contact, their relative functional use and relative valorization is very important. A state of functional equilibrium may also exist. In the case of diglossia, different use of each language is determined at the societal level. In that case we have a predictable form—function mapping. However, if the equilibrium is disrupted at one level, it will disrupt the equilibrium at all other levels. A change in the relative use of the two languages in the social networks, e.g. when the individual has a new network because of a job change, will inevitably provoke a change in the language behaviour of the individual. A change in the use of two languages at the societal level, for example, introducing a compulsory language of schooling, will bring about a change in the use of language in the social network, hence in the interpersonal interactions and the language behaviour of the individual. When enough individuals start changing their language behaviour (e.g. using French instead of English), this will in turn modify language use.

Language shift is defined as the change from the use of one language to the use of another language across generations; language attrition is a shift occurring within one individual. In both cases, it refers to the loss of functions, forms and language skills. The shift is complete when parents of one generation ce
transmit their language to their children and when the latter are no longer motivated to acquire a
competence in that language. Language behaviour is based on the following five principles:

(1) There is a constant interaction between the societal and the individual dynamics of language.

(2) There are complex mapping processes between the form of language behaviour and the fun
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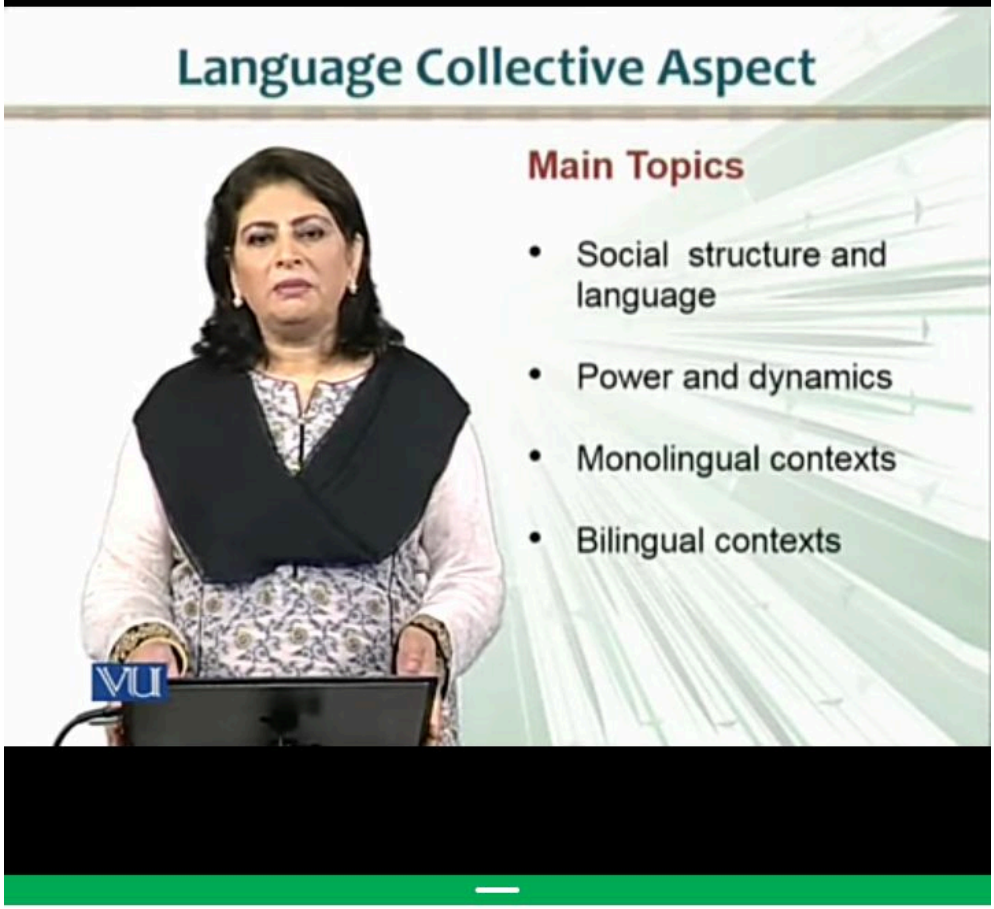

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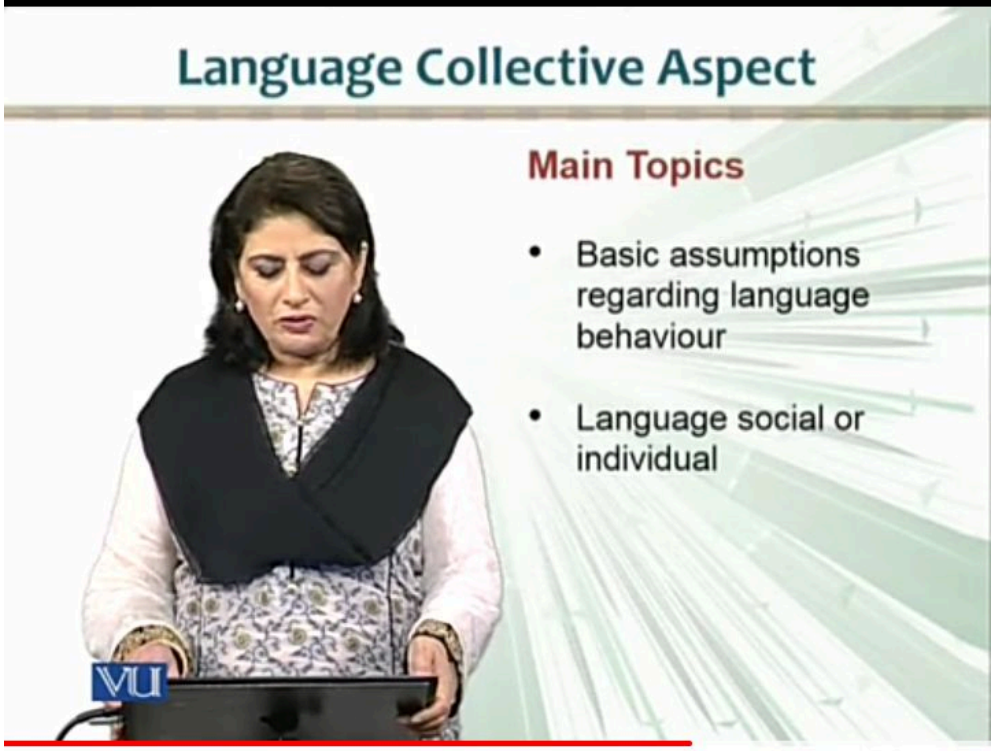

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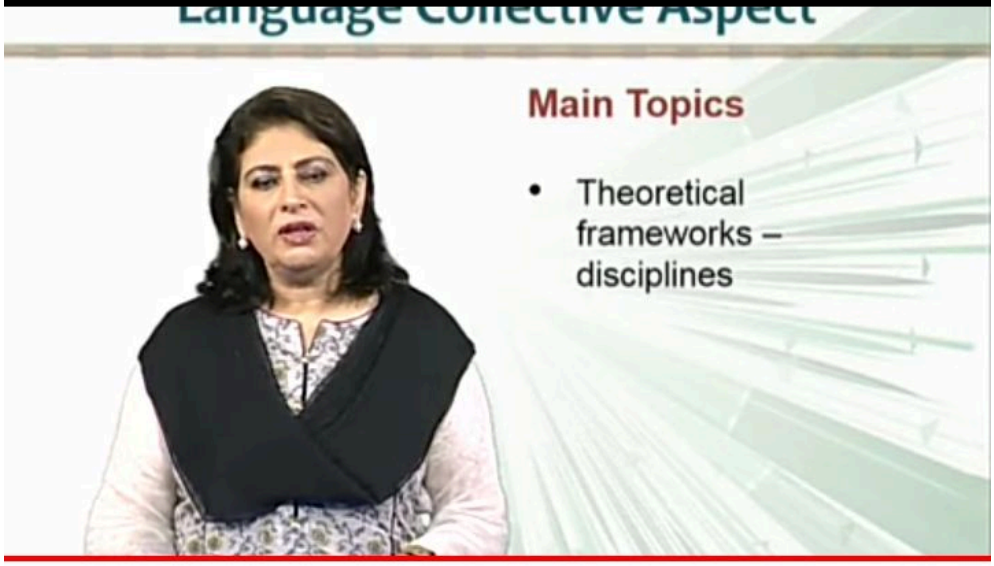

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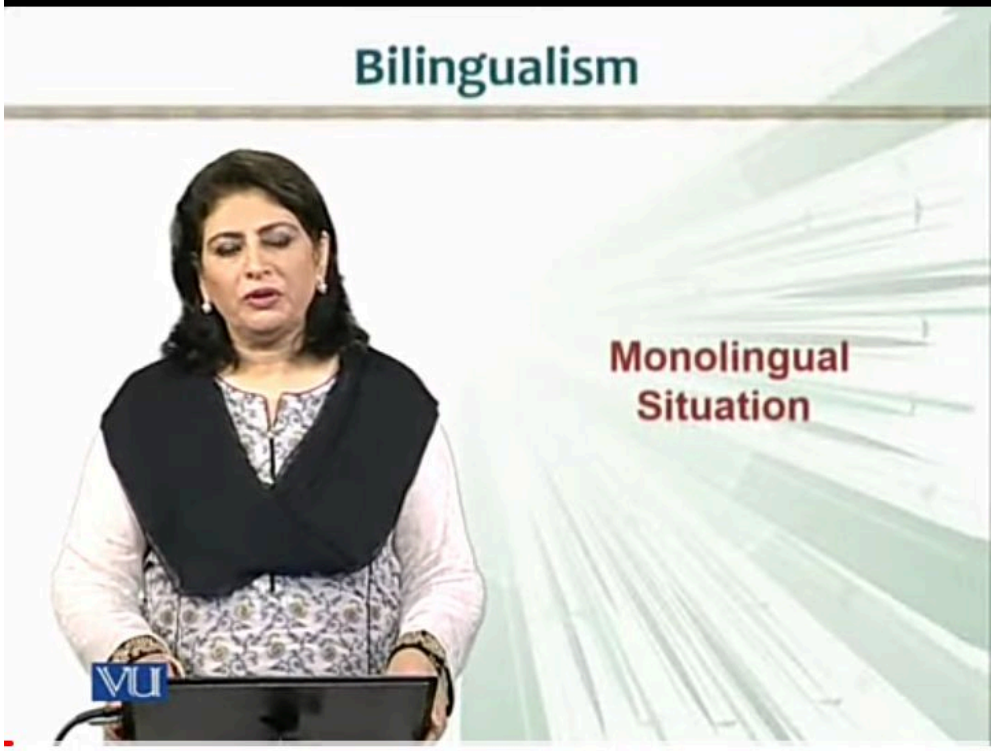

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Monolingual Situation

Language Function

- Communicative
- Cognitive
- Social
- Language related to power

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Monolingual Situation

Language Function

- Linguistic market
- Family, schools, workplace

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Monolingual Situation

Social Function

- Utterances in interactions have a social meaning – power relations

3:44

Monolingual Situation

Social hierarchy in linguistic market:

- Embedded in use and mode of acquisition and language use
- Dictated by market forces and individual perceptions

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Monolingual Situation

Linguistic market:

- Social networks the locus of interaction between individual and society
- Local languages- group solidarity – dominant – mobility

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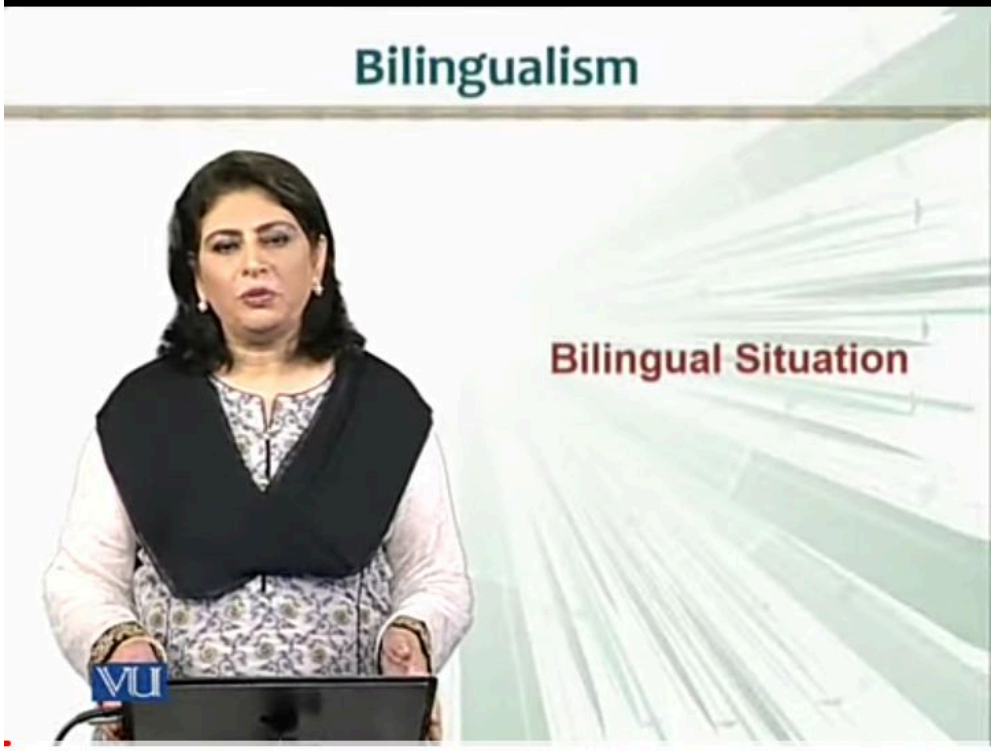

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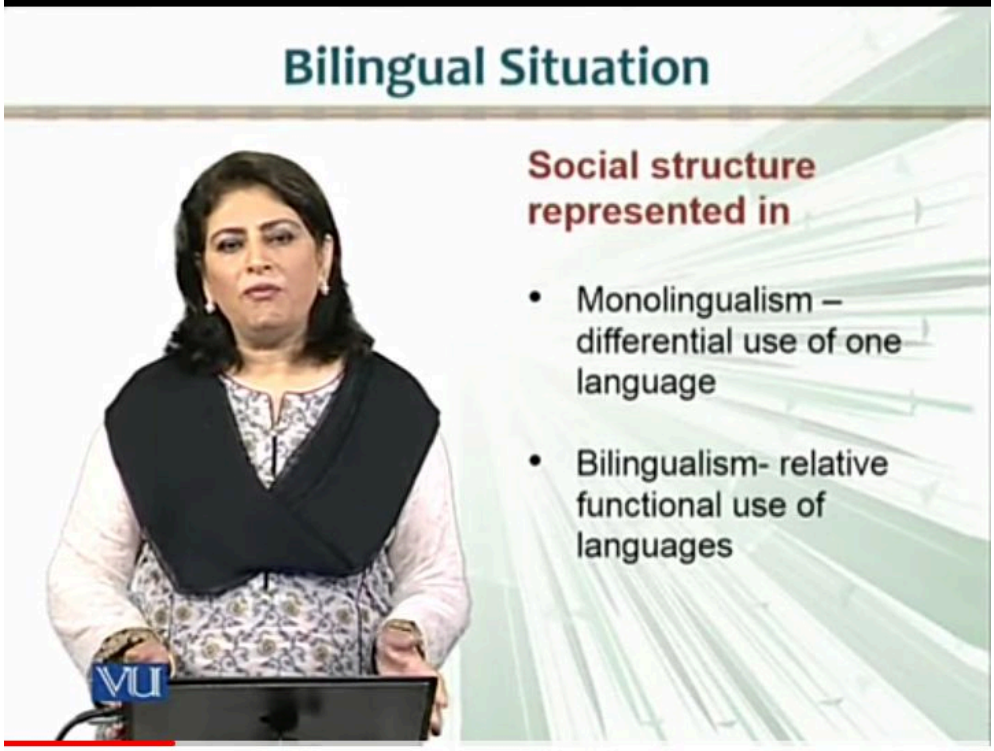

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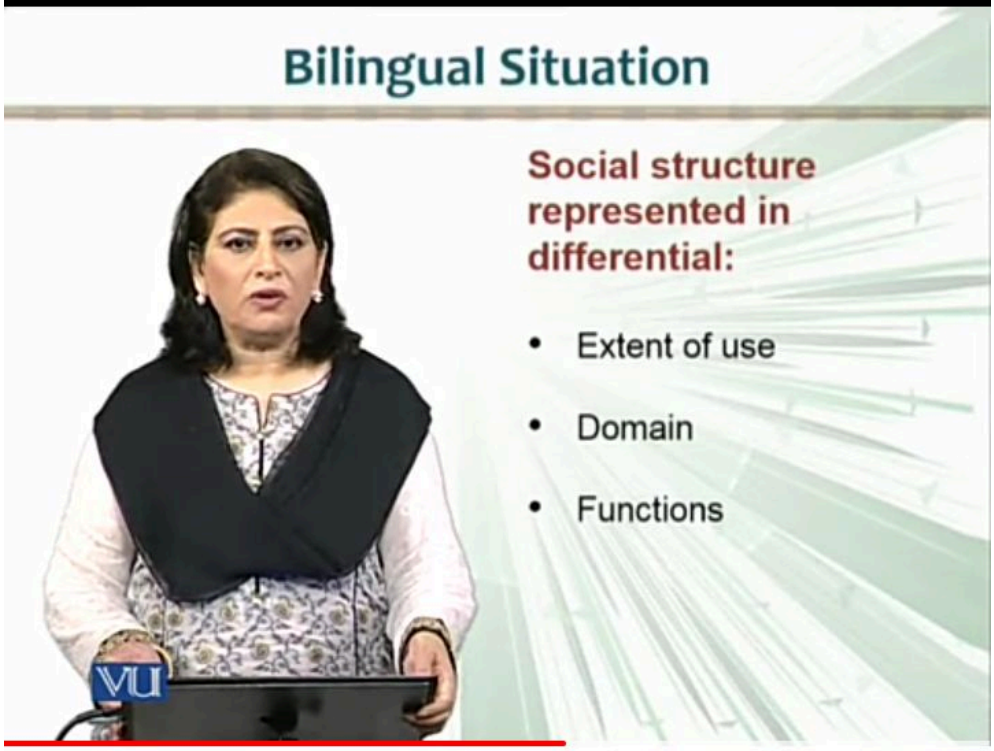

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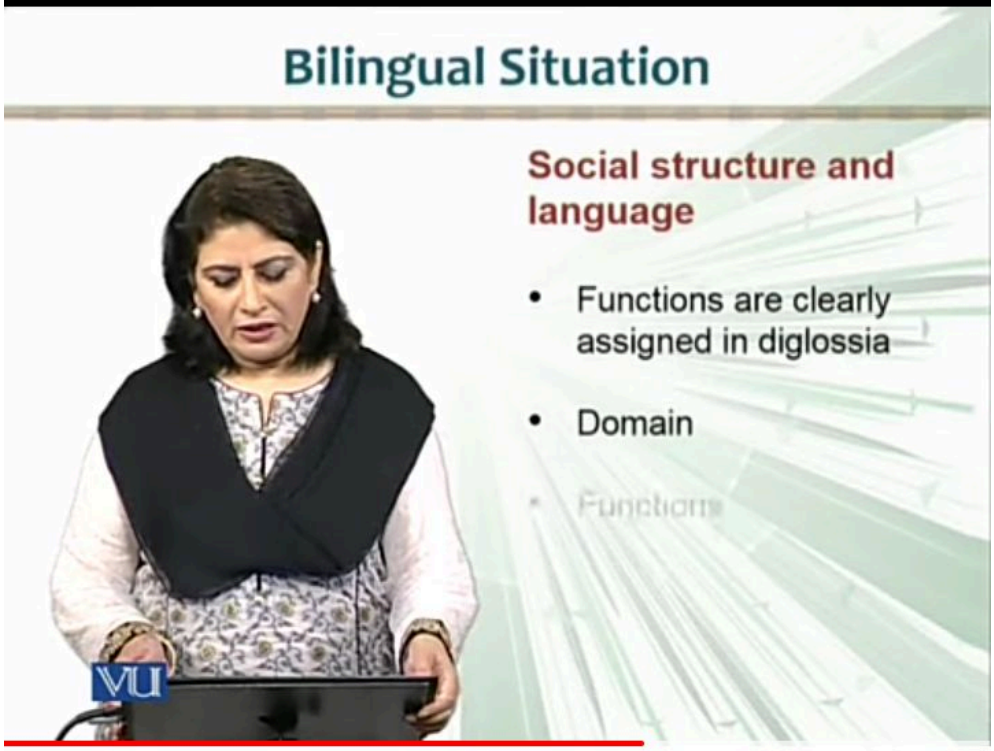

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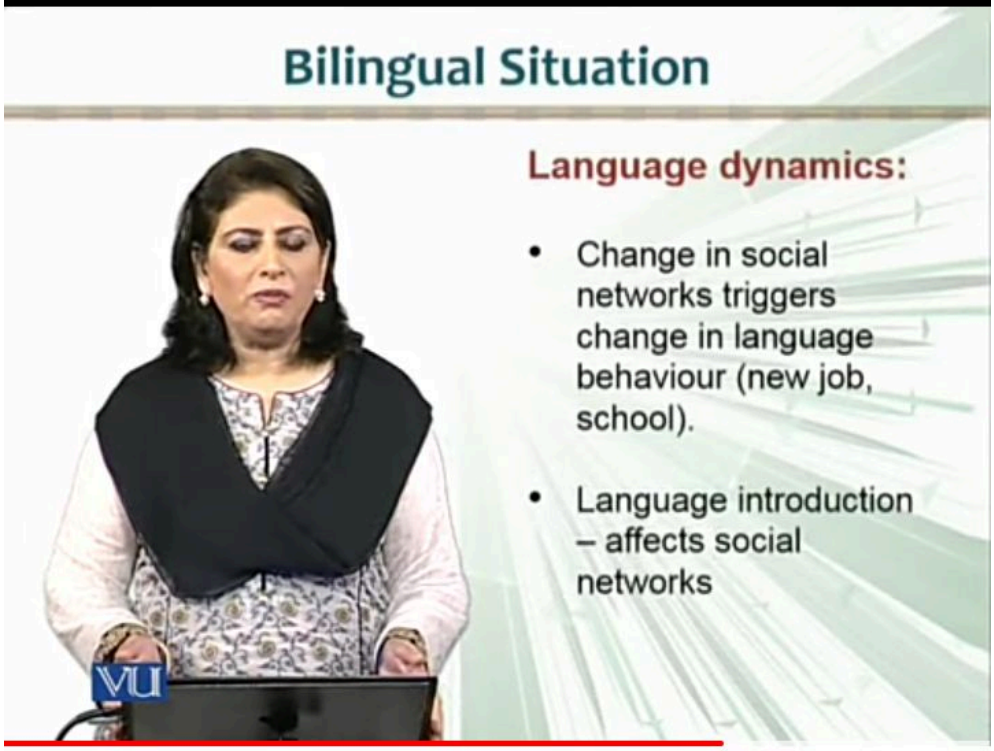

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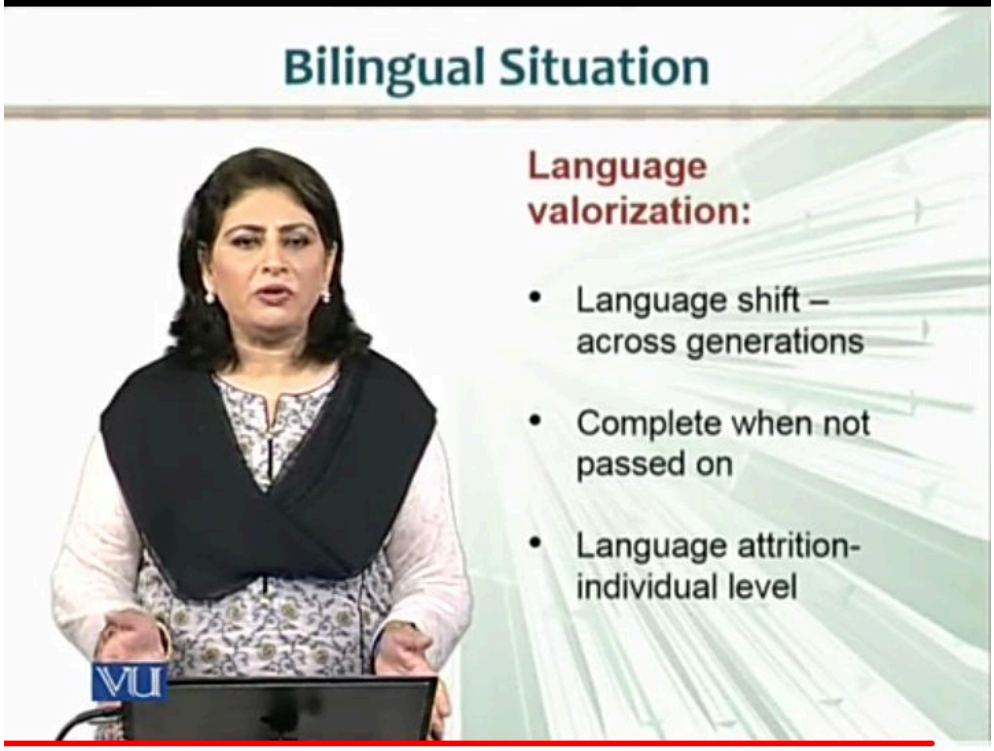

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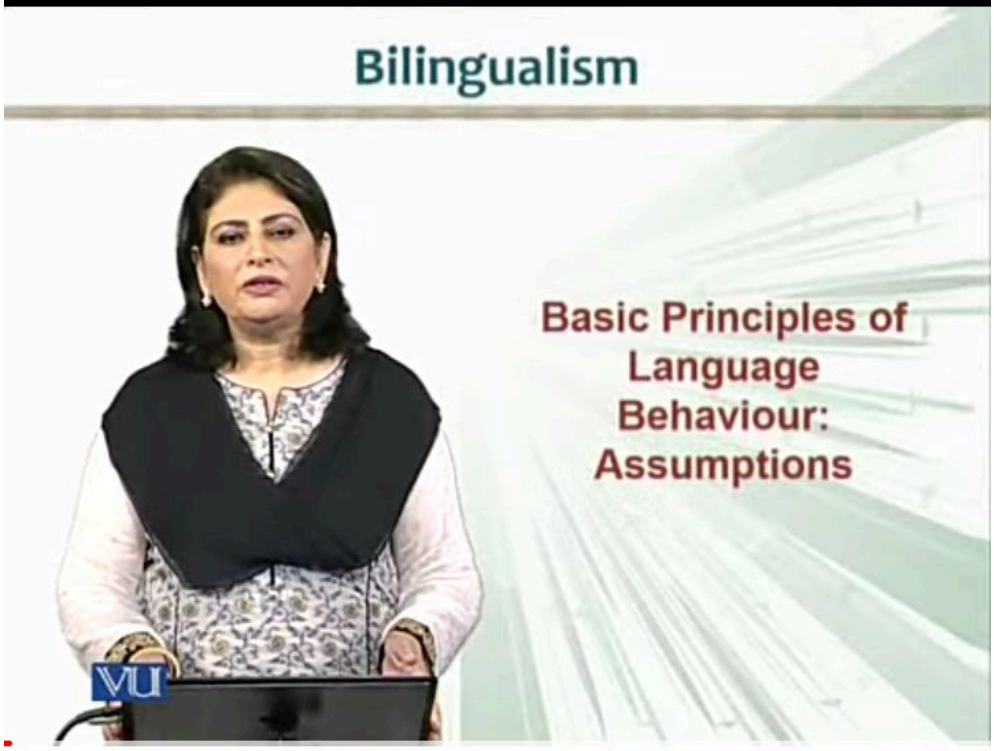

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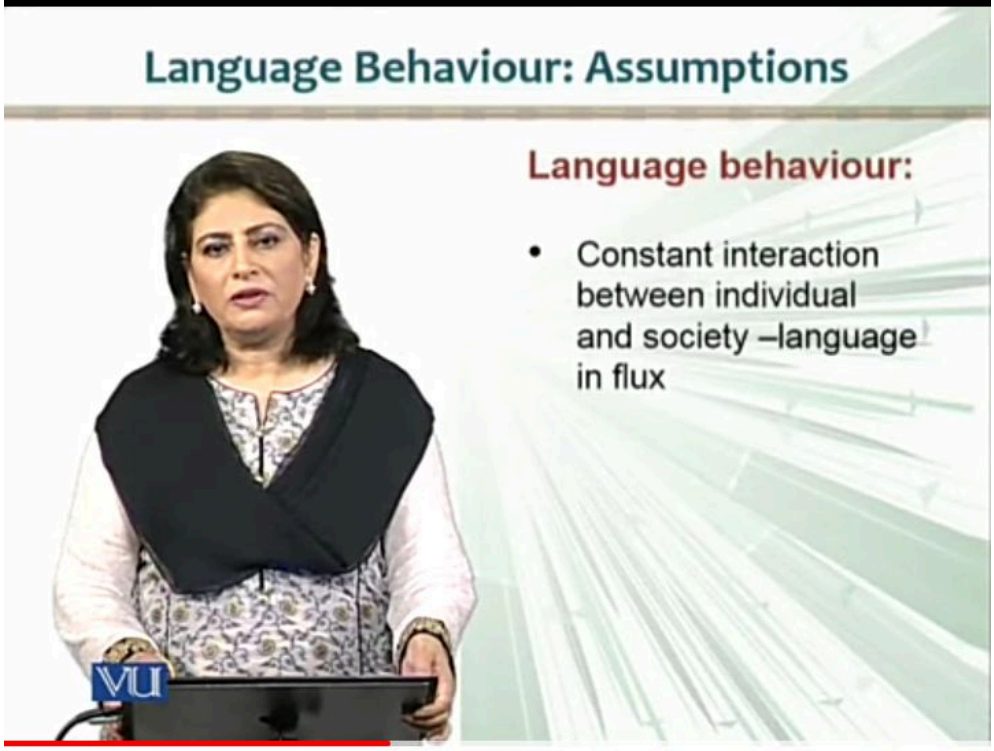

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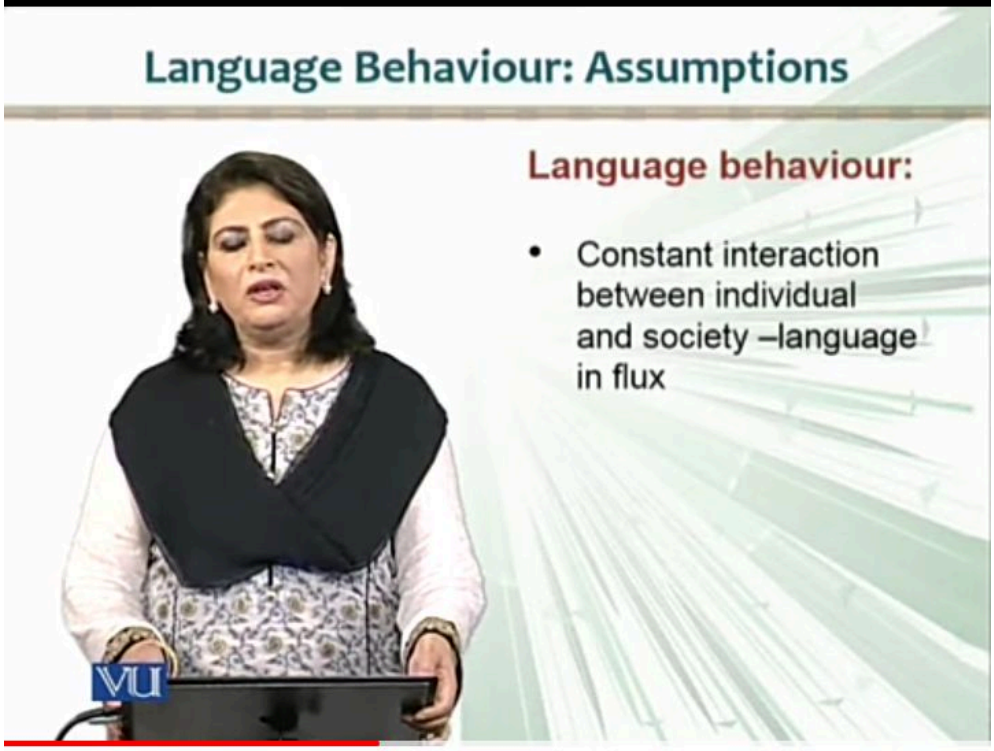

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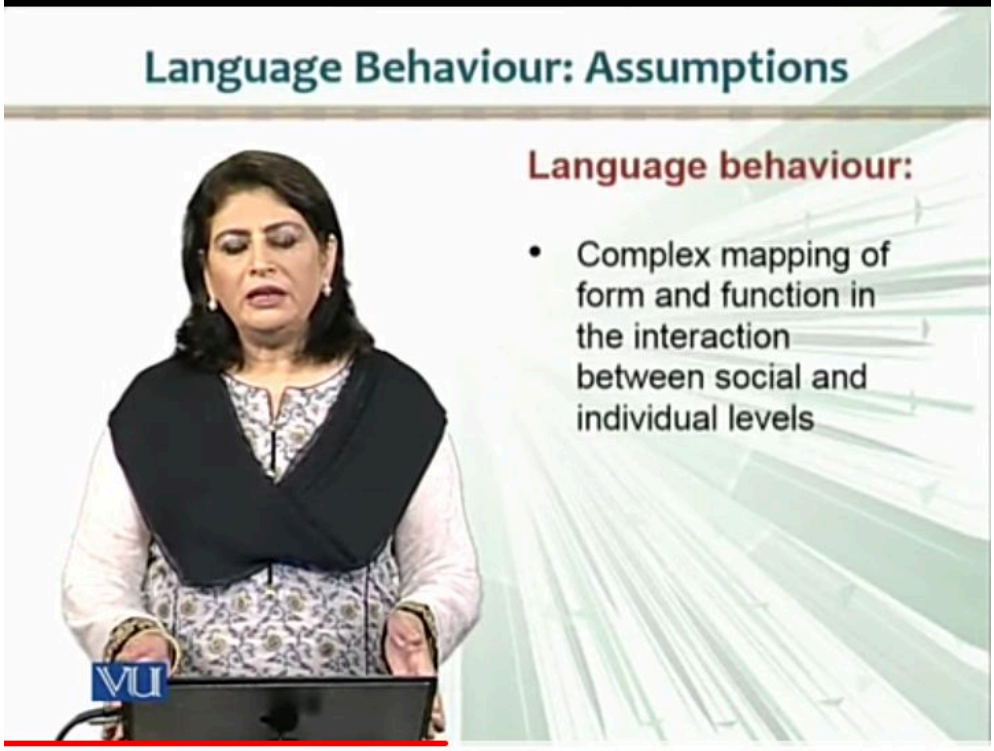

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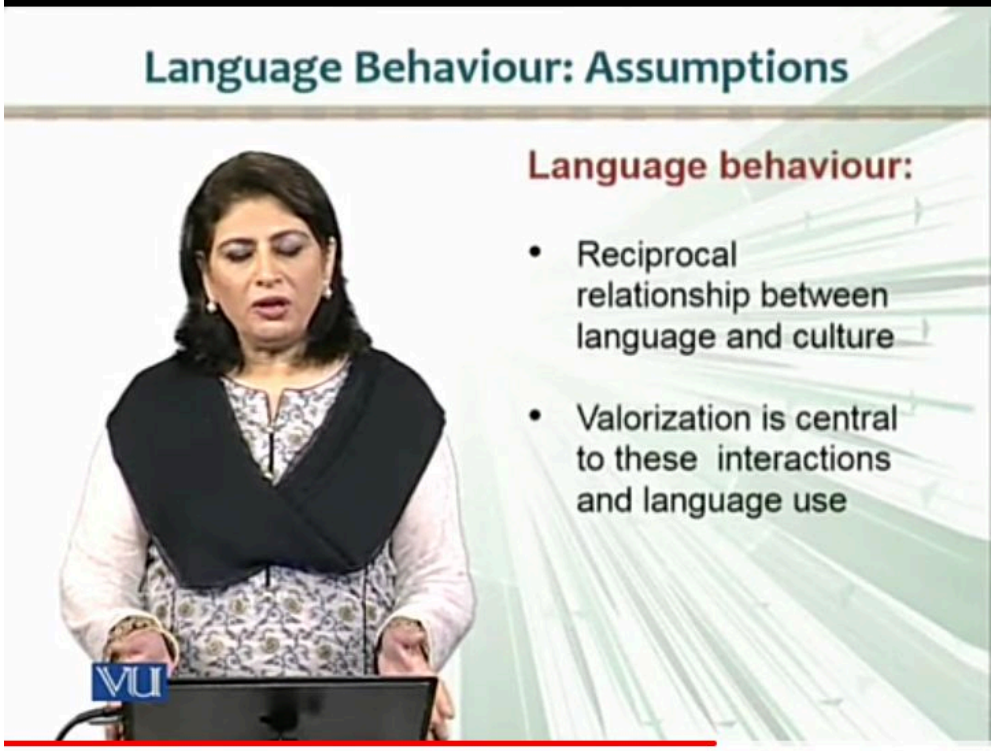

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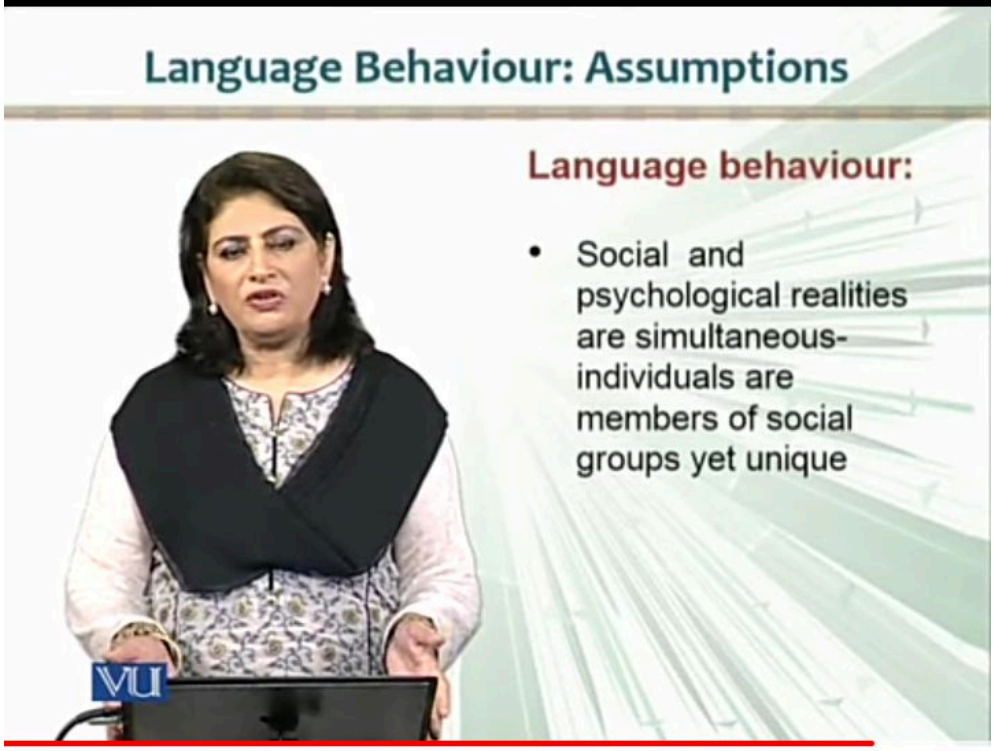

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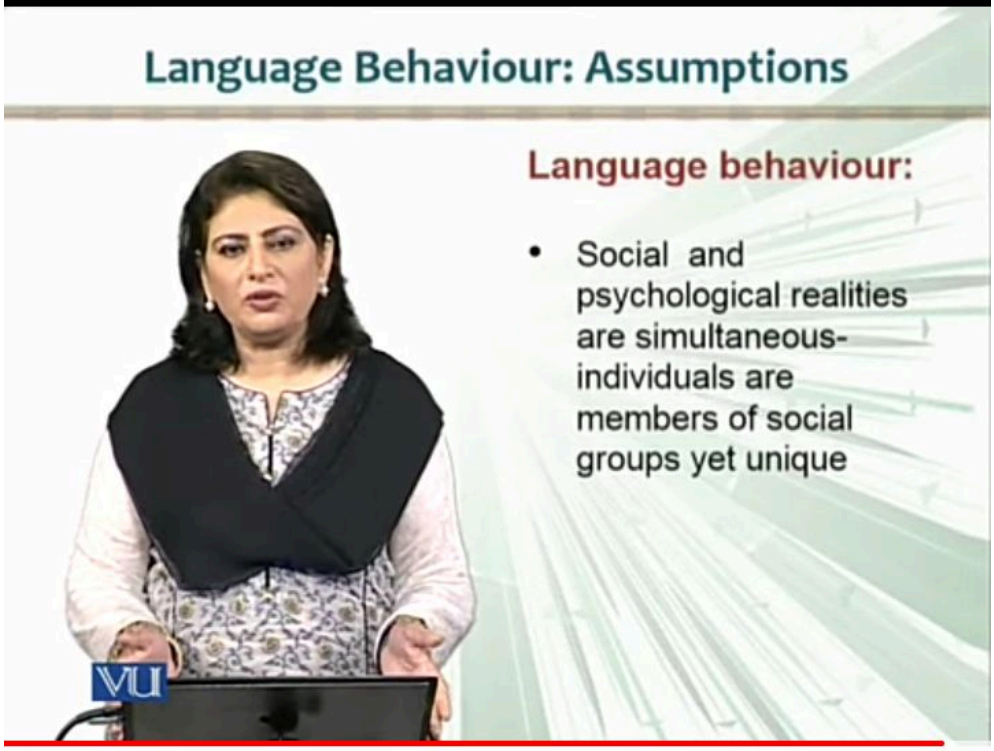

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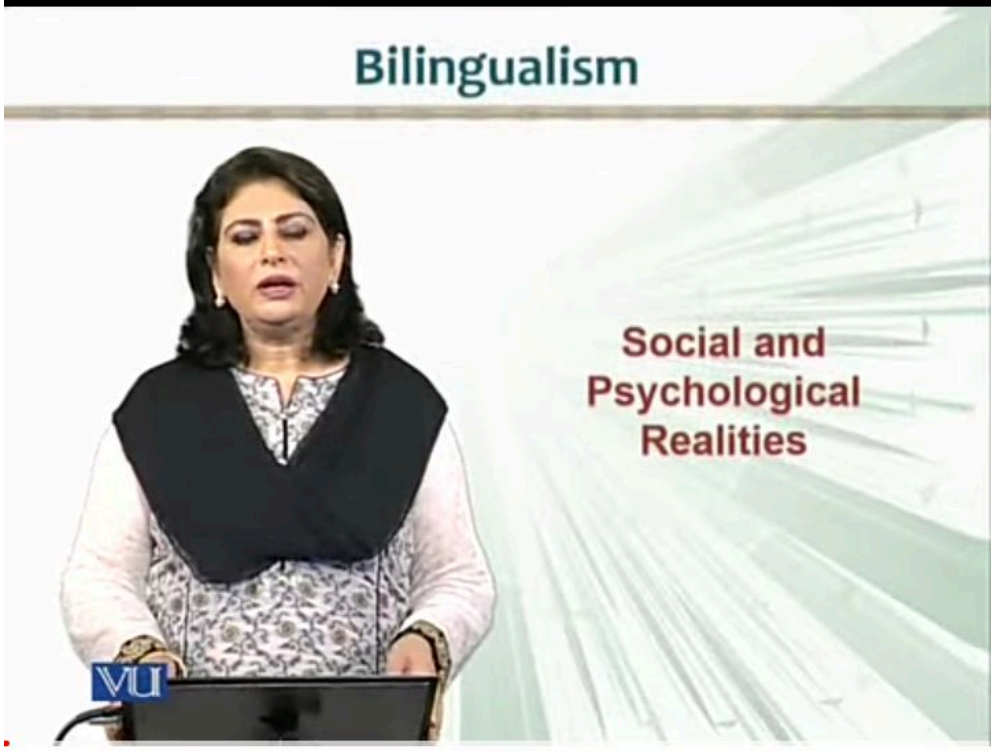

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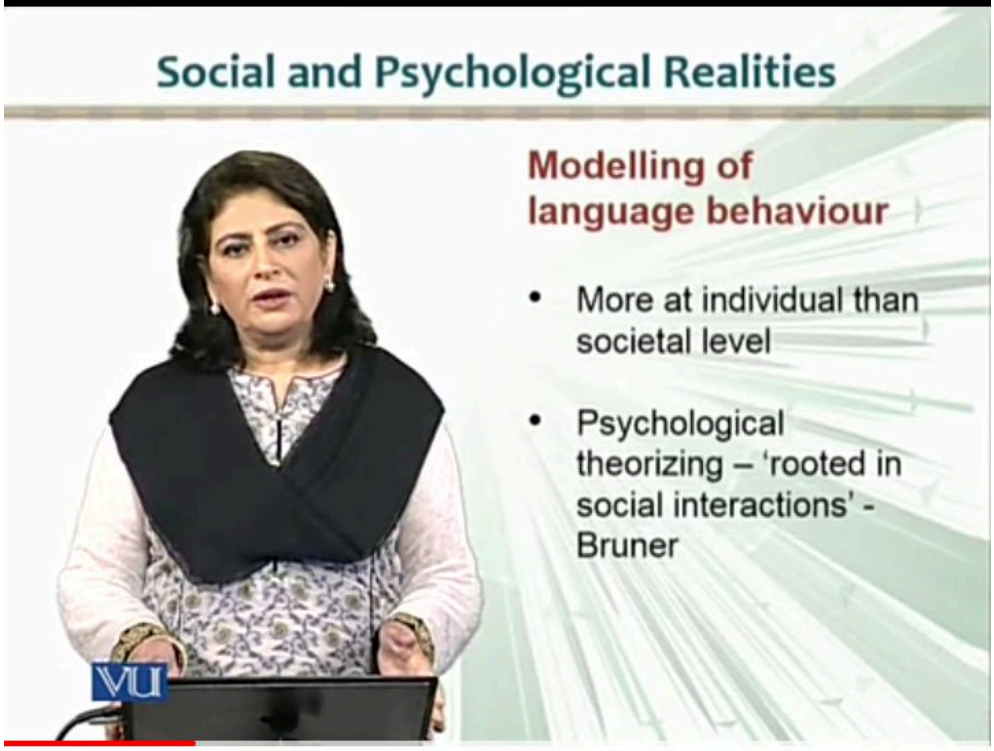

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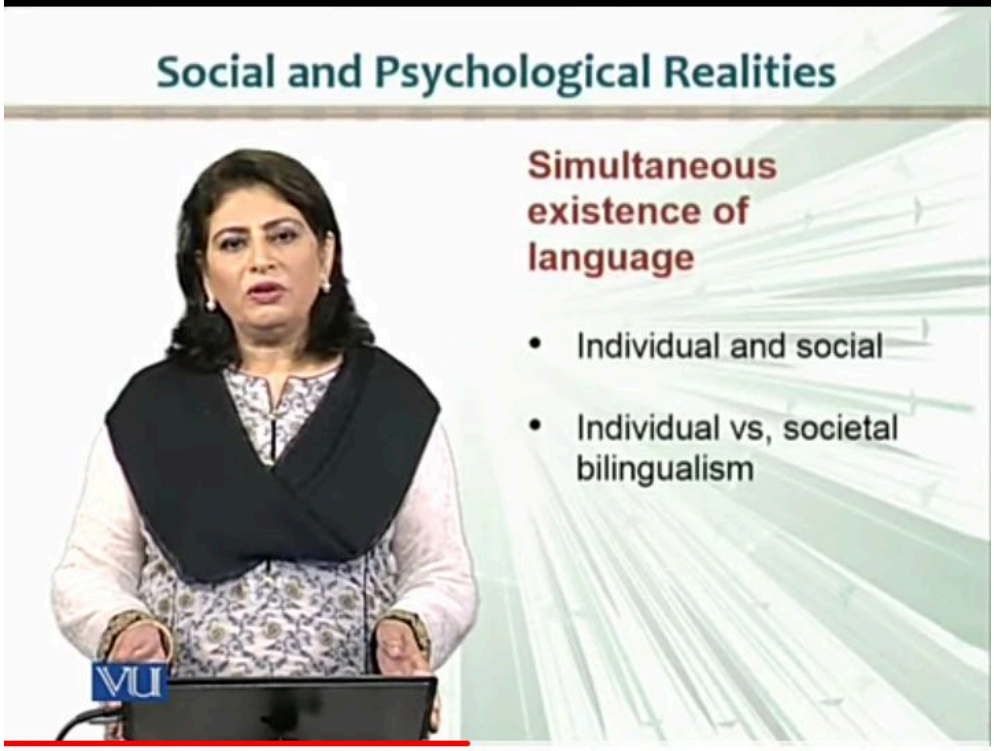

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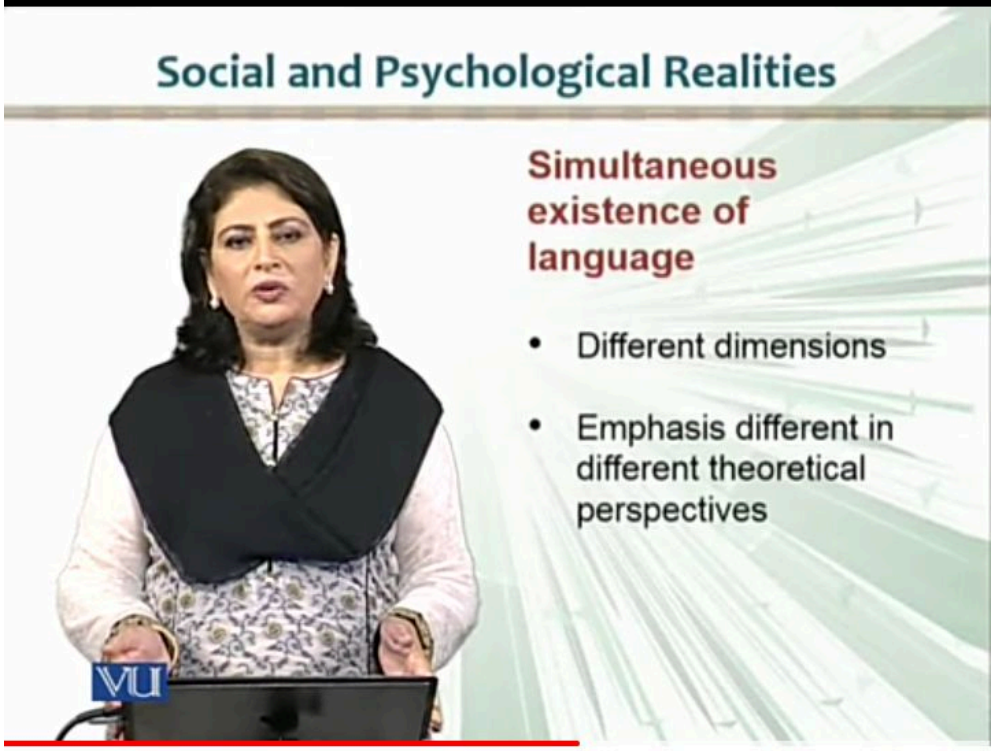

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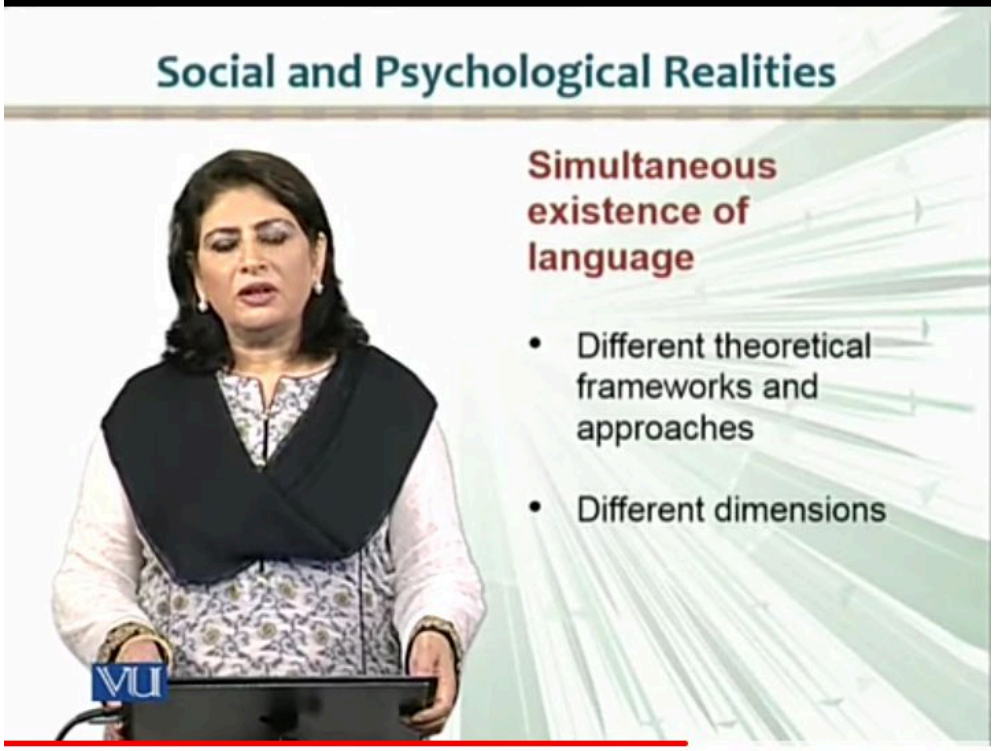

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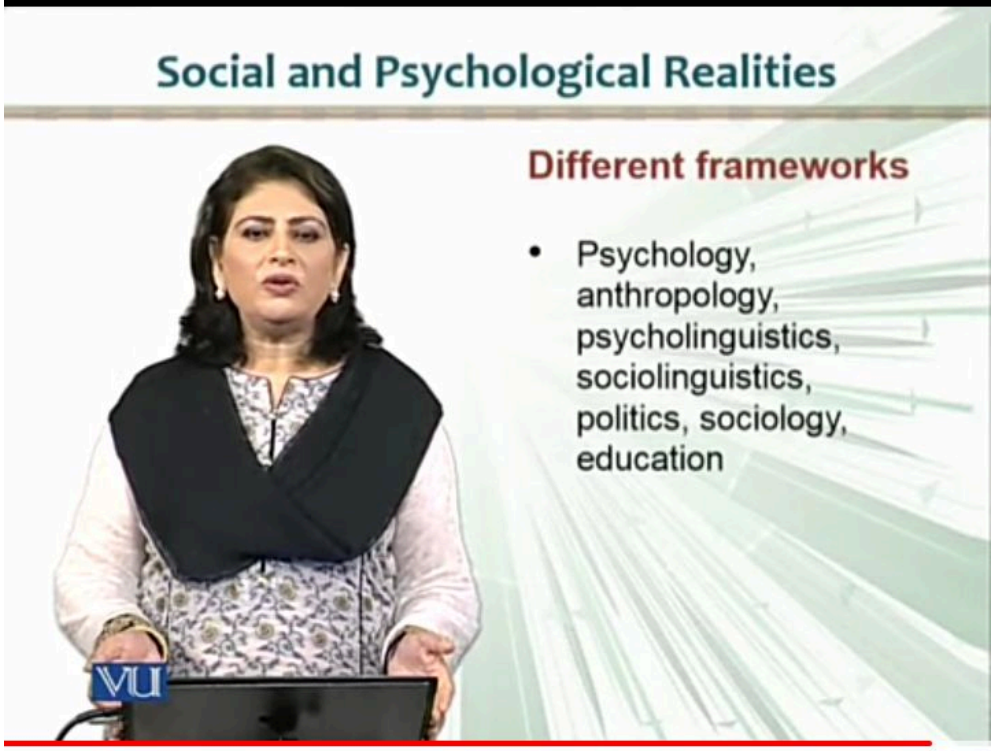

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ENG512_Topic017

Lesson-04

DIMENSIONS AND MEASURMENT OF BILINGUALITY

Topic No. 017-023

Introduction; Relative Competence; Cognitive Organization; Age of Acquisition; Exogeneity; Social Status; Cultural Identity

Bilinguality is a psychological state of an individual who has access to more than one linguistic code as a means of social communication. This access is multidimensional as it varies along a number of psychological and sociological dimensions. Some dimensions of relevance are:

(1) Relative competence: competence in both languages as either

(a) Balanced bilinguality: equal proficiency in both languages

(b) Dominant bilinguality: higher proficiency in one language

(2) Cognitive organization: compound bilinguality vs. coordinate bilinguality

(3) Age of acquisition: childhood (before the age of 11); adolescence (11-17 yrs), adult (after 17 yrs) acquisition and simultaneous vs consecutive bilinguality

(4) Exogeneity:

(a) Endogenous bilinguality: presence of both languages in the community environment

(b) Exogenous bilinguality: absence of the second language in the community

(5) Social cultural status: This includes either of the following:

(a) Additive bilinguality: (both languages encouraged equally give socially valorized cognitive advantage

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(6) Cultural identity:

a) Bicultural bilinguality: double membership and bicultural identity

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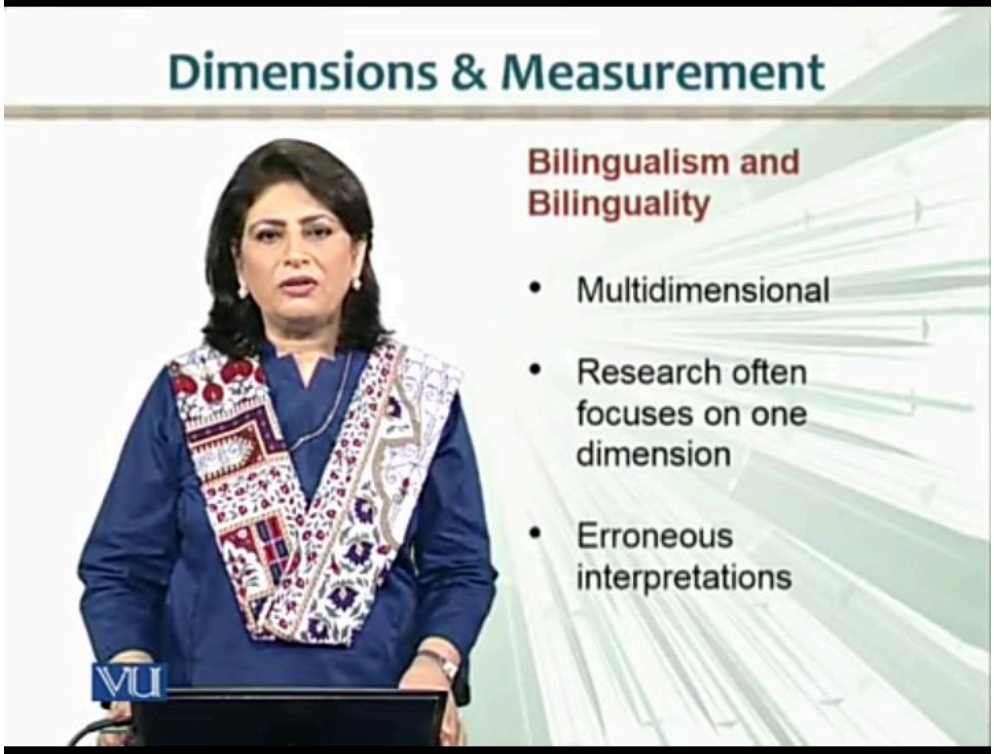

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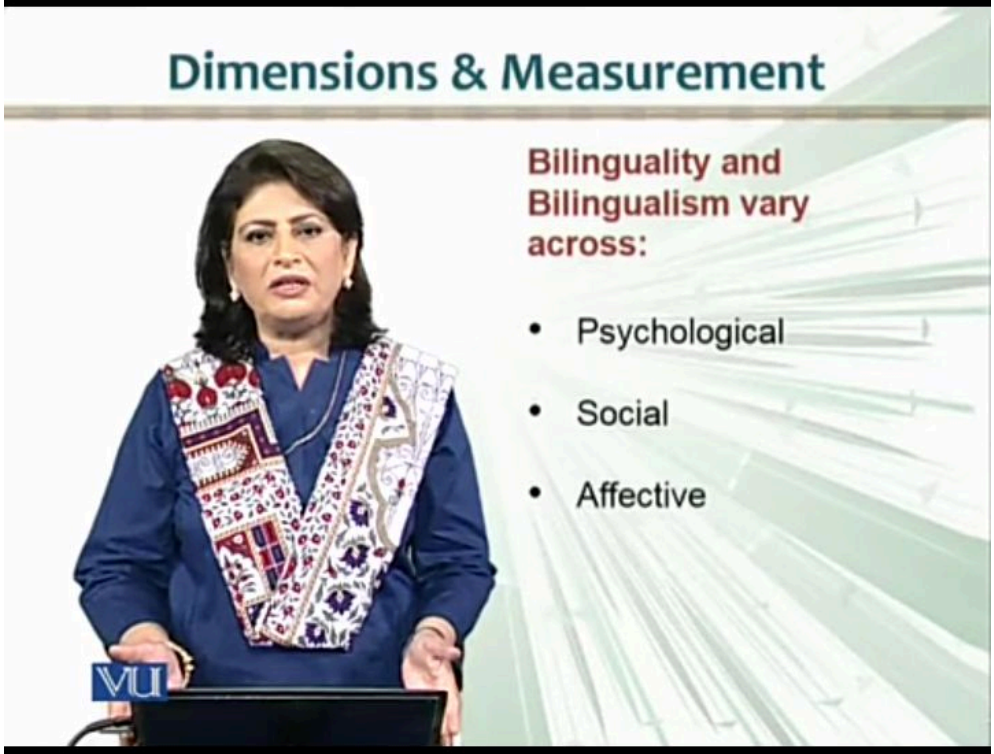

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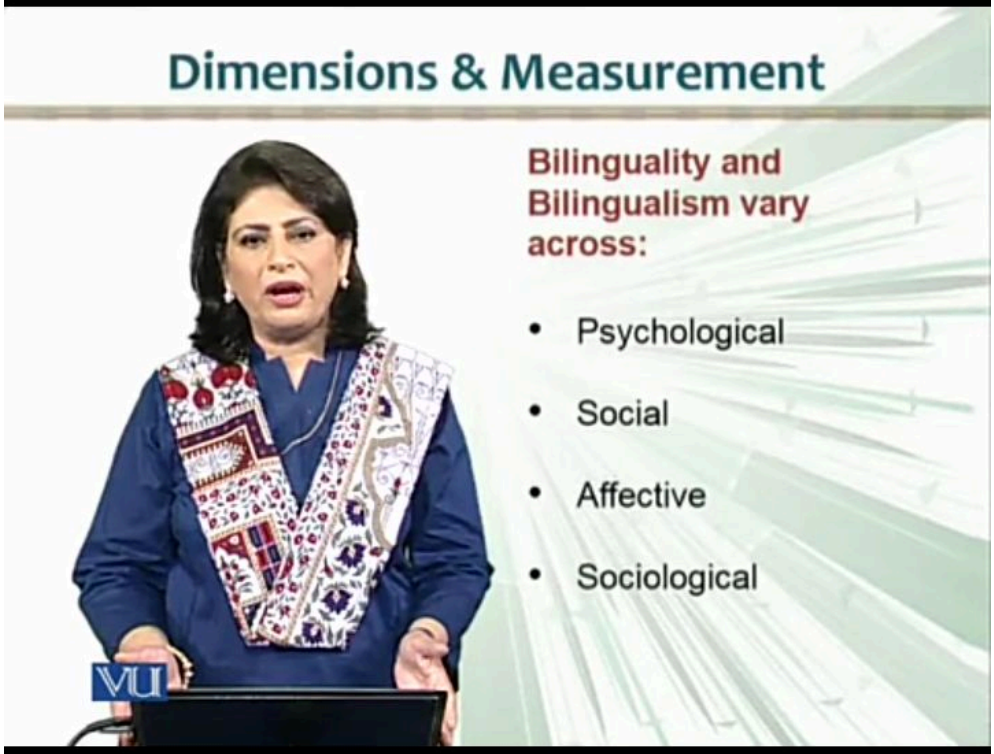

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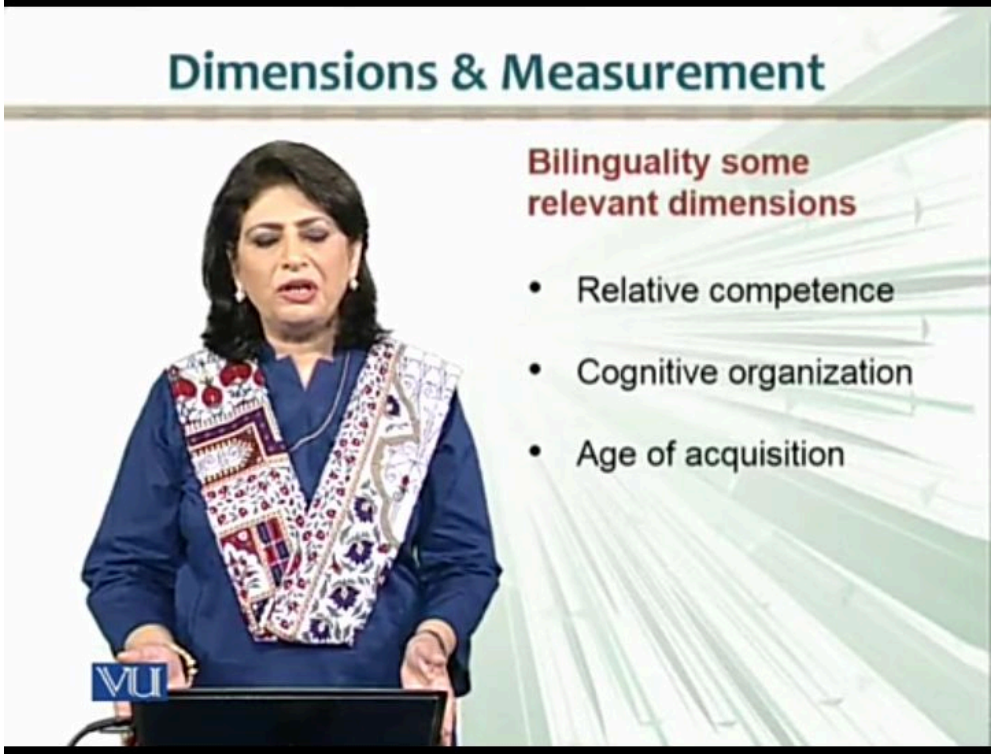

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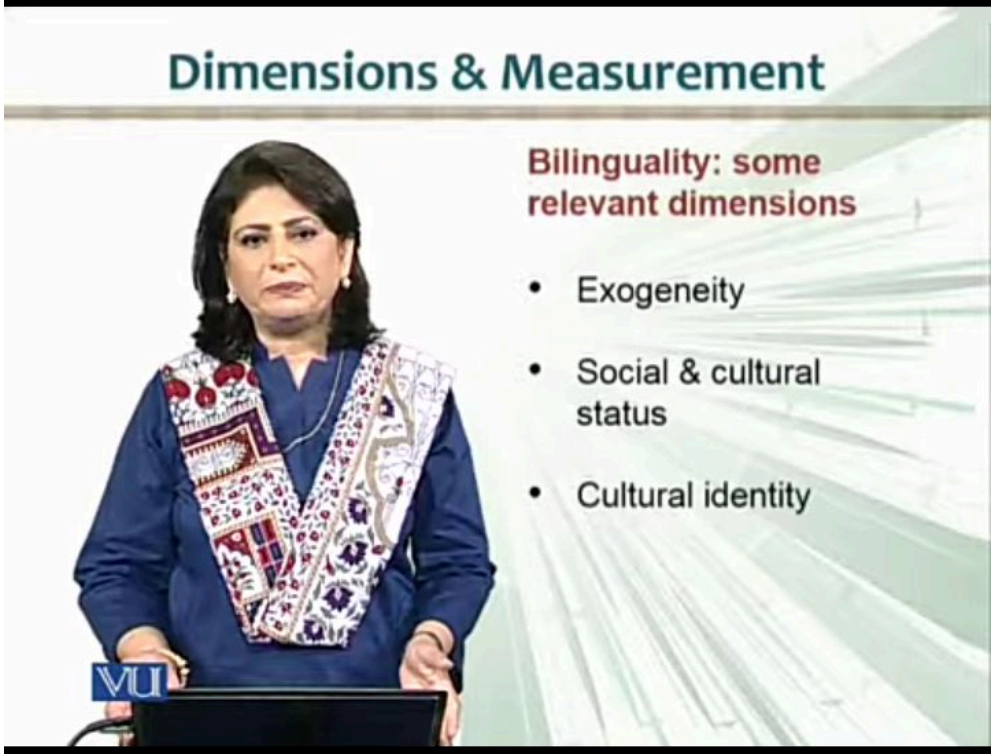

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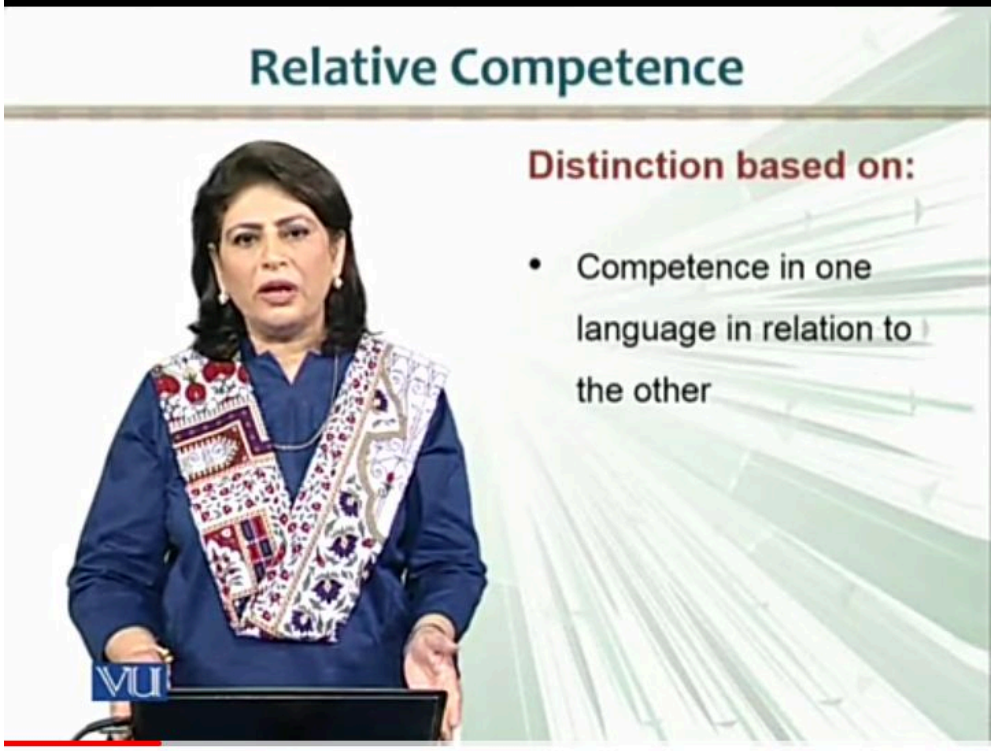

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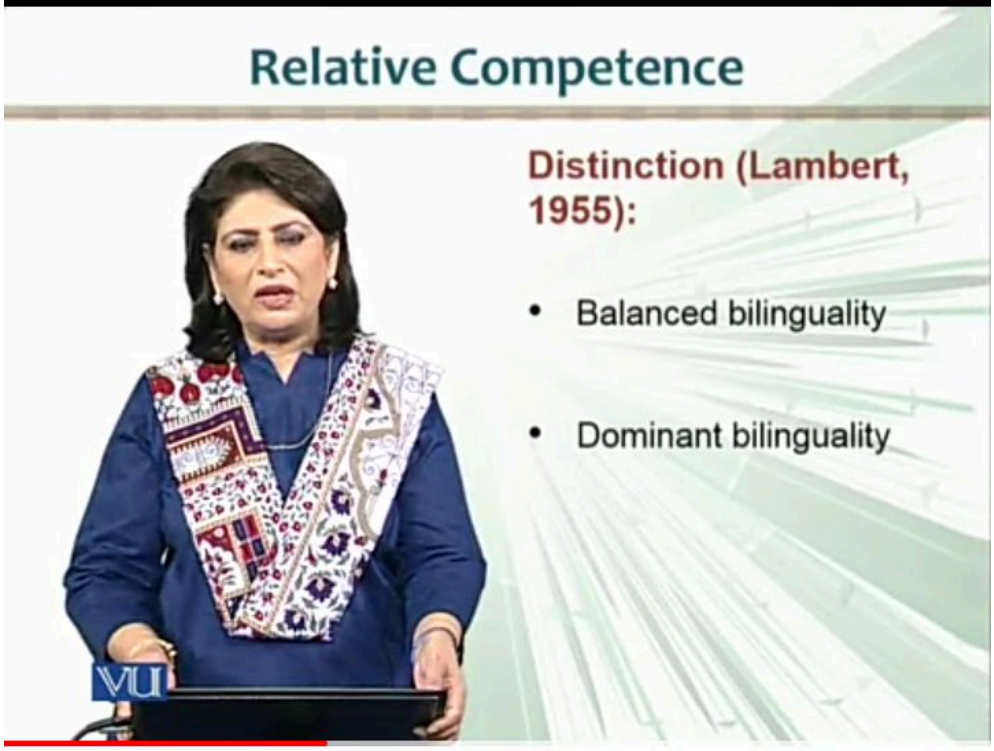

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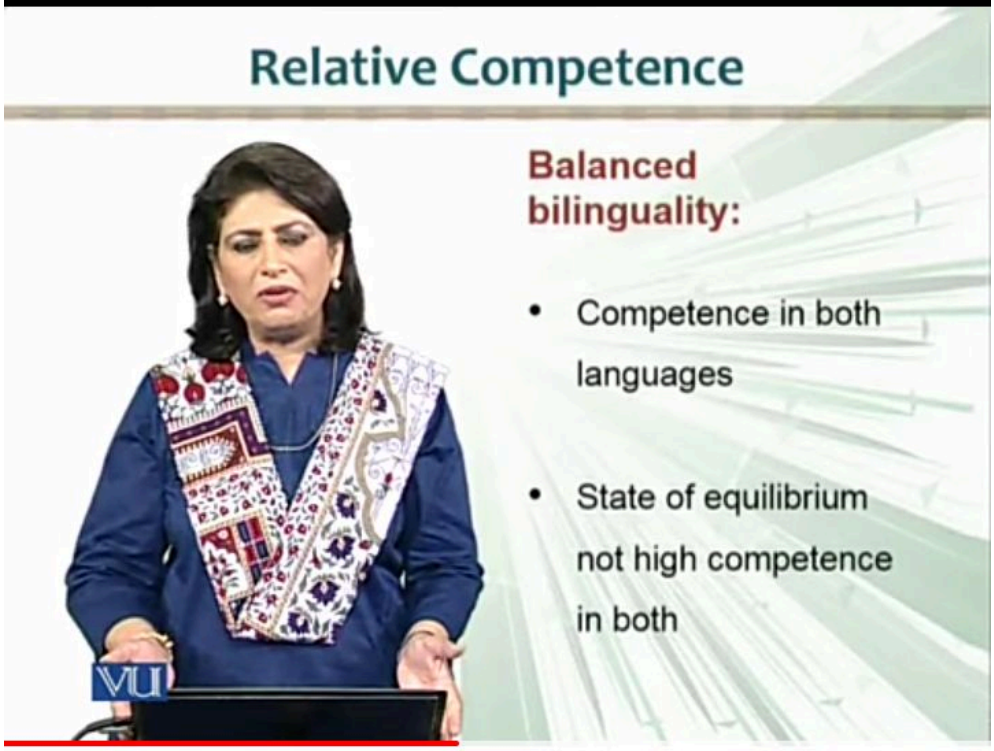

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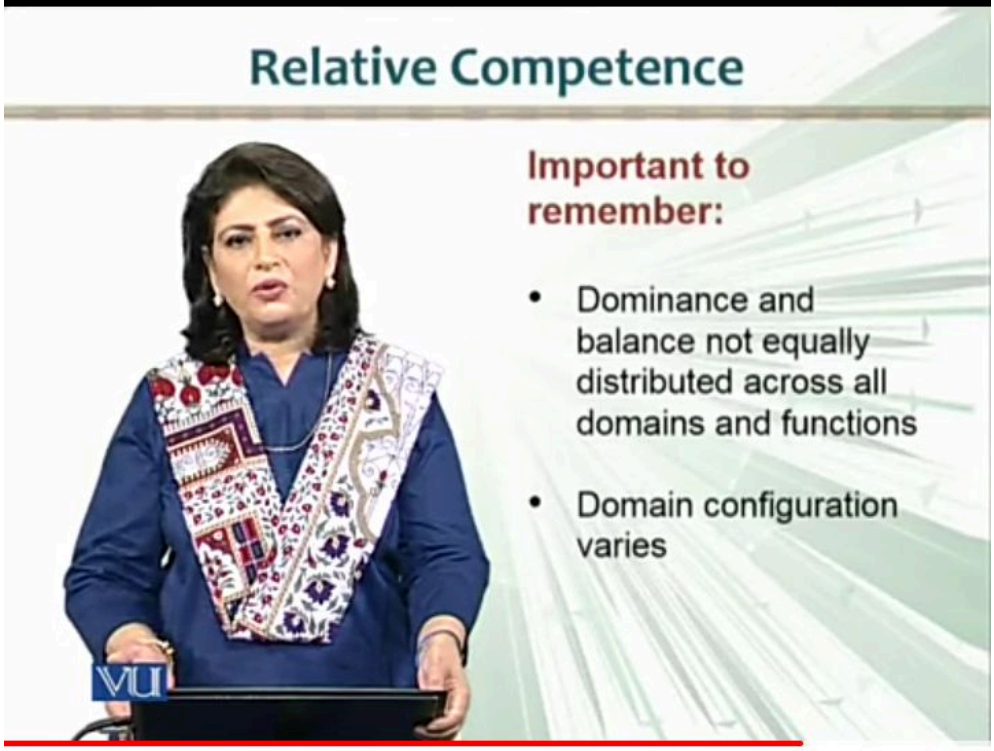

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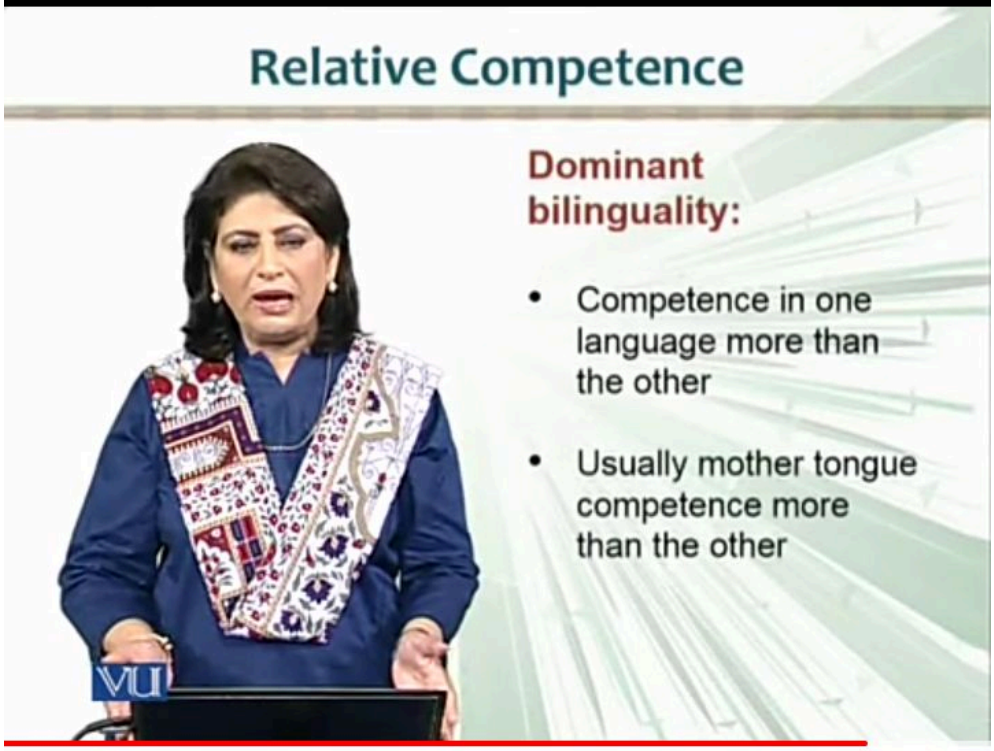

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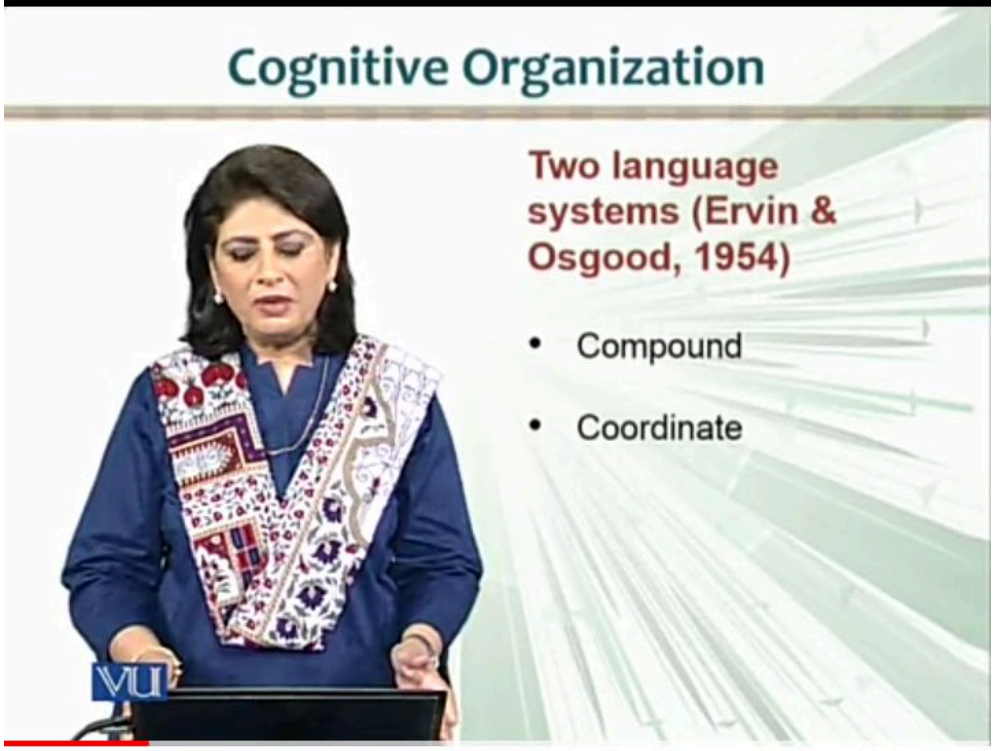

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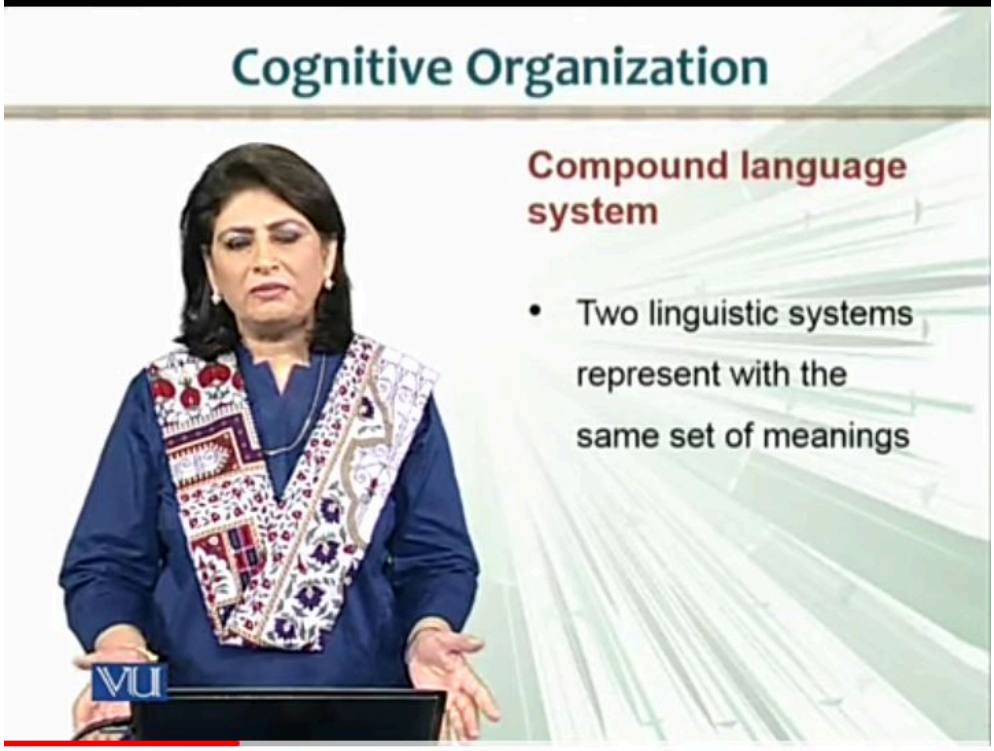

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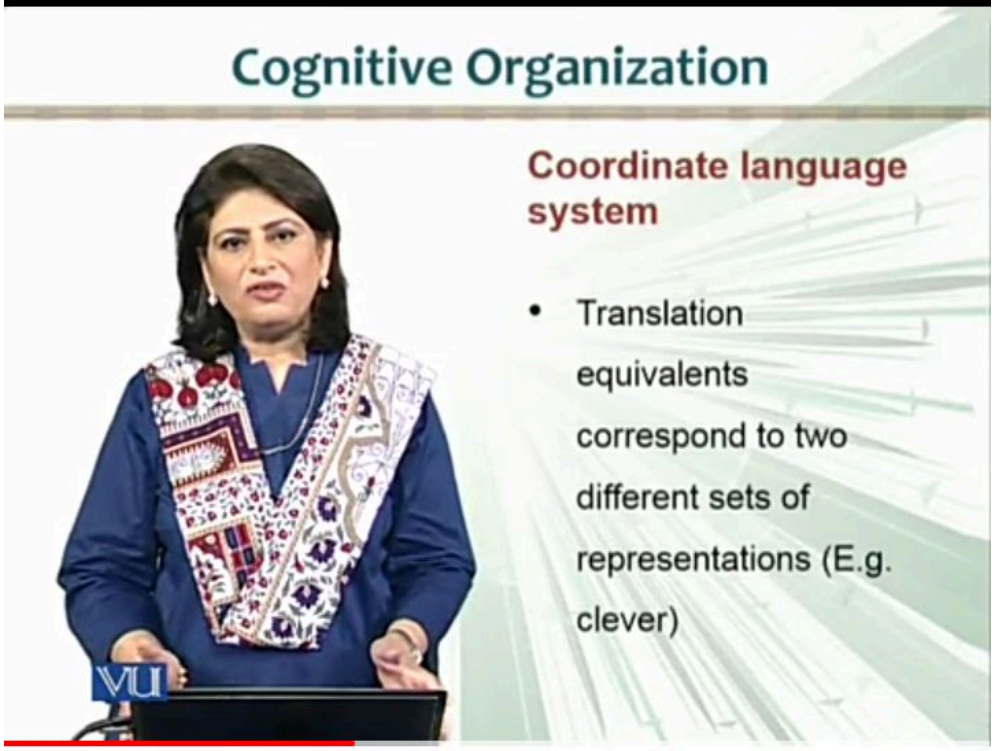

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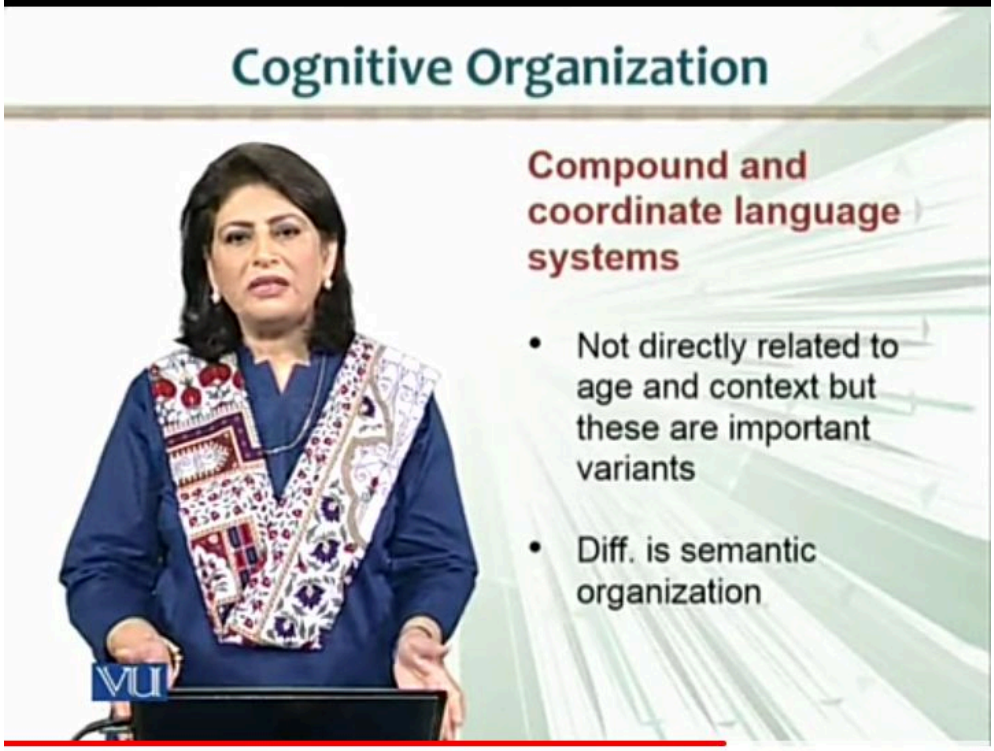

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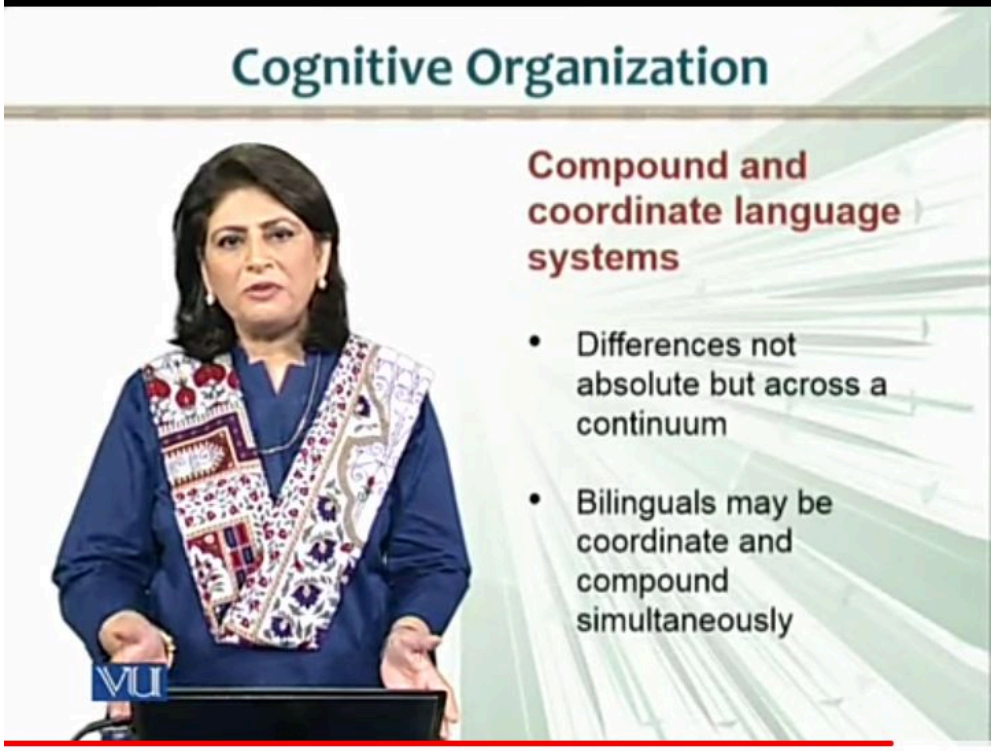

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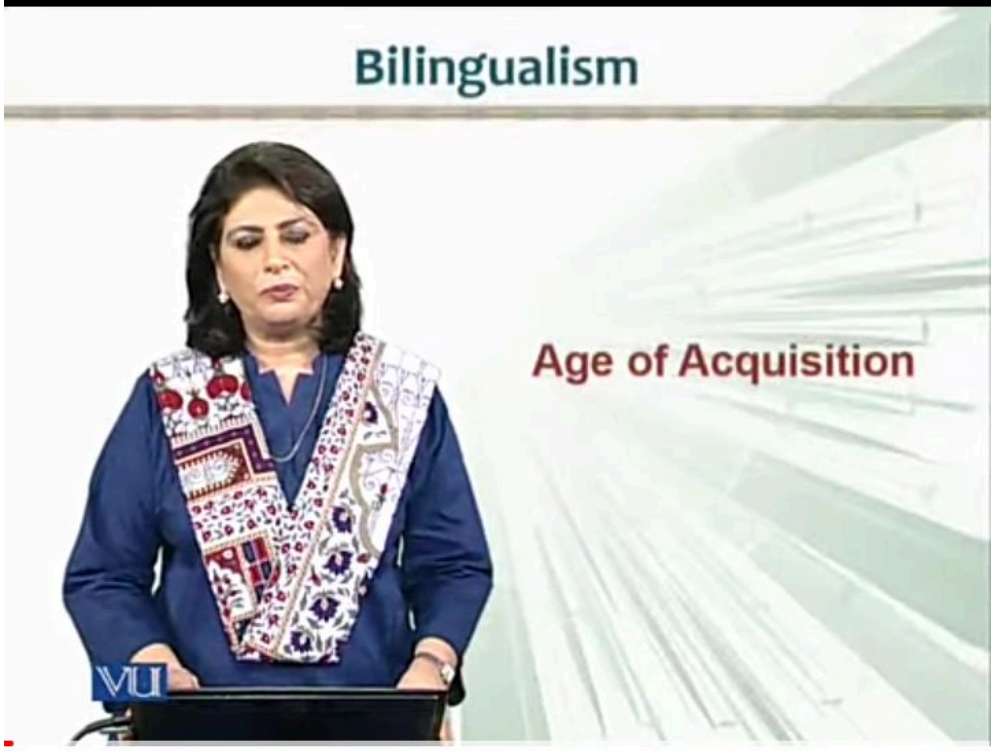

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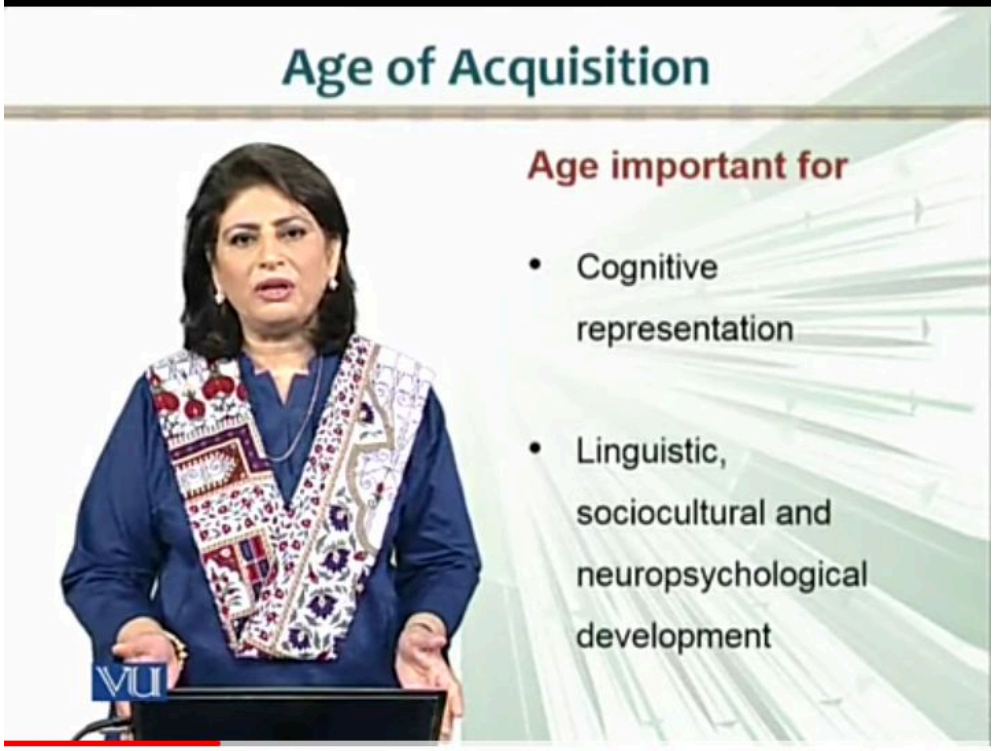

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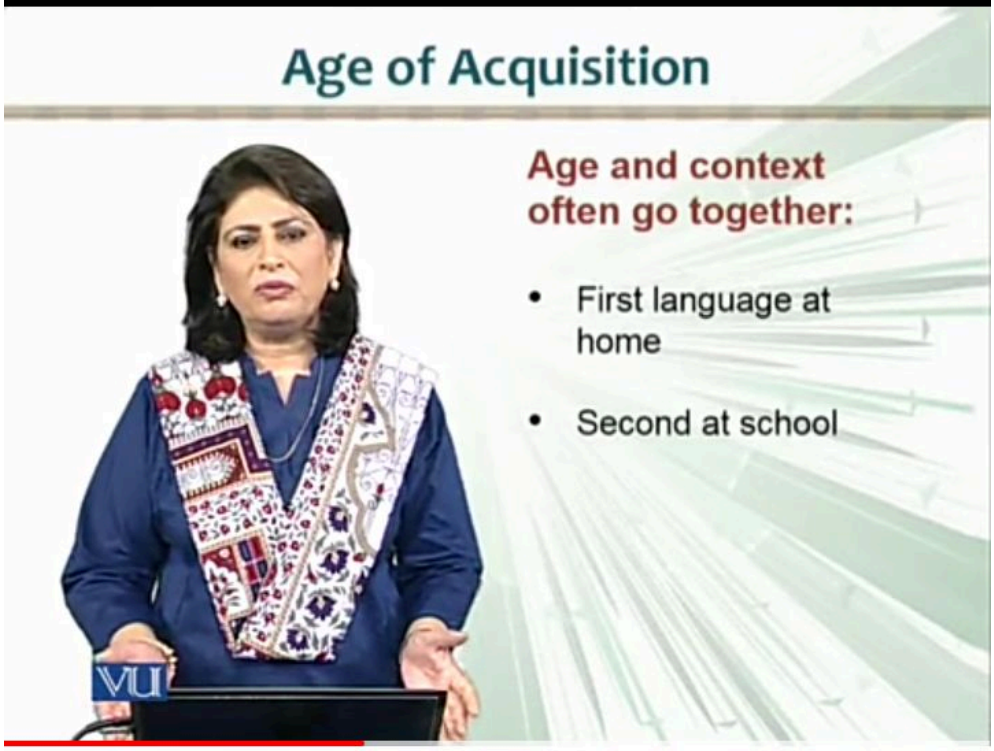

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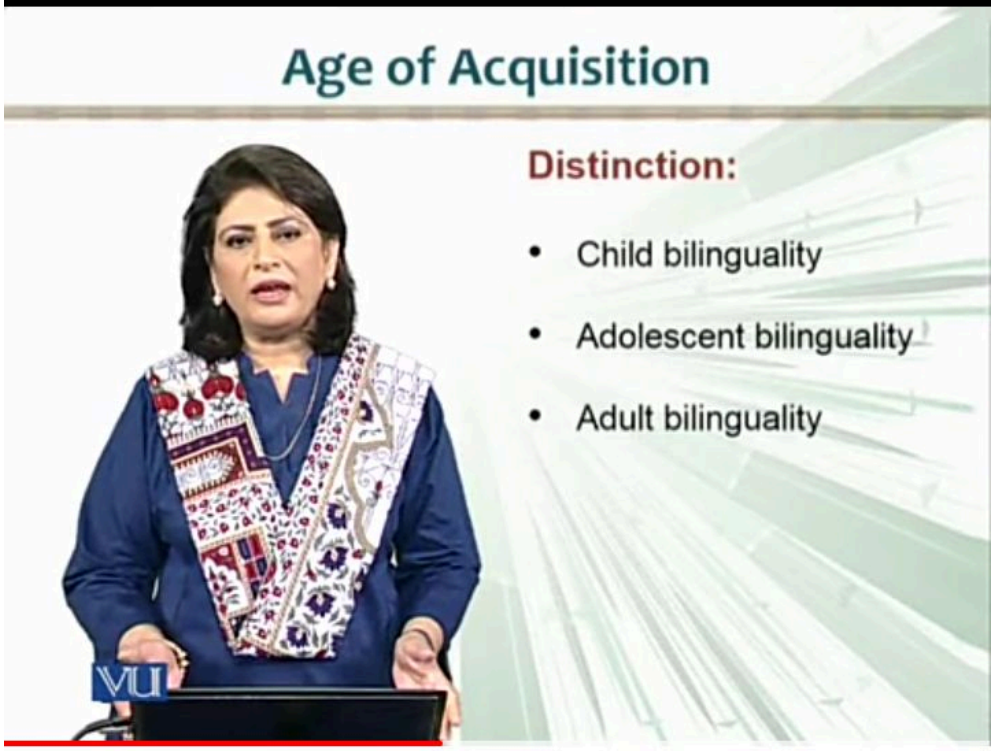

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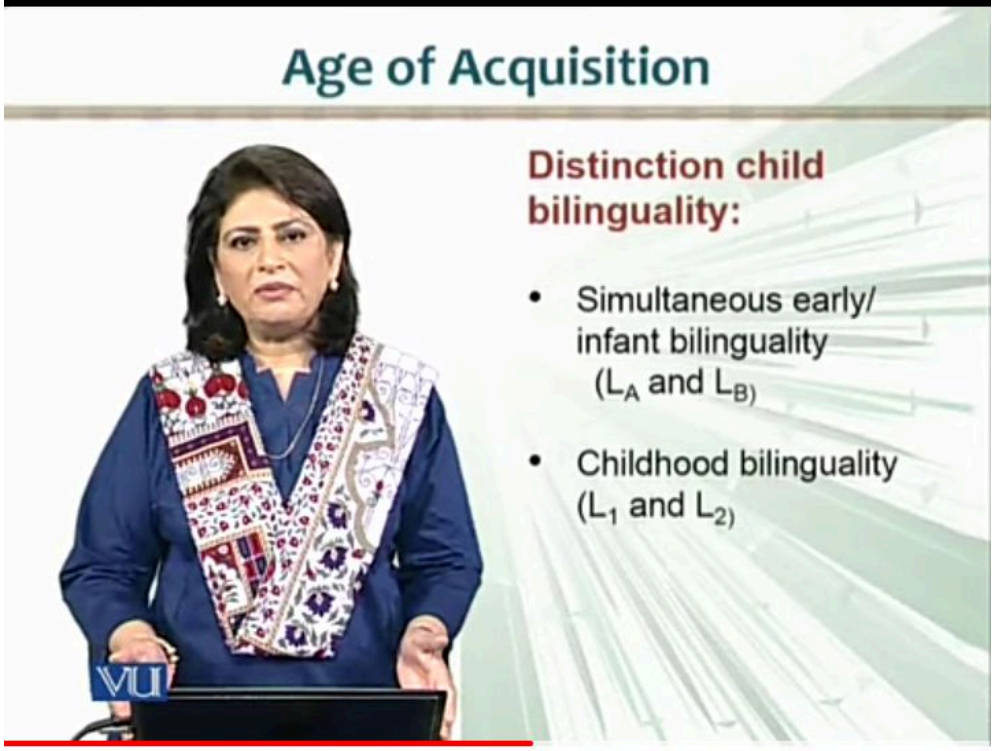

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Age of Acquisition

Distinction :

- Simultaneous bilinguality- unintentional- different forms same function

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Age of Acquisition

Distinction :

- Simultaneous bilinguality- unintentional- different forms same function
- Childhood bilinguality- intentional – form/function

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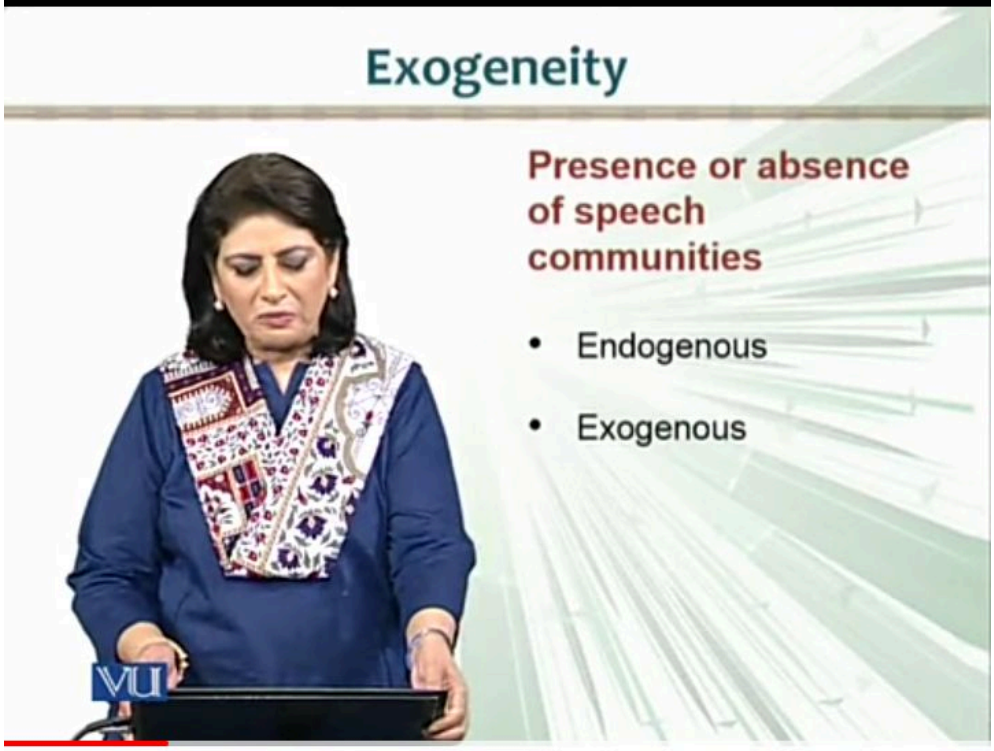

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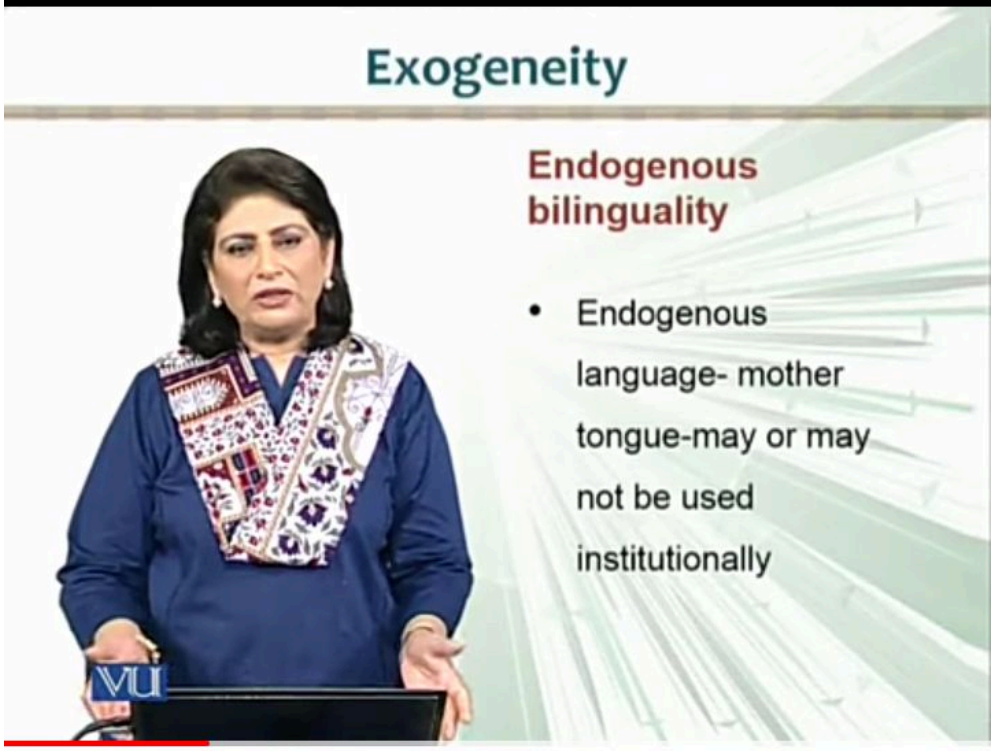

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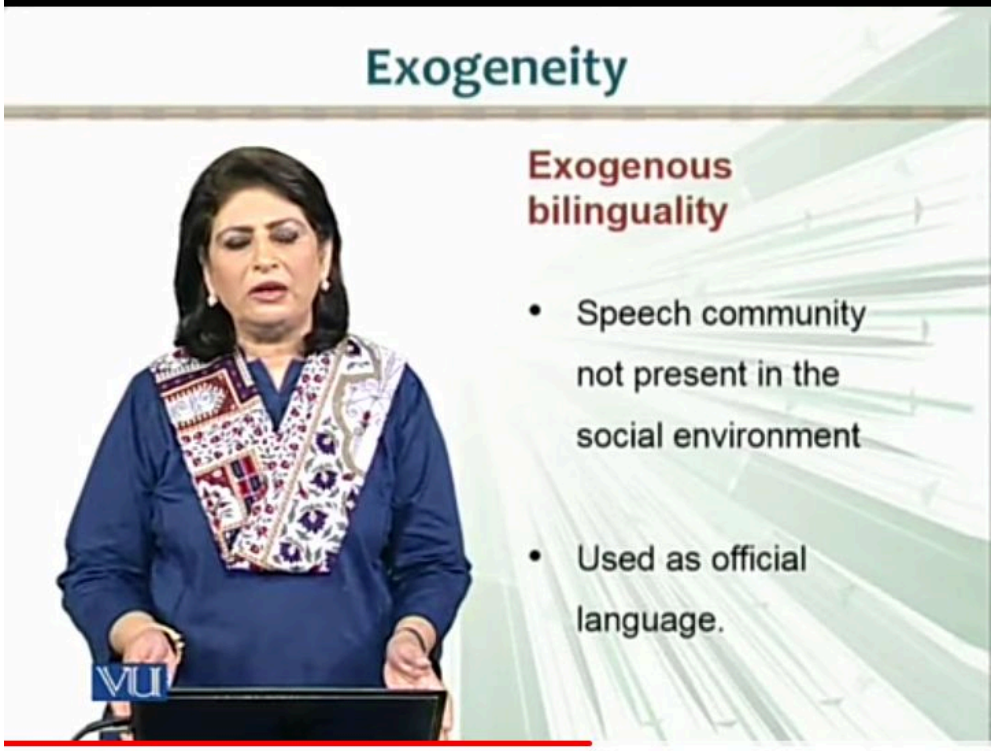

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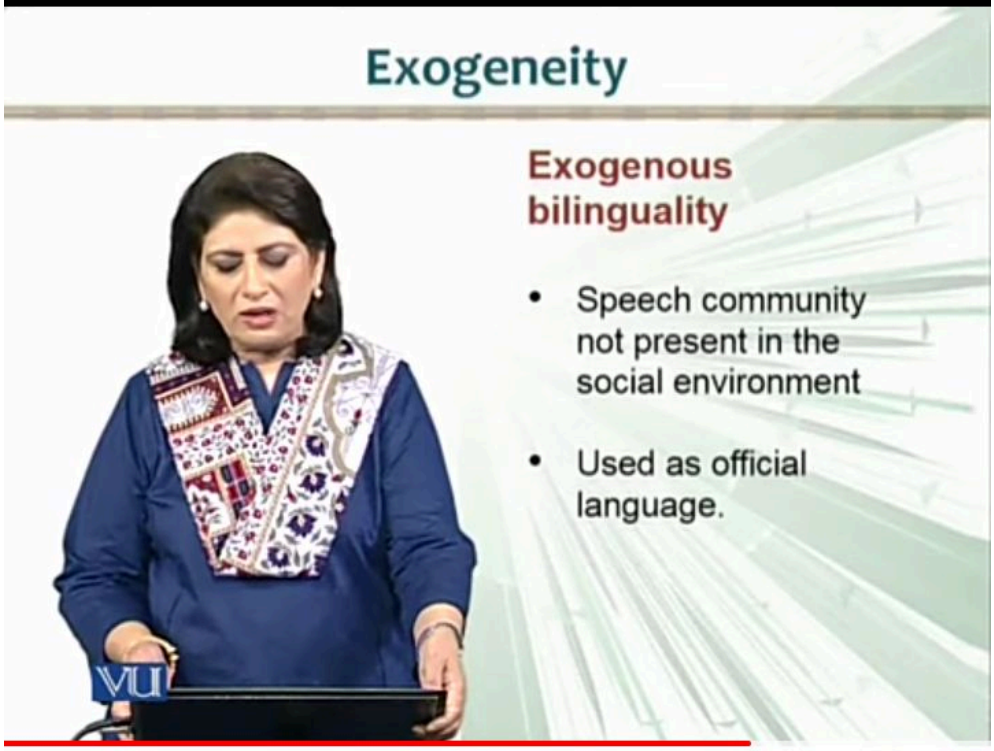

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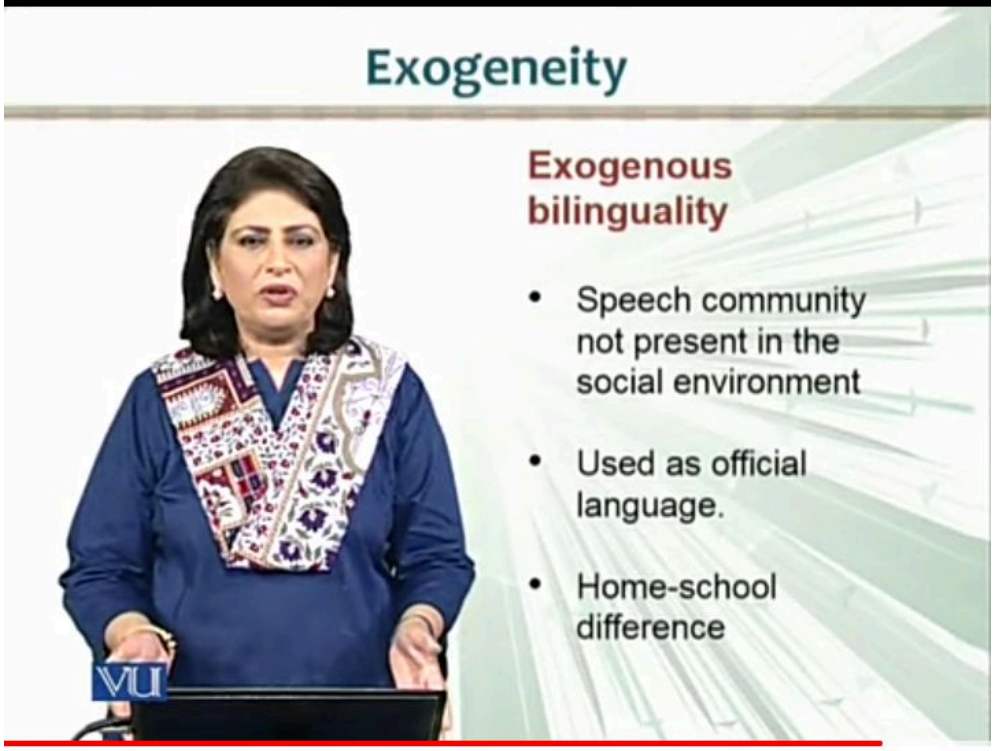

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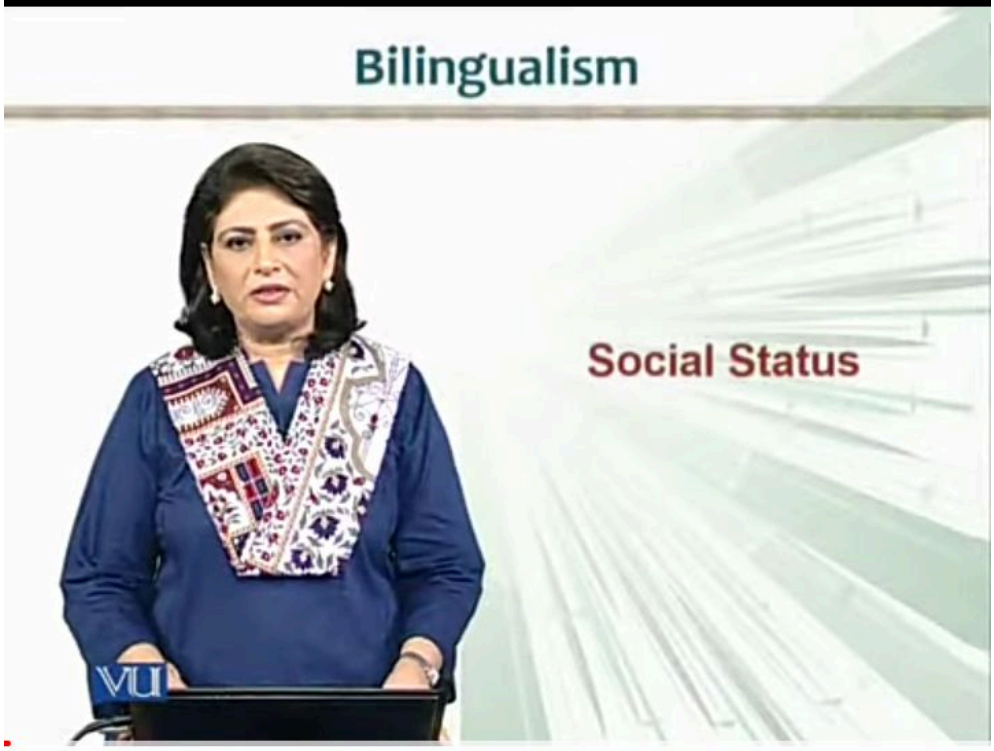

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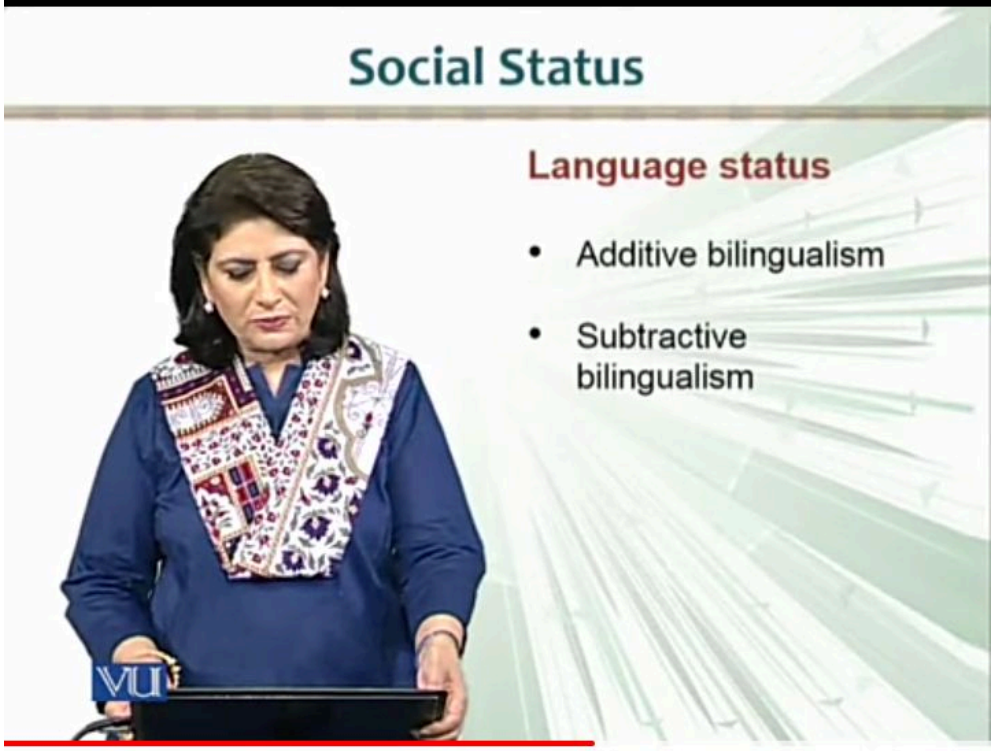

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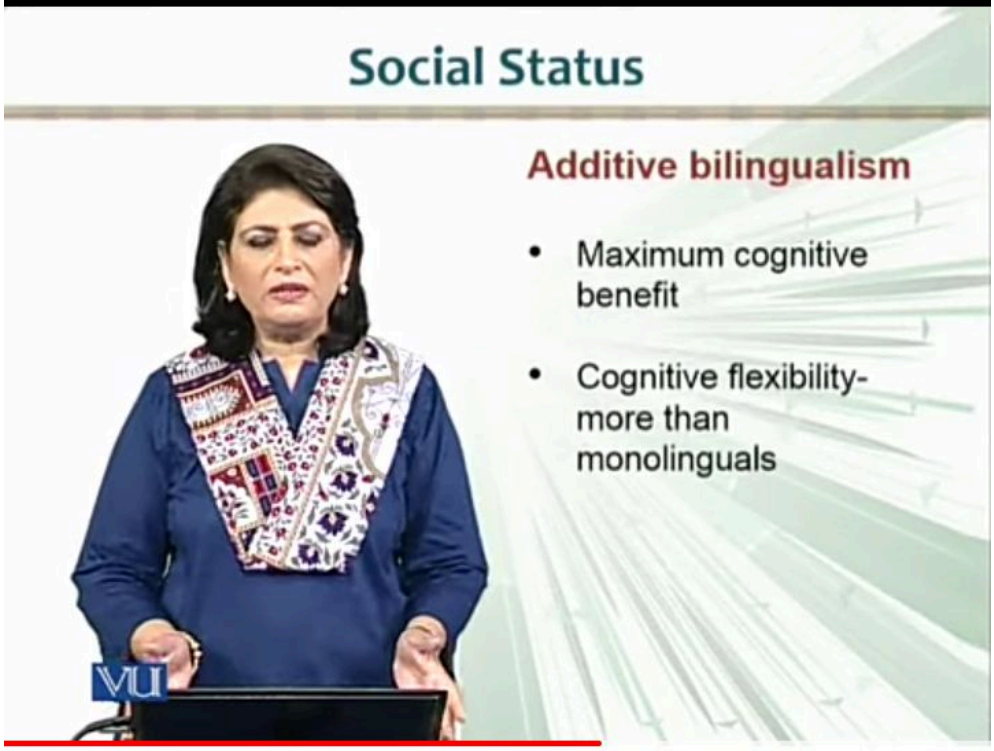

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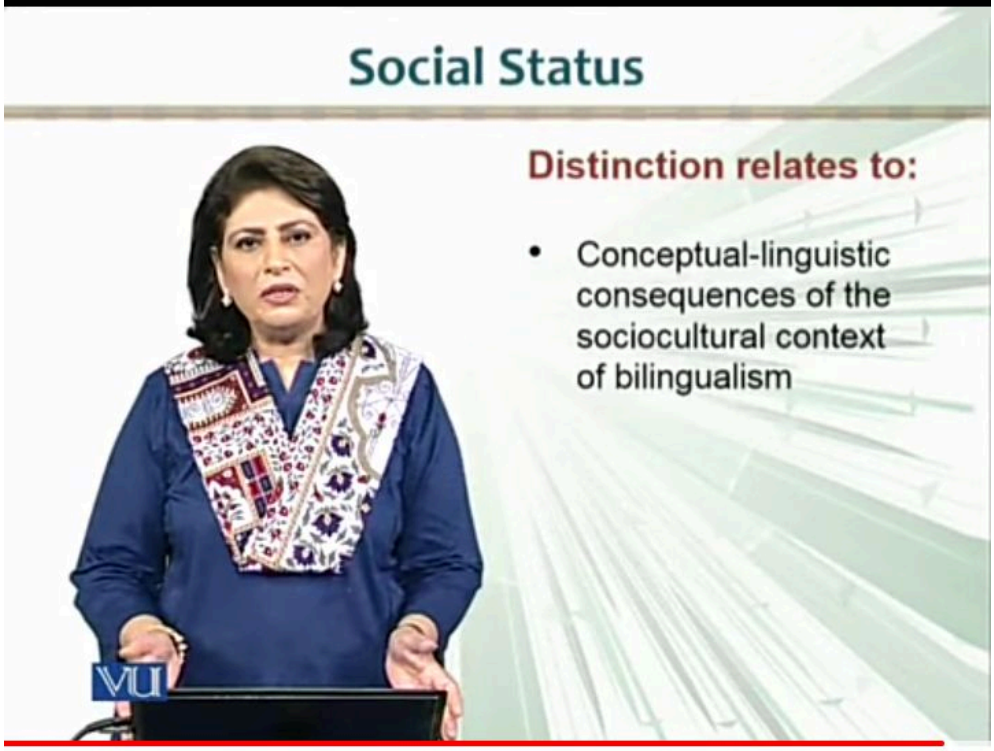

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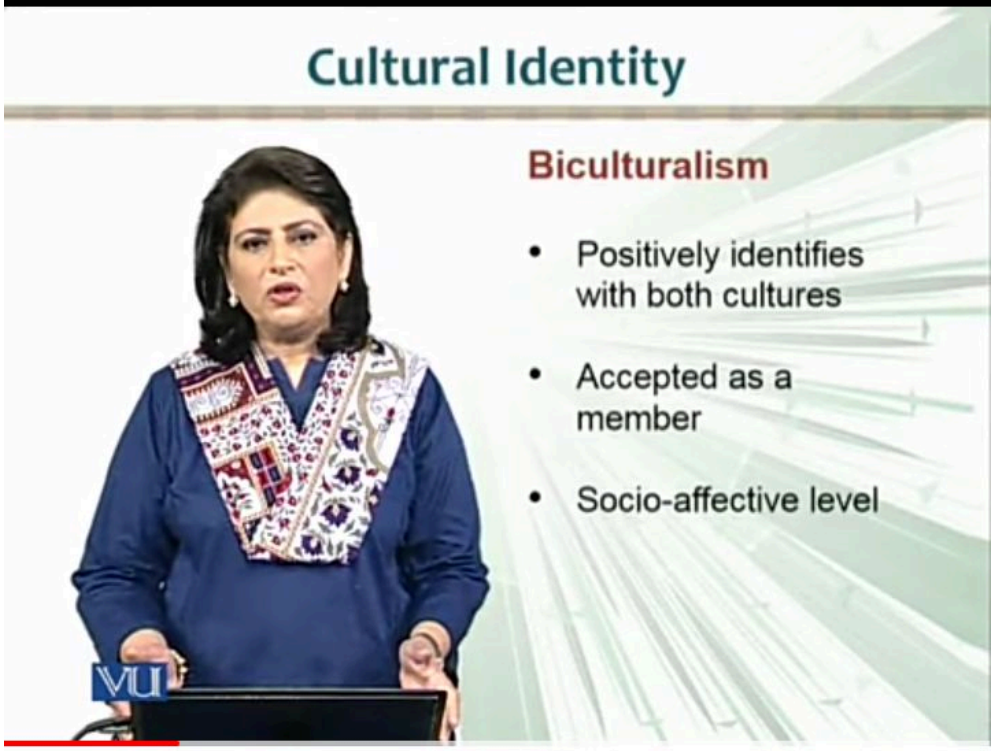

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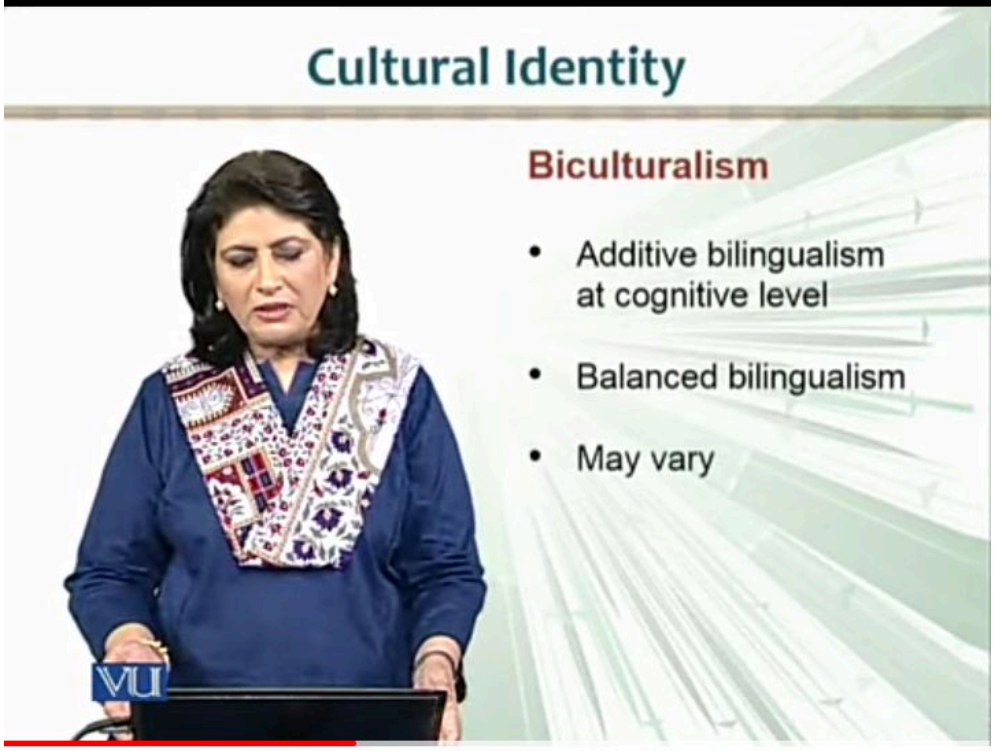

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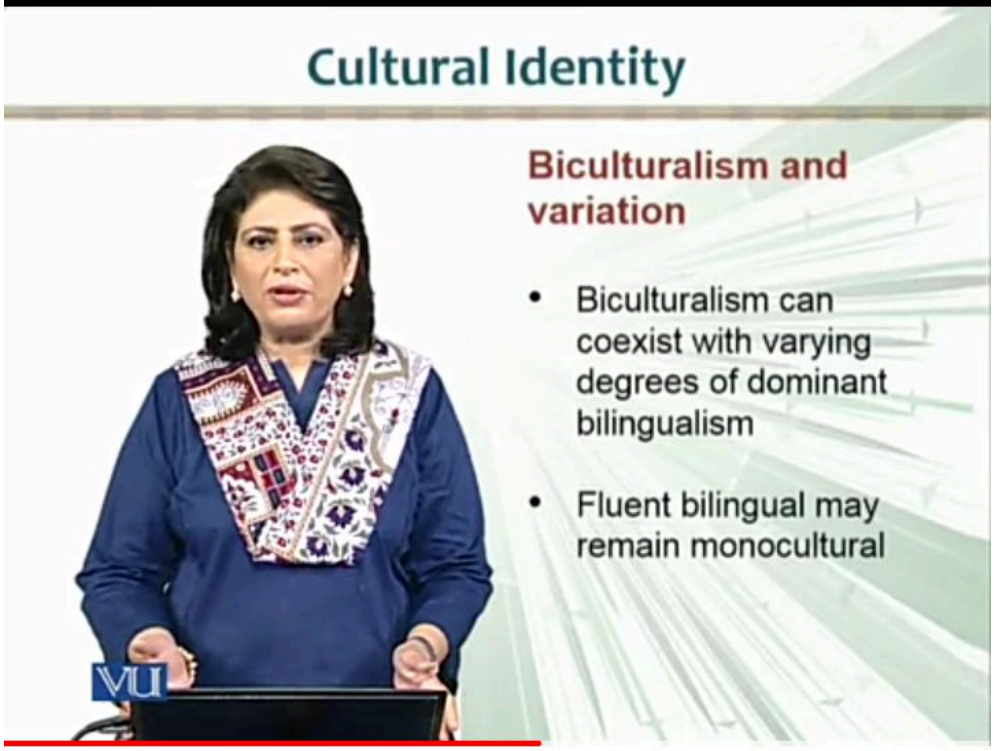

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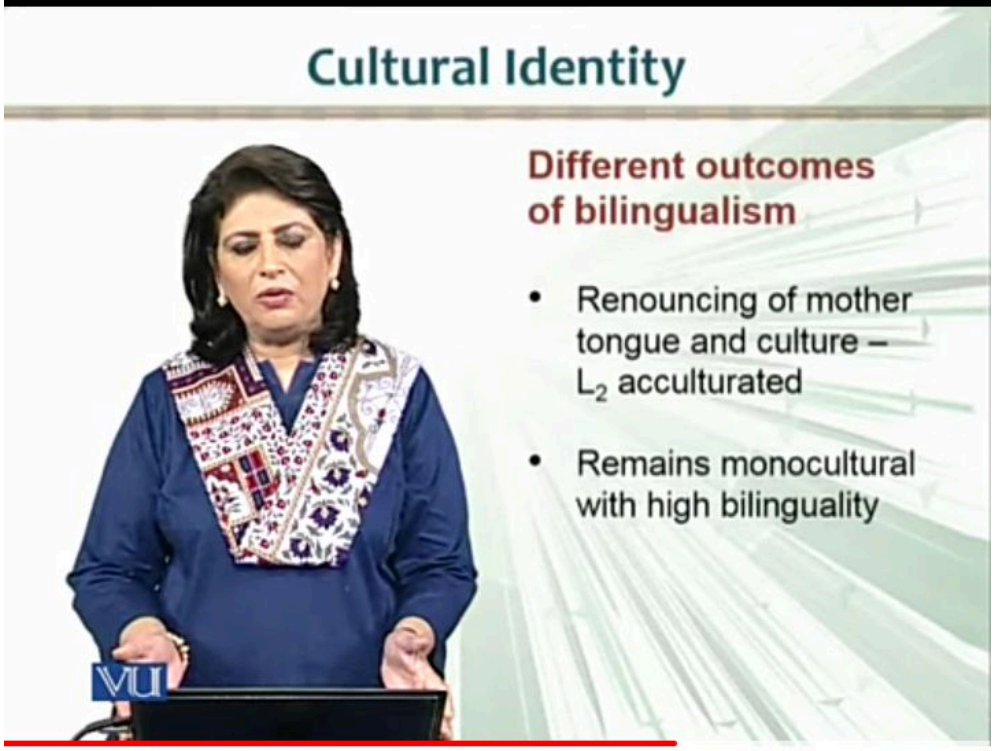

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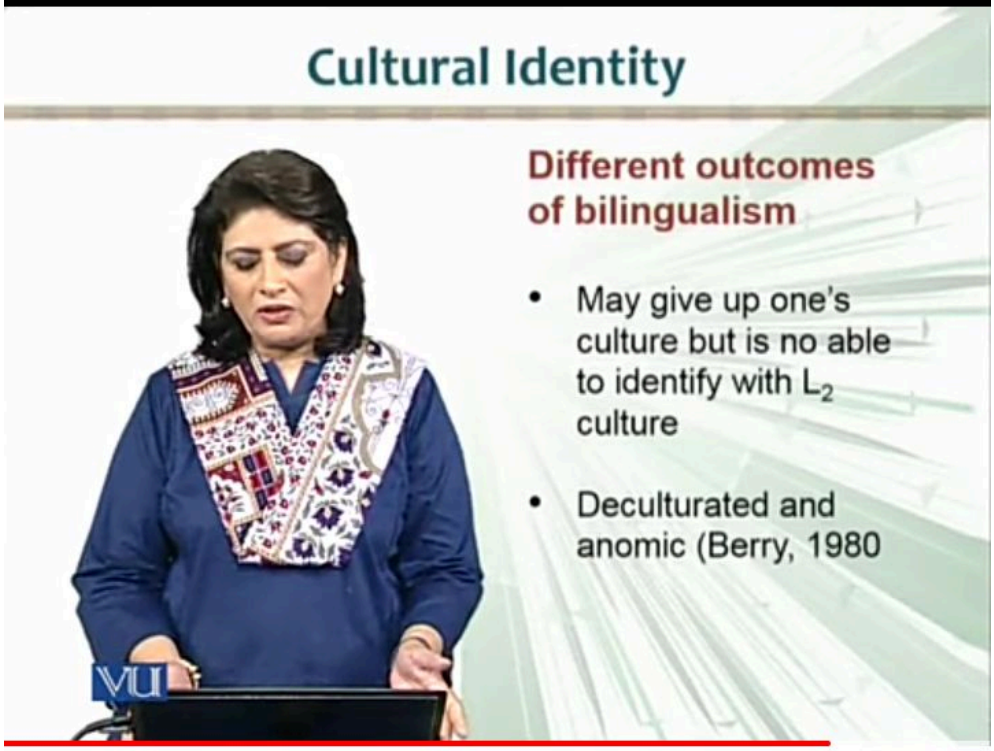

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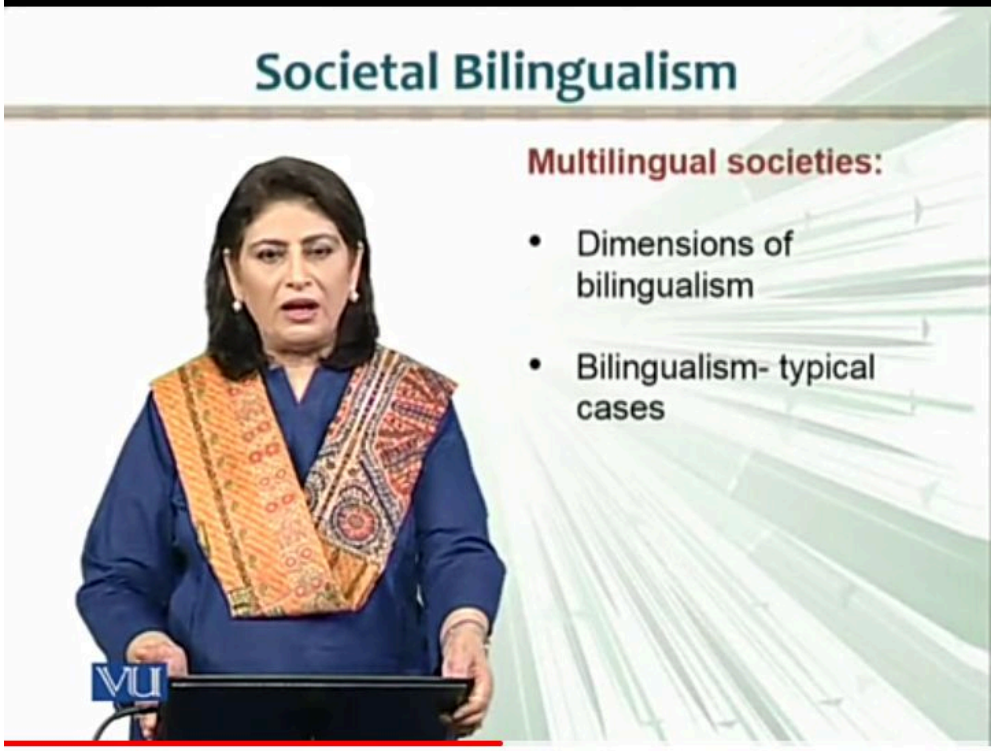

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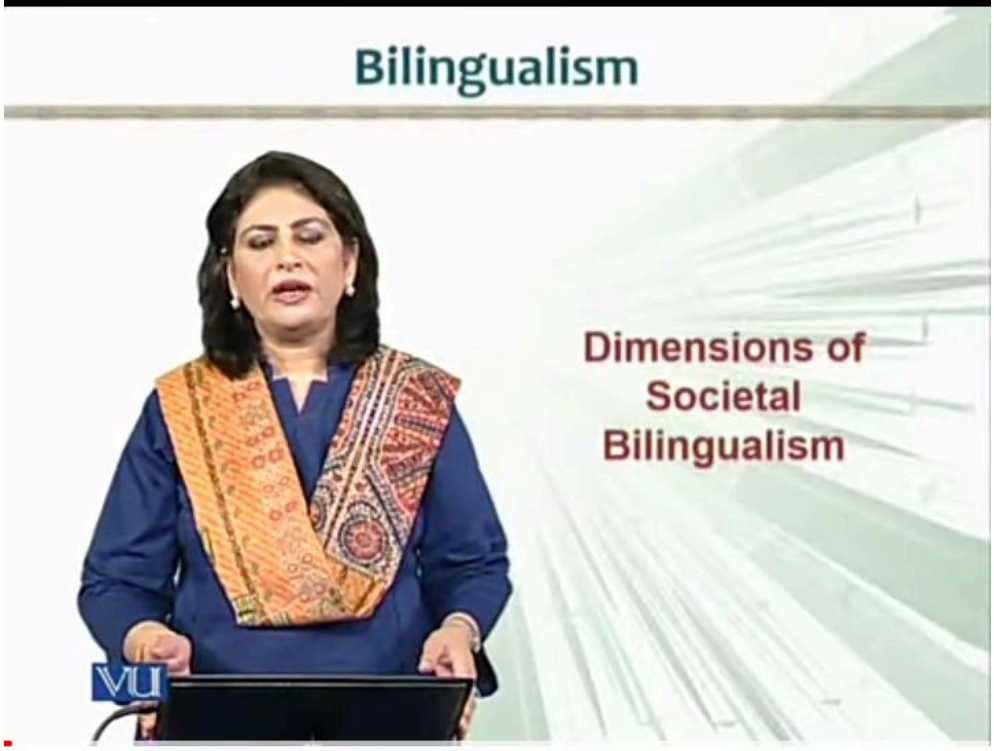

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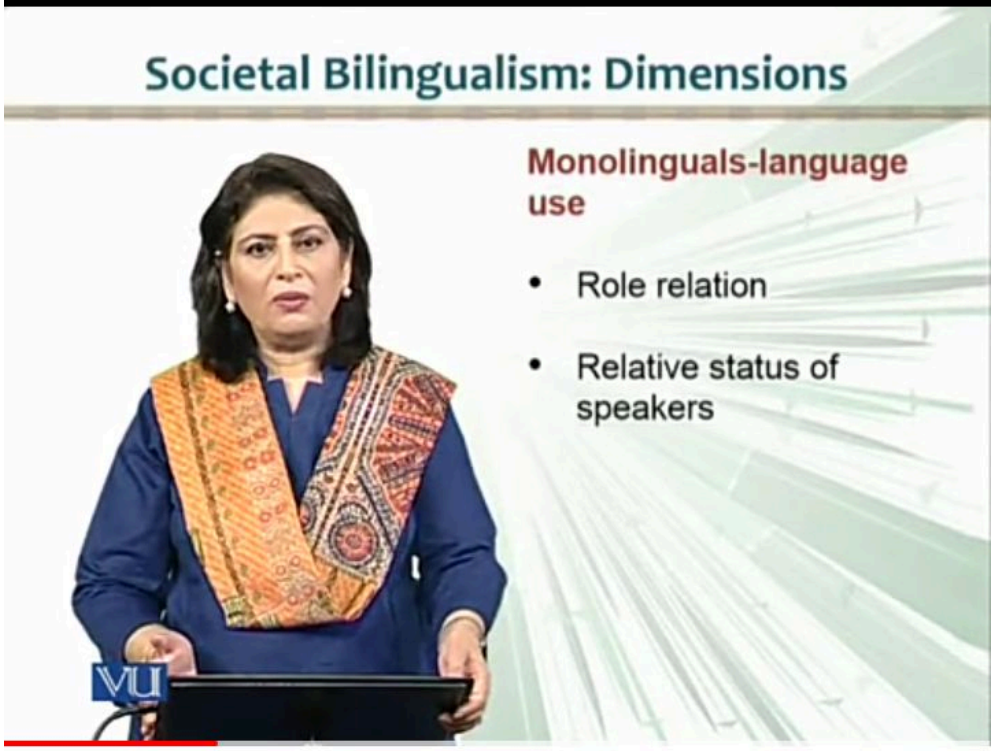

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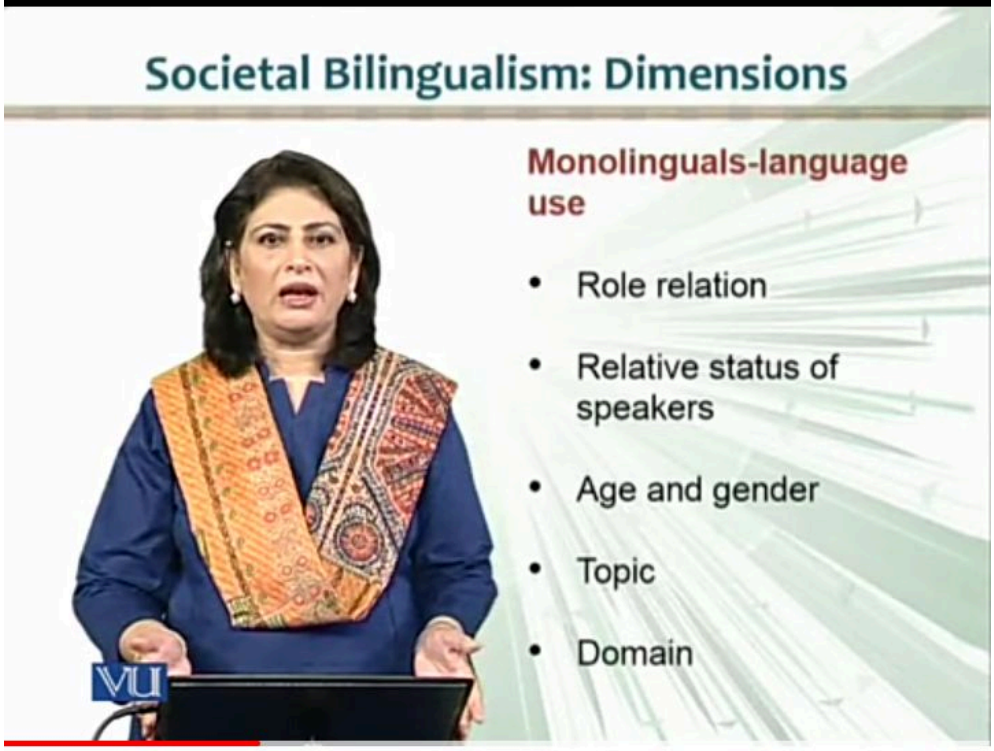

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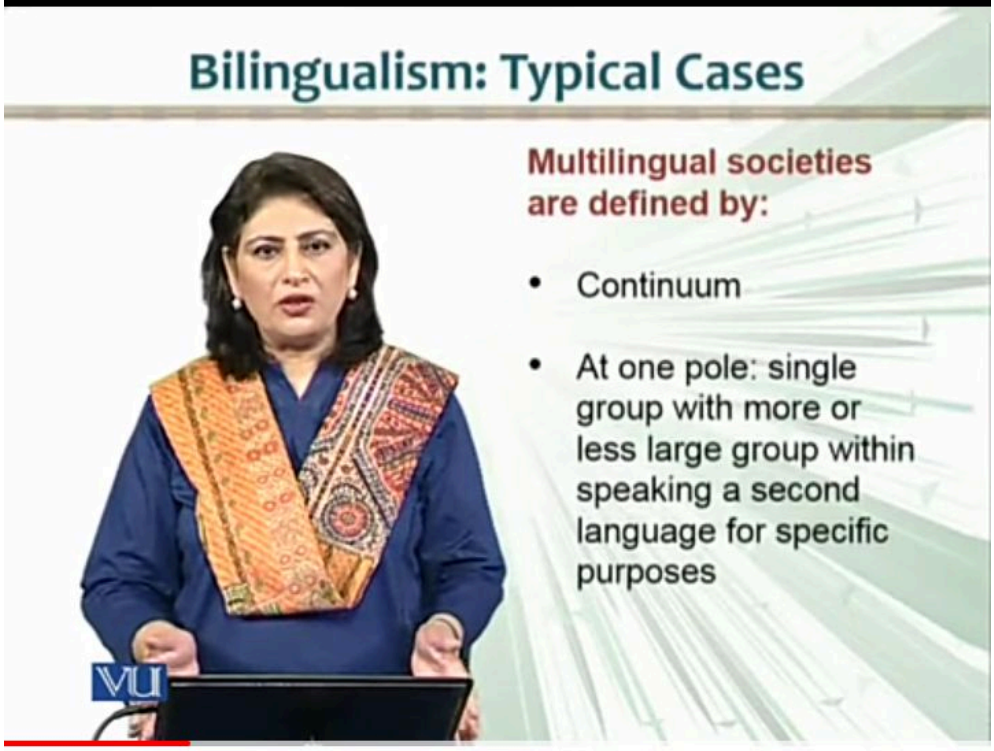

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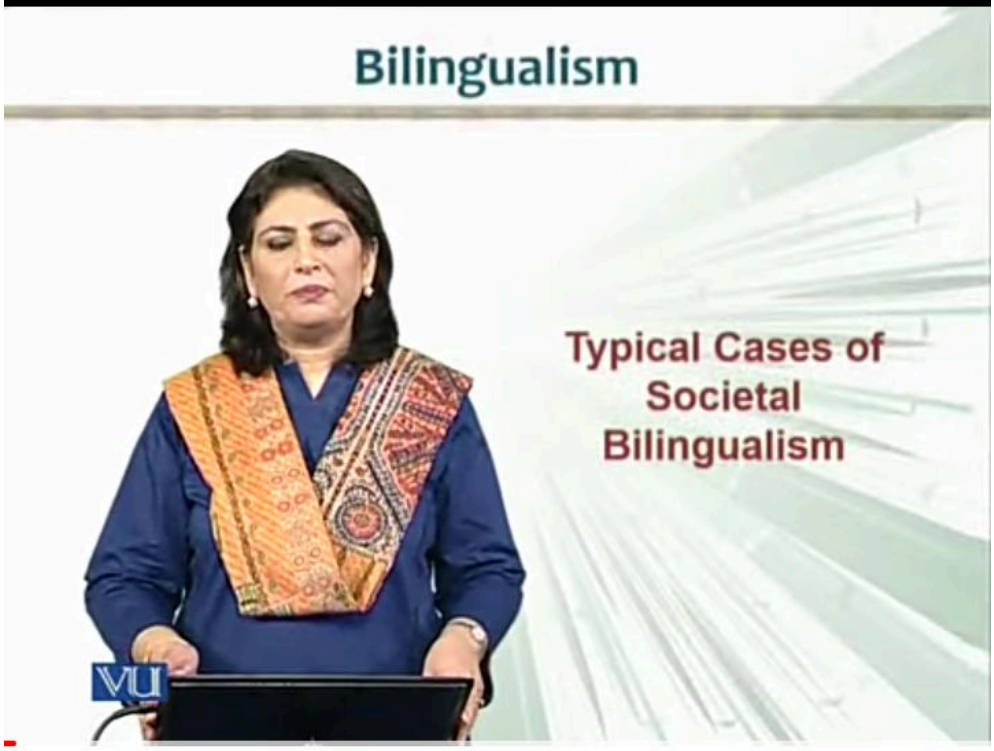

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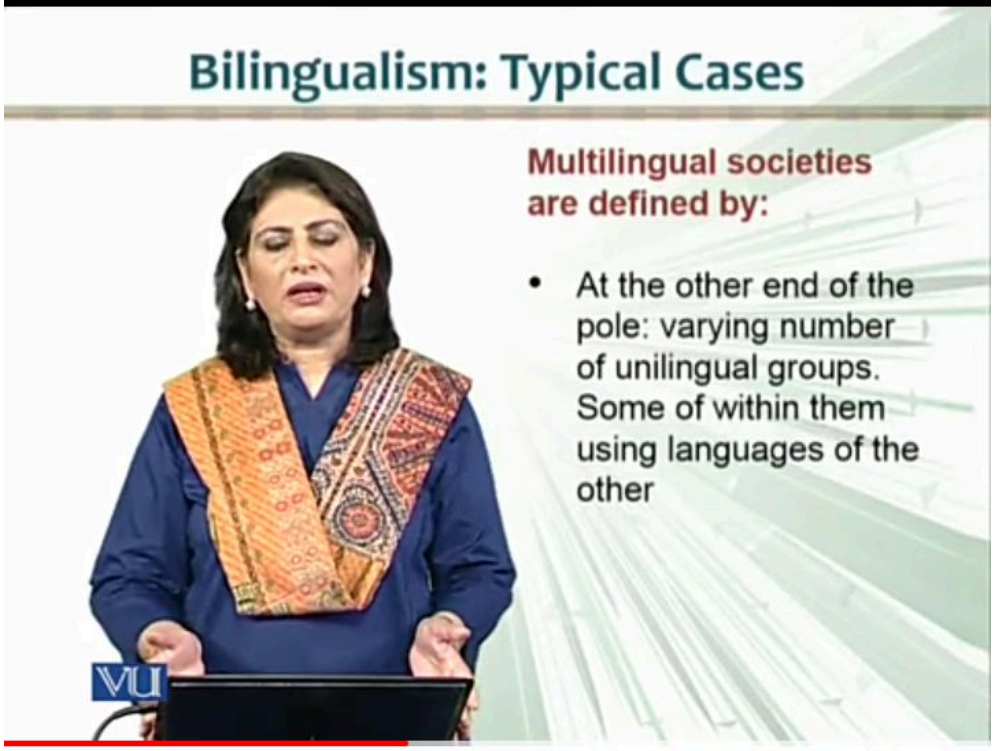

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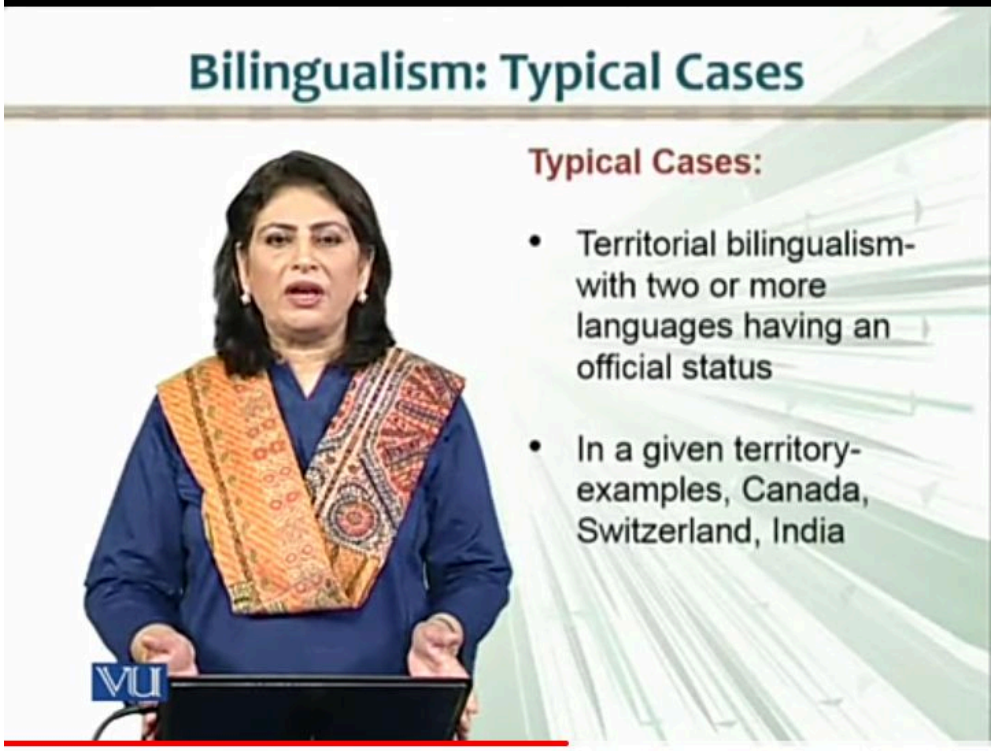

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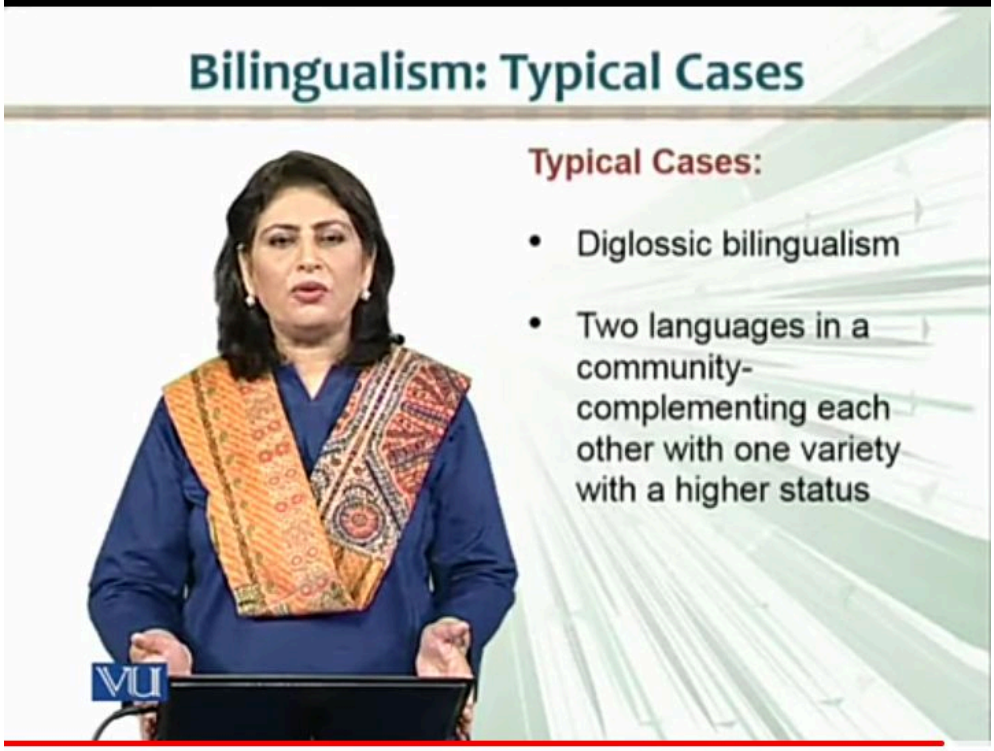

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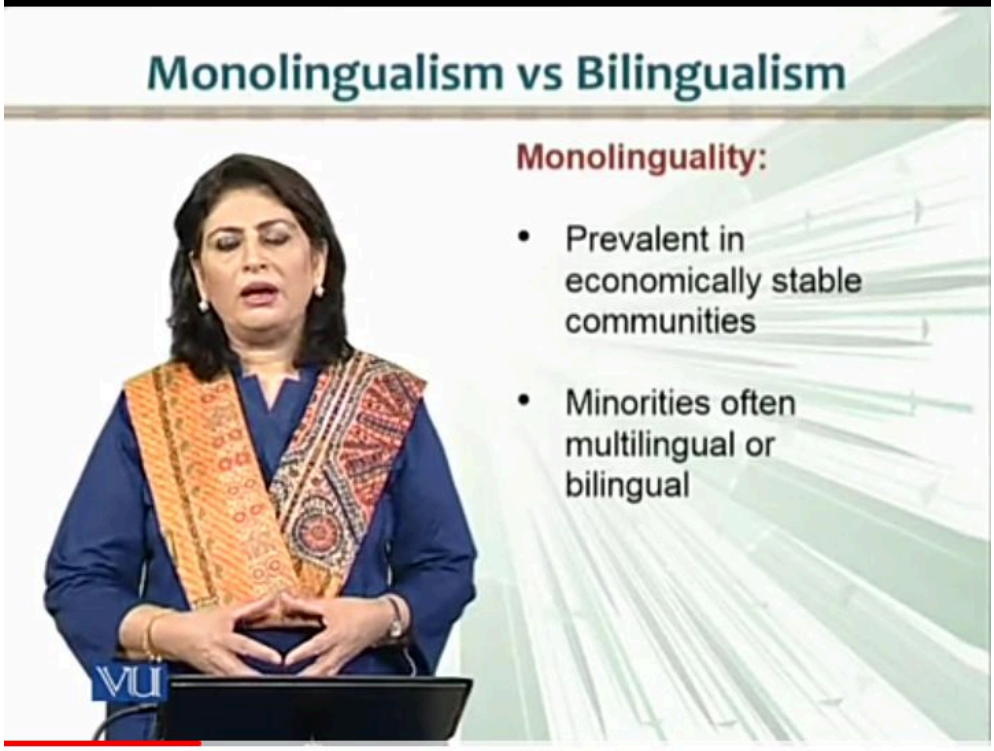

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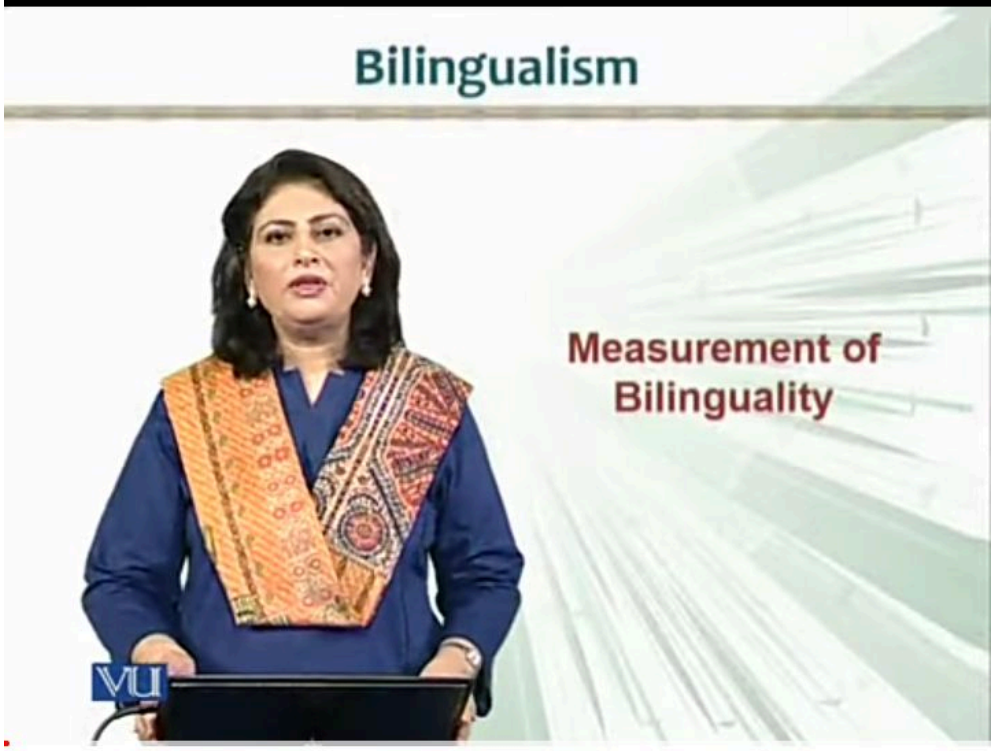

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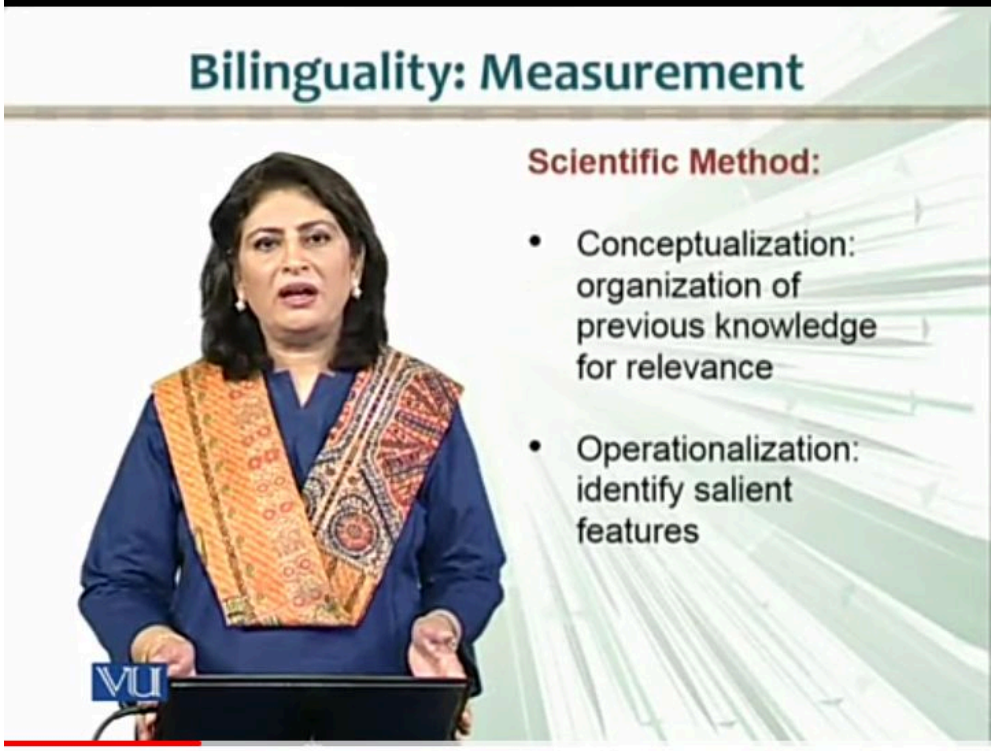

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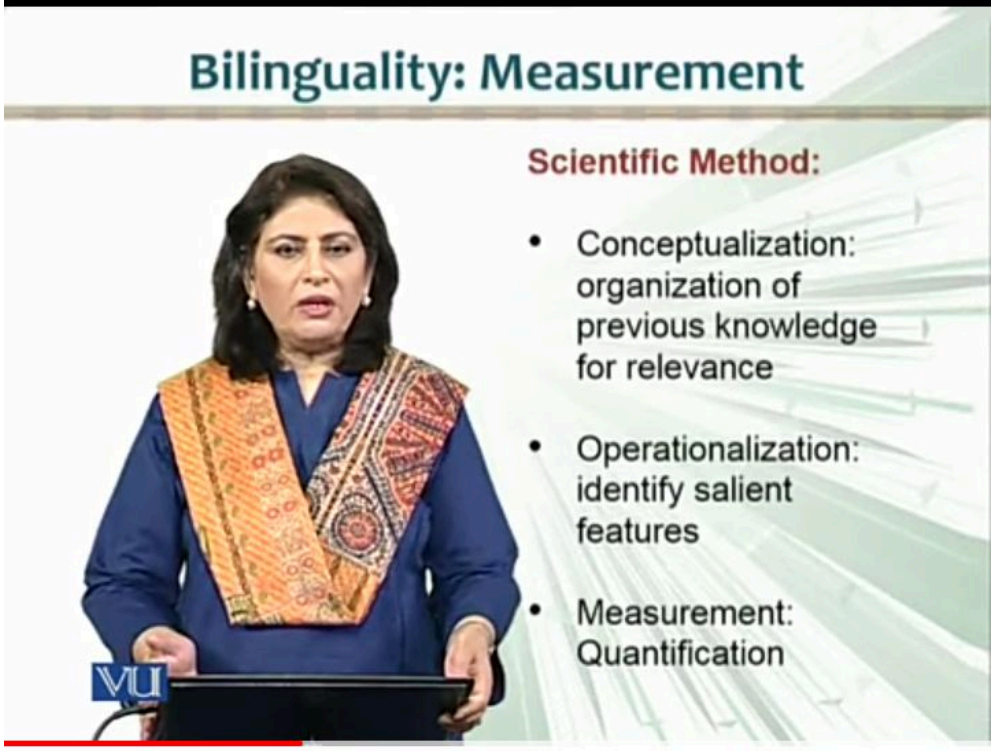

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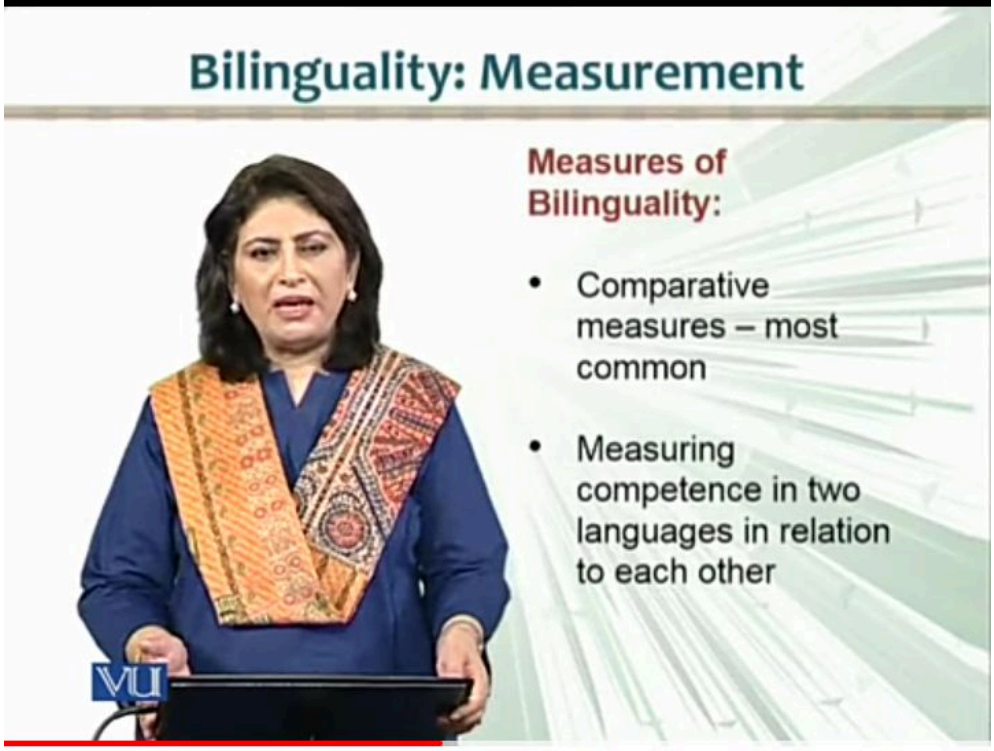

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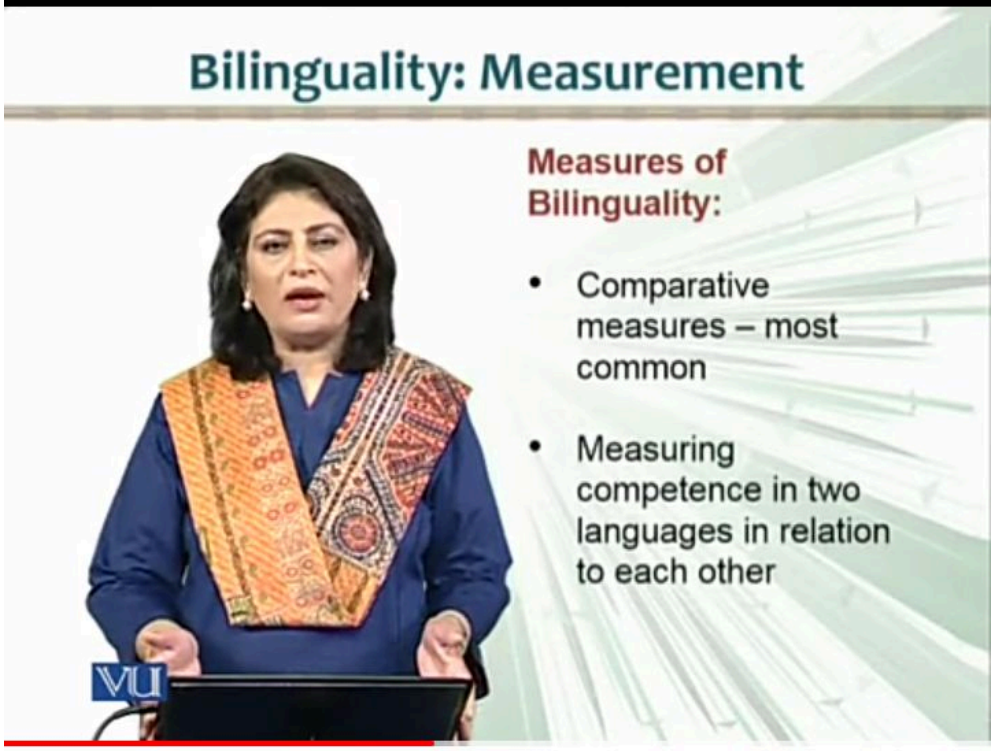

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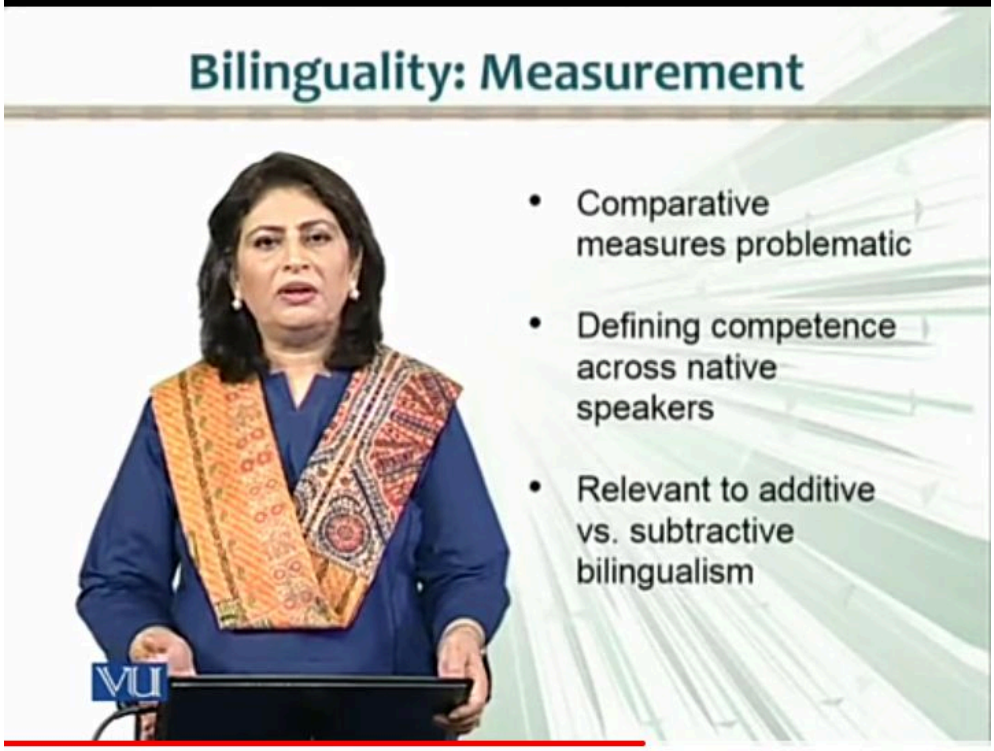

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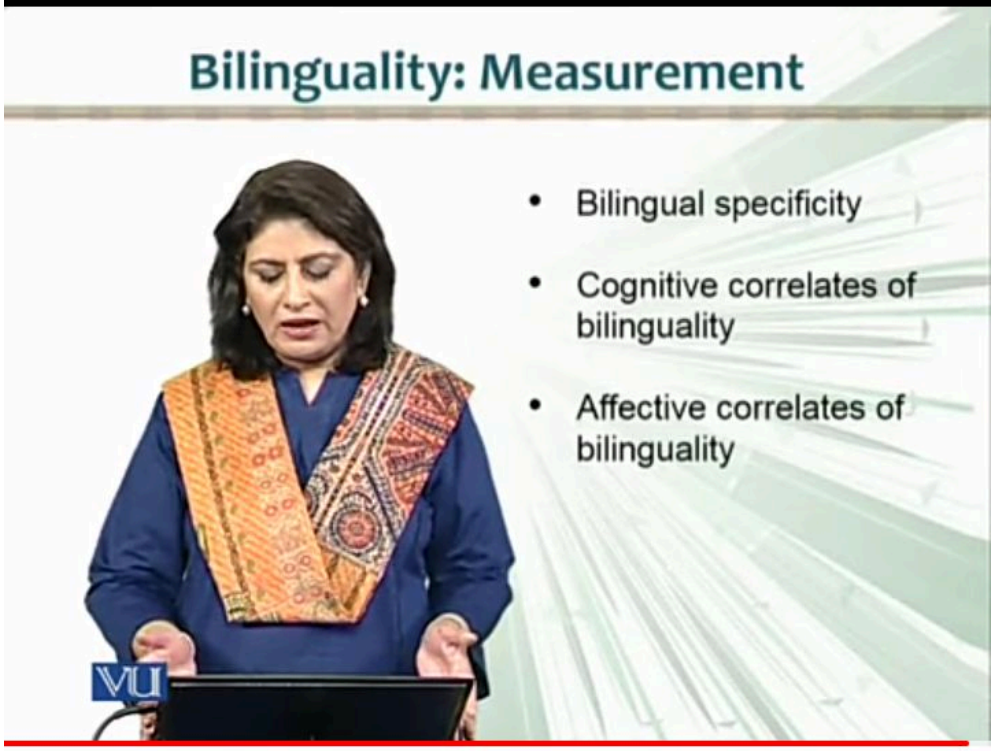

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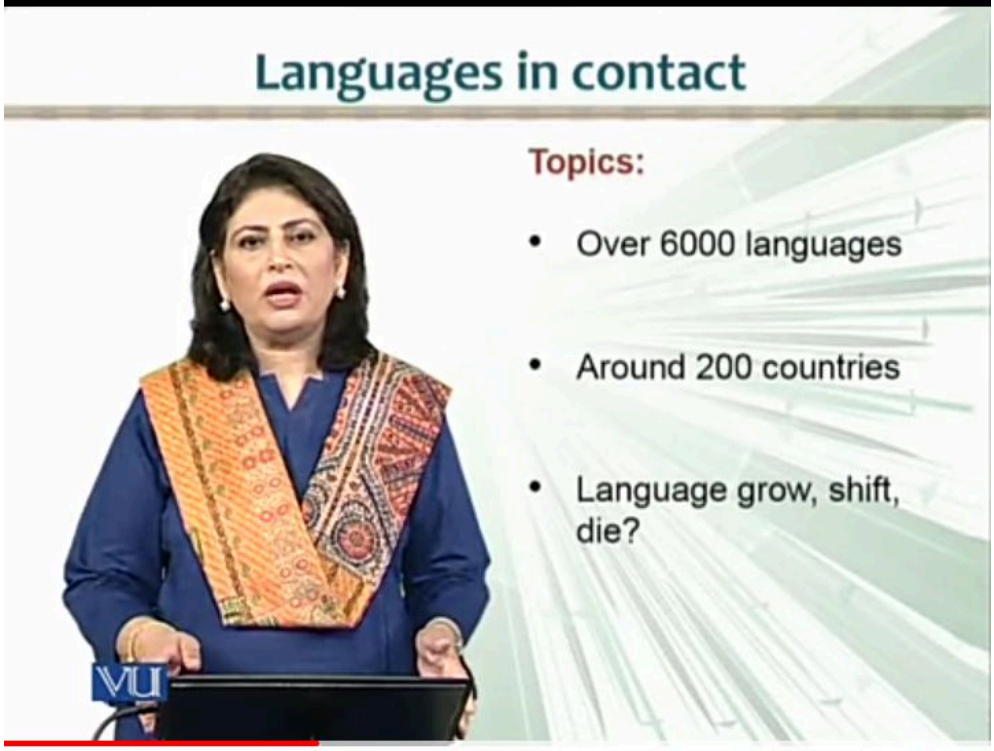

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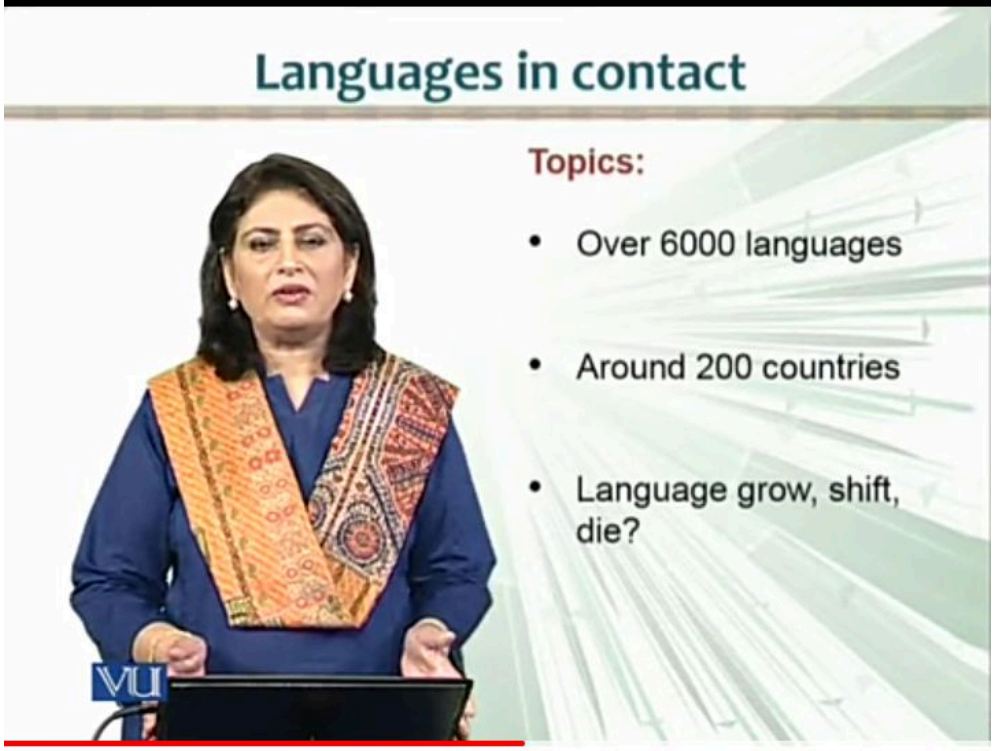

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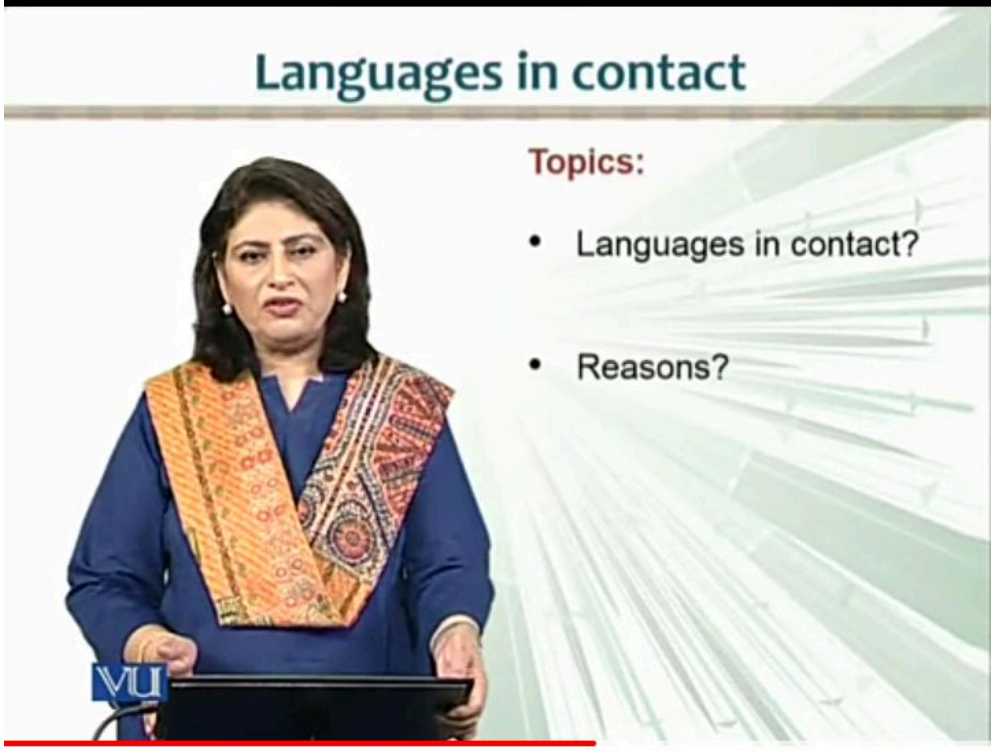

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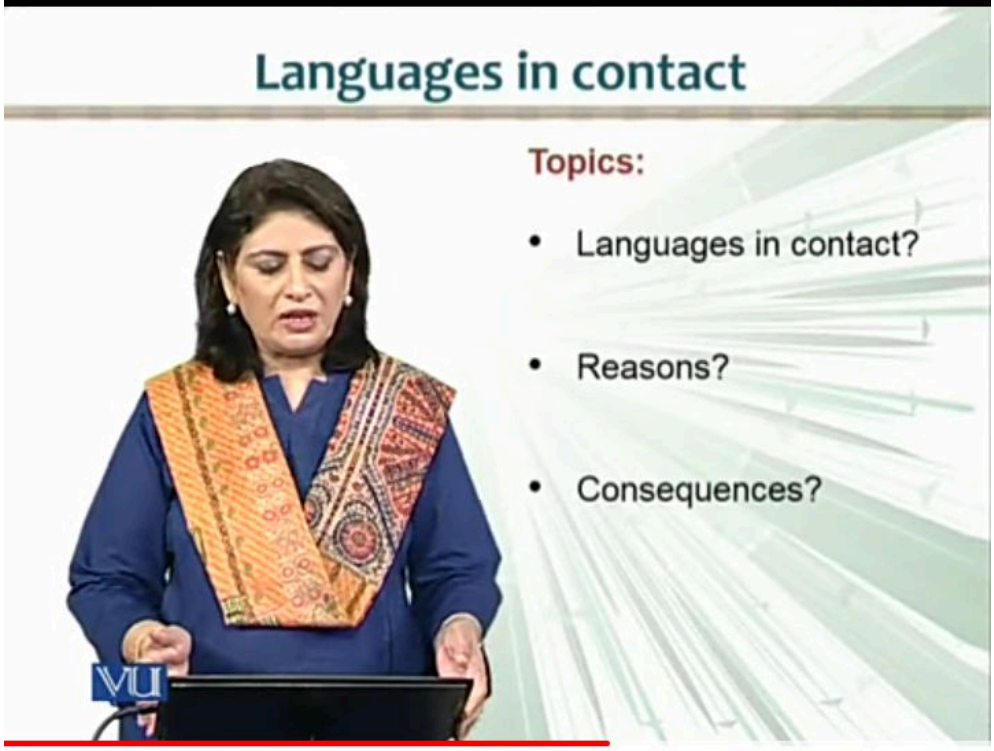

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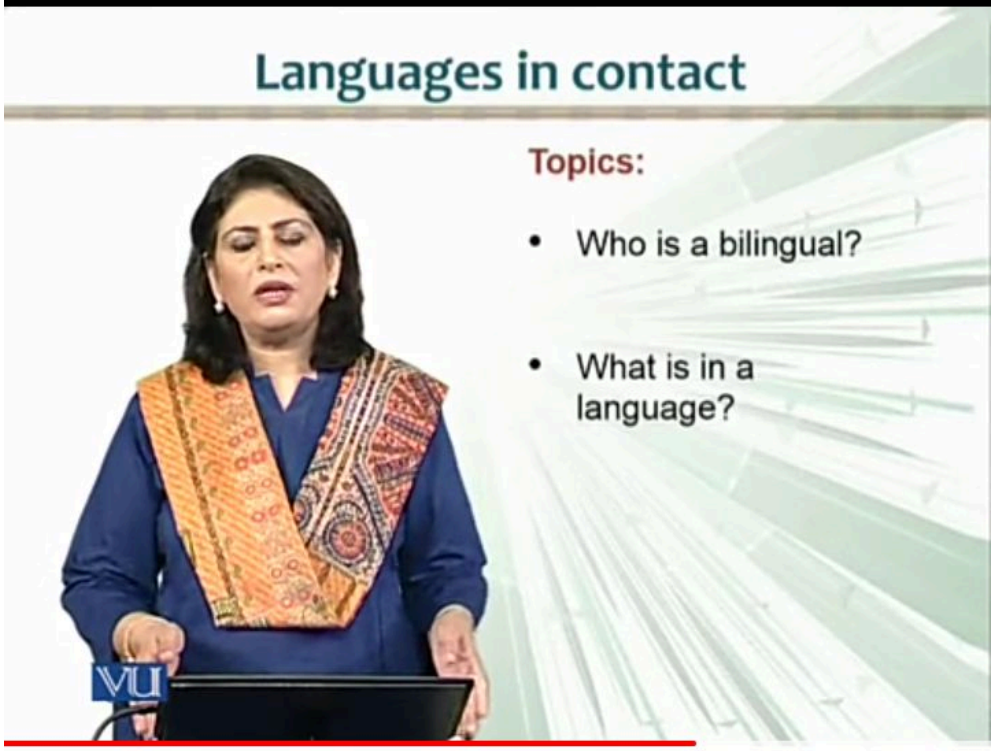

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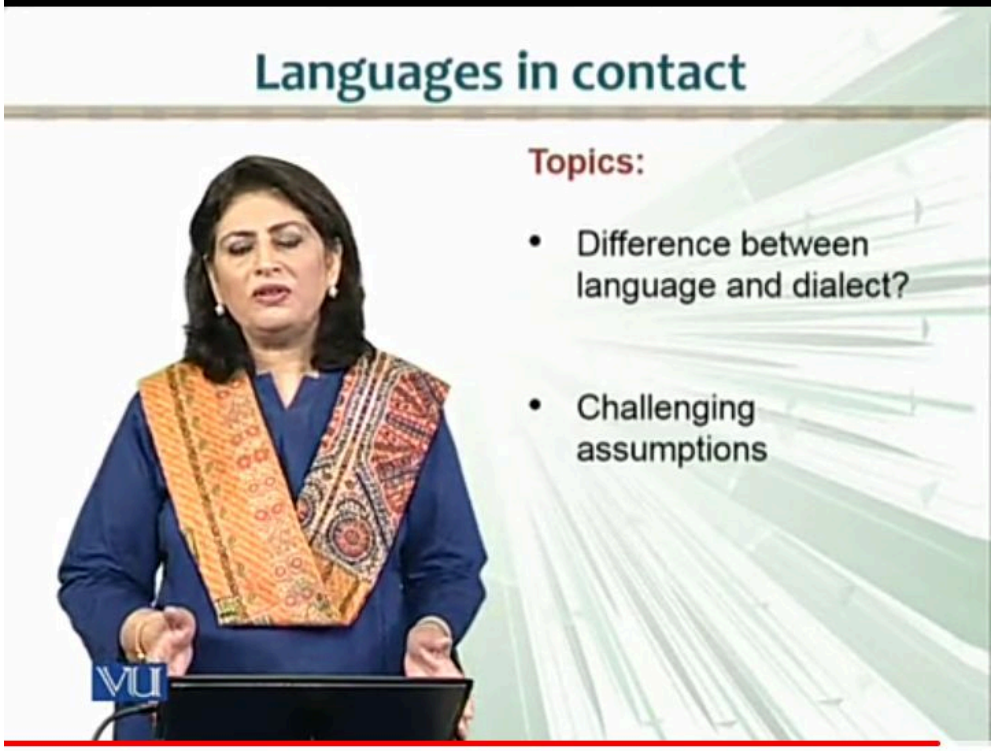

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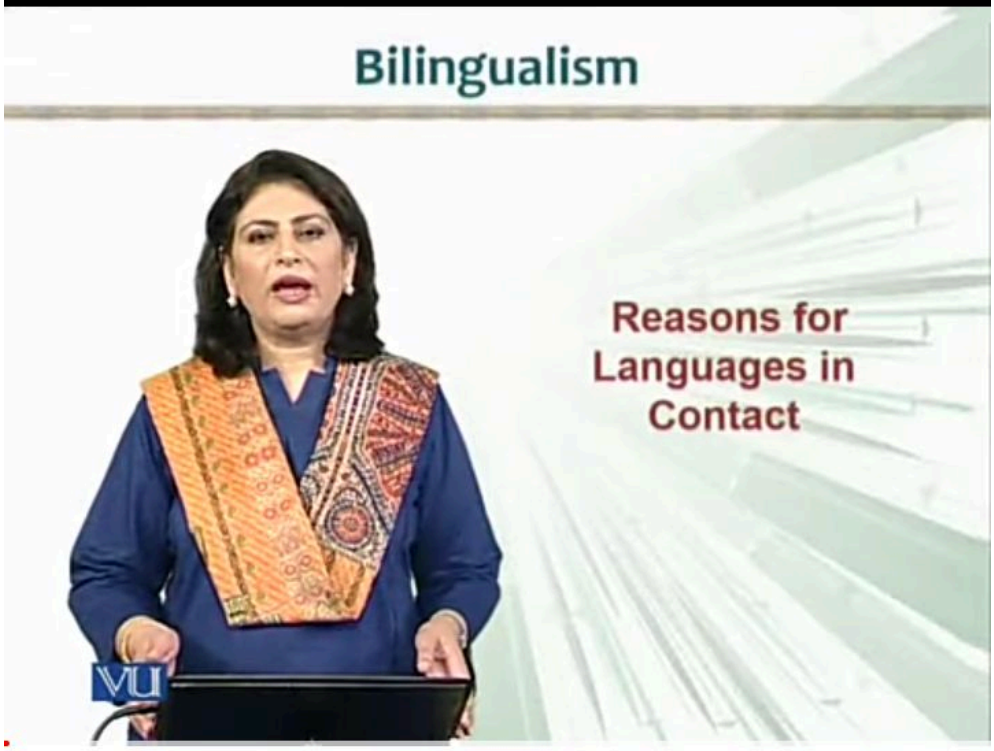

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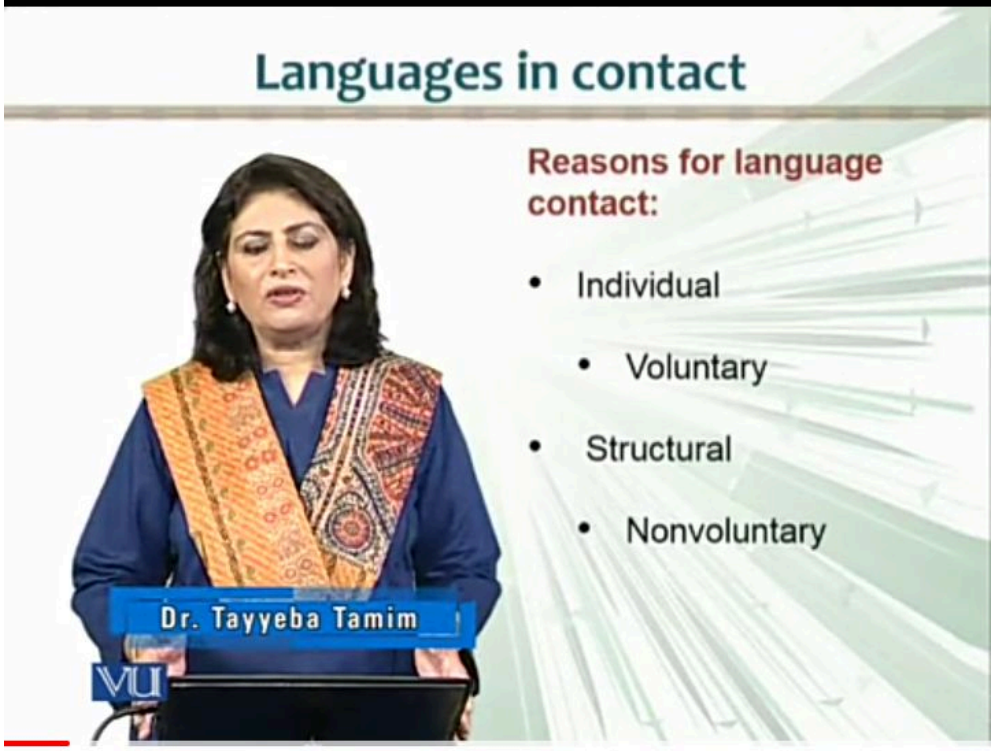

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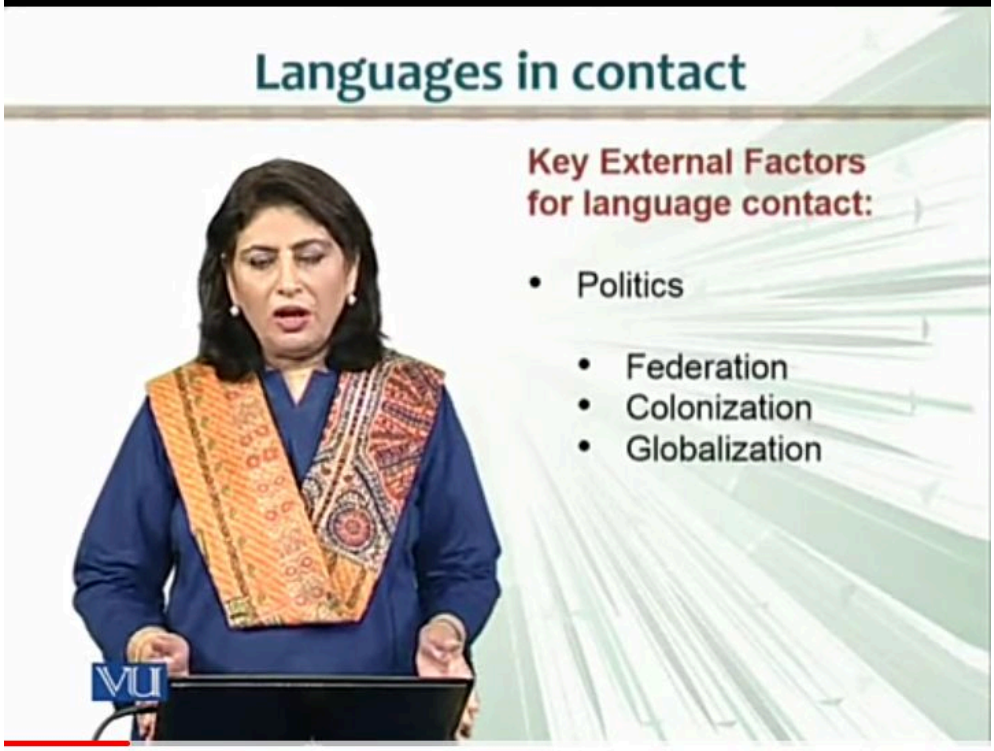

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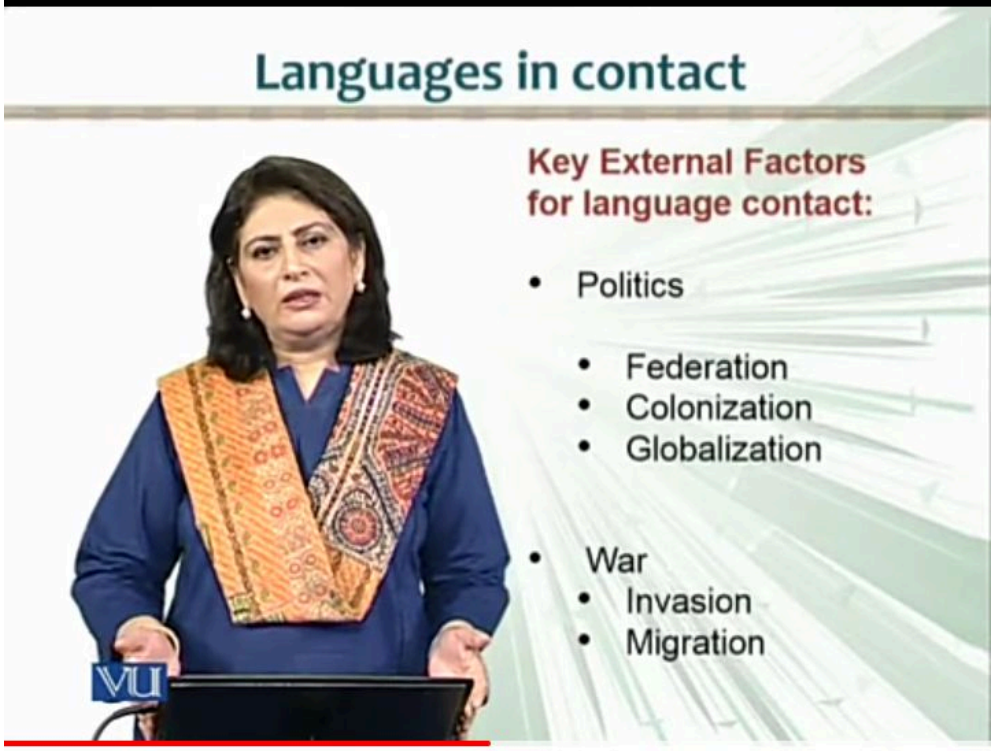

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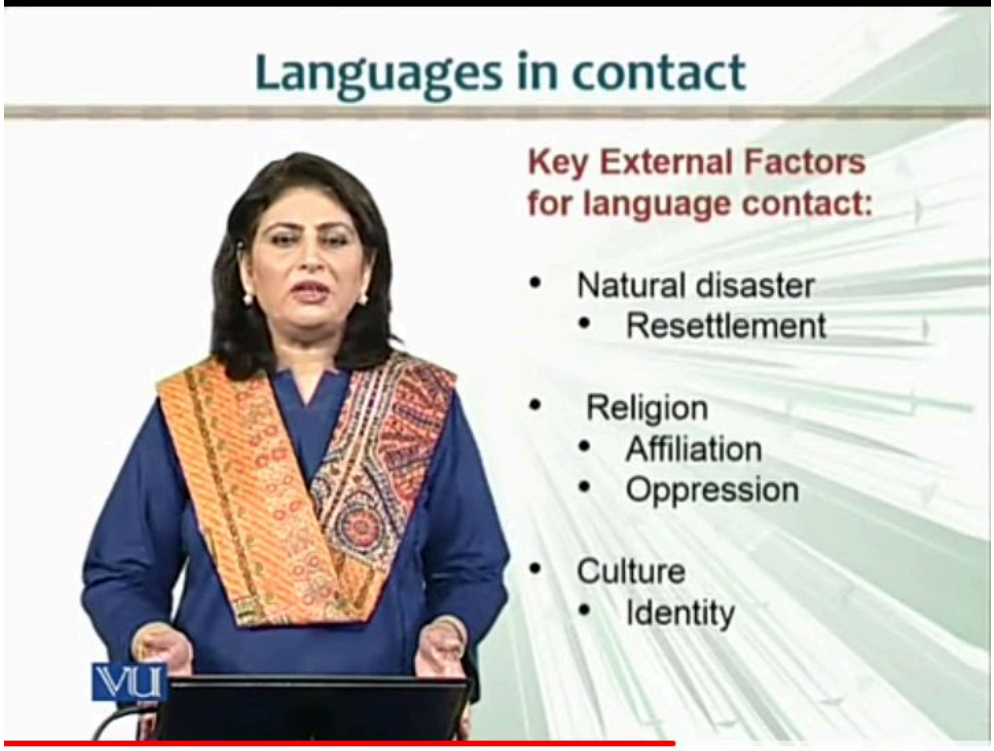

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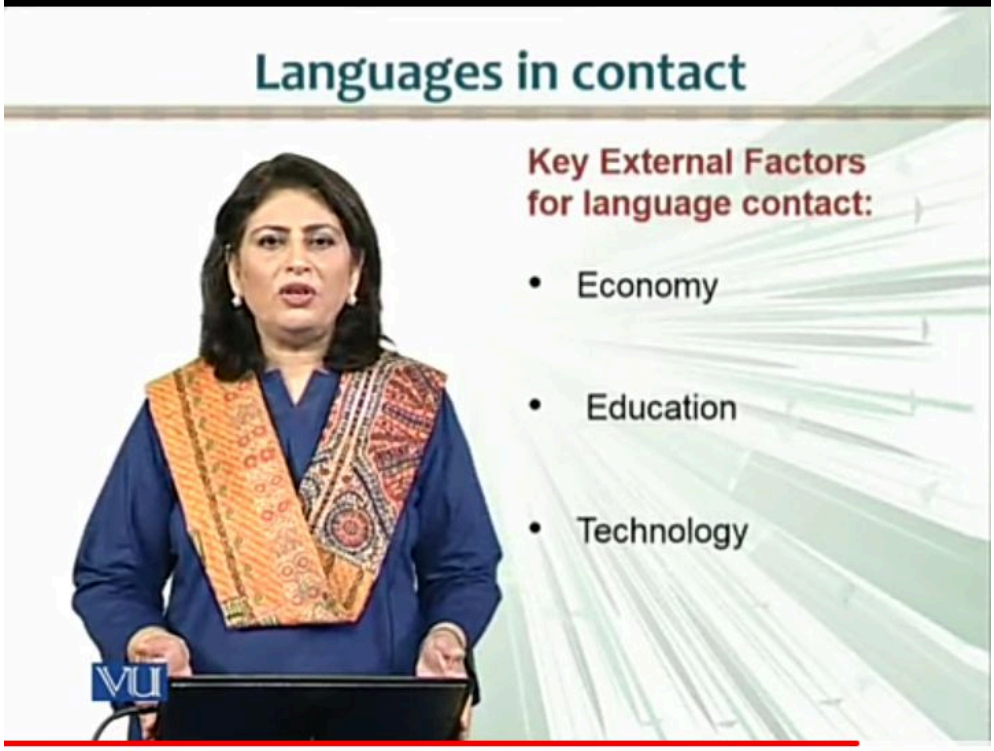

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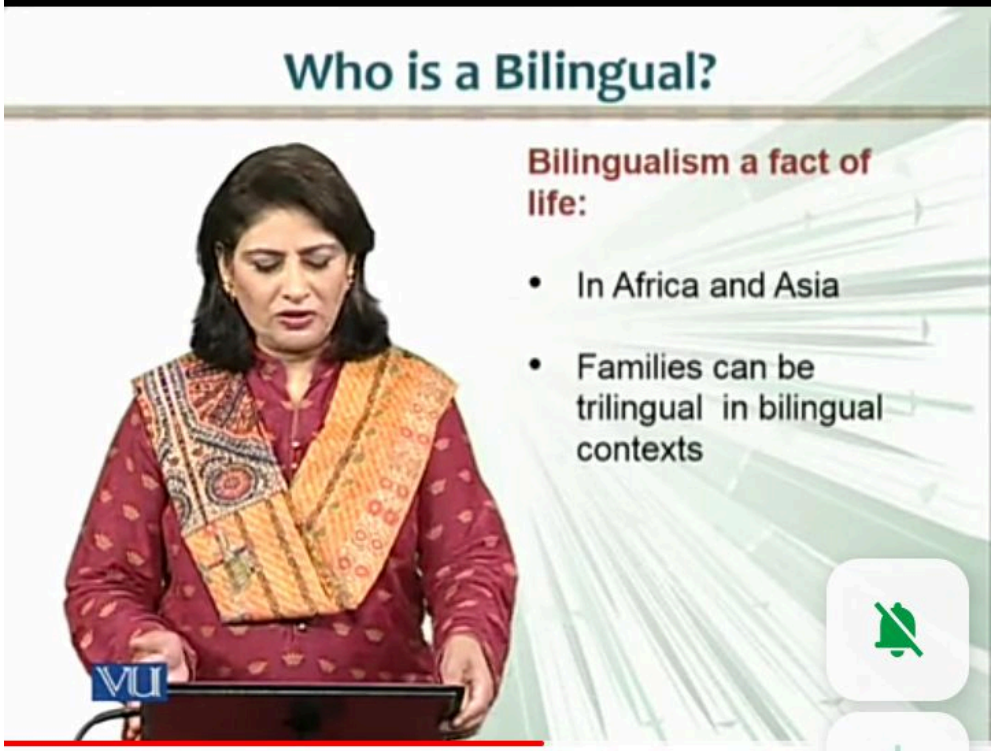

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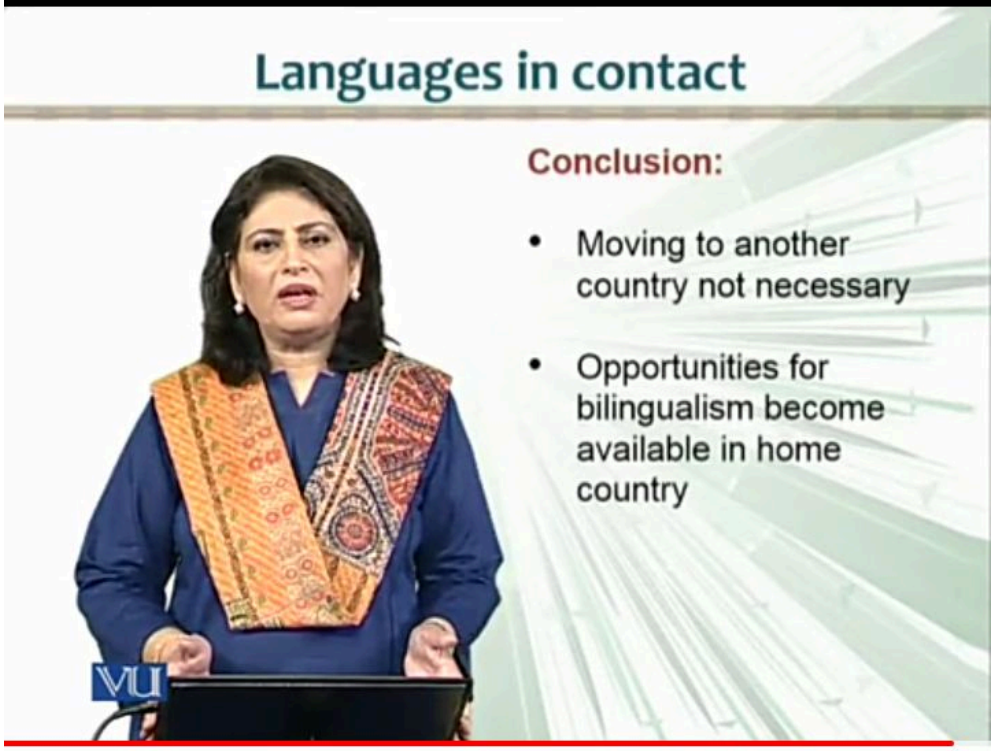

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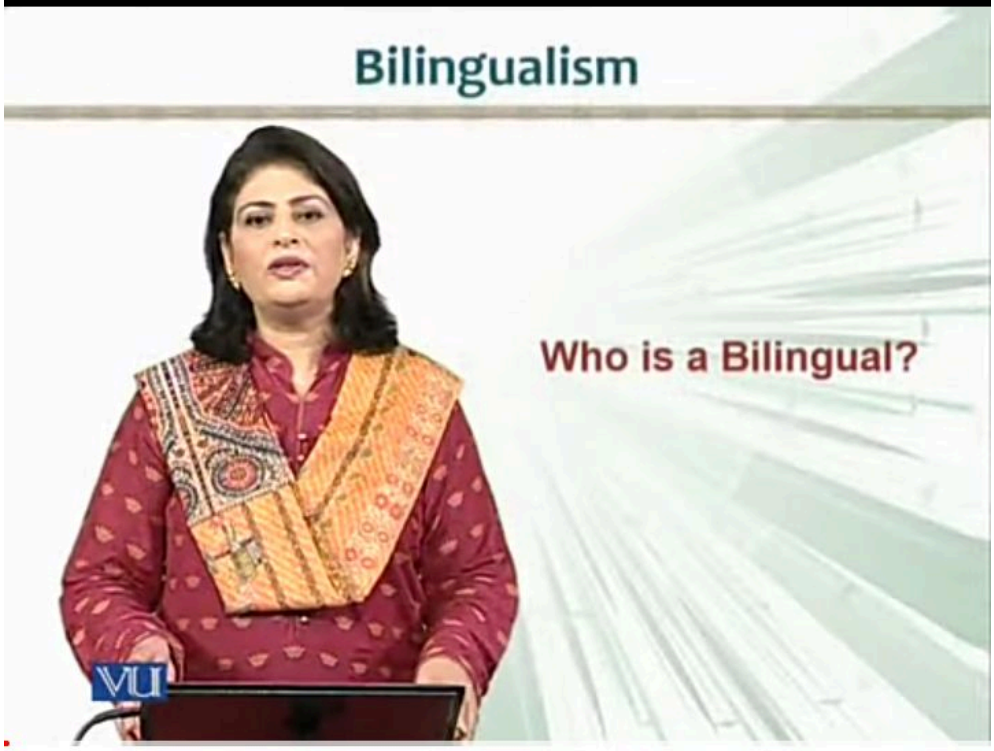

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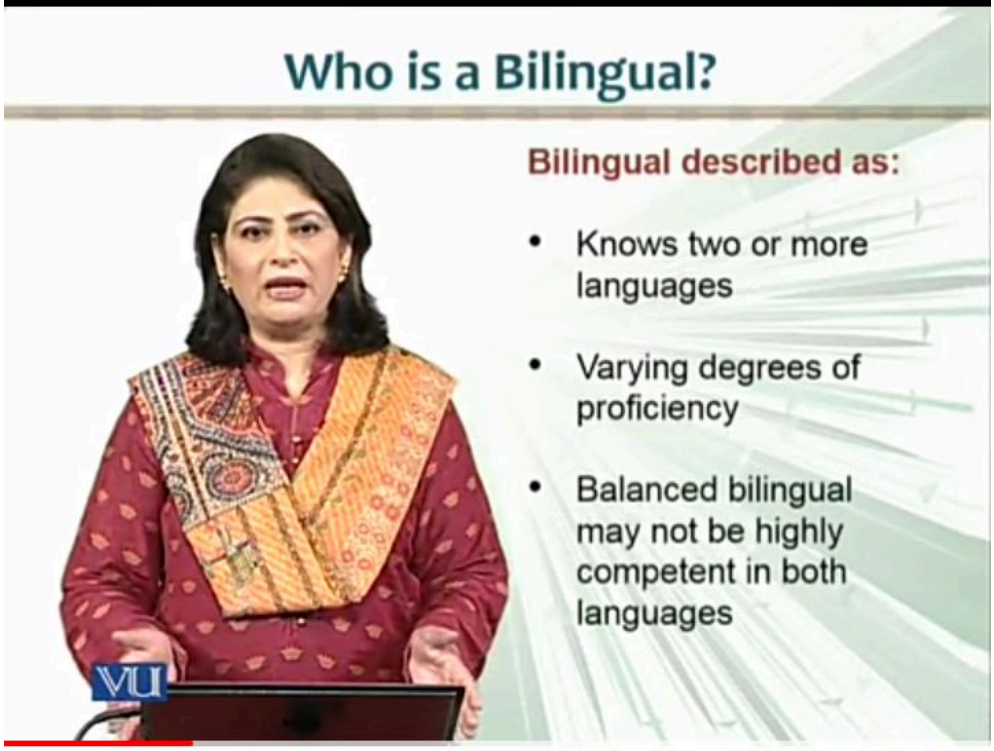

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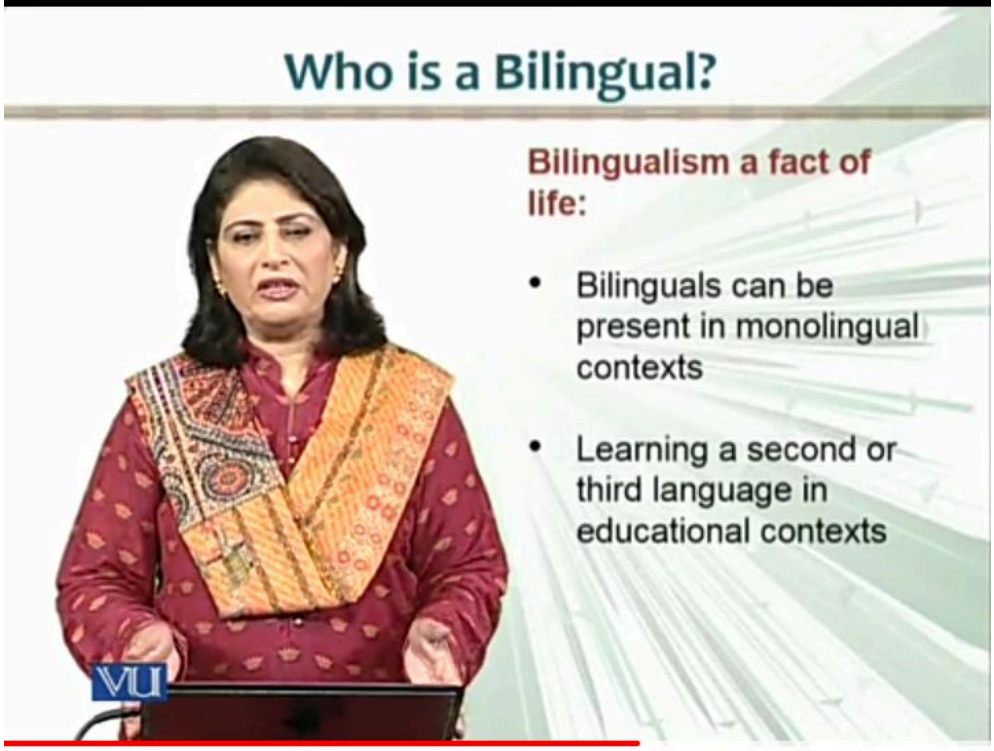

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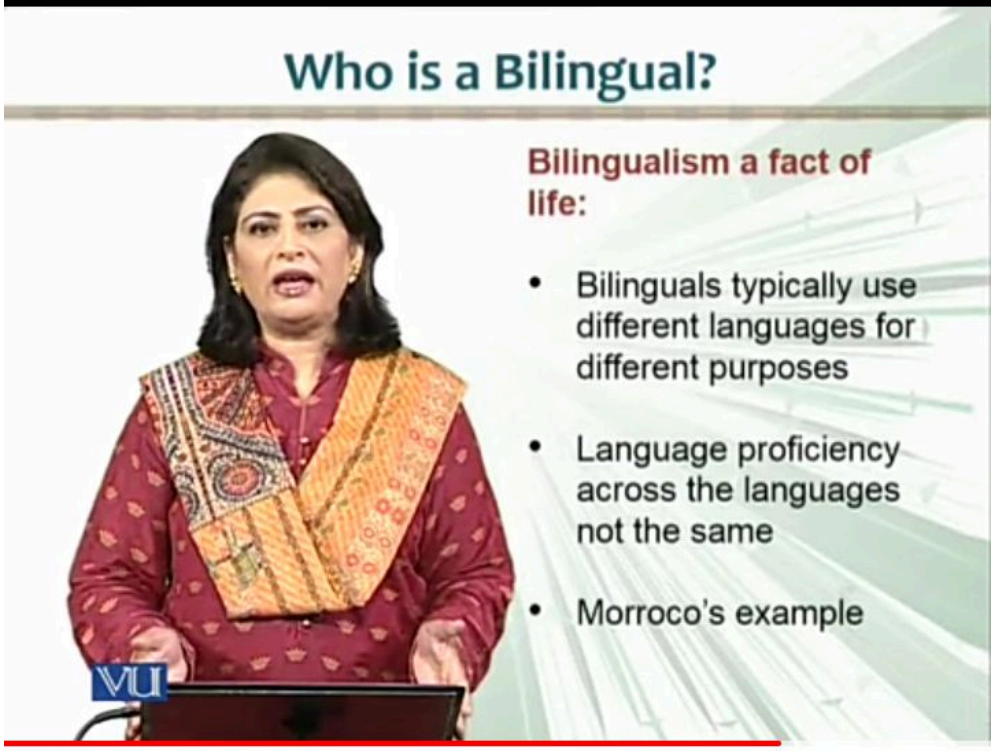

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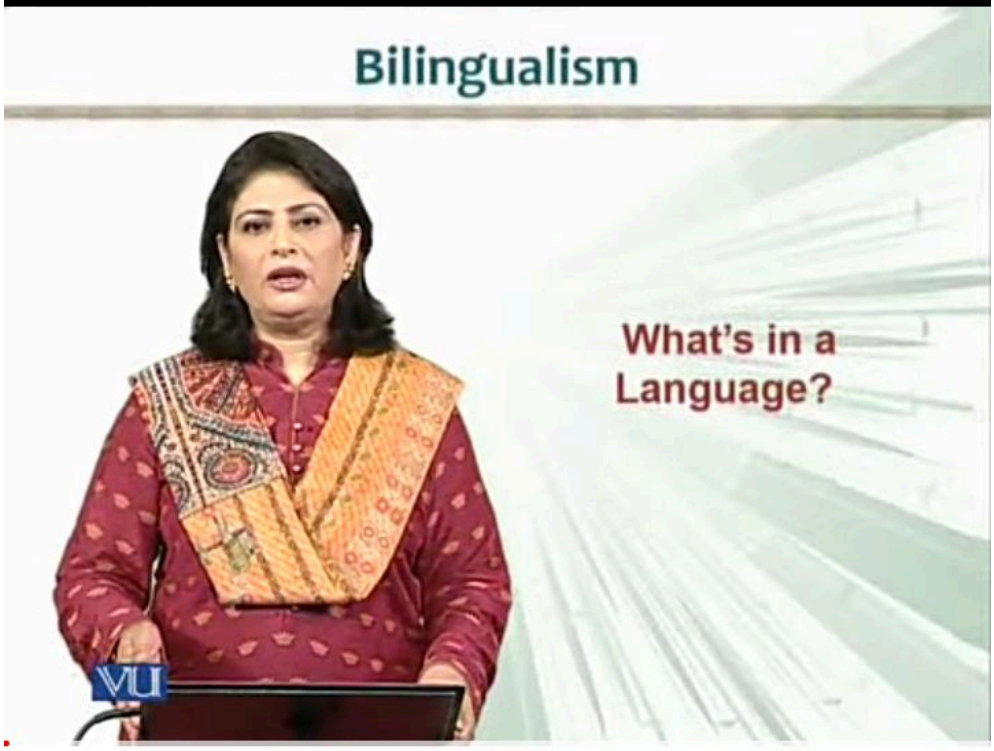

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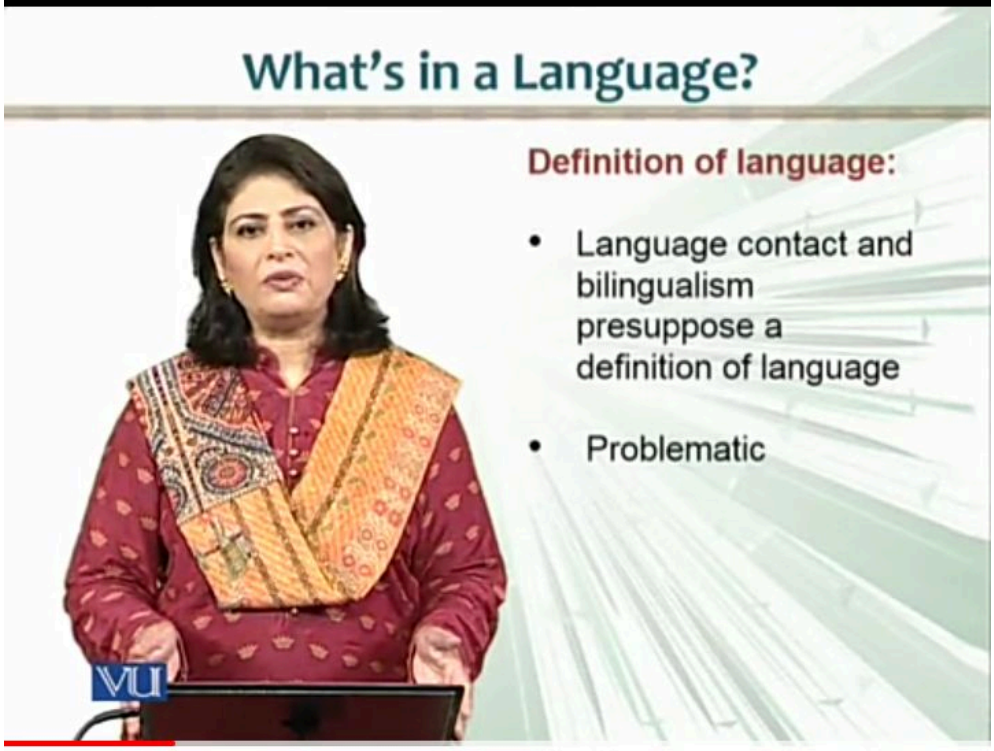

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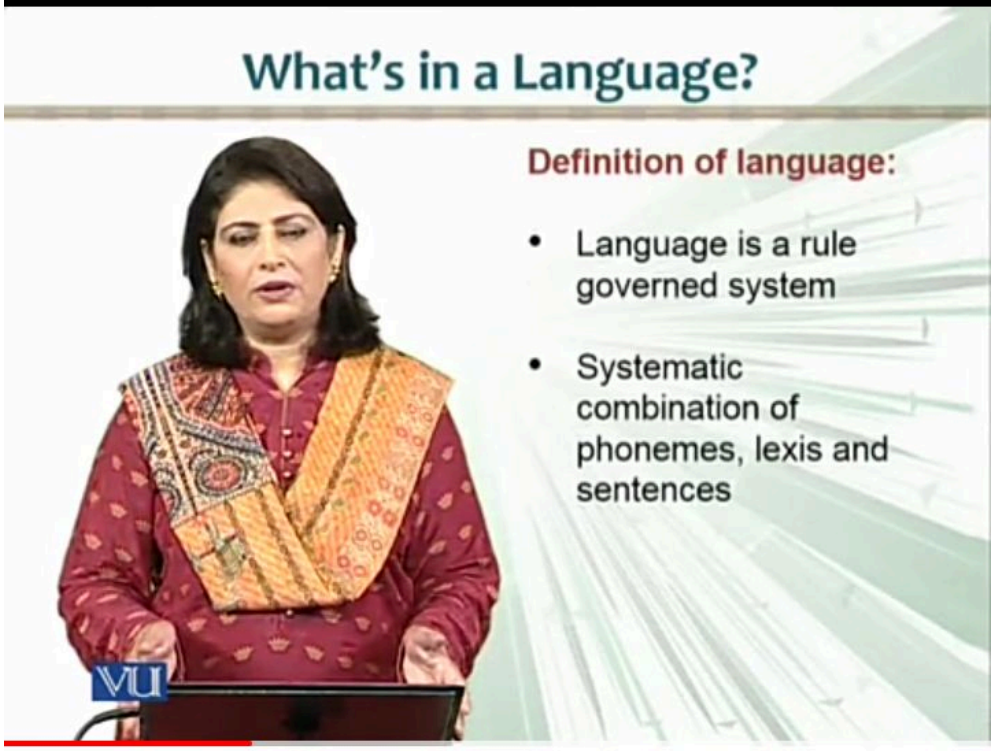

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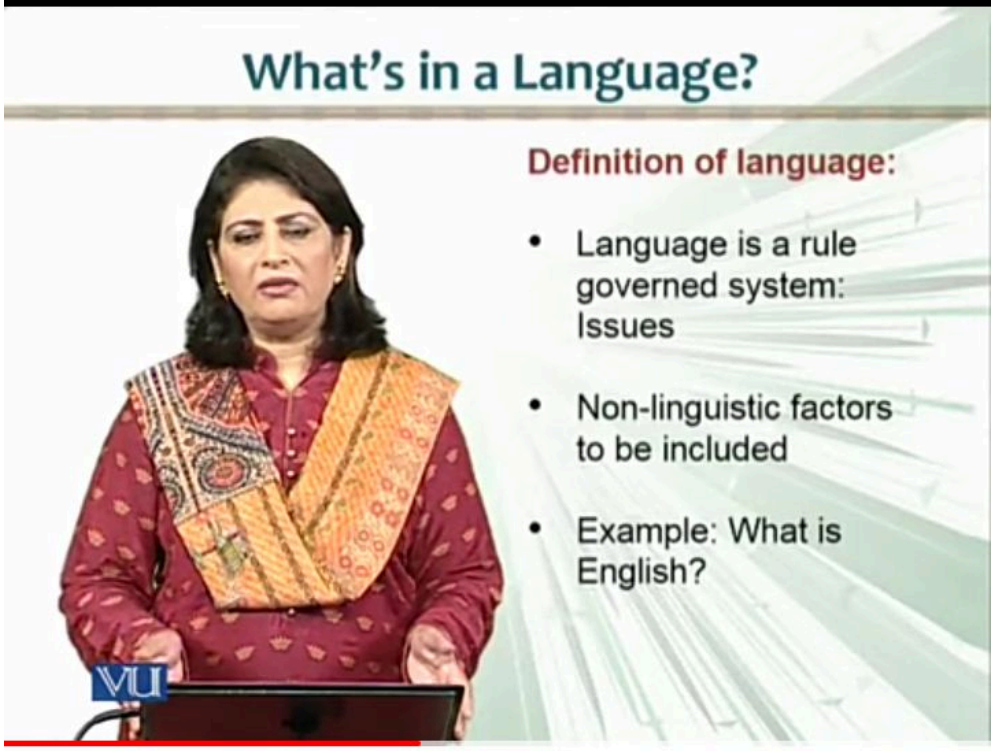

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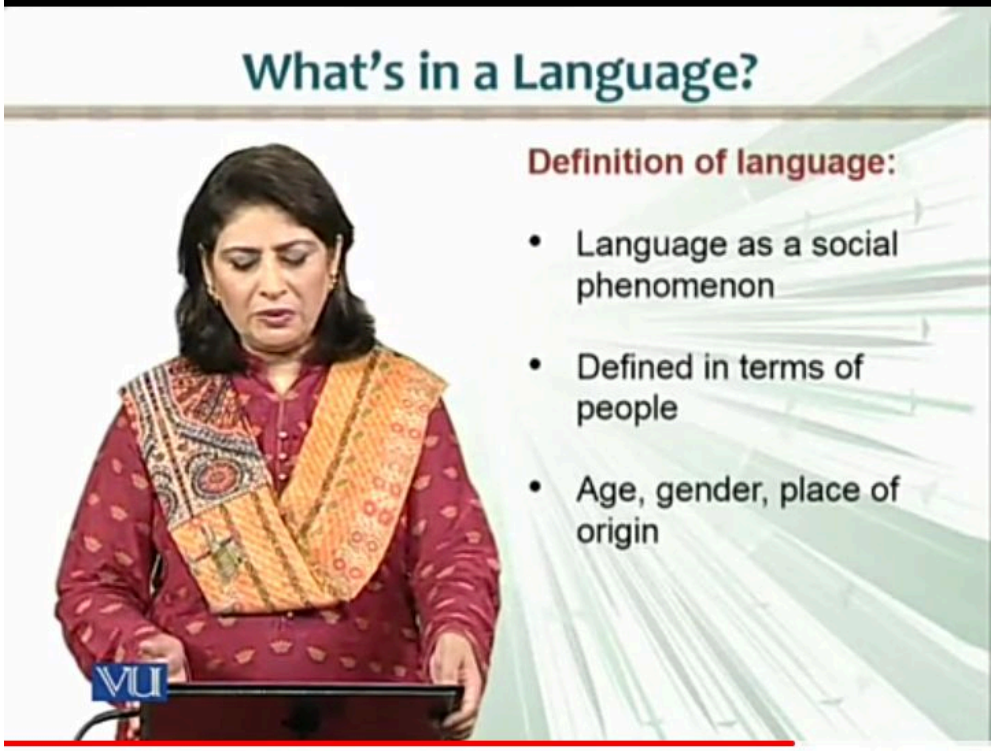

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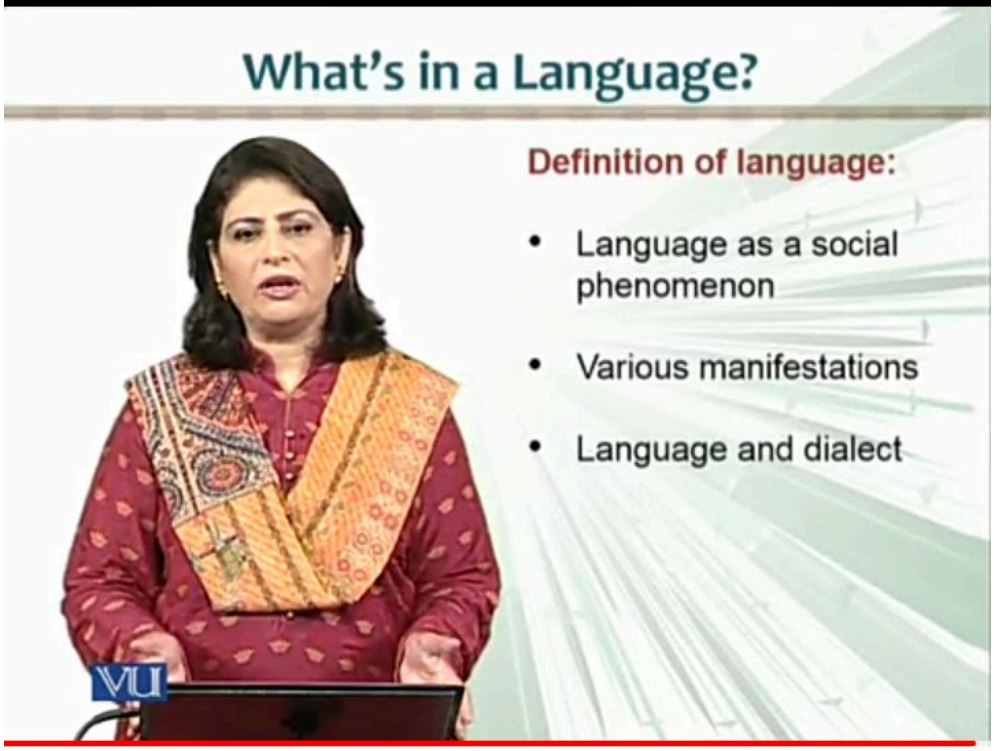

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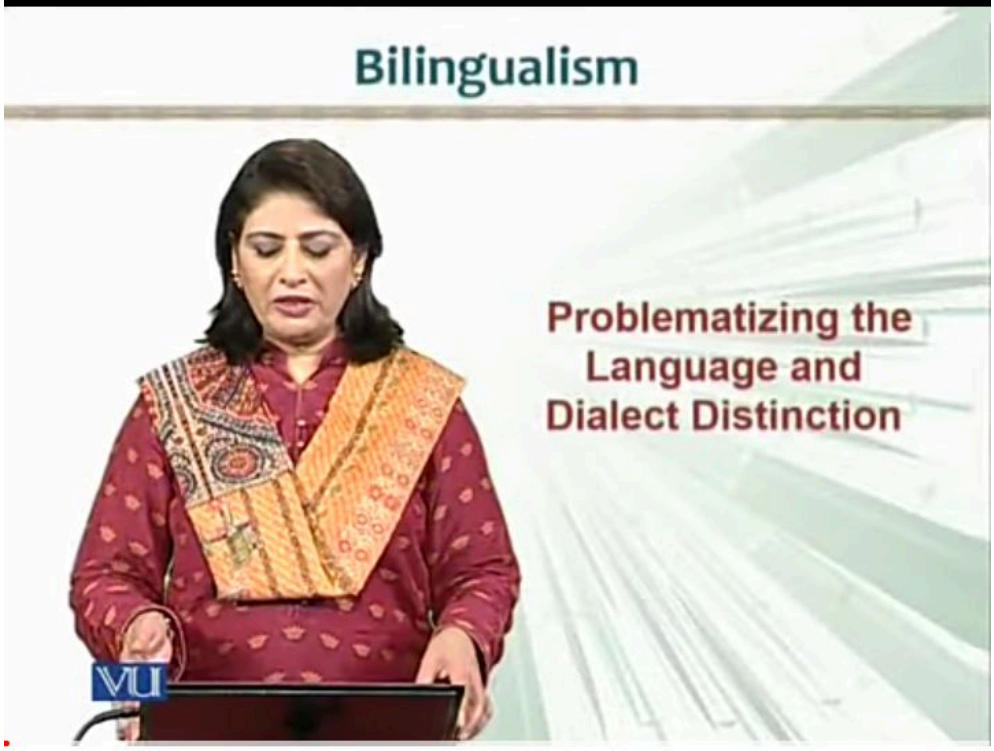

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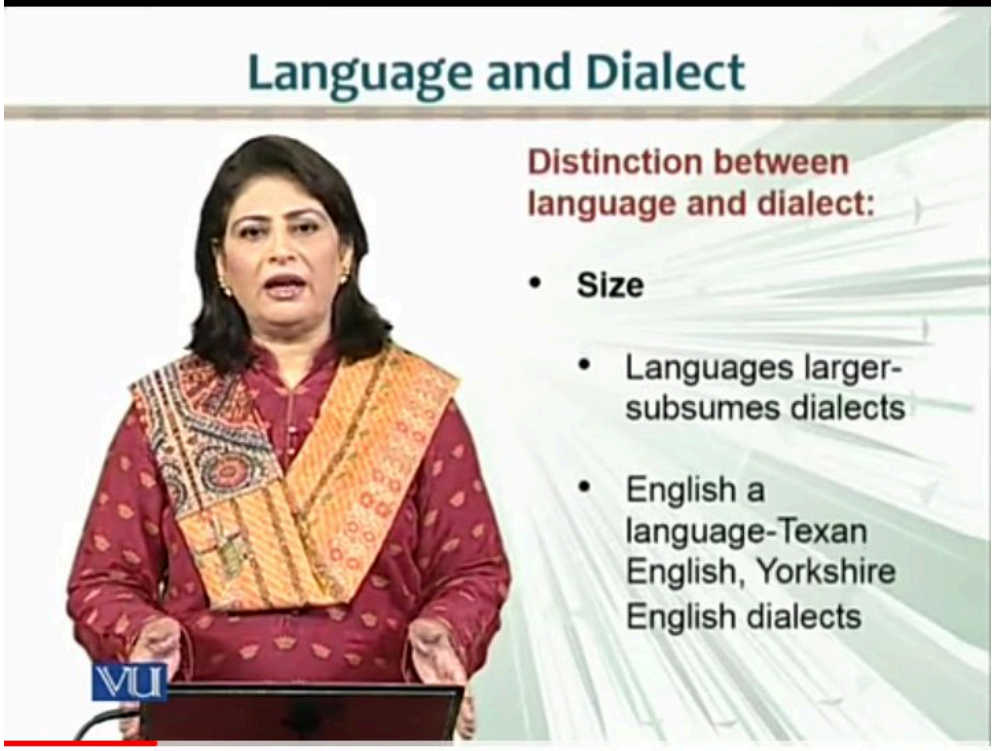

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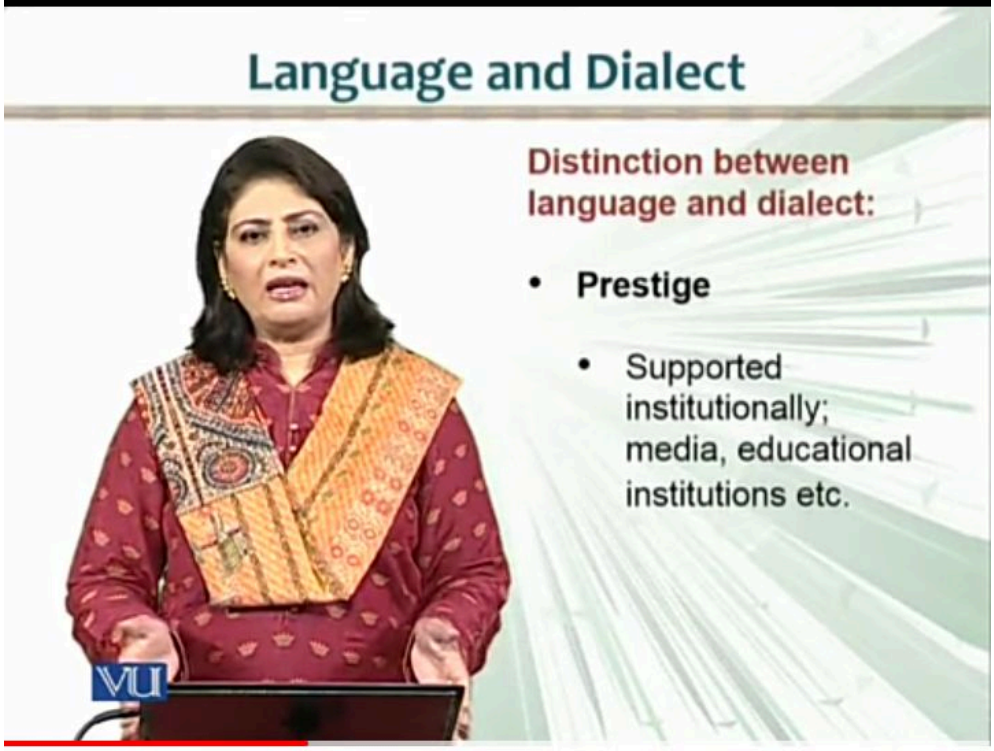

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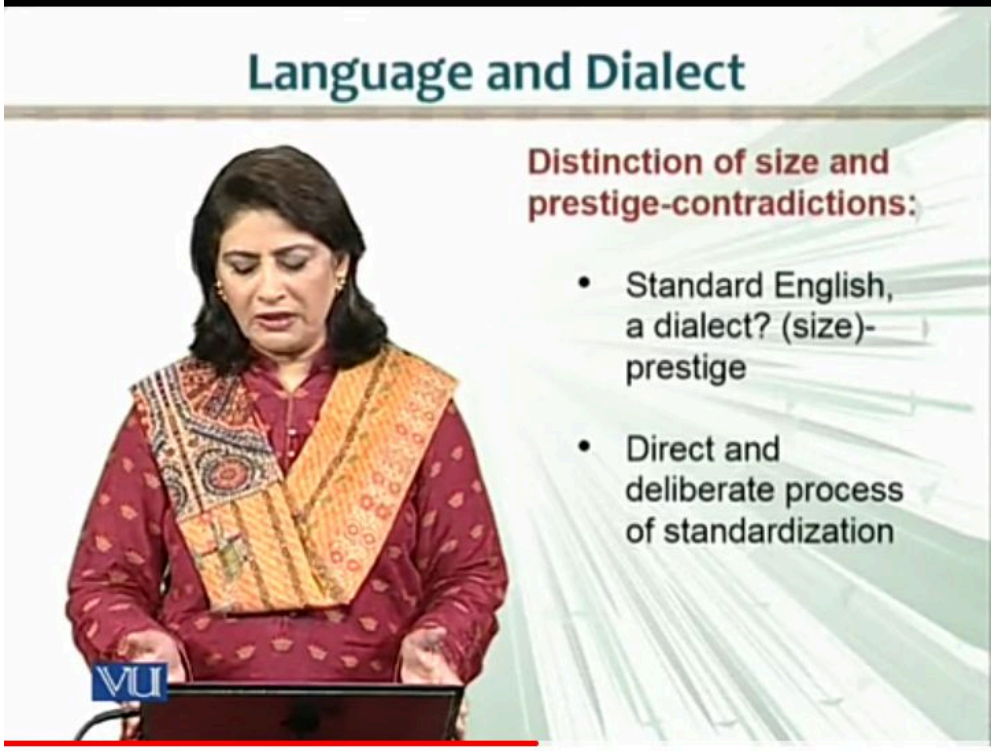

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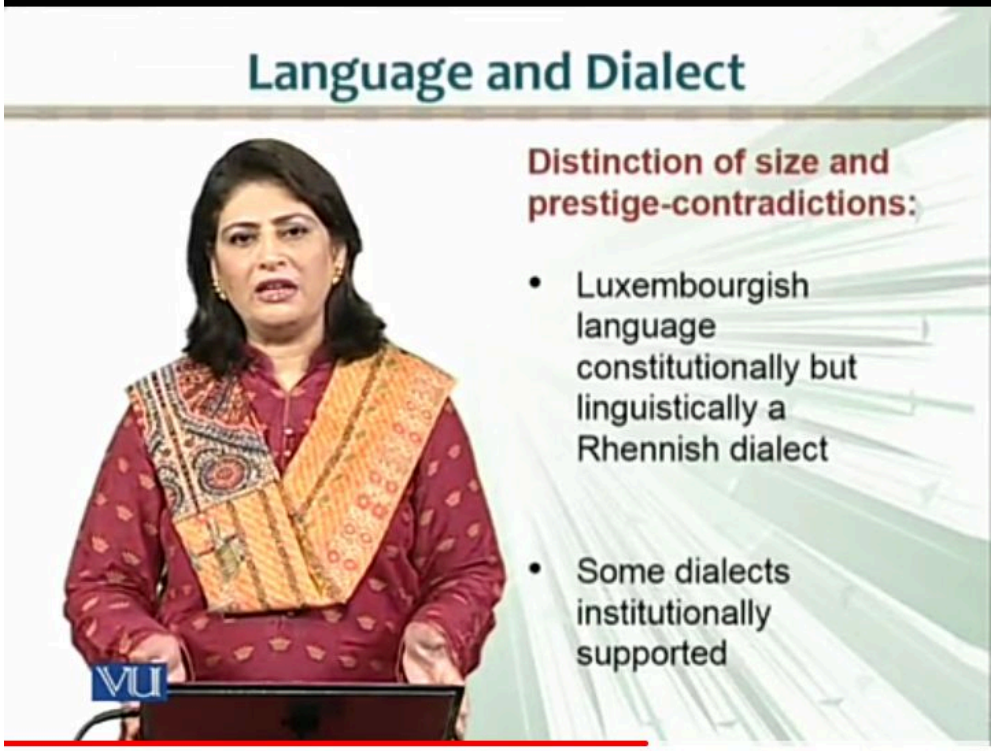

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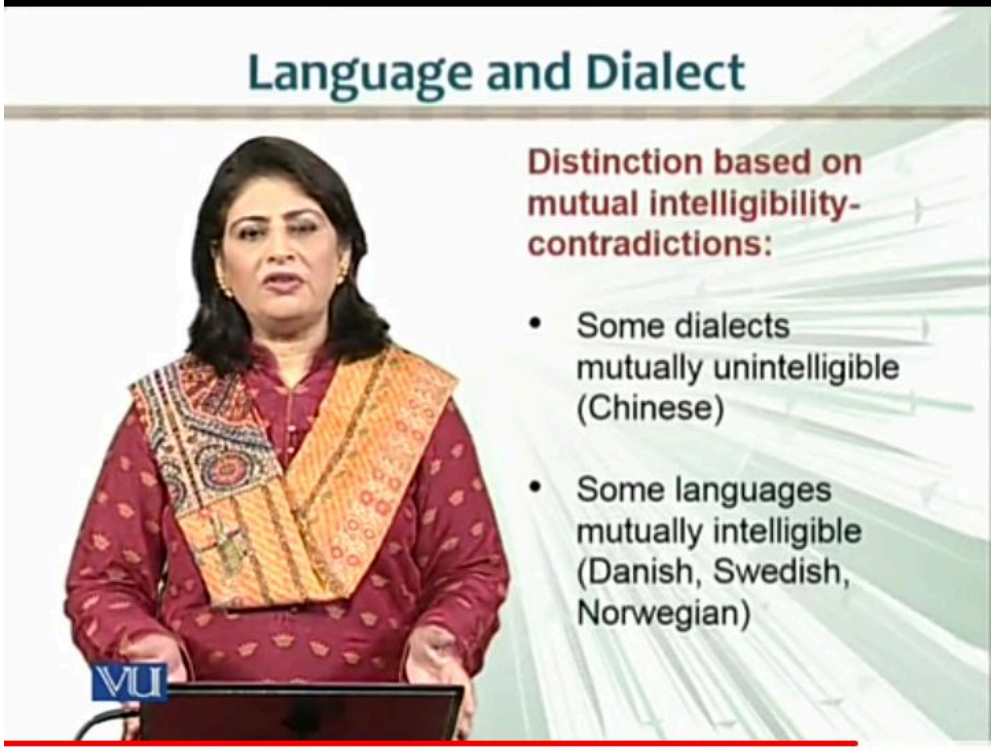

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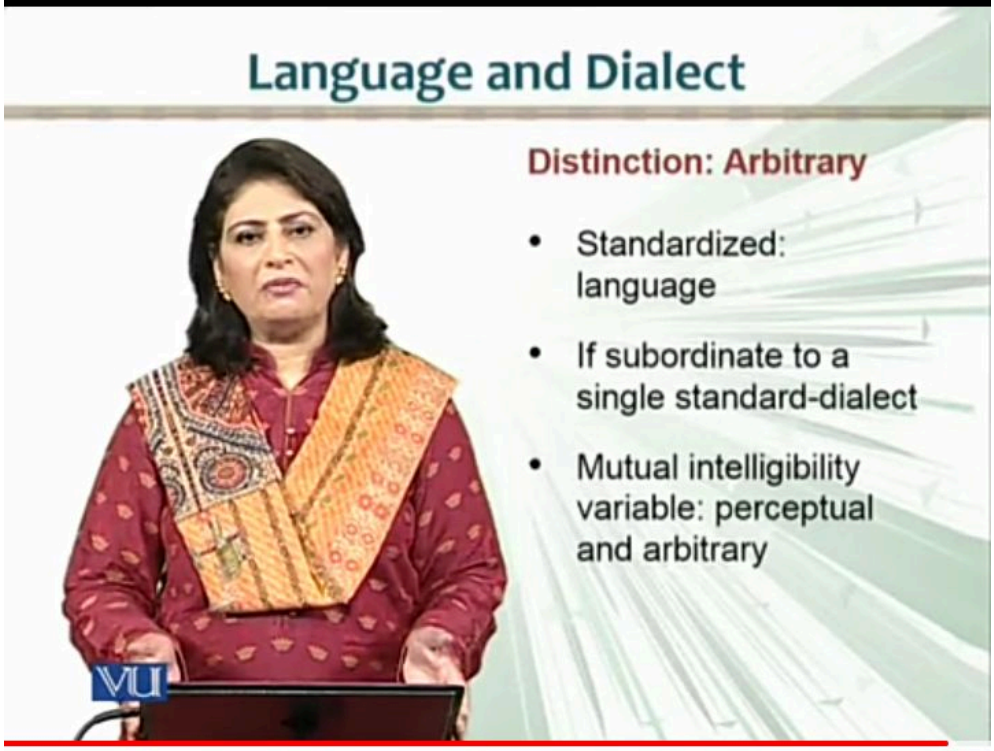

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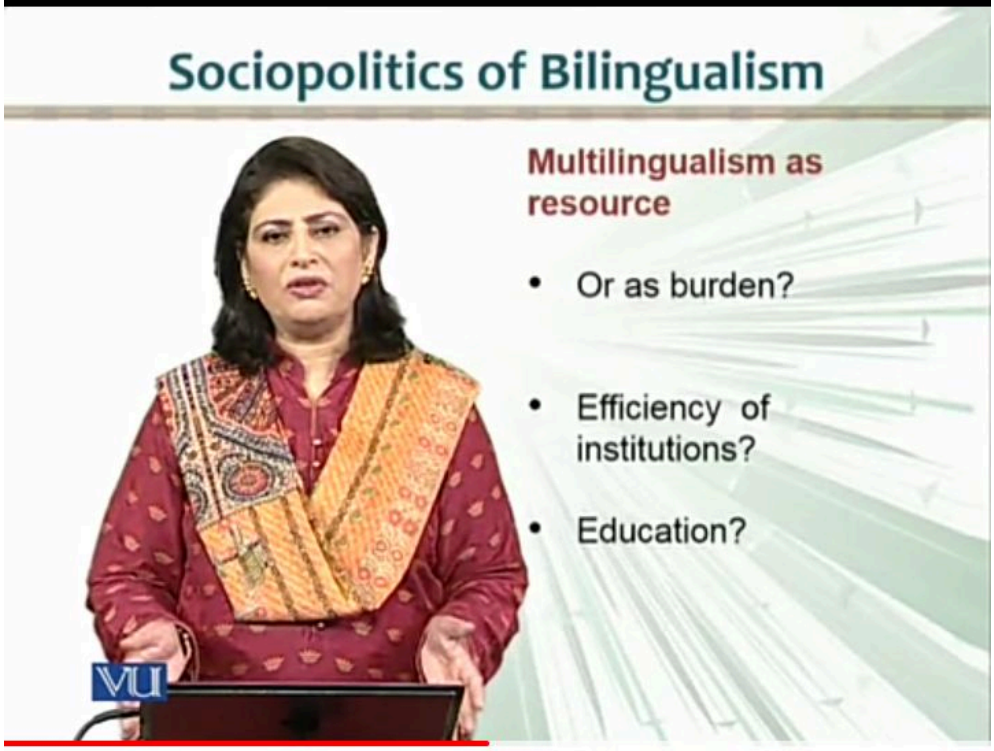

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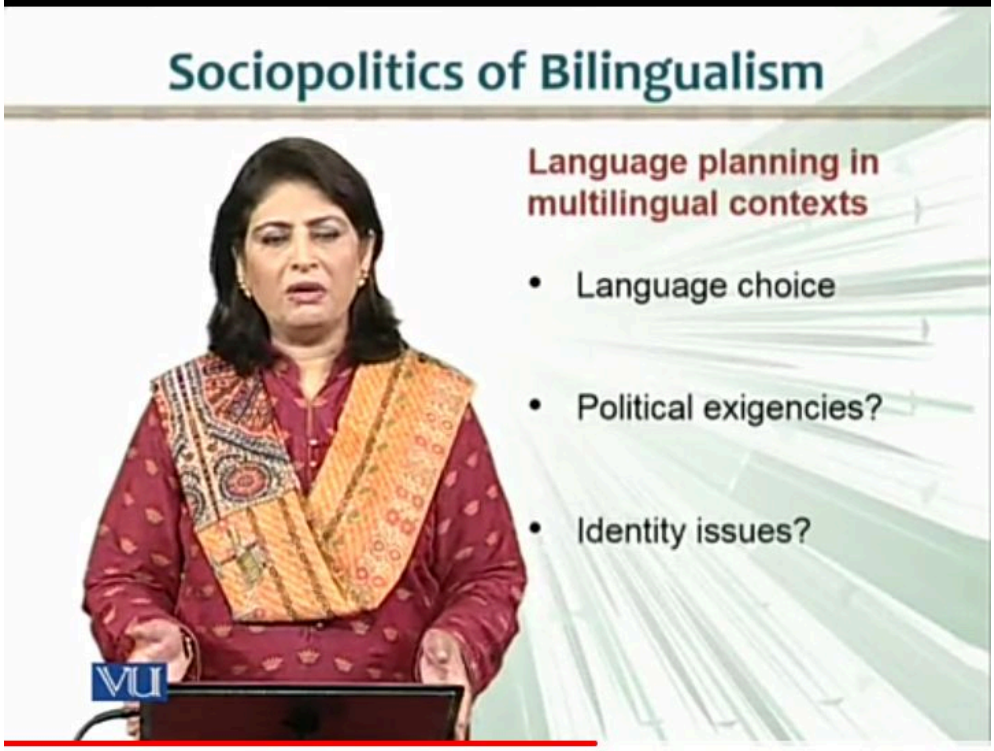

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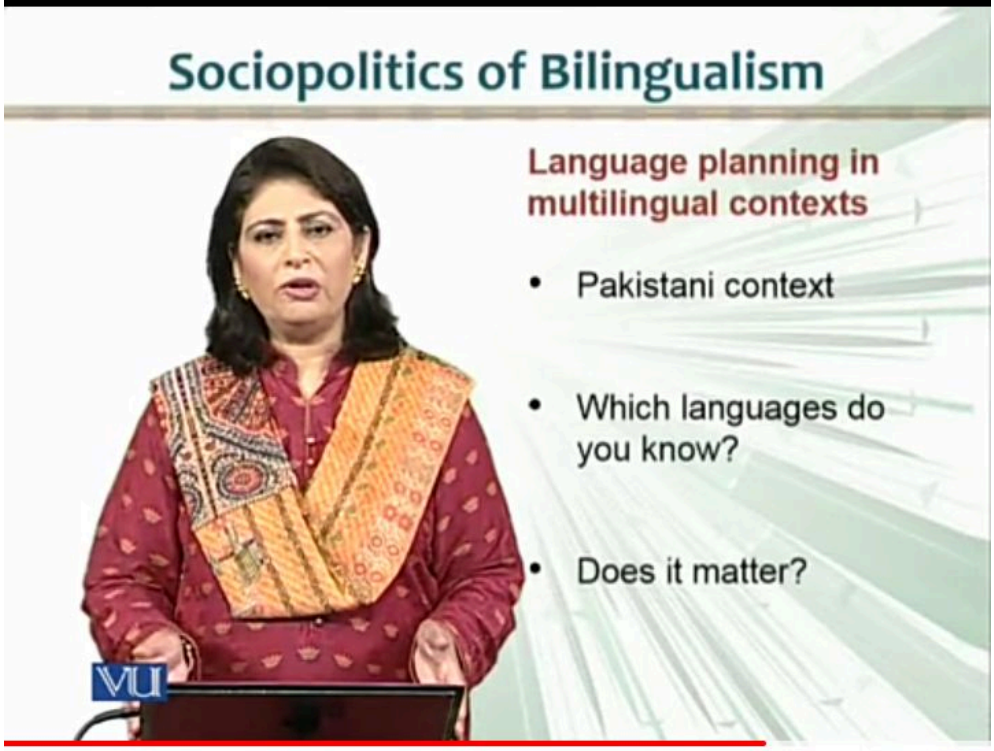

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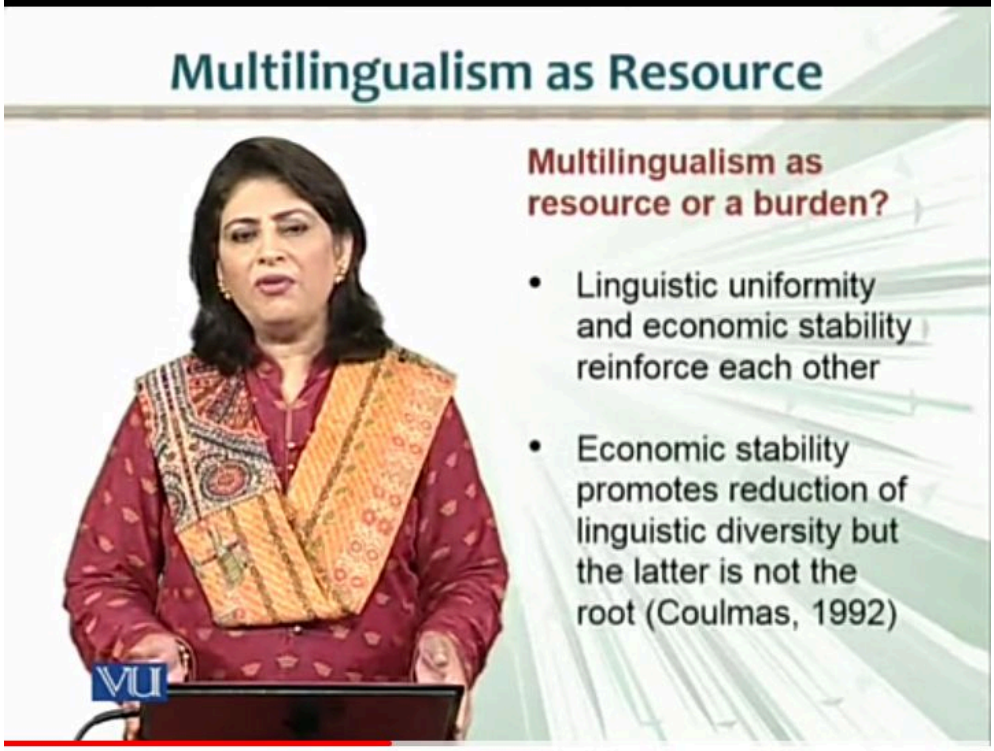

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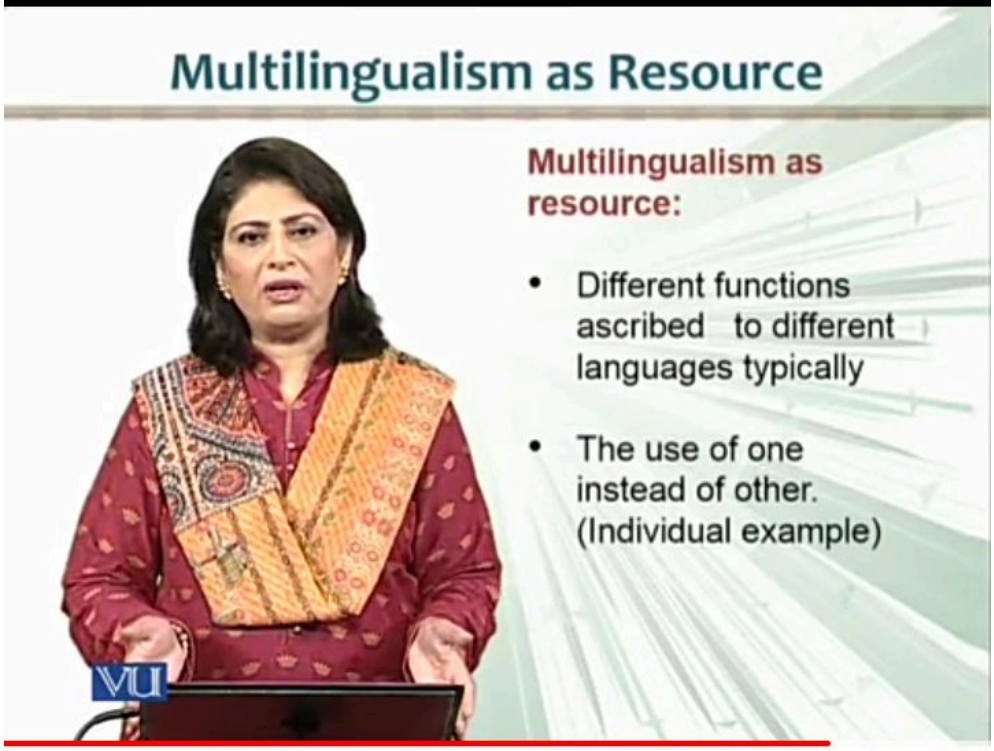

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ENG512_Topic036
Bilingualism
Language Planning in Multilingual Contexts
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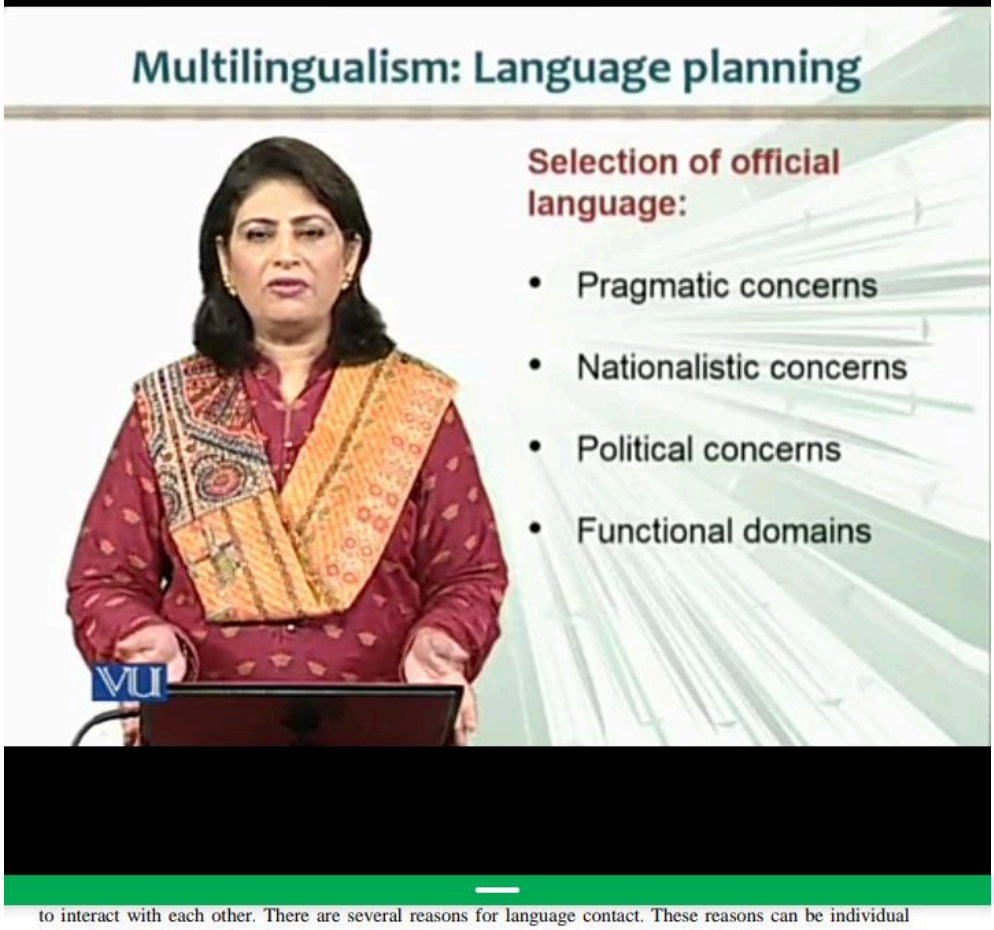
to interact with each other. There are several reasons for language contact. These reasons can be individual and voluntary, structural and non-voluntary i.e. where there is little individual choice for language use. For example, in a migrant situation, where everyone has to use the dominant language of the host country, other key factors resulting in language are political factors (for example, new language laws or colonialism, globalization, war or invasion); resettlement of people; religious affiliation; oppression, culture and identity negotiation, economy, education and technology and immigration.

Who is a bilingual?

The discussion revolves around how much proficiency in two languages is required by an individual to be labeled as a bilingual. A bilingual may be balanced where there is equal proficiency in both languages but this is a rare phenomenon. More often than not individuals have unequal proficiency in different languages across different skills. Usually this individual proficiency is in harmony with different functions associated with different languages.

Any construct of bilingualism incorporates within it a concept of language. This is again problematic because language definitions are also contested. Language is simultaneously, a linguistic, cognitive and social phenomenon. The linguistic phenomenon is evident in its structure and its composition of form, the cognitive aspect is related to the mental processes involved in language knowledge, while the social dimension is related to issues of power (for example, the difference between language and variety) in society.

The differences between dialect and languages are made on the basis of size. Language is believed to be a larger repertoire of linguistic items and subsuming dialects. The difference between a dialect and language is also explained in terms of their mutual intelligibility i.e. where two languages may not be mutually understood by speakers, the dialect of a language might be mutually understood. Lastly, a language holds more prestige than a dialect. However, these distinctions are not inherent qualities of a language or a dialect. Dialects may undergo a deliberate process of standardization that expands its vocabulary and its functions to give it a status of language. Language formation is a result of a deliberate decision-making. Several dialects are not mutually intelligible while some languages are mutually intelligible but still considered languages. The example, Urdu and Hindi can be cited here. Hence, the difference between the dialect and language is related to the power and status of its speakers.



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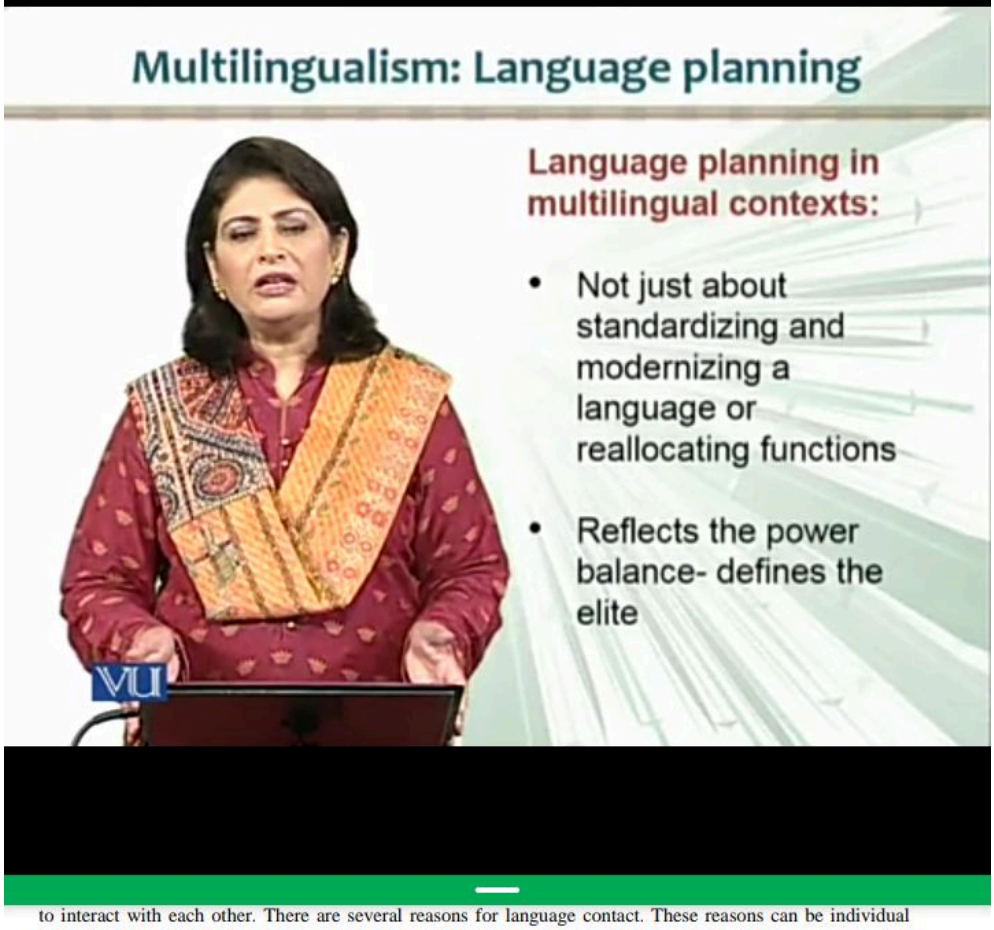

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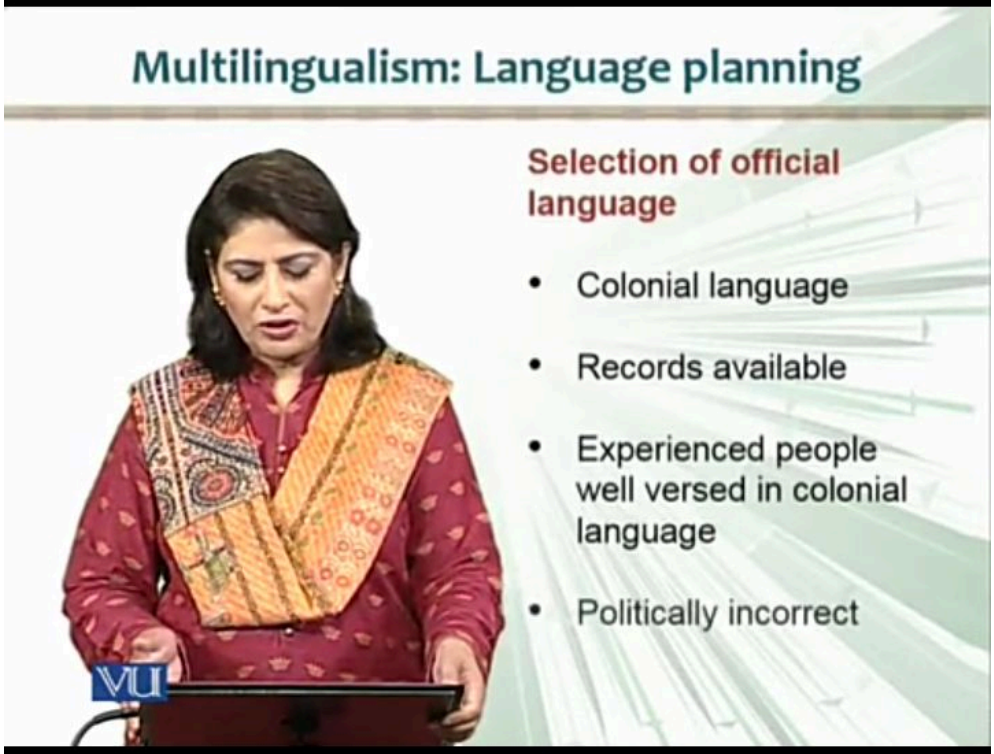

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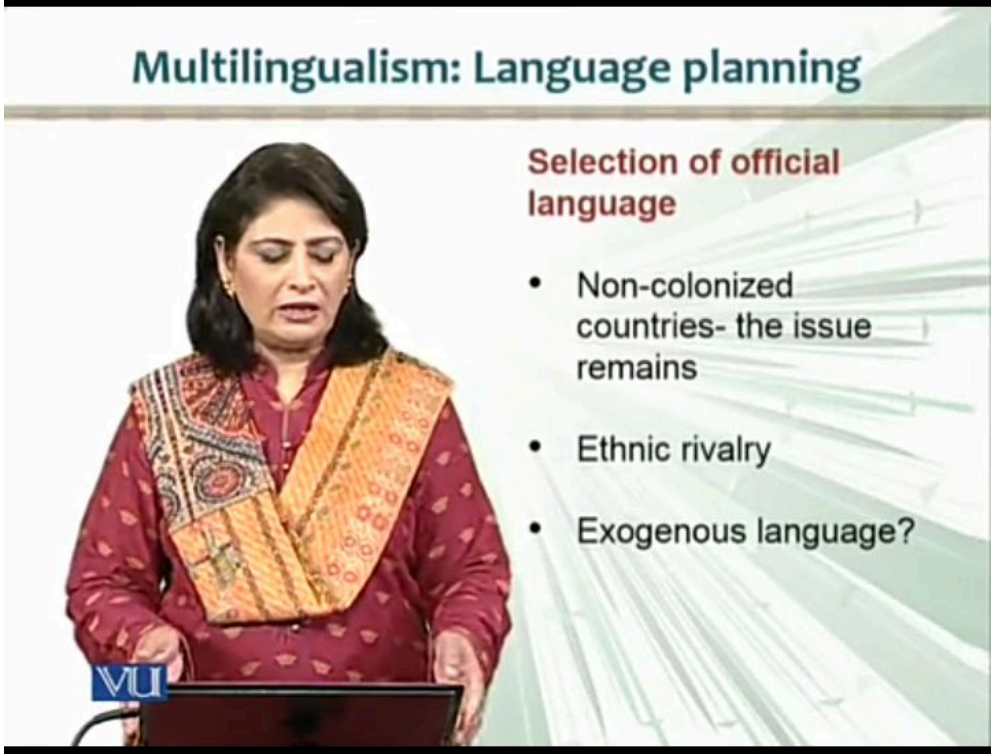

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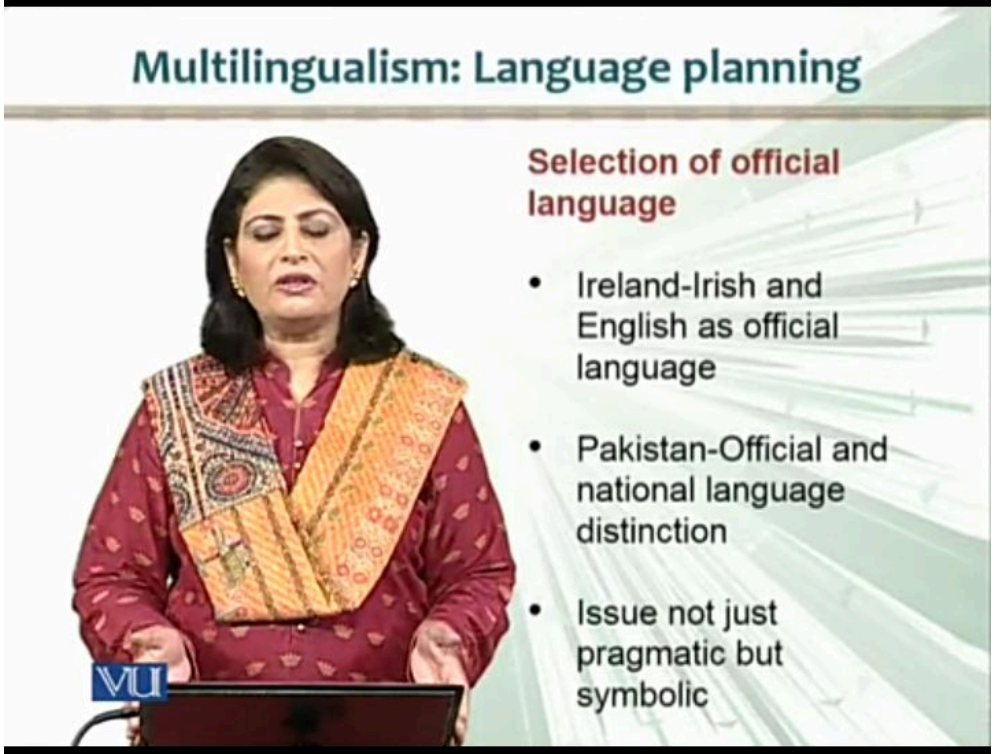
The differences between dialect and languages are made on the basis of size. Language is believed to be a larger repertoire of linguistic items and subsuming dialects. The difference between a dialect and language is also explained in terms of their mutual intelligibility i.e. where two languages may not be mutually understood by speakers, the dialect of a language might be mutually understood. Lastly, a language holds more prestige than a dialect. However, these distinctions are not inherent qualities of a language or a dialect. Dialects may undergo a deliberate process of standardization that expands its vocabulary and its functions to give it a status of language. Language formation is a result of a deliberate decision-making. Several dialects are not mutually intelligible while some languages are mutually intelligible but still considered languages. The example, Urdu and Hindi can be cited here. Hence, the difference between the dialect and language is related to the power and status of its speakers.



to interact with each other. There are several reasons for language contact. These reasons can be individual and voluntary, structural and non-voluntary i.e. where there is little individual choice for language use. For example, in a migrant situation, where everyone has to use the dominant language of the host country, other key factors resulting in language are political factors (for example, new language laws or colonialism, globalization, war or invasion); resettlement of people; religious affiliation; oppression, culture and identity negotiation, economy, education and technology and immigration.

Who is a bilingual?

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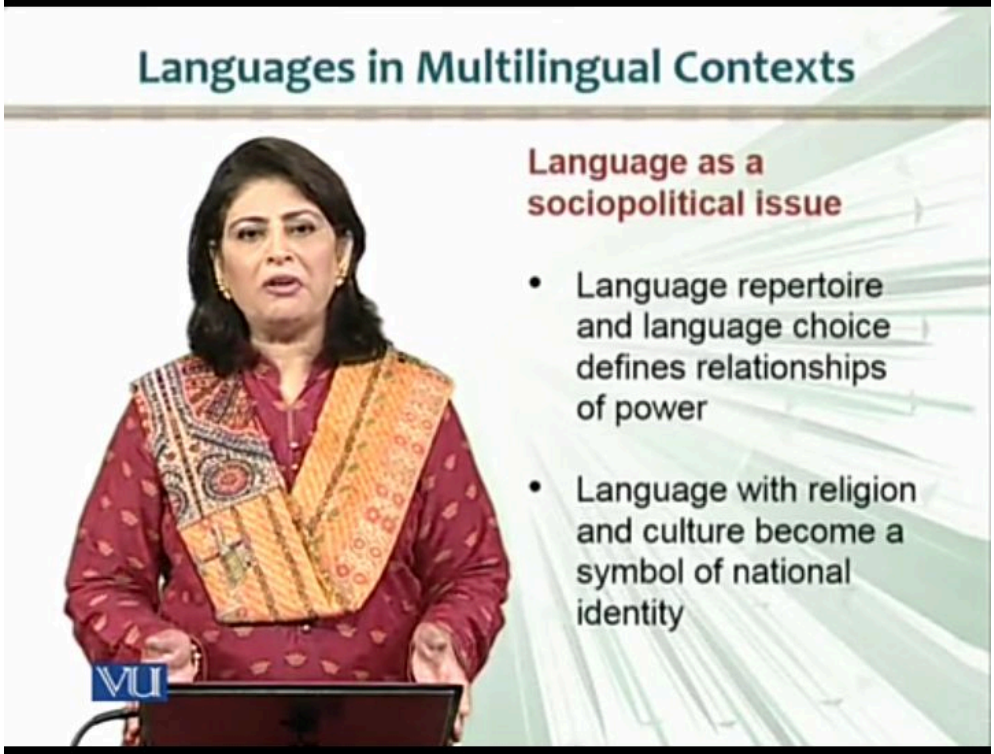

Lesson-07

SOCIOPOLITICS OF BILINGUALISM

Topic No. 034-037

Introduction- Sociopolitics of Bilingualism; Languages in Multilingual Contexts; Multilingualism as Resource; Language Planning in Multilingual Contexts

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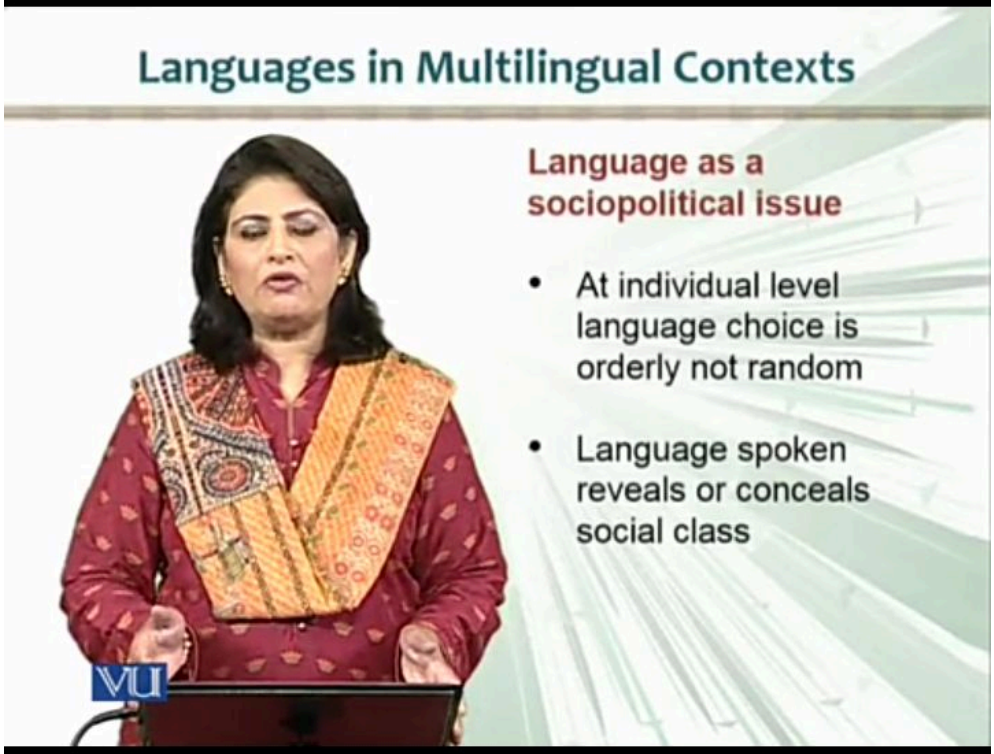

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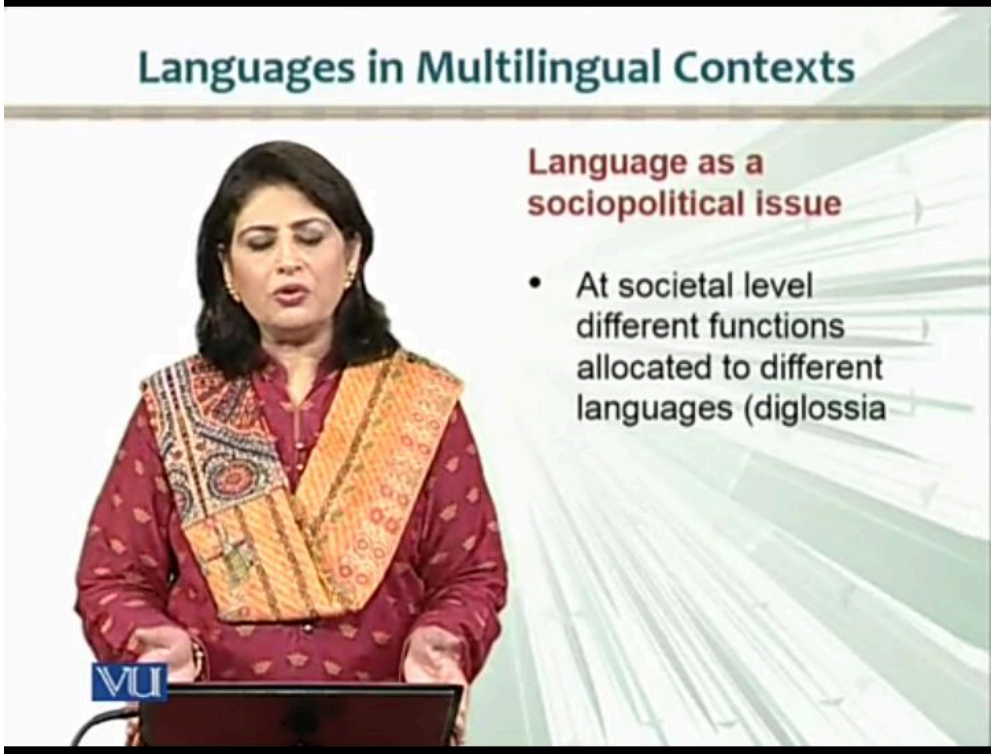

SOCIOPOLITICS OF BILINGUALISM

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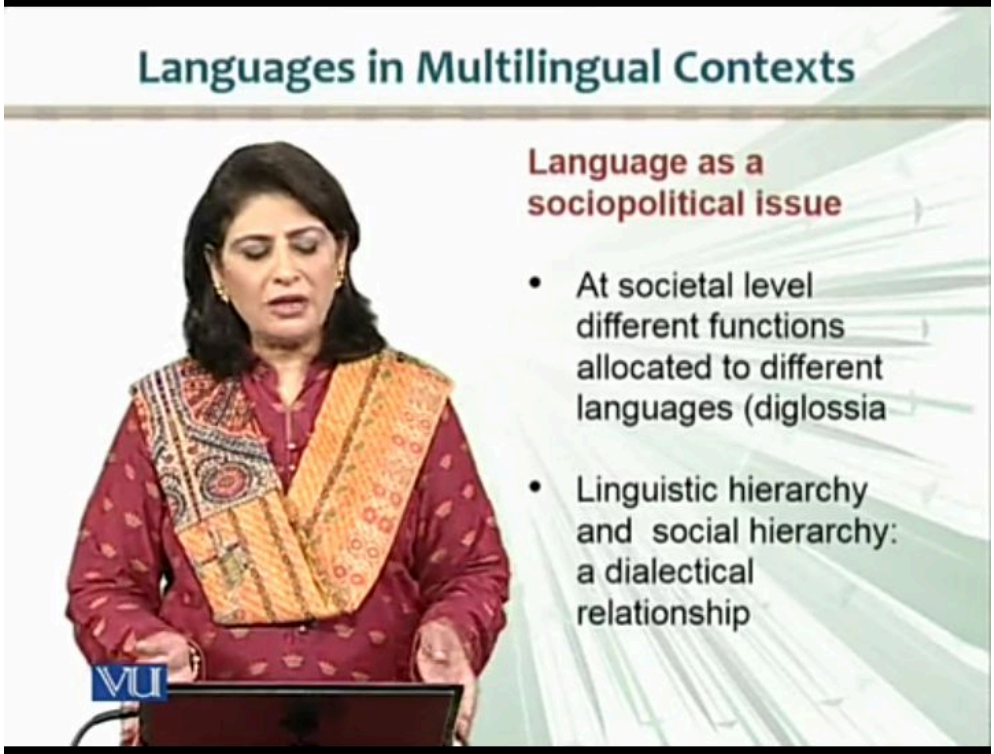

Lesson-07

SOCIOPOLITICS OF BILINGUALISM

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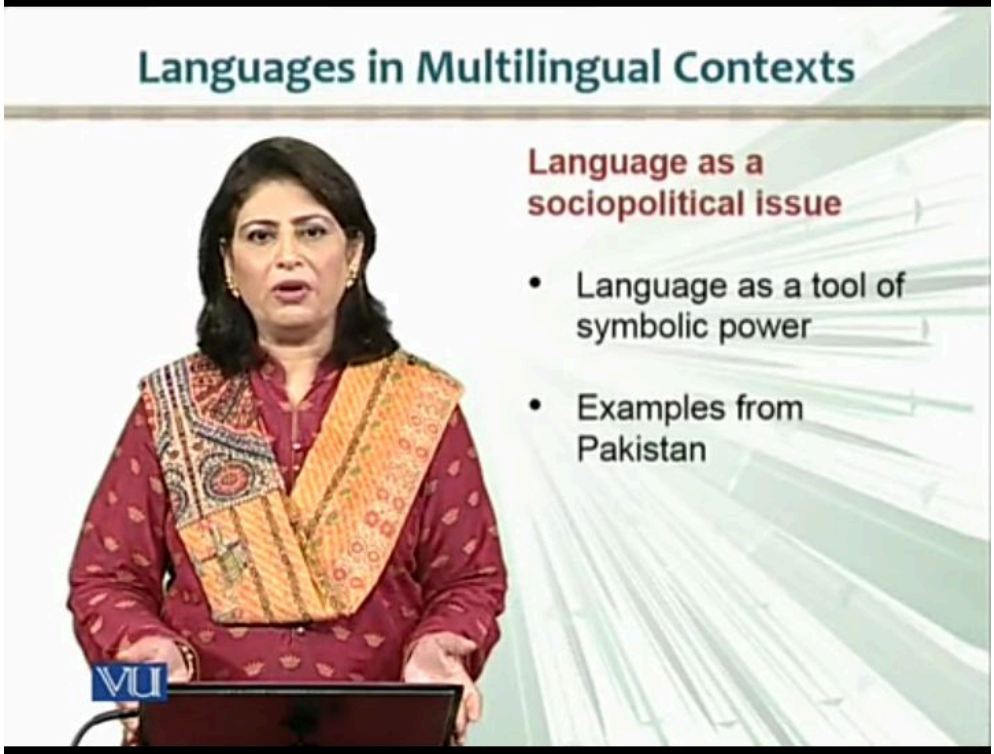

Lesson-07

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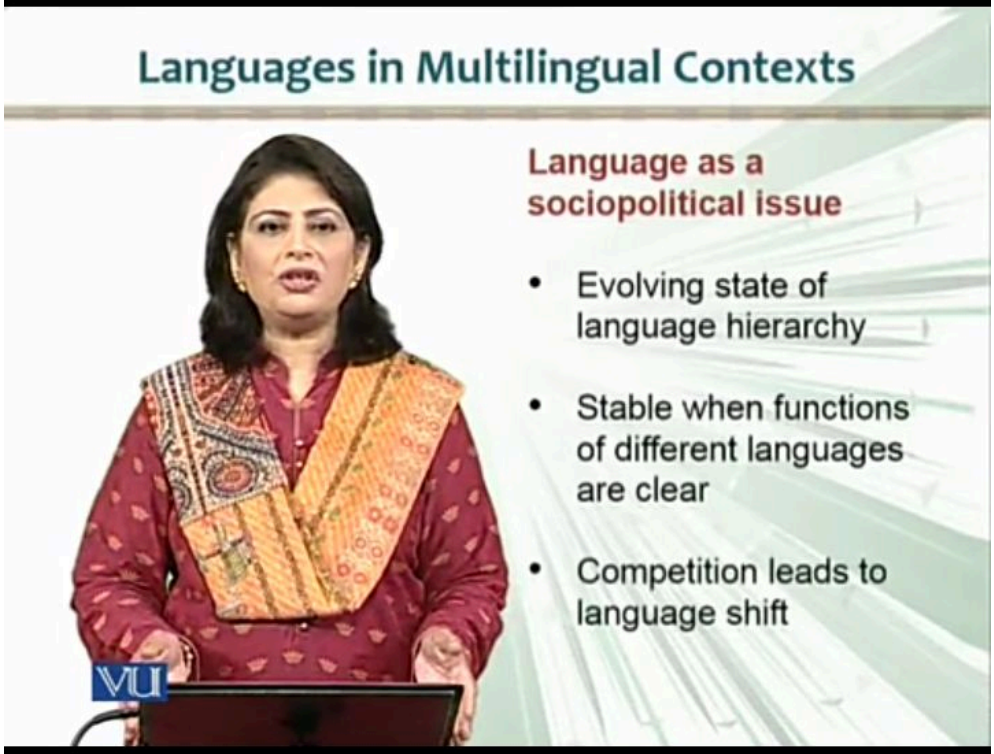

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Bilingualism
Functioning as a Bilingual: Introduction
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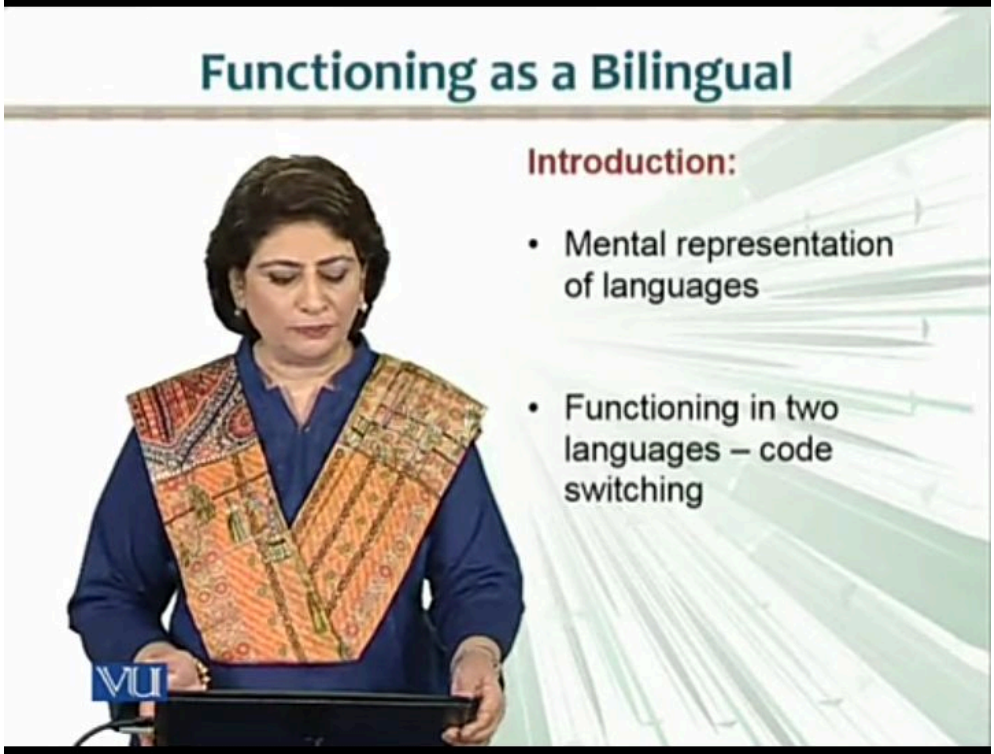

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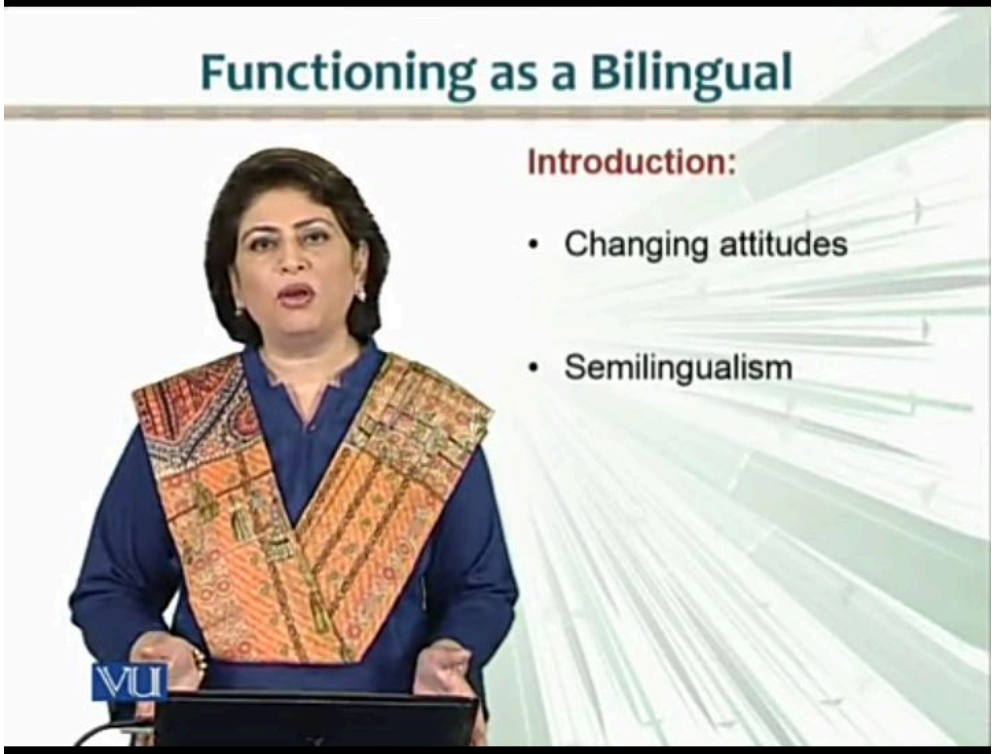

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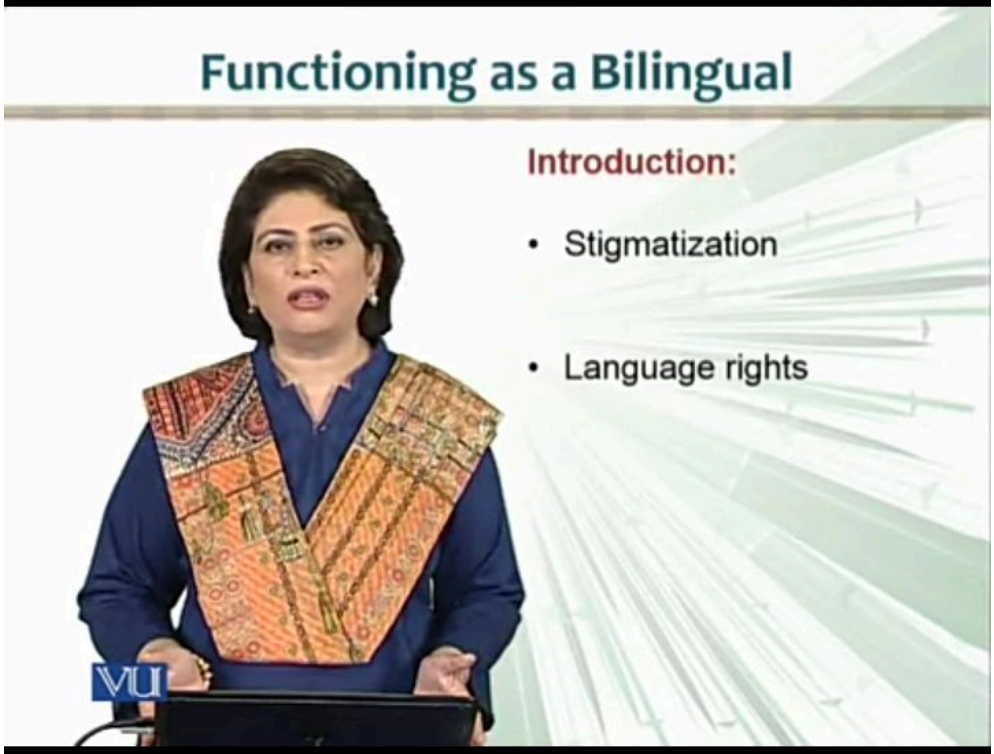

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Introduction- Sociopolitics of Bilingualism; Languages in Multilingual Contexts; Multilingualism as Resource; Language Planning in Multilingual Contexts

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Diglossia not only defines a concept but also develops an approach to bilingualism which has been extremely influential. It originates from the fact that the co-existing languages of a community are likely to have different functions and to be used in different contexts. A distinction is made between High (H) and Low (L) language varieties and Ferguson noted nine areas in which H and L could differ.

According to Fishman, relative stability can be maintained as long as societal compartmentalization of language lasts. When two languages compete for use in the same situations, as in the case of bilingualism without diglossia, language shift, a process in which a speech community collectively gives up a language in favour of some other, may occur.

Language as a Resource

Multilingual countries are often thought to have certain problems which monolingual states do not. On the practical level, difficulties in communication are one. It should be pointed out that there is no scientific evidence to show that multilingual countries are particularly disadvantaged, in socio economic terms, compared to monolingual ones. Although, it might be true that linguistic uniformity and economic development reinforce each other; in other words, economic wellbeing promotes the reduction of linguistic diversity.

Multilingualism is an important resource at both the societal and personal levels. For a linguistically diverse country to maintain the ethnic-group languages alongside the national or official language(s) can prove to be an effective way to motivate individuals while unifying the nation. Additionally, a multiethnic society is arguably a richer, more exciting and stimulating place to live in than a community with only one dominant ethnic group. For the multilingual speaker, the availability of various languages in the community repertoire serves as a useful interactional resource.

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Multilingualism as Resource; Language Planning in Multilingual Contexts

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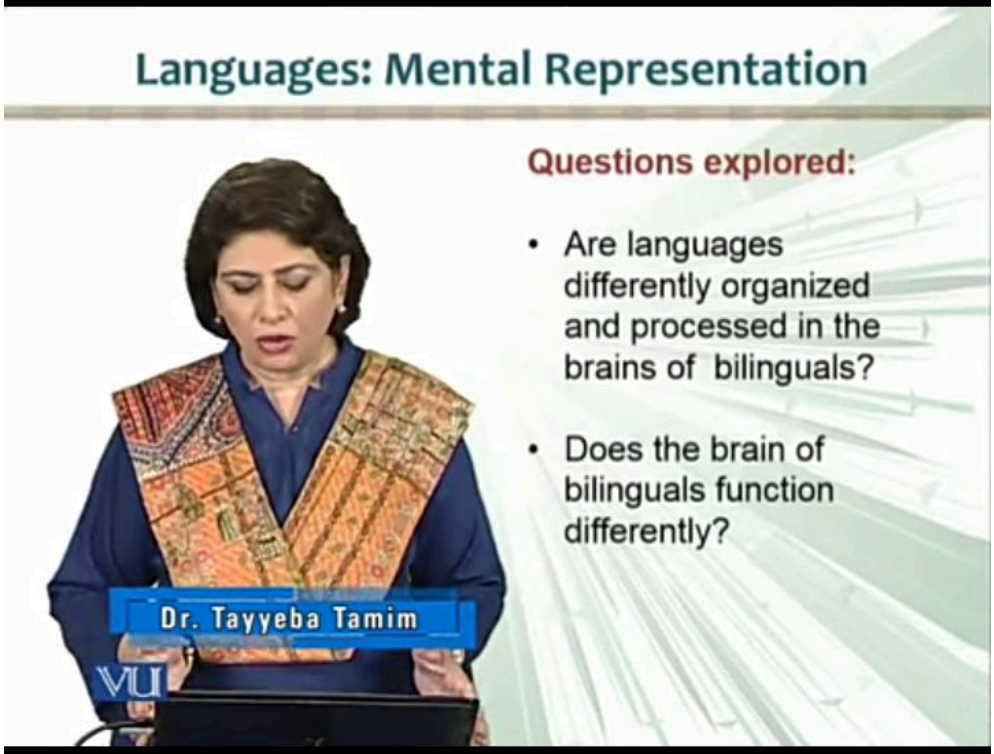

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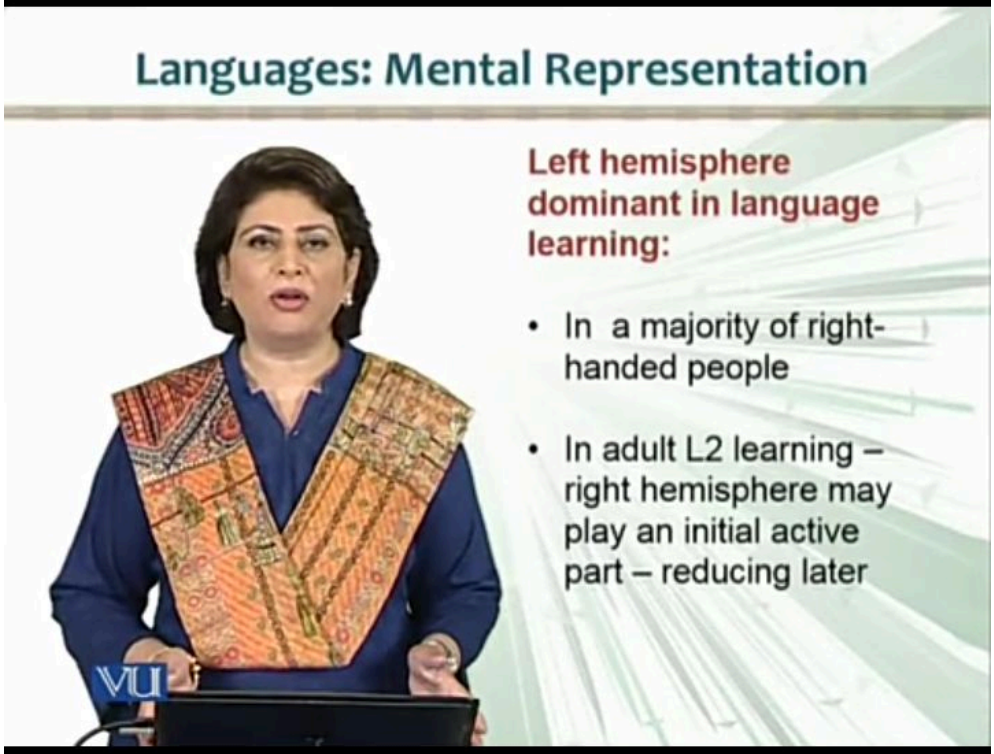

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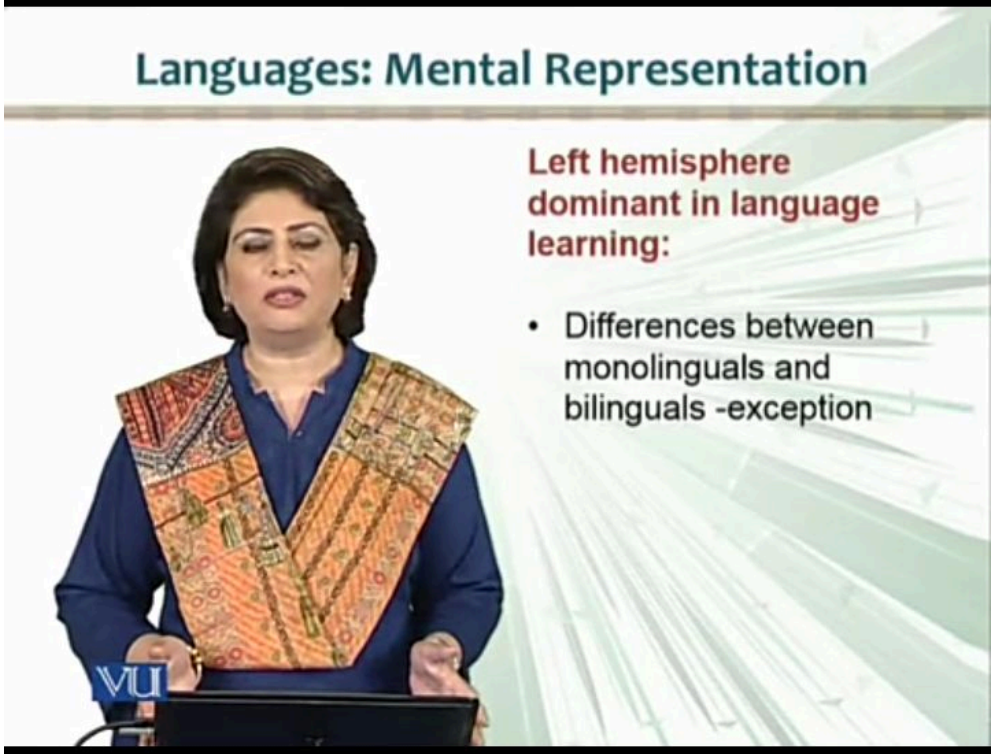

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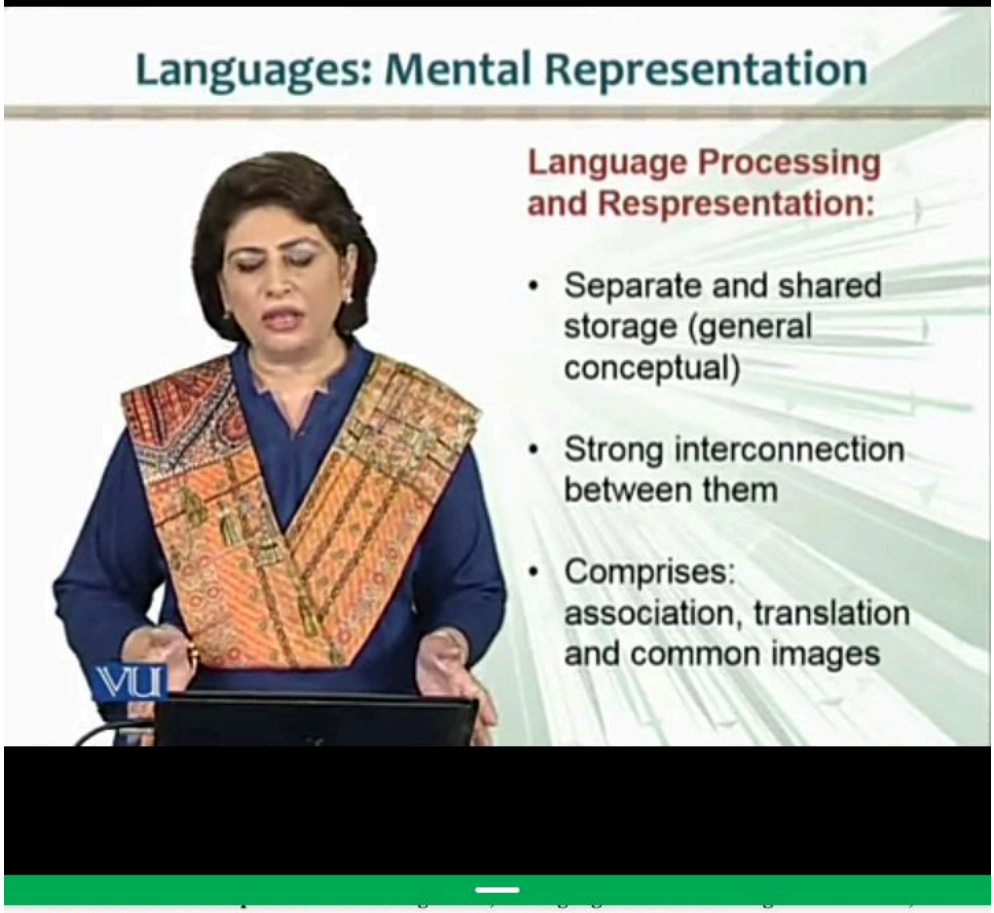

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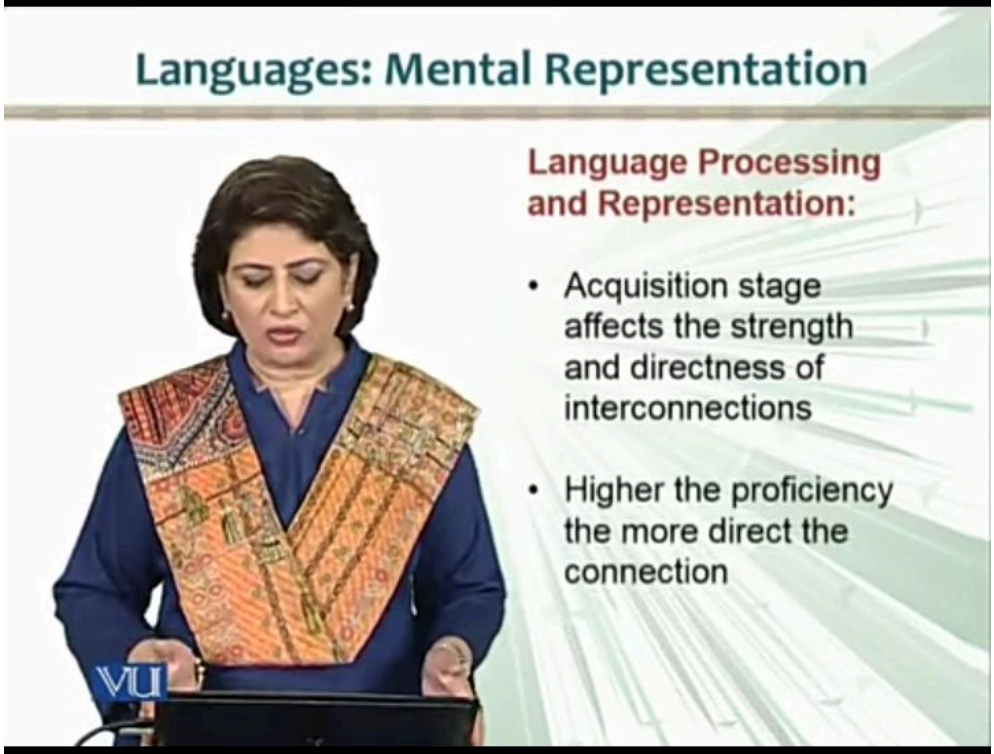

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Bilingualism
Functioning in both Languages: Code Switching
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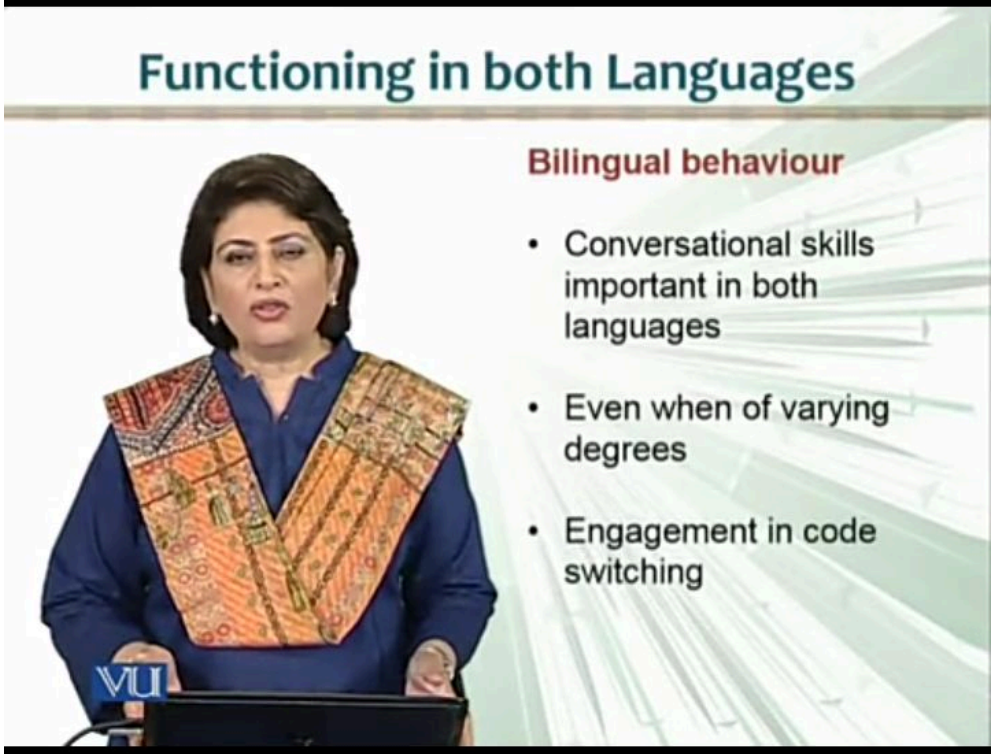

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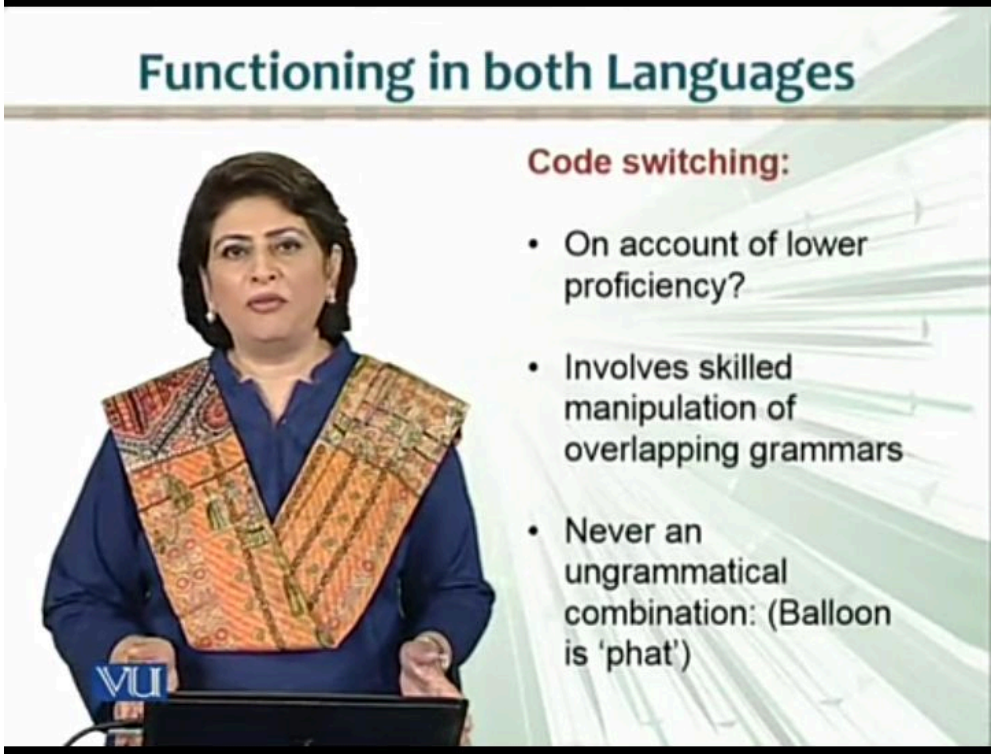

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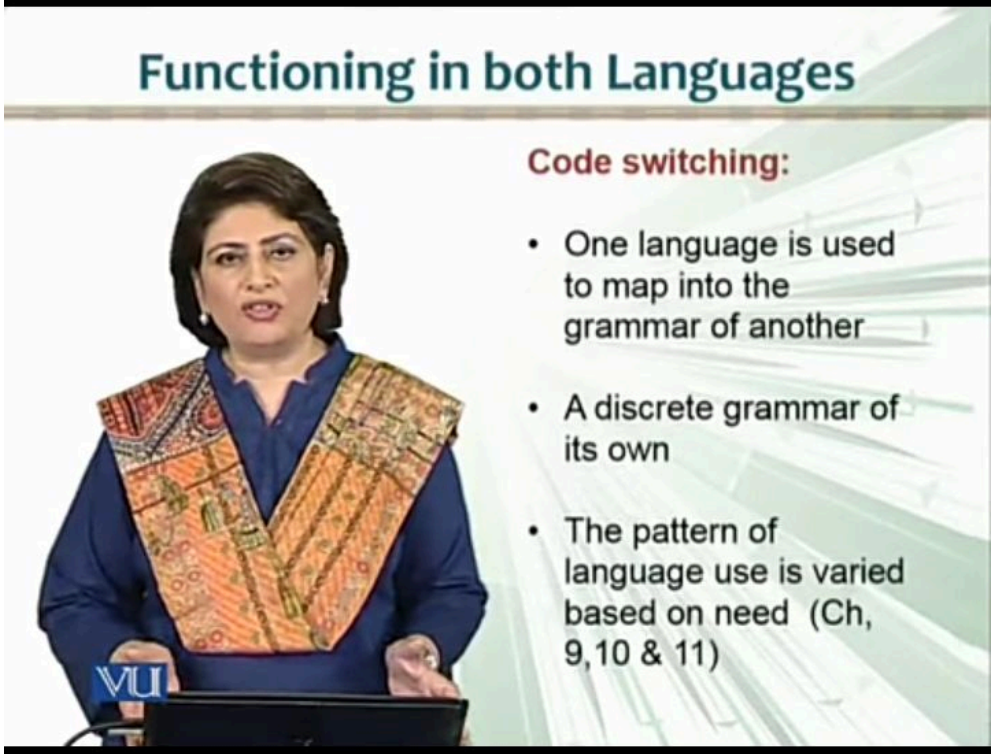

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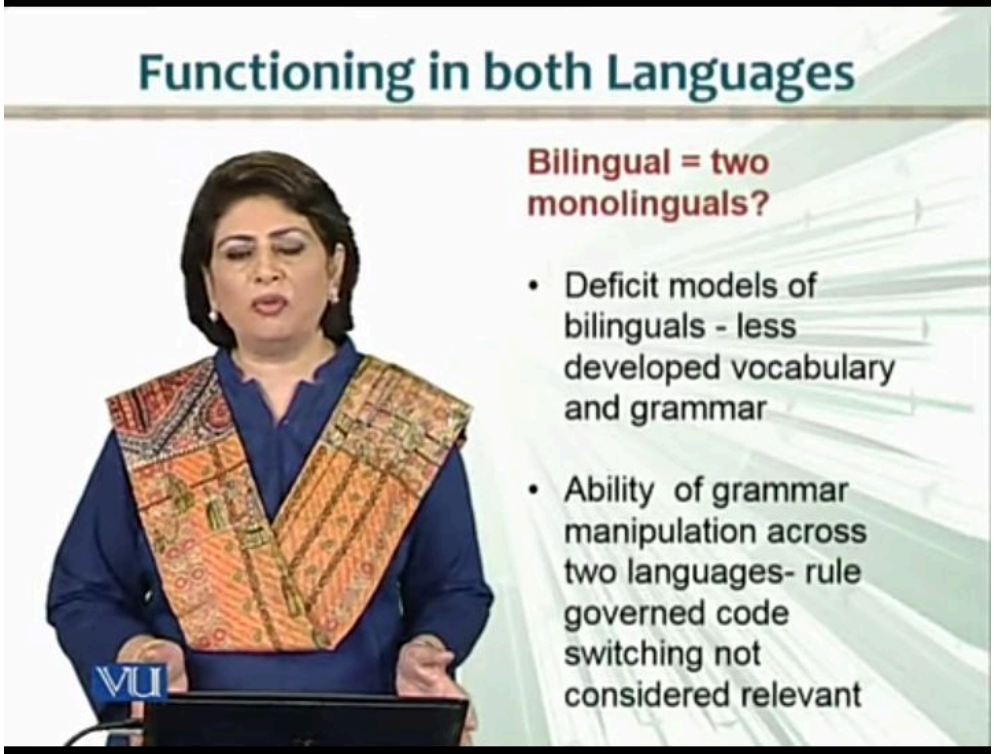

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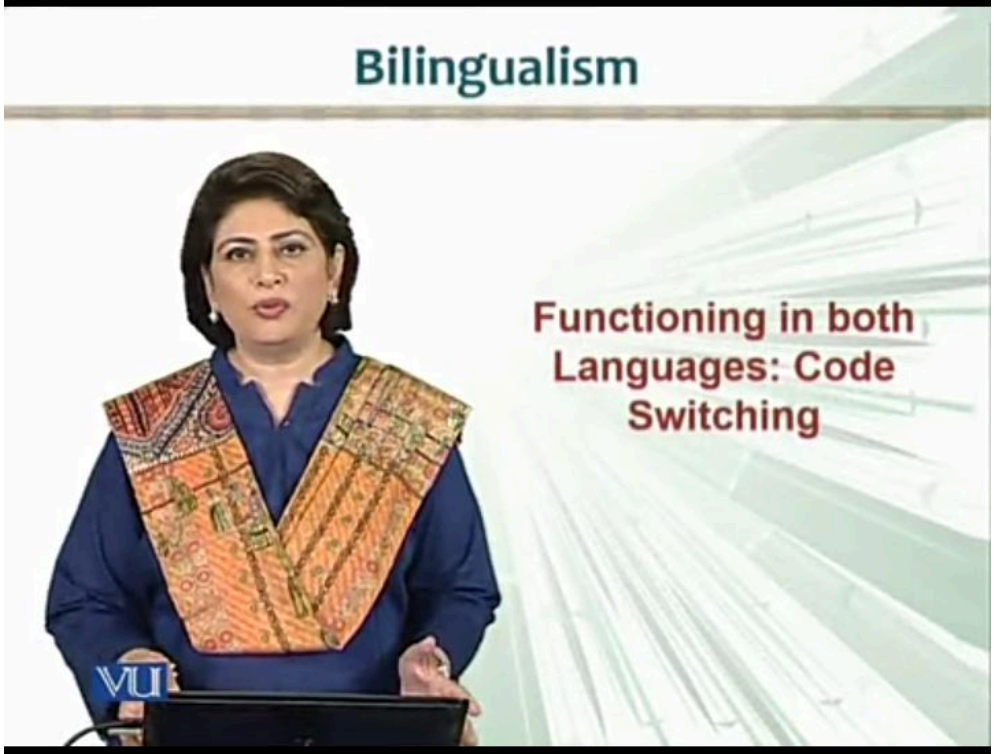

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Topic No 038-043

Functioning as a Bilingual; Mental Representation of Languages; Functioning in Both Languages; Changing Attitudes; Semilingualism; Stigmatization and Language Rights

A frequently asked question is whether a bilingual speaker's brain functions differently from that of a monolingual's brain. Quantitative analyses of the existing data often show that differences between them are the exceptions rather than the rule. Bilinguals do not seem to vary from monolinguals in neurological processes; the lateralization of language in the brains of the two groups of speakers is also similar.

A related issue concerns the mental representation of a bilingual's two languages and the processing emanating from such representation. Evidence exists for both separate storage and shared storage of the two languages in the bilingual's brain, resulting in the suggestion that bilinguals have a language store for each of their two languages and a more general conceptual store. There are strong, direct interconnecting channels between each of these three separate stores. The interconnections between the two languages comprise association and translation systems, and common images in the conceptual store act as mediators.

Speakers of different proficiency levels or at different acquisitional stages vary in strength and directness of the interconnections between the separate stores in language processing; for instance, those who are highly proficient in two languages may go directly from a concept to the target language, while those whose second language is weaker than their first tend to use the first language to mediate.

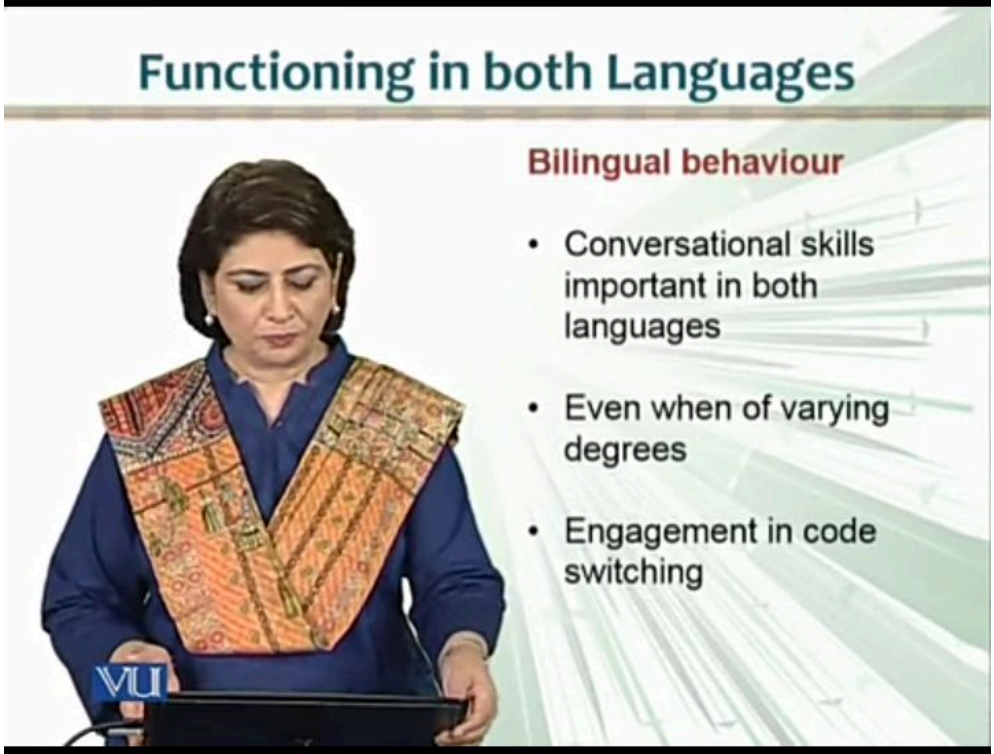
Although the more general definitions of bilingualism would include people who understand a second language in either spoken or written form or both but do not necessarily speak or write it, a more common usage of the term refers to someone who can function in both languages in conversational interaction. Bilingual speakers choose to use their different languages depending on a variety of factors, including the type of person addressed and different situations and contexts.

Code Switching

There is a widespread impression that bilingual speakers code-switch because they cannot express themselves adequately in one language. This may be true to some extent when a bilingual is momentarily lost for words in one of his or her languages. However, code-switching is an extremely common practice among bilinguals and takes many forms. It has been demonstrated that code-switching involves skilled manipulation of overlapping sections of two (or more) grammars. Some suggest that code-switching is itself a discrete mode of speaking, emanating from a single code-switching grammar.

One important aspect of the code-switching grammar is that the two languages involved do not play the same role in sentence making. Typically one language sets the grammatical framework, with the other providing certain items to fit into the framework. Code-switching; therefore, is not a simple combination of two sets of grammatical rules but grammatical integration of one language in another.

The possible existence of a code-switching grammar calls into question the traditional view of the bilingual as two monolinguals in one person. One consequence of the 'two-in-one' perspective is that bilingual



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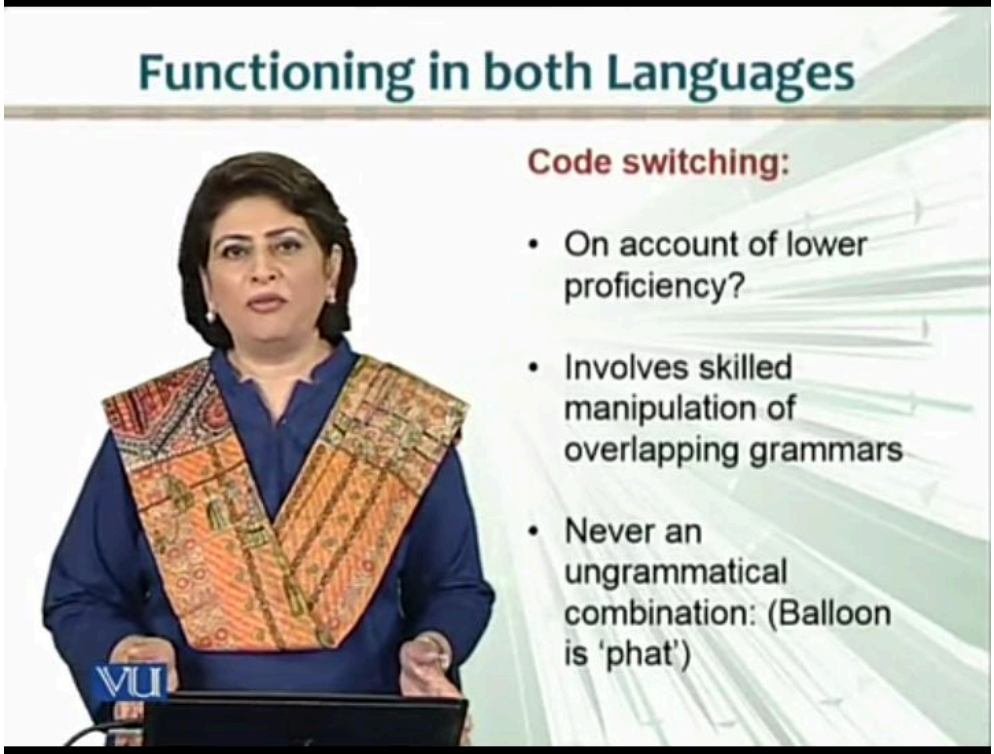

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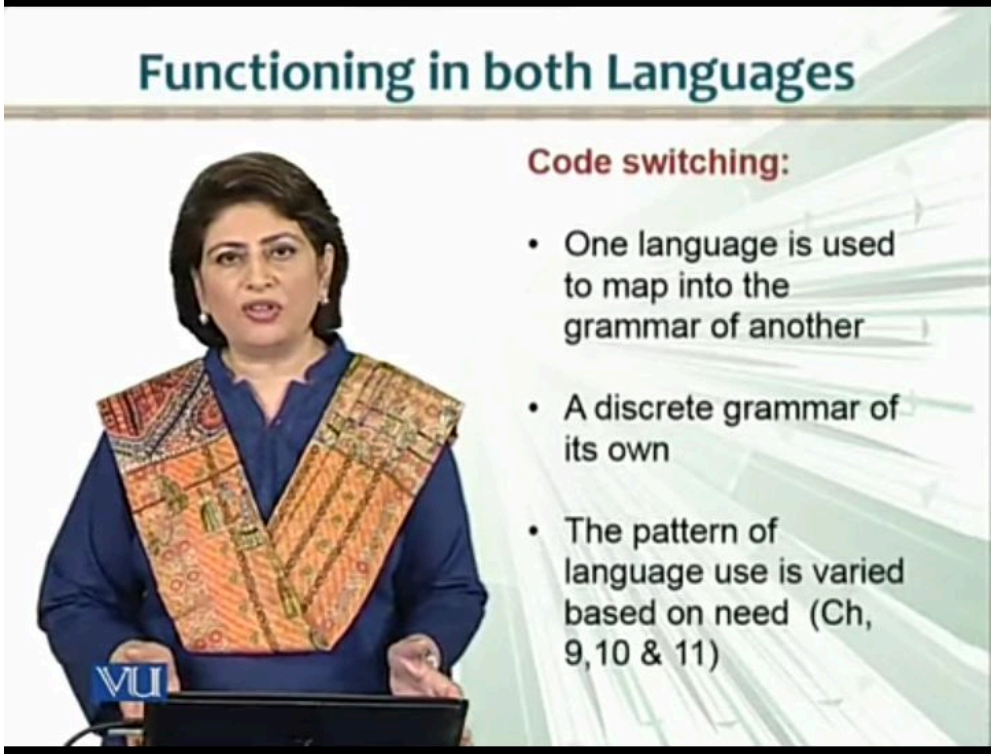

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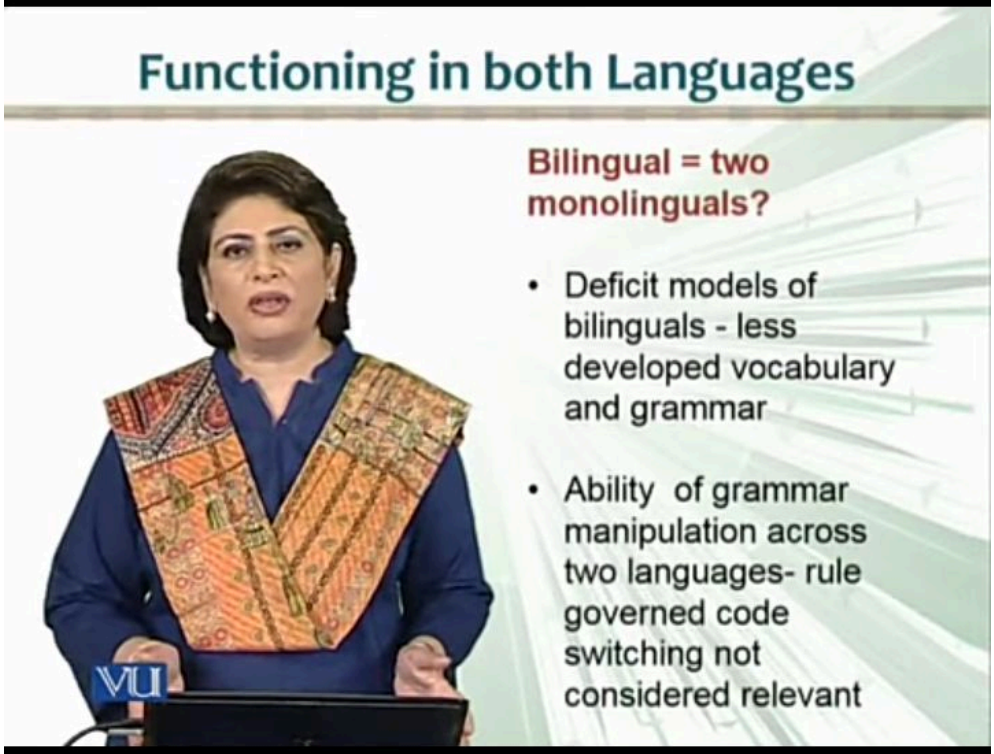

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In some experimental psycholinguistic studies, tests are given without taking into account that bilingual speakers may have learnt their two languages under different conditions for different purposes, and they only use them in different situations. It is important to emphasize that bilingual speakers have a unique linguistic and psychological profile; their two languages are constantly in different states of activation; they are able to call upon their linguistic knowledge and resources according to the context and adapt their behaviour.

In addition to the social use of code-switching, some bilinguals regularly change their speech production from one language to another in their professional life. Interpreters and translators, for example, switch between languages as a routine part of their job. Often we think of professional interpreters and translators as special people with highly developed language skills in each of their languages. In fact, even they are rarely perfectly balanced in two languages. They are trained to translate from the 'passive' to the 'active' language. They are also trained to think rapidly of appropriate wording of ideas and produce words from a restricted area of meaning.

Another group of bilinguals engage themselves in cross-modality language production. This is the case with speech-sign bilinguals who, in addition to the oral modality, use the manual-visual modality in everyday communication. They are special in one aspect, i.e. the two different modalities allow for the simultaneous production of the two languages. In other words, one can speak and sign at the same time.

Attitudes

From the early nineteenth century to about the 1960s, there was a widespread belief that bilingualism has a detrimental effect on a human being's intellectual and spiritual growth. The early research on bilingualism and cognition tended to confirm this negative viewpoint, finding that monolinguals were superior to bilinguals on intelligence tests. However, serious issues regarding these discredit the evidence.

Semilingualism

A bilingual who could not acquire full competence in any of the languages were termed as 'semilinguals'. They were believed to have linguistic deficits in six areas of language (see Hansegard, 1975; Skutnabb-Kangas, 1981):

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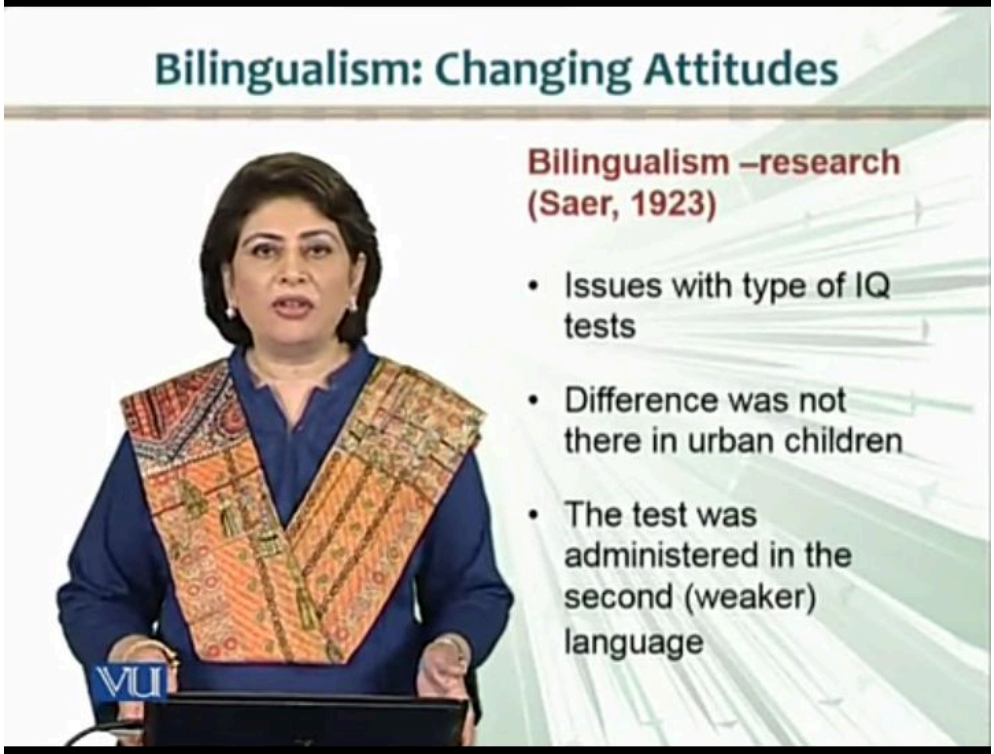

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It is significant that the term 'semilingualism' emerged in connection with the study of language skills of people belonging to ethnic minority groups. Research which provided evidence in support of the notion of 'semilingualism' was conducted in Scandinavia and North America and was concerned with accounting for the educational outcomes of submersion programs where minority children were taught through the medium of the majority language. However, these studies, like the ones conducted also had

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• Second, bilingual children are still in the process of developing their languages. It is unfair to compare them to some idealized adults.

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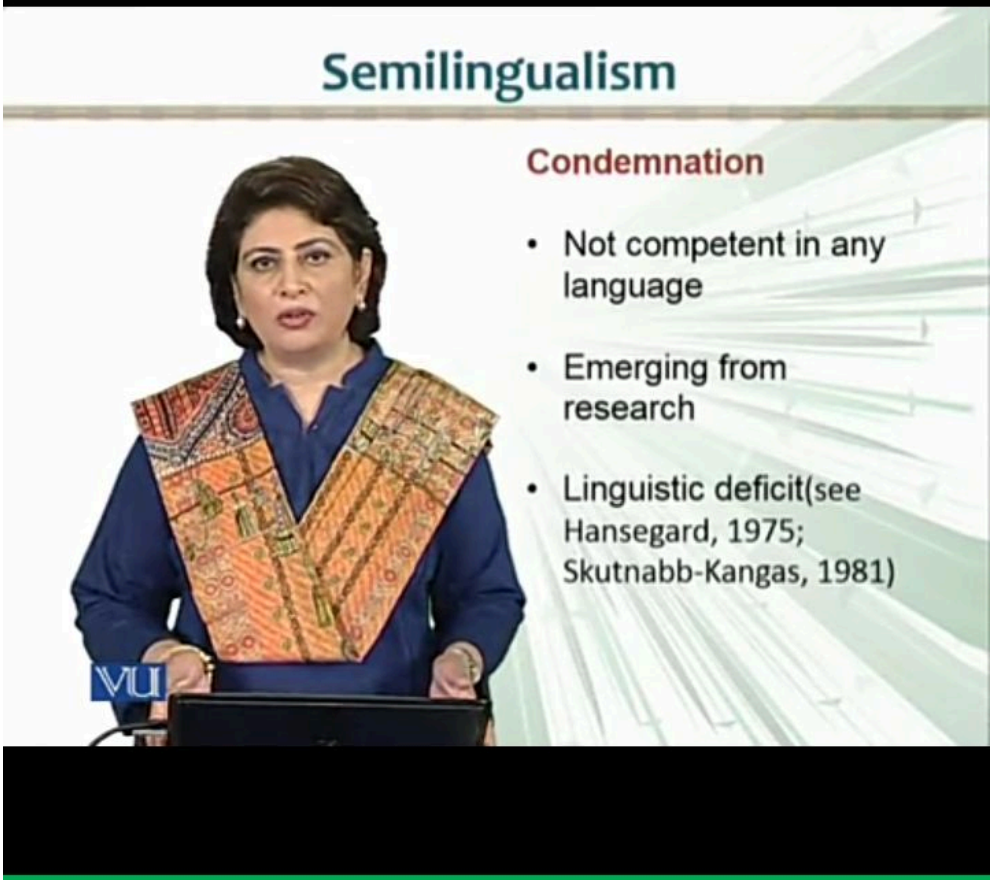

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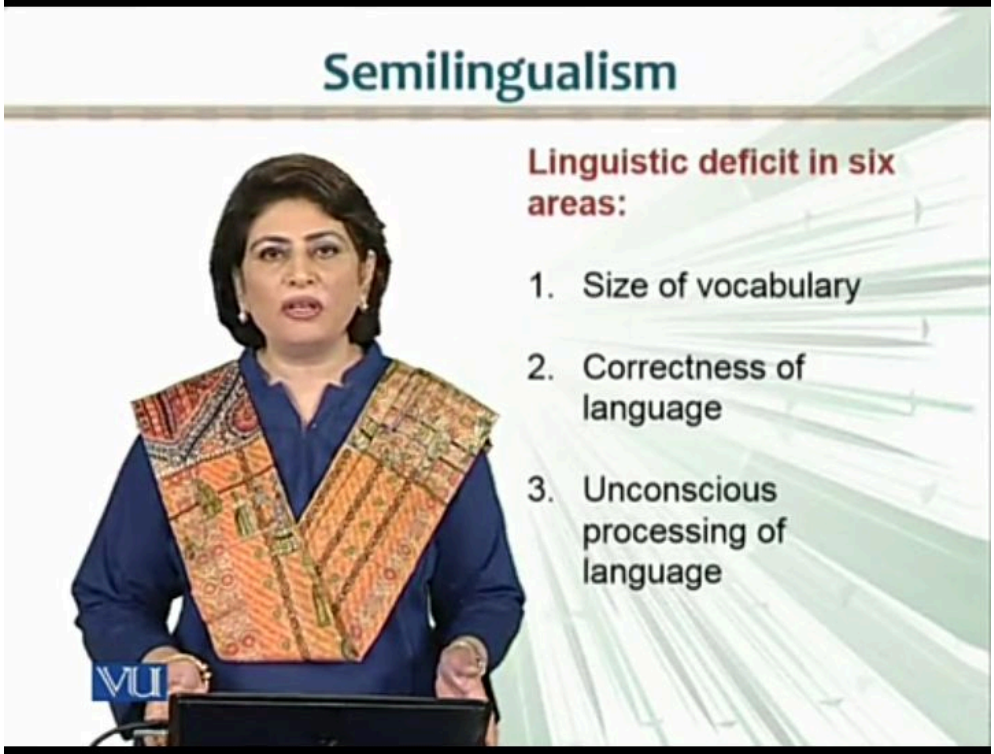

Semilingualism

A bilingual who could not acquire full competence in any of the languages were termed as 'semilinguals'. They were believed to have linguistic deficits in six areas of language (see Hansegard, 1975; Skutnabb-Kangas, 1981):

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2. Correctness of language
3. Unconscious processing of language
4. Language creation
5. Mastery of the functions of language
6. Meanings and imagery

It is significant that the term 'semilingualism' emerged in connection with the study of language skills of people belonging to ethnic minority groups. Research which provided evidence in support of the notion of 'semilingualism' was conducted in Scandinavia and North America and was concerned with accounting for the educational outcomes of submersion programs where minority children were taught through the medium of the majority language. However, these studies, like the ones conducted also had

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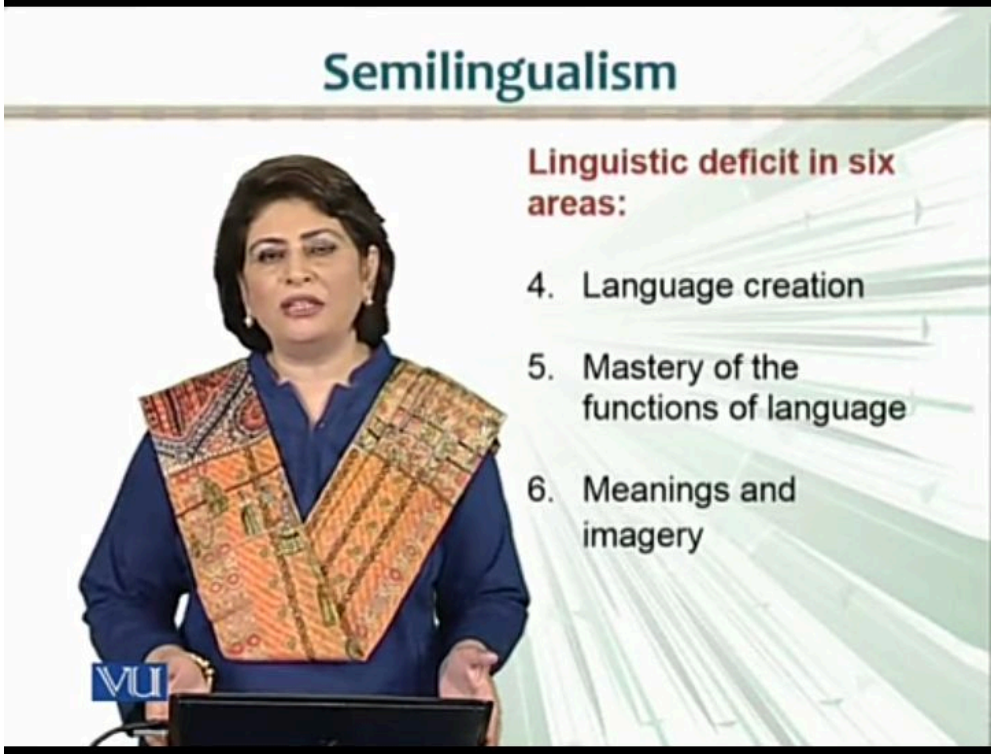

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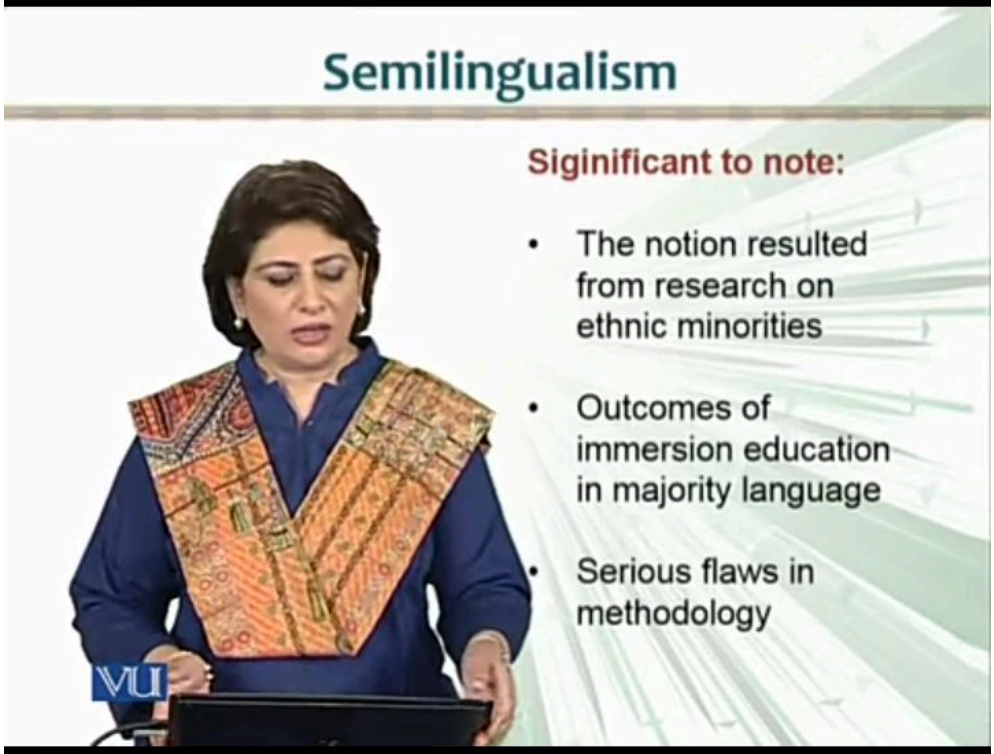

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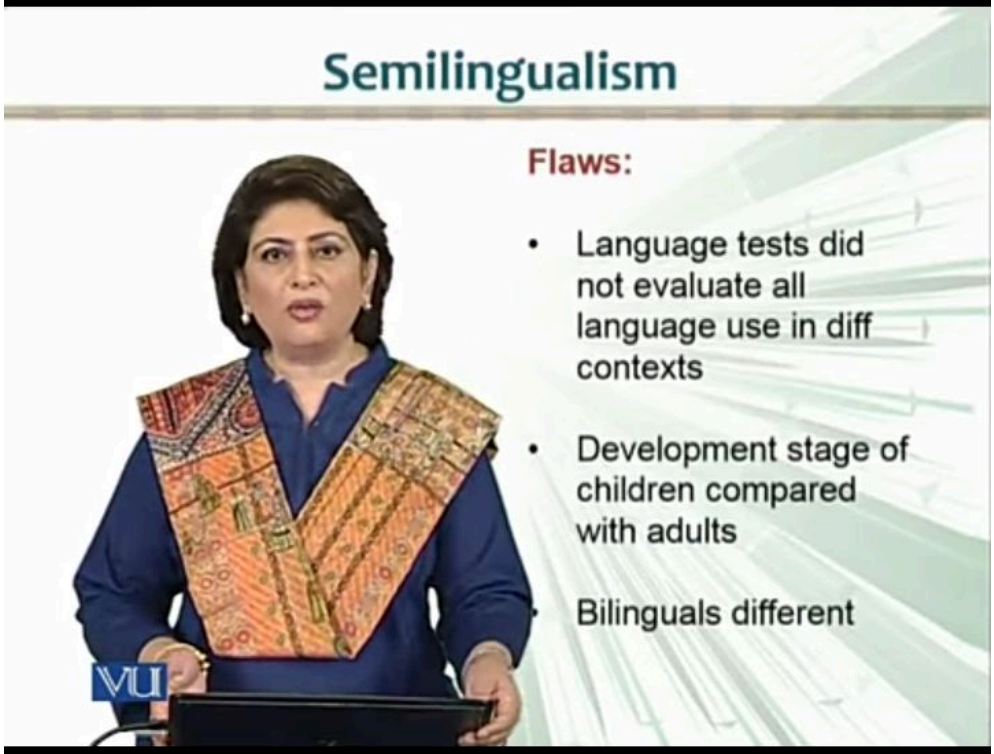

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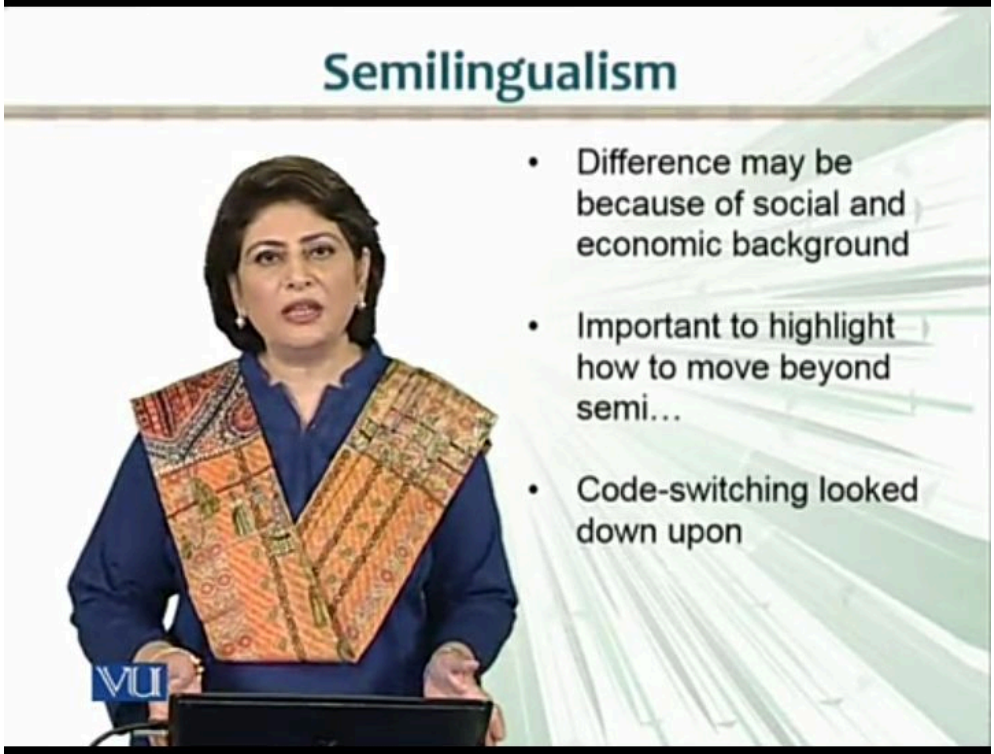

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Unfortunately, although switching and mixing of languages occur in practically all bilingual communities and all bilingual speakers' speech, it is stigmatized as an illegitimate mode of communication, even sometimes by the bilingual speakers themselves.

Language Rights

Attitudes do not, of course, remain constant over time. At a personal level, changes in attitudes may occur when there is some personal reward involved. Speakers of minority languages will be more motivated to maintain and use their languages if they prove to be useful in increasing their employability or social mobility. In some cases, certain jobs are reserved for bilingual speakers only. At the societal level, attitudes towards bilingualism change when the political ideology changes.

Since the 1960s, there has been a political movement, particularly in the US, advocating language rights. In the US, questions about language rights are widely discussed, not only in college classrooms and language communities but also in government and federal legislatures. The legal battles concerned not just minority language vs. majority language contests, but also children vs. schools, parents vs. school boards, state vs. the federal authorities, etc.

The kind of rights, apart from language rights, that minority groups may claim include: protection, membership of their ethnic group and separate existence, non-discrimination and equal treatment, education and information in their ethnic language, freedom to worship, freedom of belief, freedom of movement, employment, peaceful assembly and association, political representation and involvement, and administrative autonomy.

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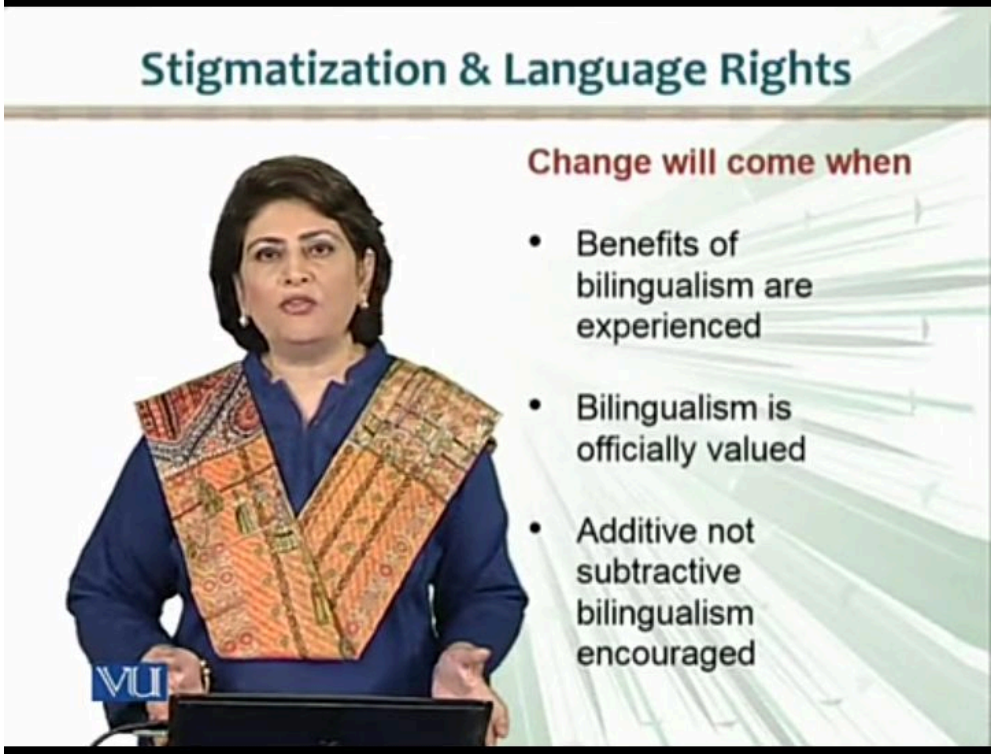

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Lesson-09

ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES OF BILINGUALISM

Topic No. 044-048

Advantages and Disadvantages of Bilingualism; Communicative Advantages; Cultural Advantage; Cognitive Advantage; Disadvantages of Bilingualism

Communicative Advantages

1. Relationships with parents and extended family: Where parents have differing first languages, the advantage of children becoming bilingual is that they will be able to communicate in each parent's preferred language. Being a bilingual allows someone to bridge the generations.

2. Community relationships: Bilingual has a chance to communicate with a wider variety of people than a monolingual.

3. Transnational communication: One barrier between nations and ethnic groups tends to be language and bilinguals can bridge that.

4.Language sensitivity: Being able to move between two languages may lead to more sensitivity in communication because bilinguals are constantly monitoring which language to use in different situations, they may be more tuned to the communicative needs of those with whom they talk.

Cultural Advantages

Another advantage of being a bilingual is having two or more worlds of experience. Bilingualism provides the opportunity to experience two or more cultures. The monolingual may experience a variety of cultures; for example, from different neighbours and communities that are using the same language but have different ways of life. The monolinguals can travel to neighbouring countries and experience other cultures as a passive on looker. However, to penetrate different cultures requires the language of that culture. To participate and become involved in the core of a culture requires knowledge of the language of that culture.

Economic Advantages

There are also potential economic advantages to being bilingual. A person with two languages may have a wider portfolio of jobs available. As economic trade barriers fall, as international relationships become closer, as unions and partnerships across nations become more widespread, an increasing number of jobs are likely to require be a person to be bilingual or multilingual.

5:03

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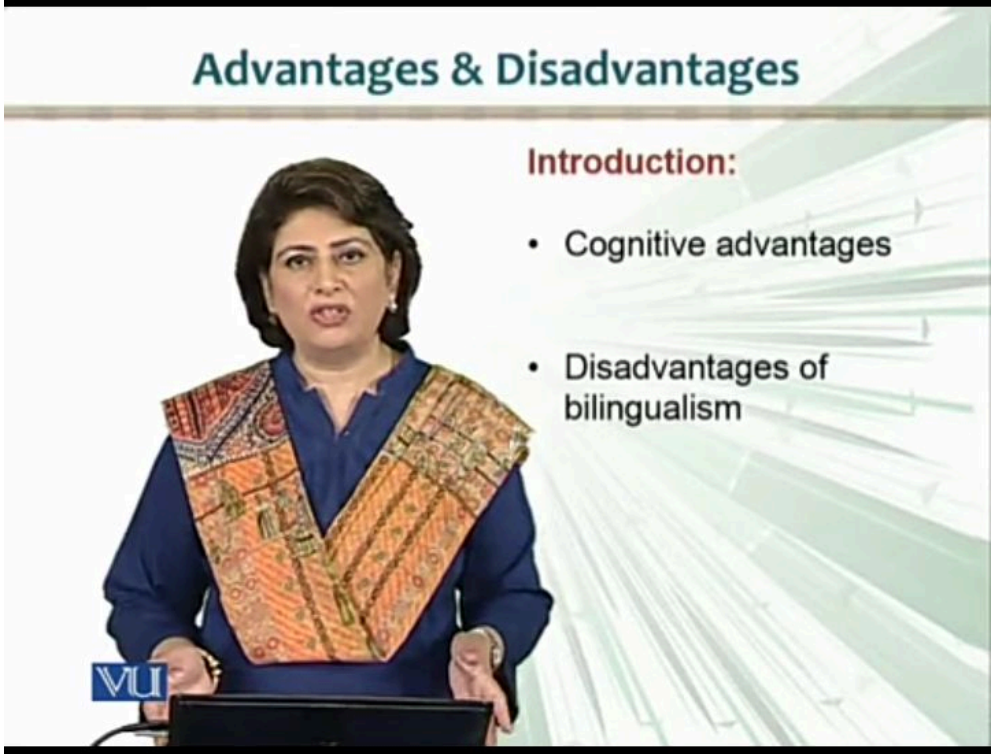

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No connection

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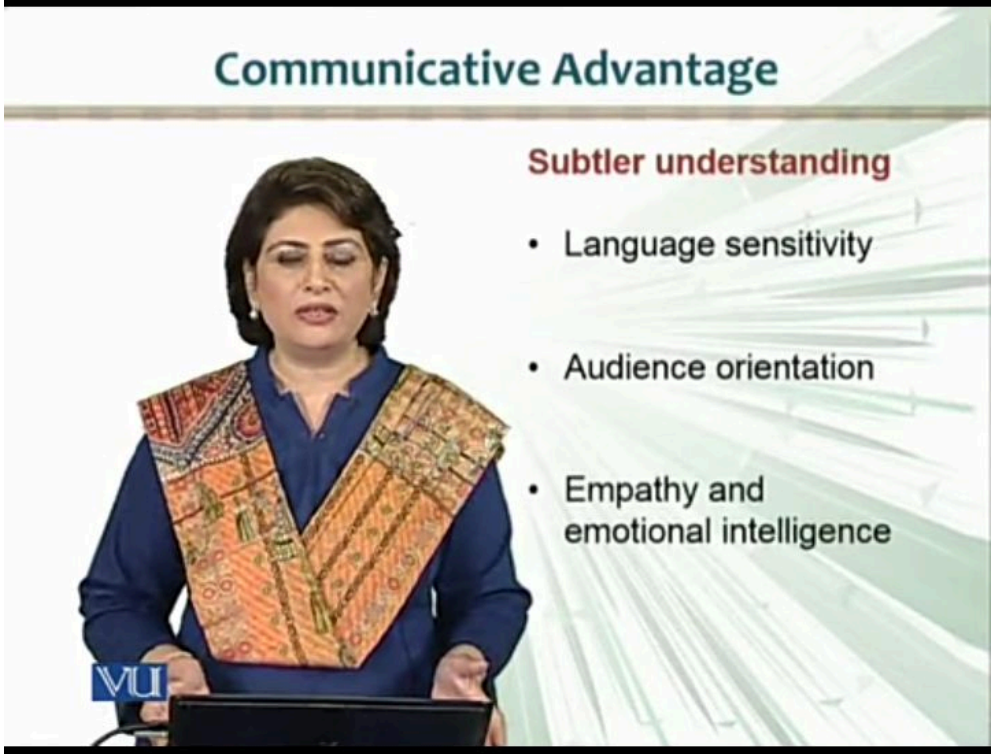

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Advantages and Disadvantages of Bilingualism; Communicative Advantages; Cultural Advantage; Cognitive Advantage; Disadvantages of Bilingualism

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1. Relationships with parents and extended family: Where parents have differing first languages, the advantage of children becoming bilingual is that they will be able to communicate in each parent's preferred language. Being a bilingual allows someone to bridge the generations.

2. Community relationships: Bilingual has a chance to communicate with a wider variety of people than a monolingual.

3. Transnational communication: One barrier between nations and ethnic groups tends to be language and bilinguals can bridge that.

4.Language sensitivity: Being able to move between two languages may lead to more sensitivity in communication because bilinguals are constantly monitoring which language to use in different situations, they may be more tuned to the communicative needs of those with whom they talk.

Cultural Advantages

Another advantage of being a bilingual is having two or more worlds of experience. Bilingualism provides the opportunity to experience two or more cultures. The monolingual may experience a variety of cultures; for example, from different neighbours and communities that are using the same language but have different ways of life. The monolinguals can travel to neighbouring countries and experience other cultures as a passive on looker. However, to penetrate different cultures requires the language of that culture. To participate and become involved in the core of a culture requires knowledge of the language of that culture.

Economic Advantages

There are also potential economic advantages to being bilingual. A person with two languages may have a wider portfolio of jobs available. As economic trade barriers fall, as international relationships become closer, as unions and partnerships across nations become more widespread, an increasing number of jobs are likely to require be a person to be bilingual or multilingual.

Cognitive Advantages

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ENG512_Topic046

Bilingualism

Cultural Advantage of Bilingualism

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No connection

Advantage; Cognitive Advantage; Disadvantages of Bilingualism

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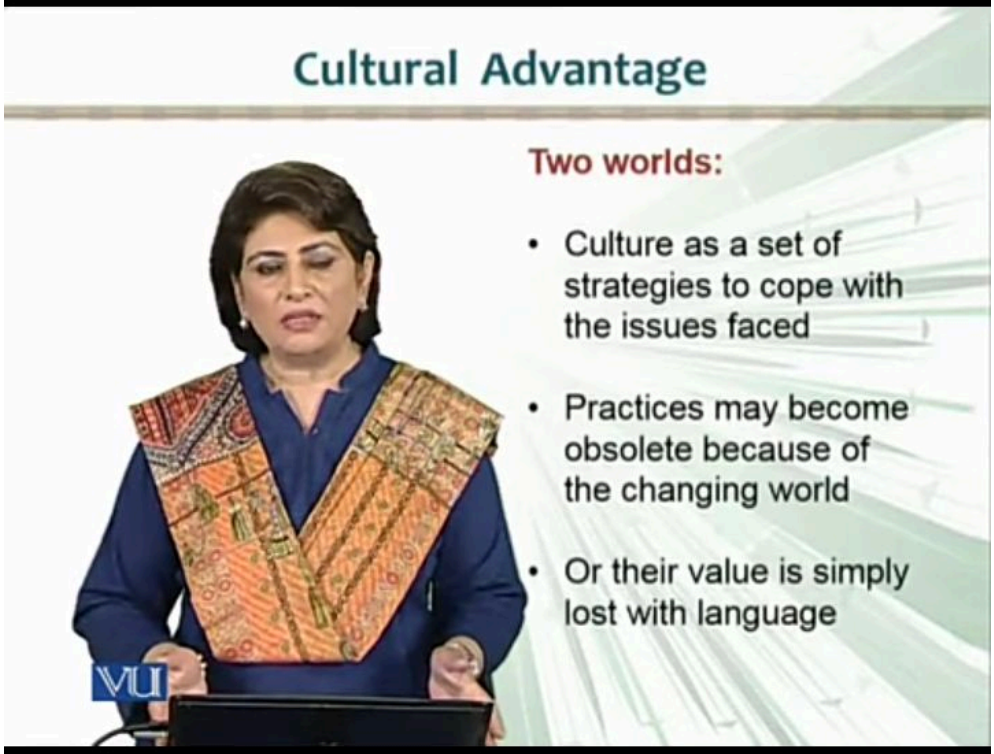

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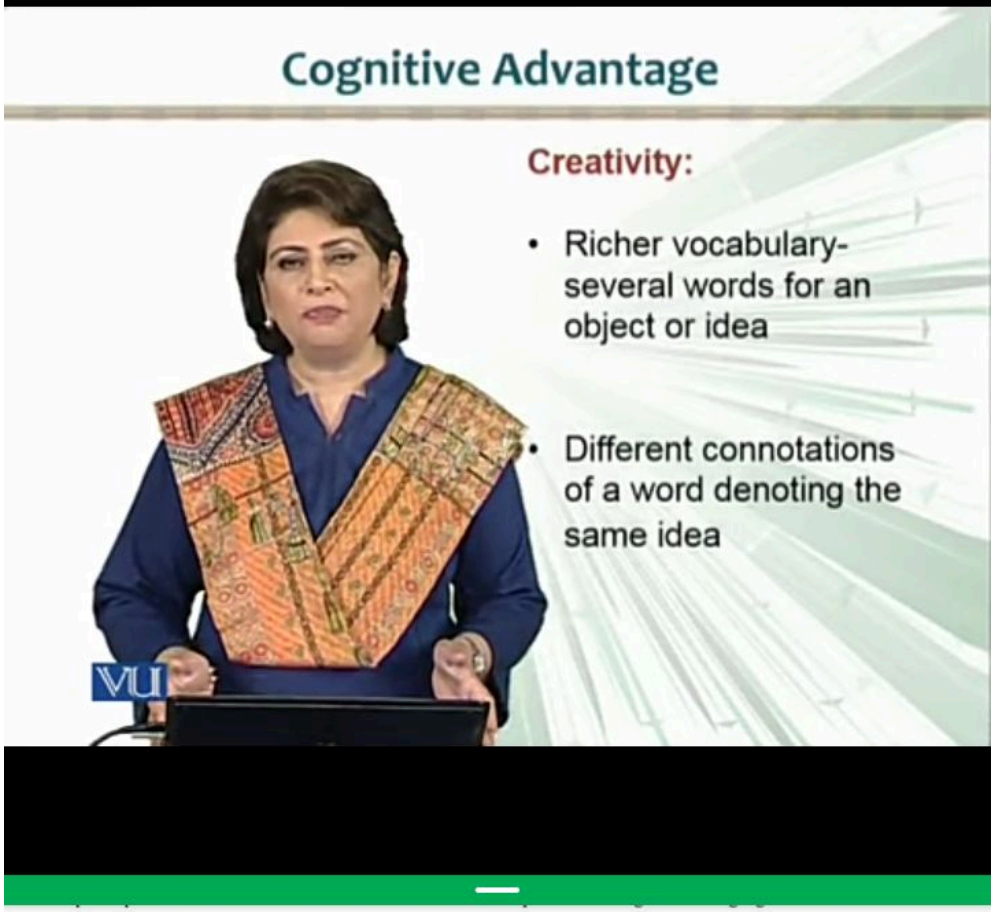

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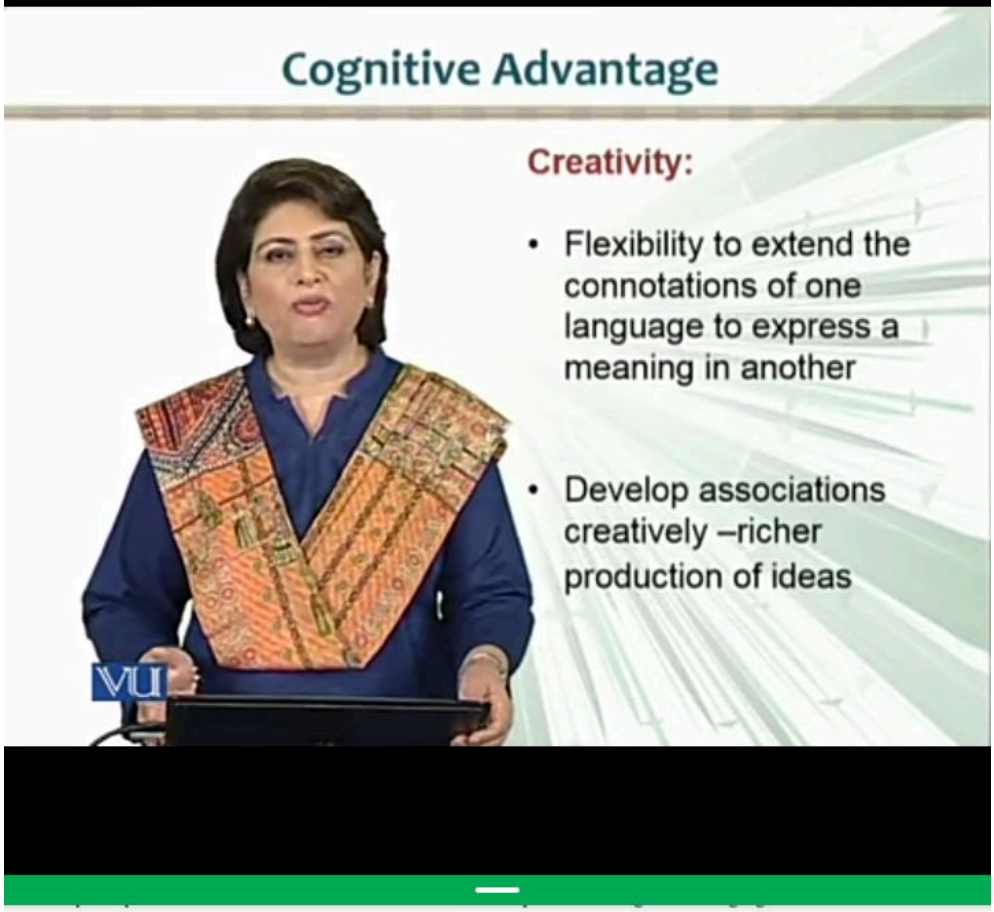

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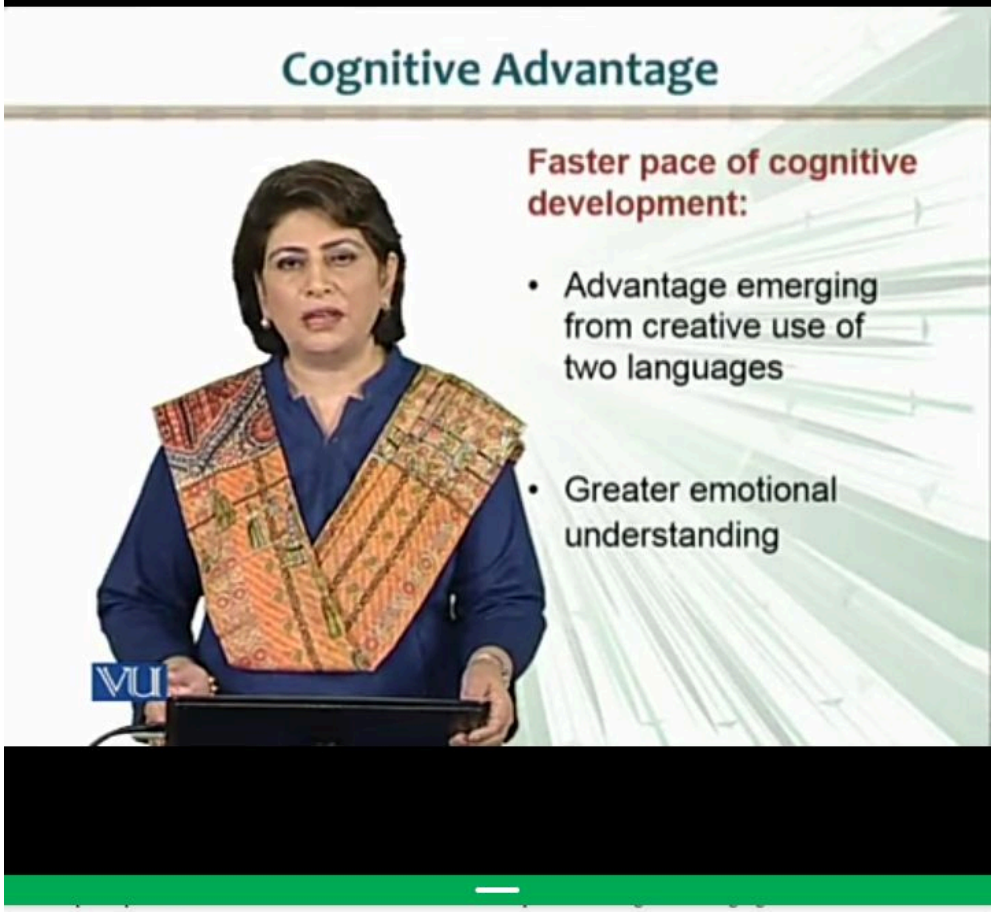

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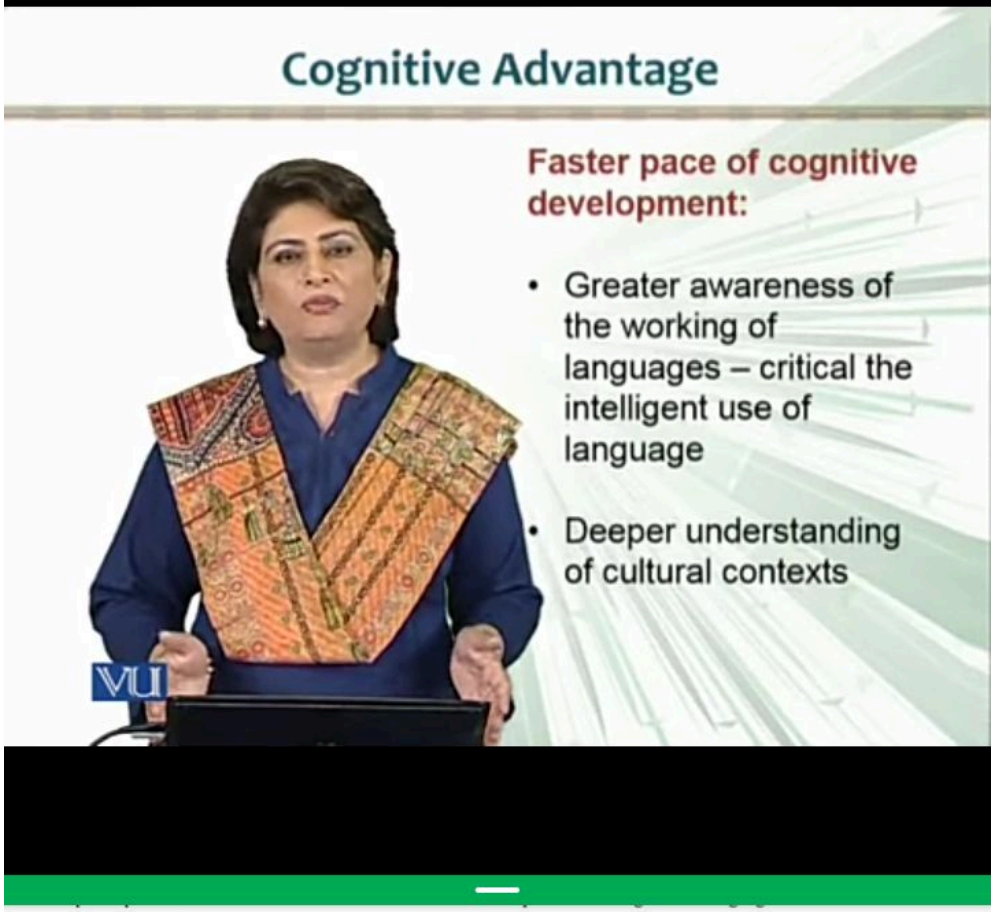

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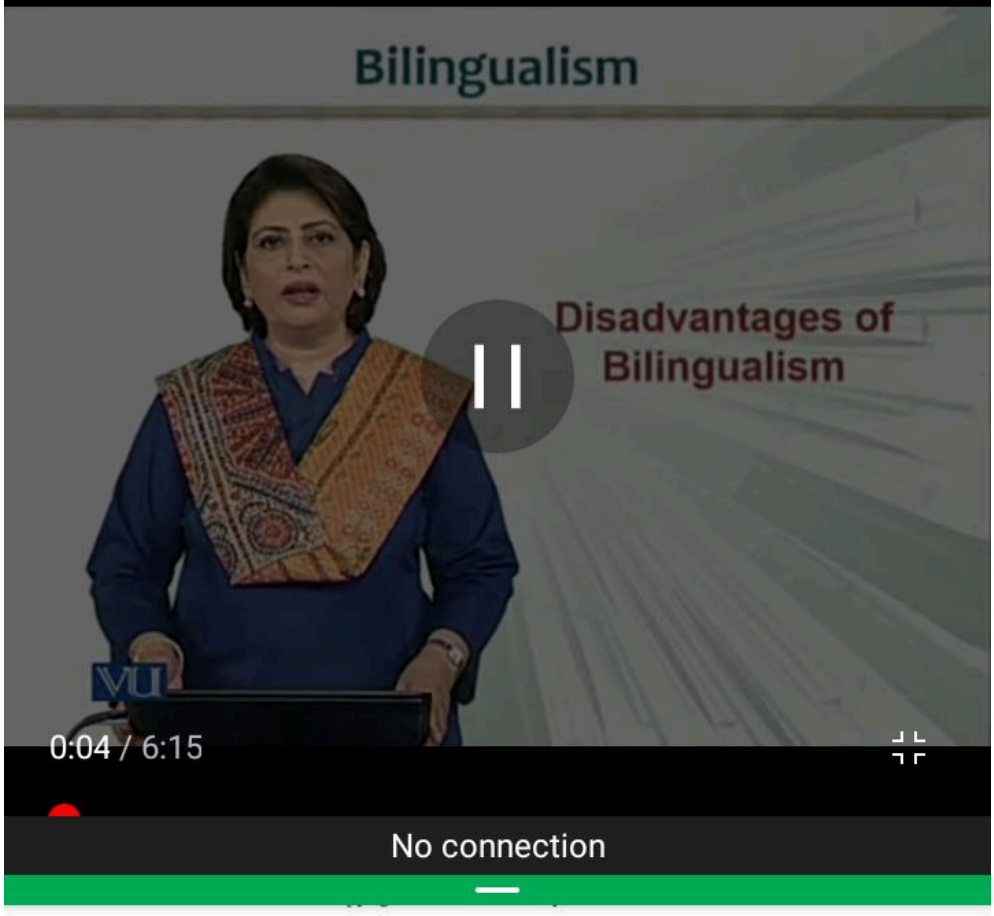

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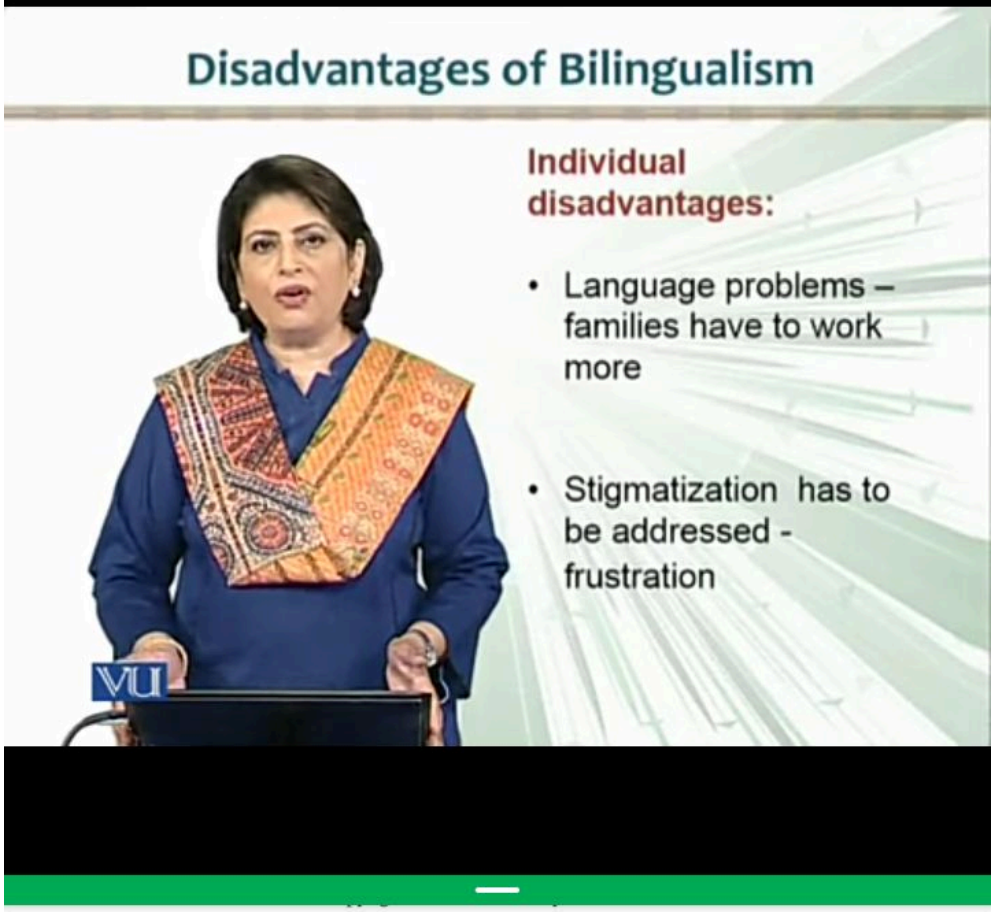

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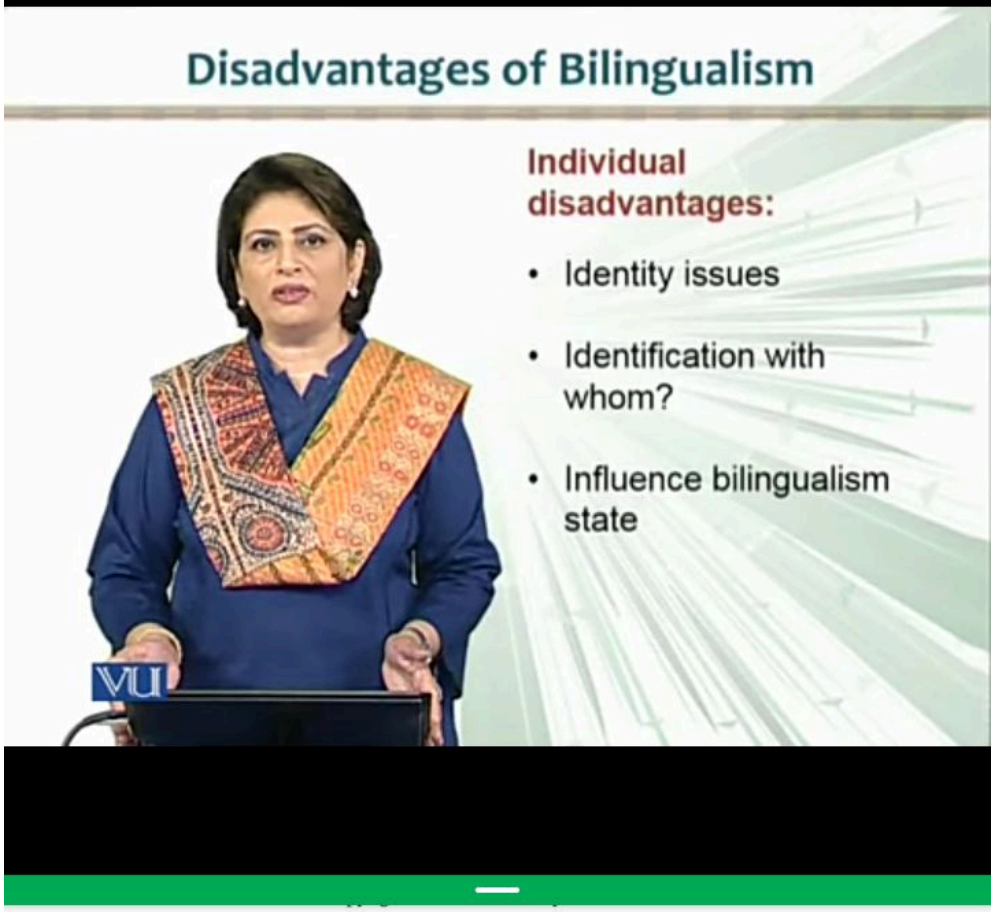

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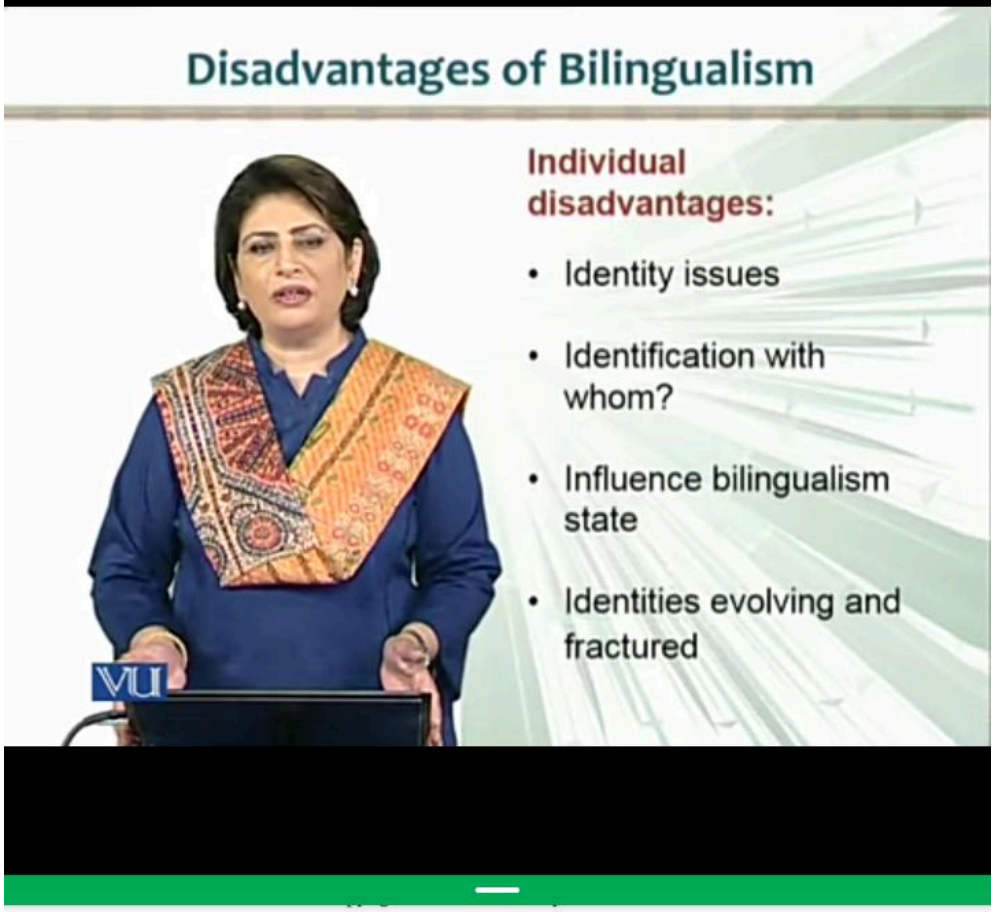

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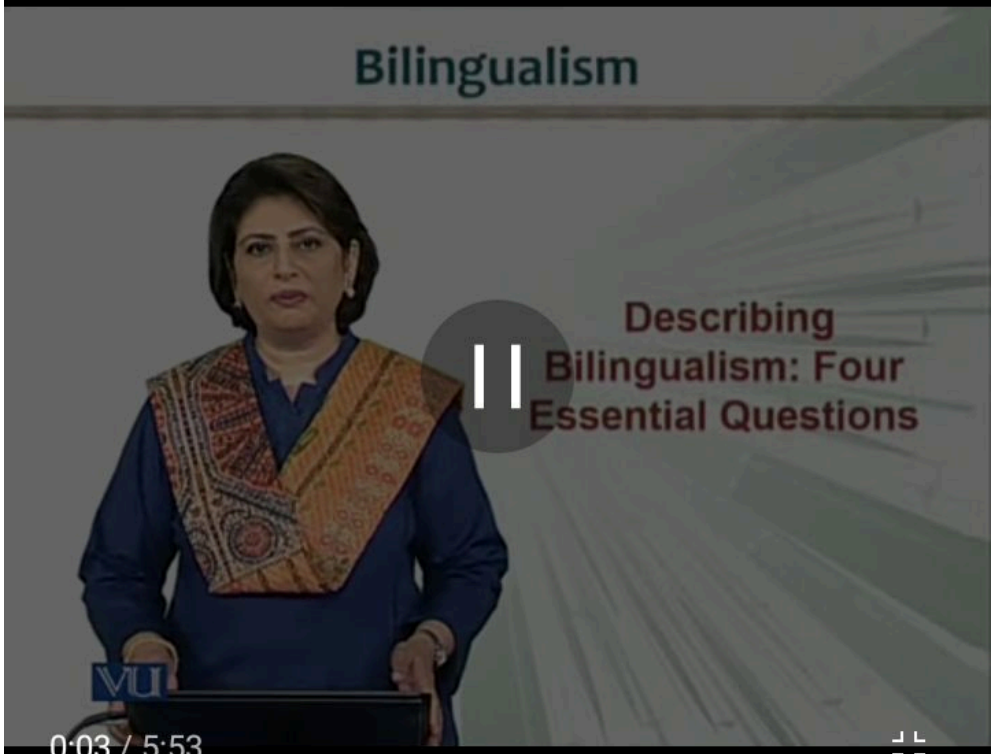

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Topic No. 049-055

Describing Bilingualism; Degree; External Functions; Variations in Language Contact; Internal Functions; Alternation; Interference

Bilingualism is a relative concept, which involves the question of degree; function; alternation and interference.

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The bilingual's language contacts may be with the languages used in the home, community, school, mass media and correspondence.

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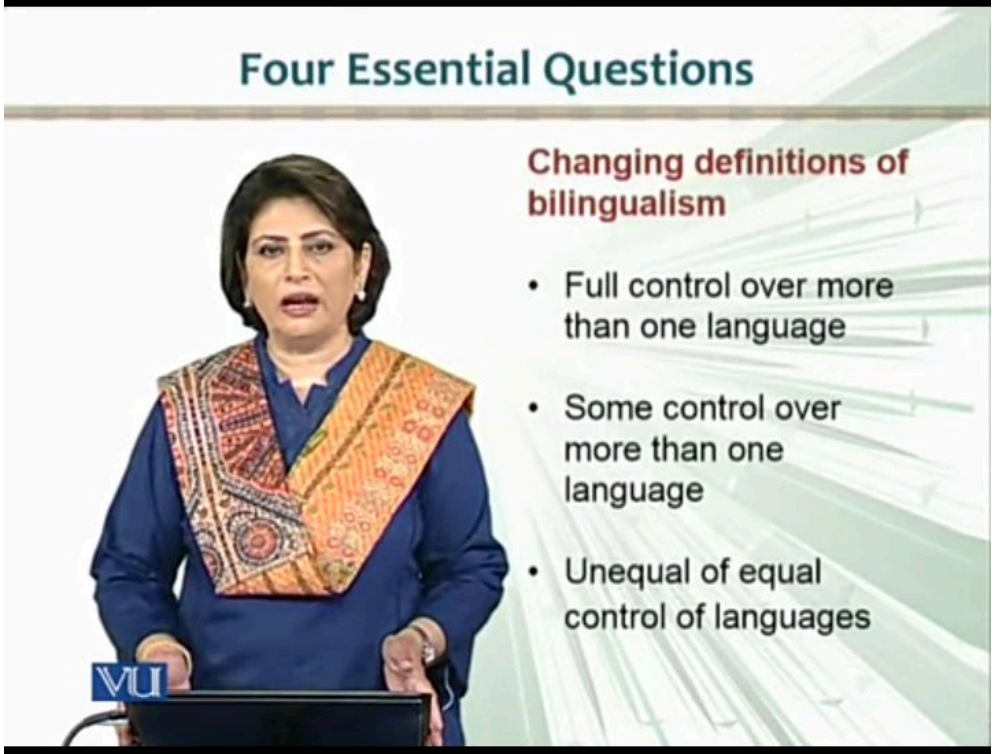

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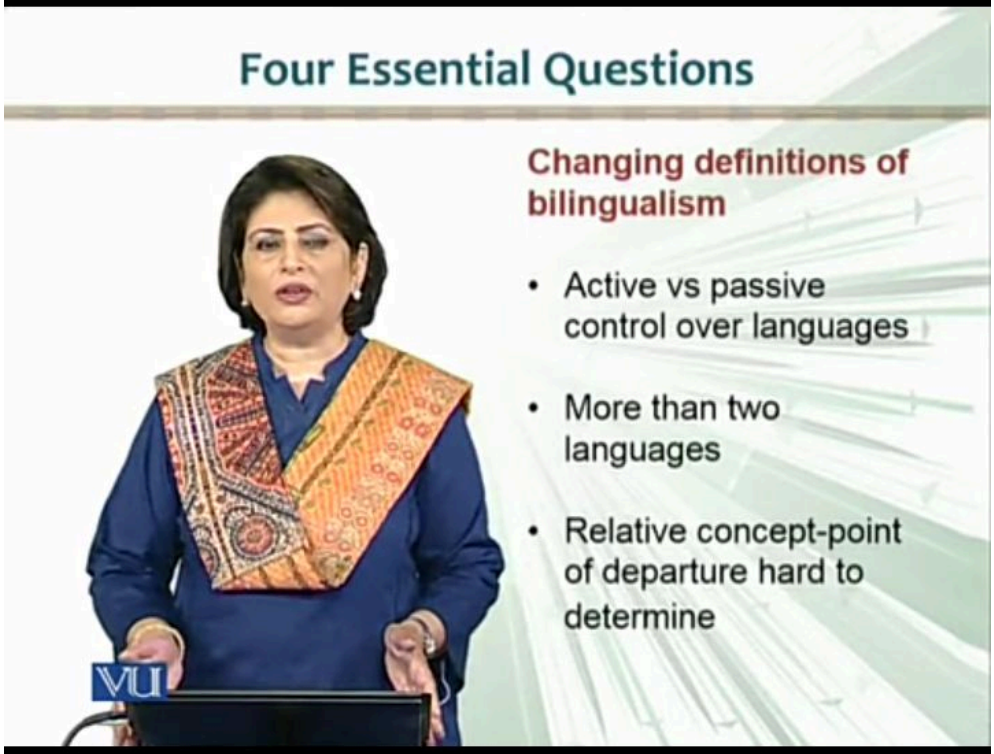

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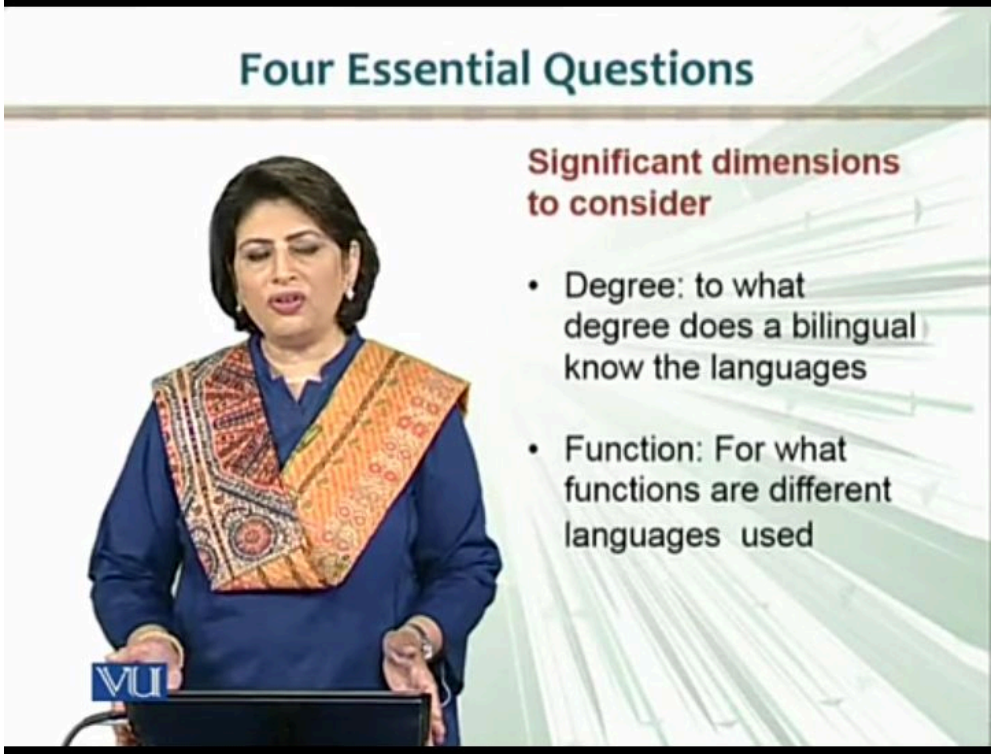

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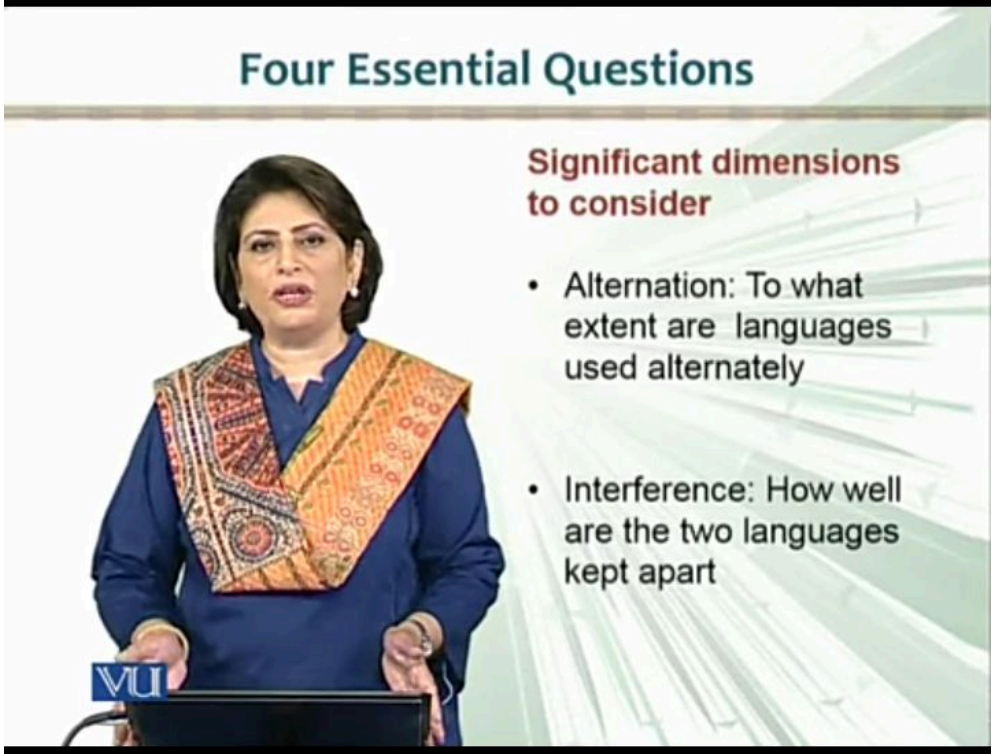

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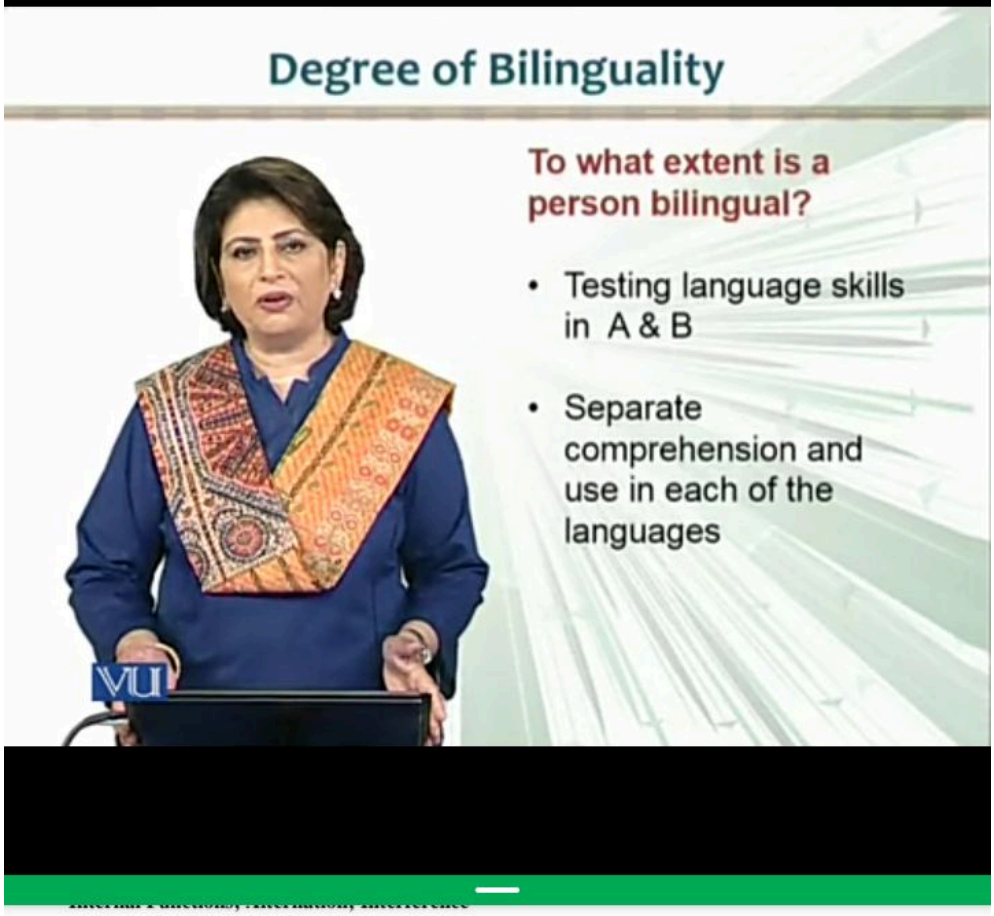

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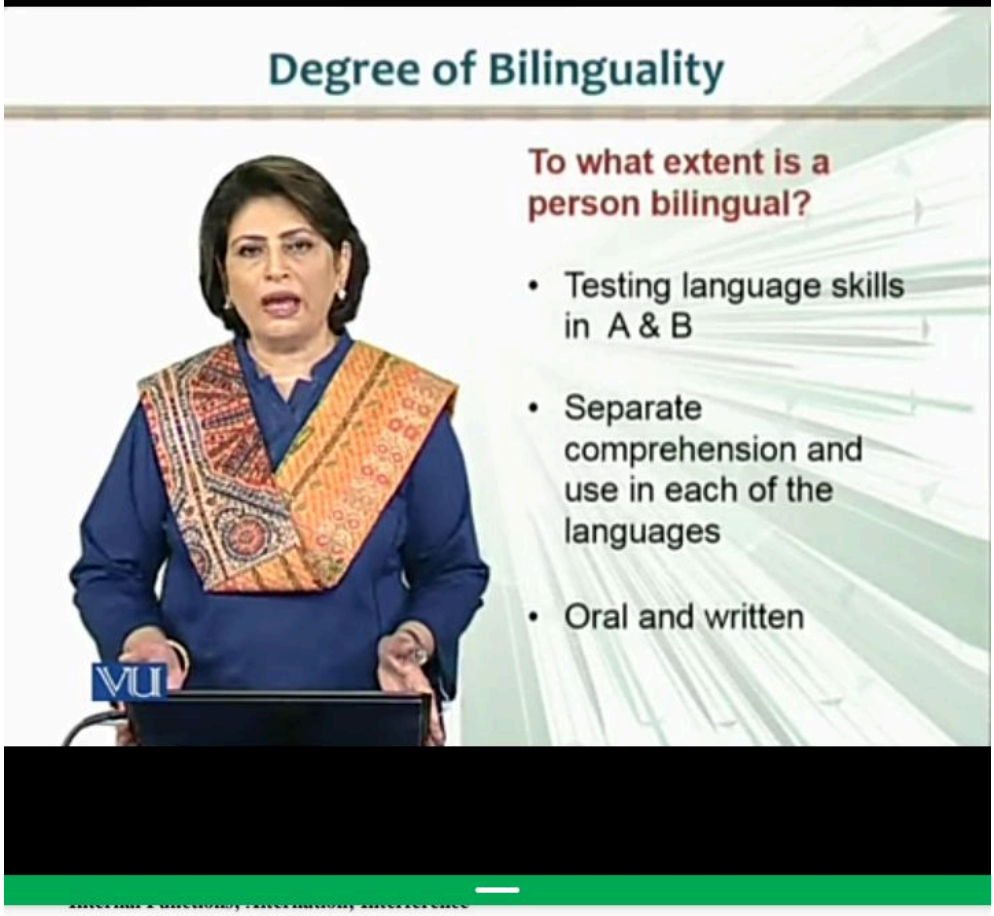

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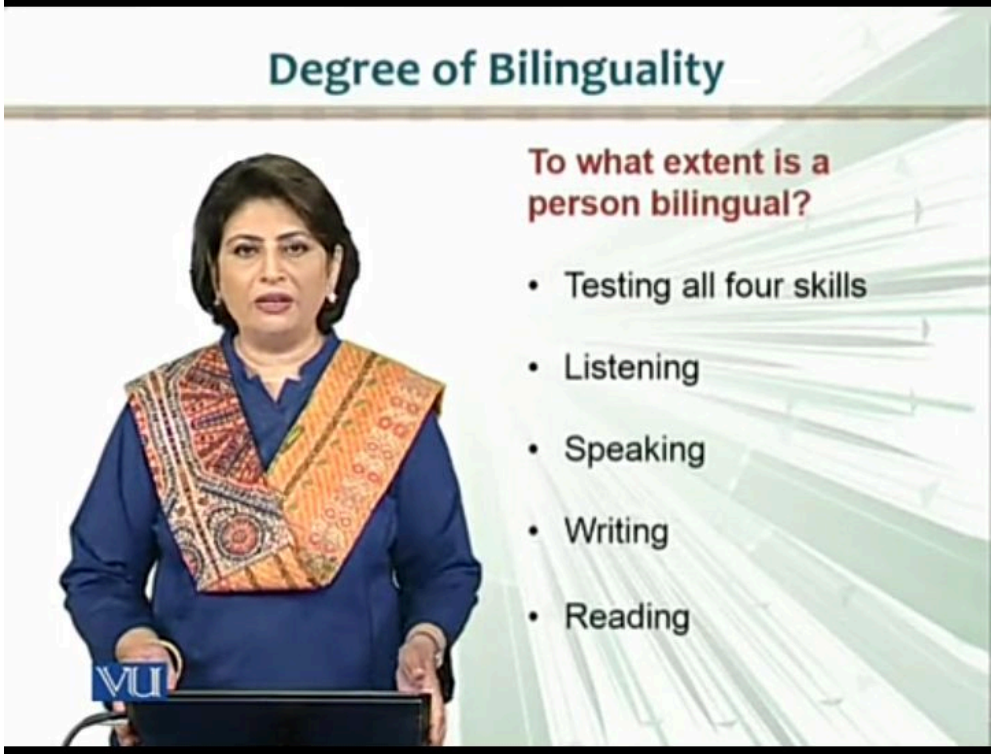

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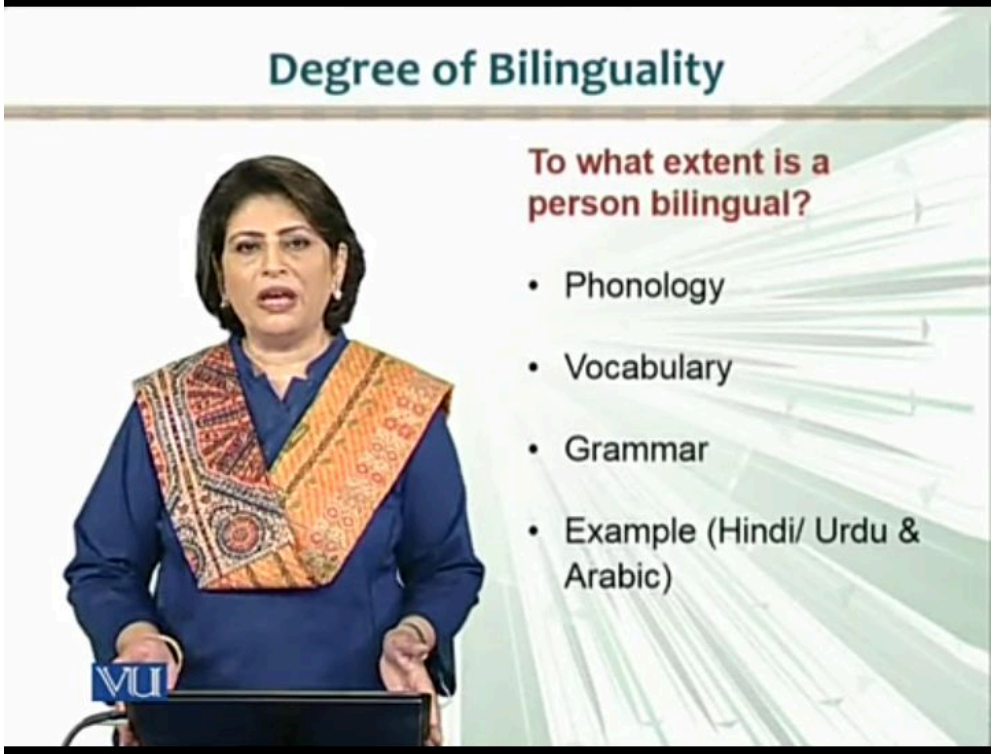

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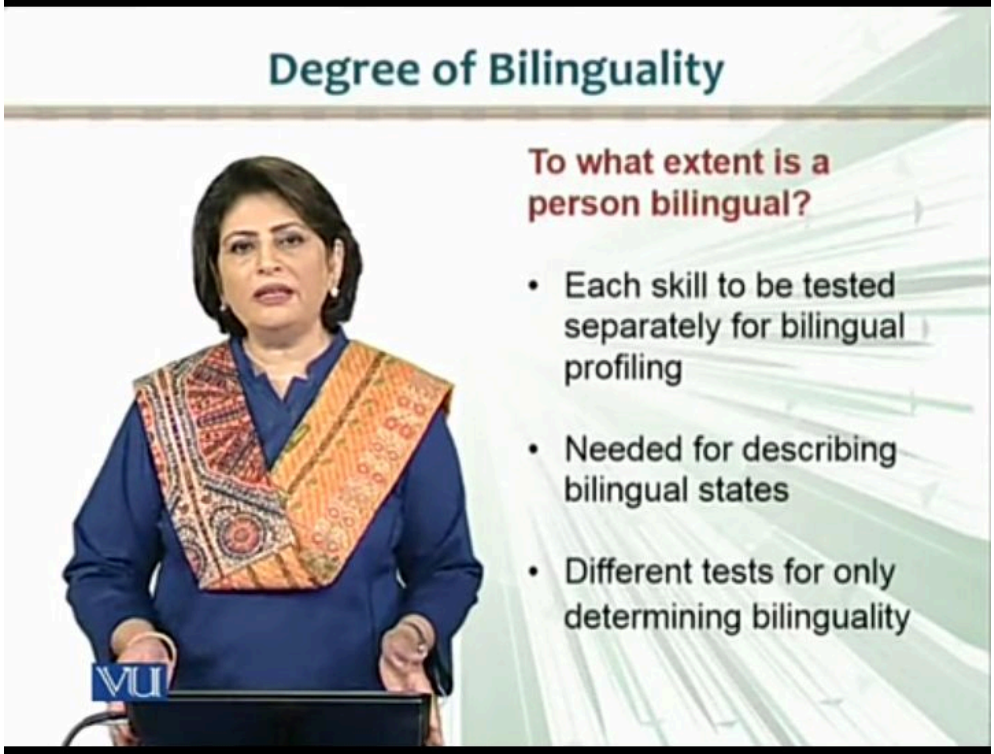

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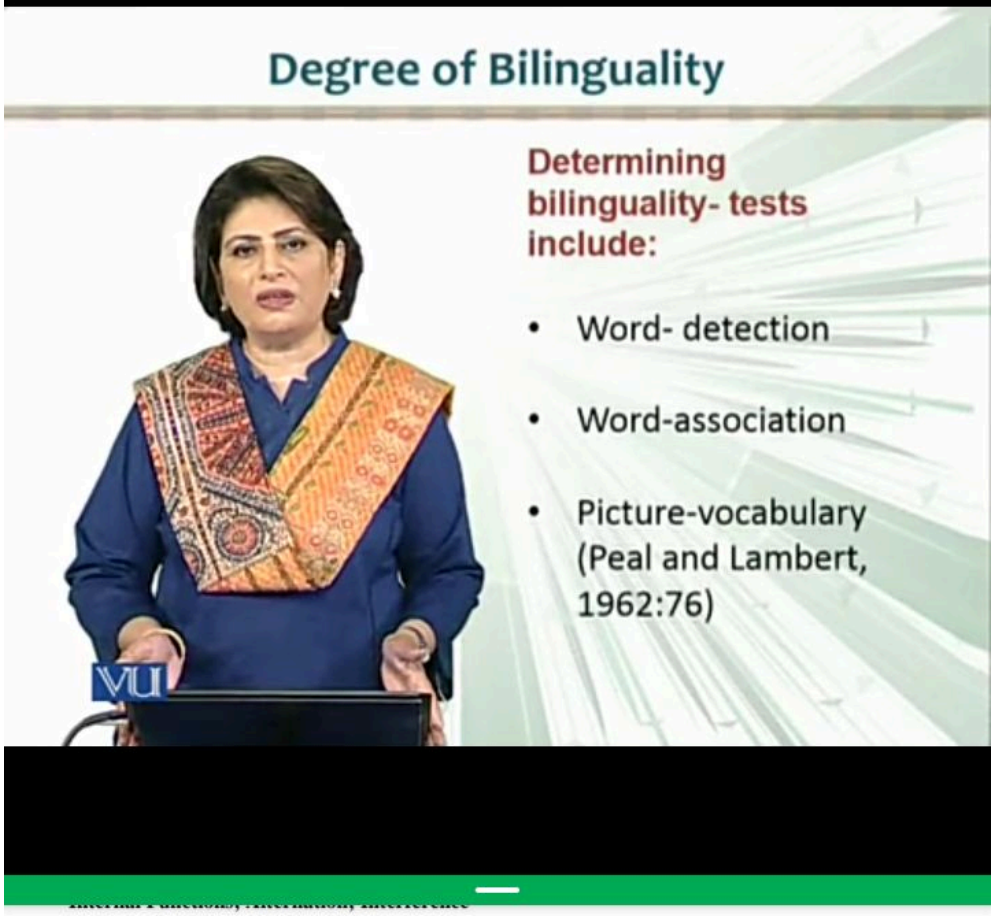

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Frequency: The duration of contact is not significant, however, unless we know its frequency. Frequency for the spoken language may be measured in average contact-hours per week or month; for the written language it may be measured in average number of words.

Pressure: In each of the areas of contact, there may be a number of pressures which influence the bilinguals in the use of one language rather than the other. These may be economic, administrative, cultural, political, military, historical, religious, or demographic.

1. *Economic:* For speakers of a minority language in an ethnic community, the knowledge of the majority language may be an economic necessity.
2. *Administrative:* Administrative workers in some areas are required to master a second language.
3. *Cultural:* In some countries, it may be essential, for cultural reasons, for any educated person to be fluent in one or more foreign languages.
4. *Political:* The use of certain languages may be maintained by the pressure of political circumstances.
5. *Military:* A bilingual who enters the armed forces of his country may be placed in situations which require him to hear or speak his second language more often than he otherwise would.
6. *Historical:* The languages a bilingual learns and the extent to which he must learn them may have been determined by past historical events. If the language of a minority has been protected by treaty, it may mean that the minority can require its children to be educated in their own language.
7. *Religious:* A bilingual may become fluent in a language for purely religious reasons. A person entering a religious order may have to learn Latin, Greek, Coptic, Sanskrit, and Arabic.
8. *Demographic:* The number of persons with whom the bilingual has the likelihood of coming into contact.

Internal Functions

Bilingualism is not only related to external factors; it is also connected with internal ones. These include non-communicative uses, like internal speech, and the expression of intrinsic aptitudes, which influence the bilingual's ability to resist or profit by the situations with which he comes in contact.

Uses: A person's bilingualism is reflected in the internal uses of each of his languages. Some bilinguals may use one and the same language for all sorts of inner expressions. This language has often been identified as the dominant language of the bilingual. Other uses include, diary writing, counting, praying etc.

Aptitude: In describing bilingualism, it is important to determine all those factors which are likely to influence the bilingual's aptitude in the use of his/her languages or which in turn may be influenced by it. These may be listed as follows:

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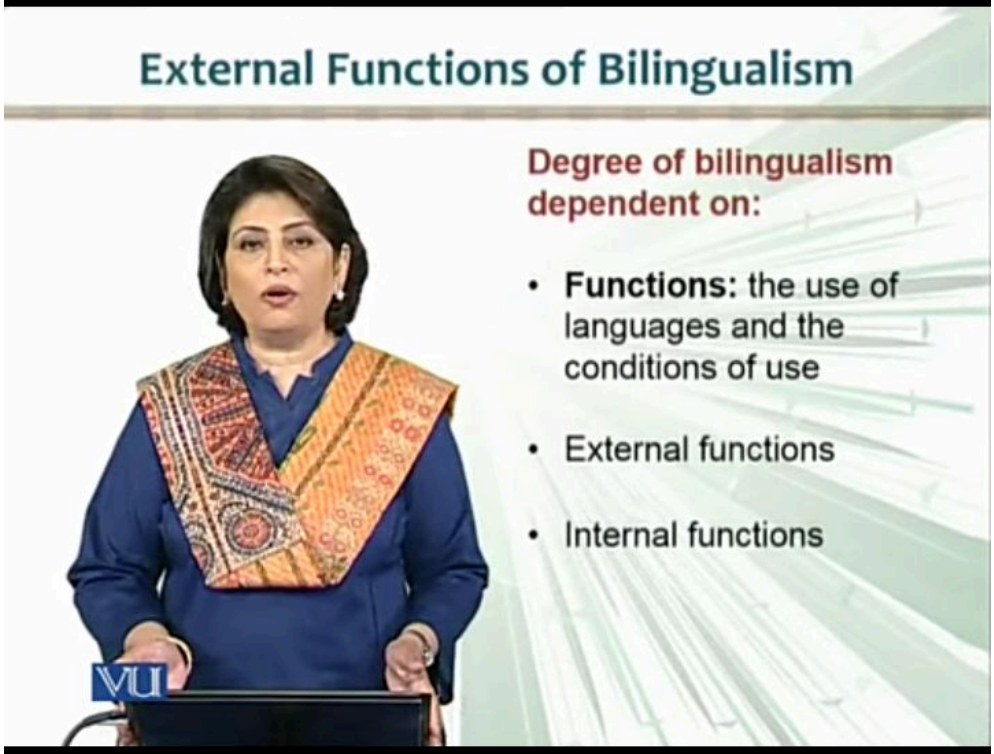

Frequency: The duration of contact is not significant, however, unless we know its frequency. Frequency for the spoken language may be measured in average contact-hours per week or month; for the written language it may be measured in average number of words.

Pressure: In each of the areas of contact, there may be a number of pressures which influence the bilinguals in the use of one language rather than the other. These may be economic, administrative, cultural, political, military, historical, religious, or demographic.

1. *Economic:* For speakers of a minority language in an ethnic community, the knowledge of the majority language may be an economic necessity.
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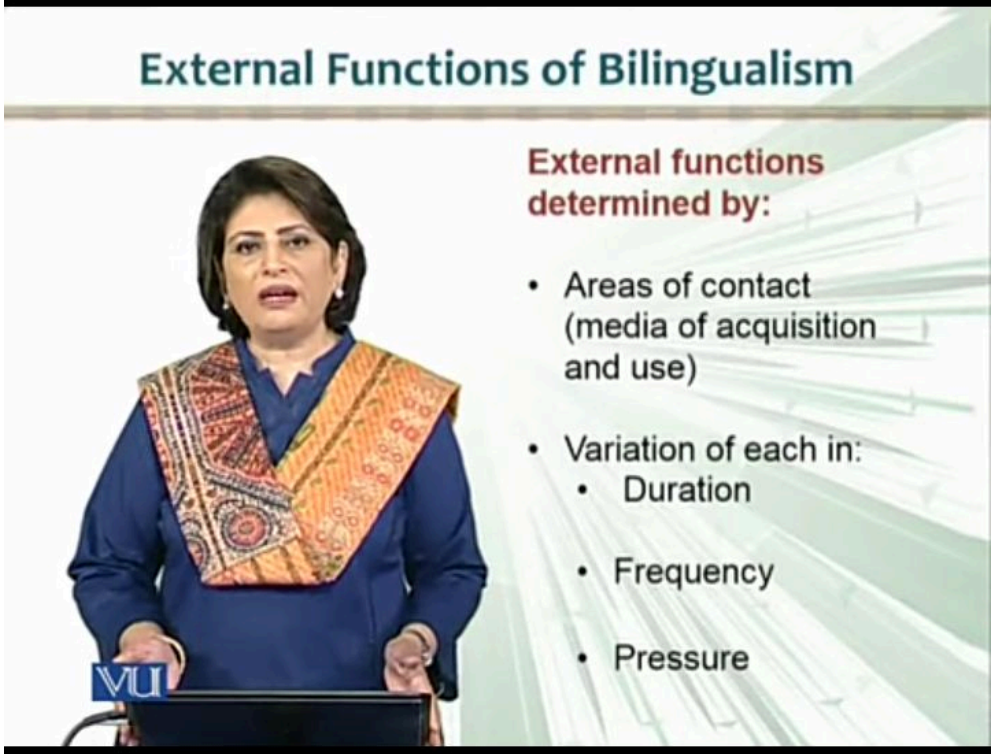

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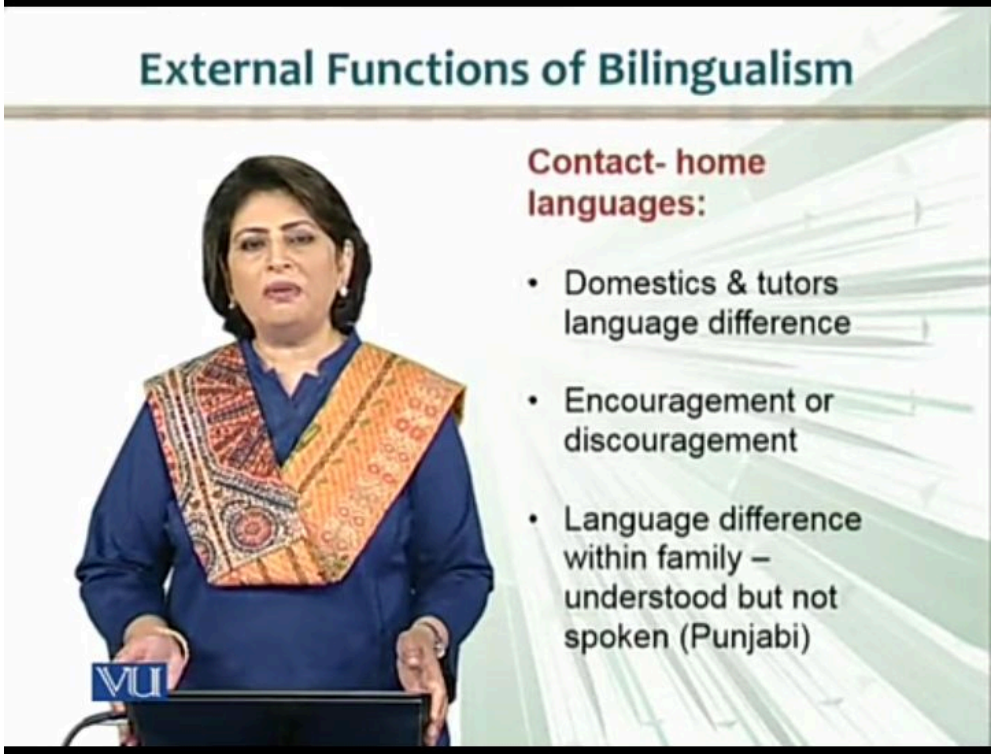

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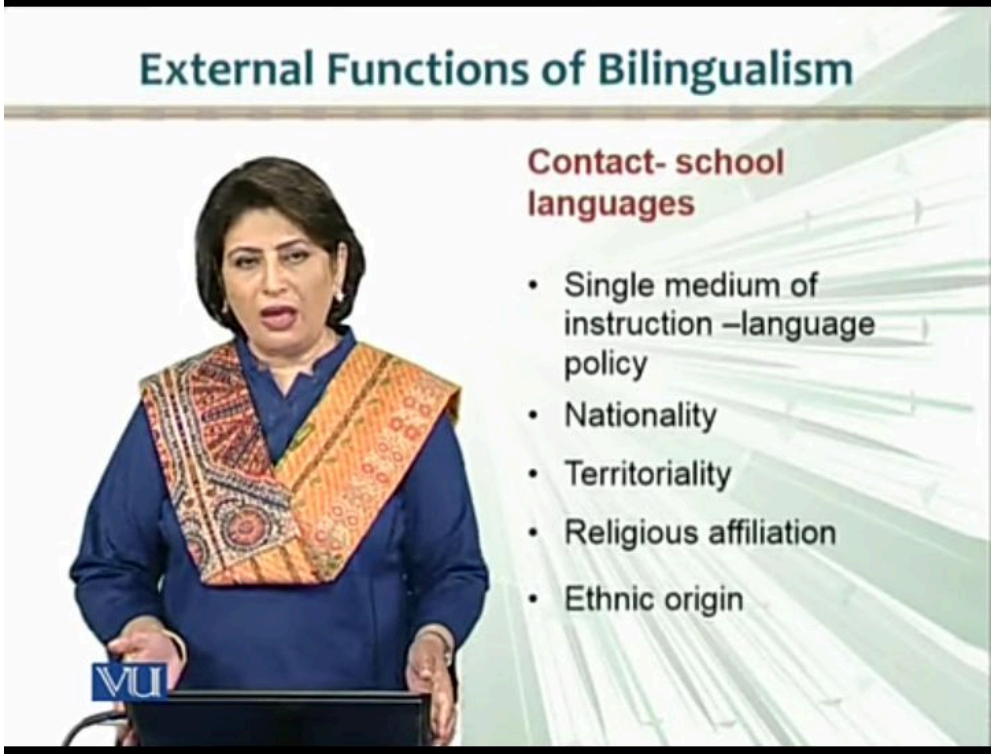

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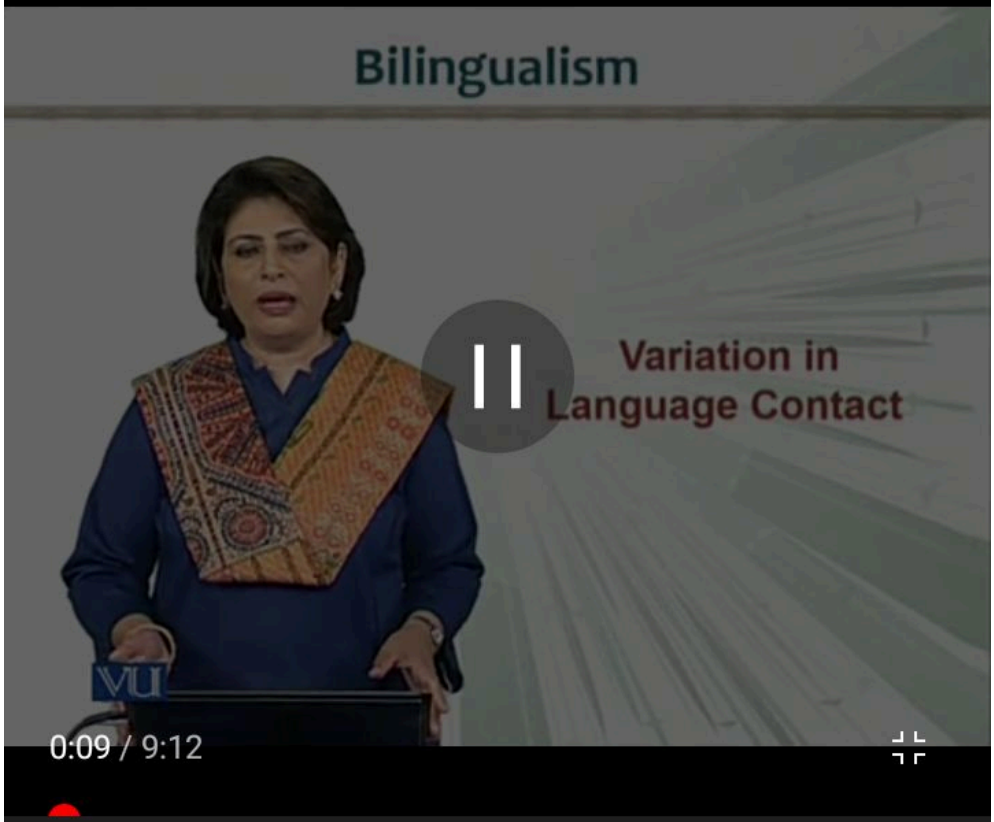

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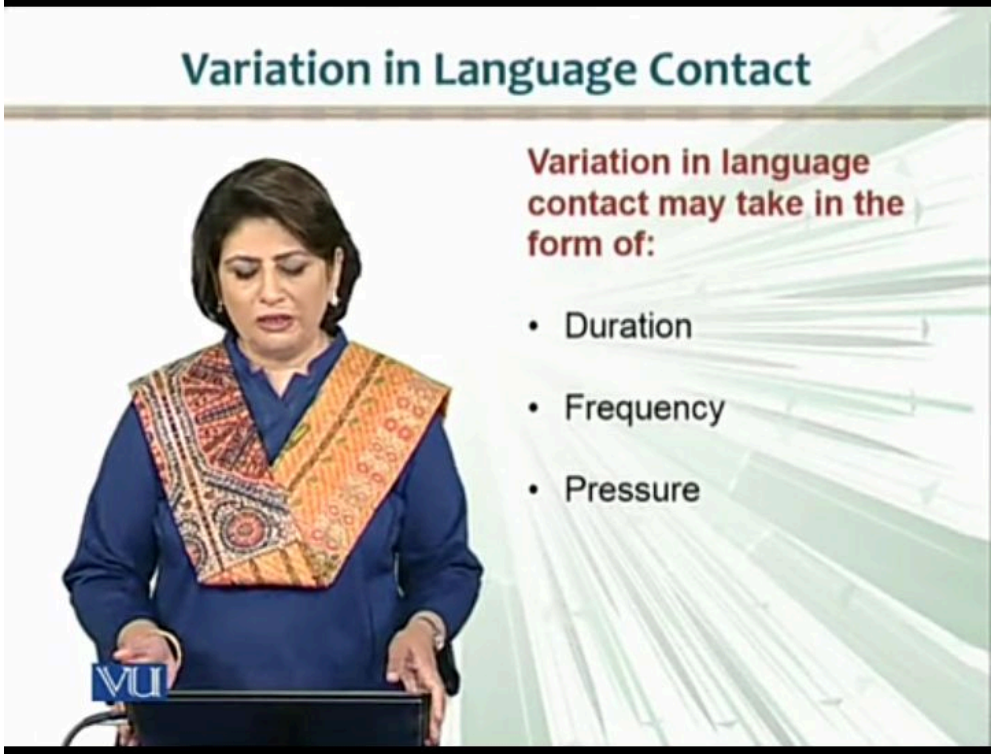

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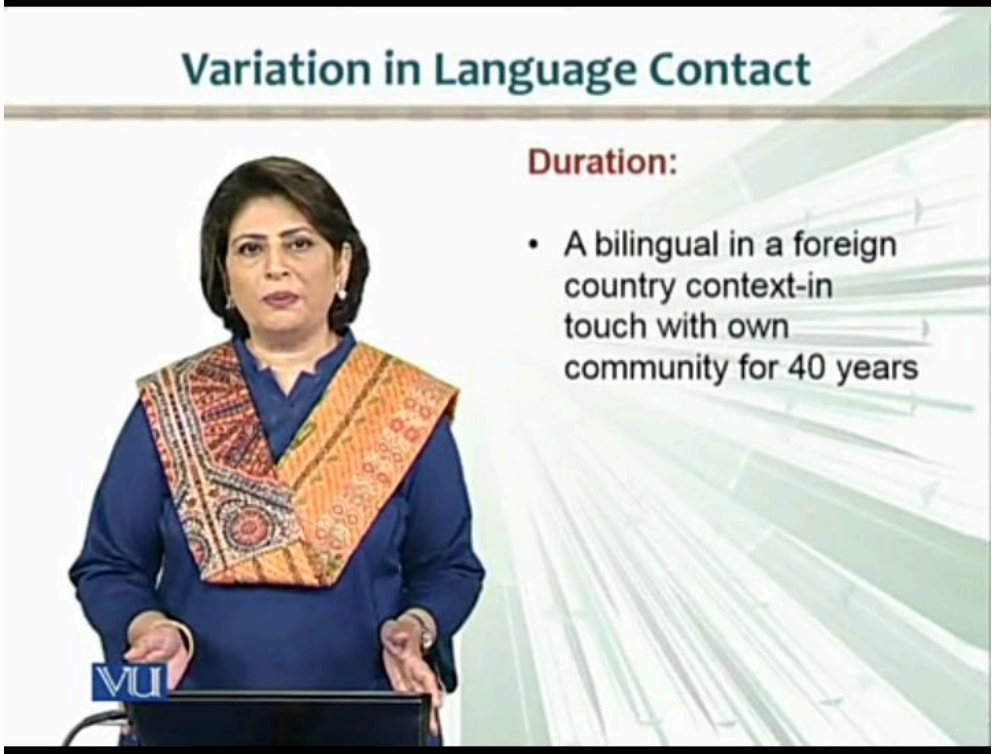

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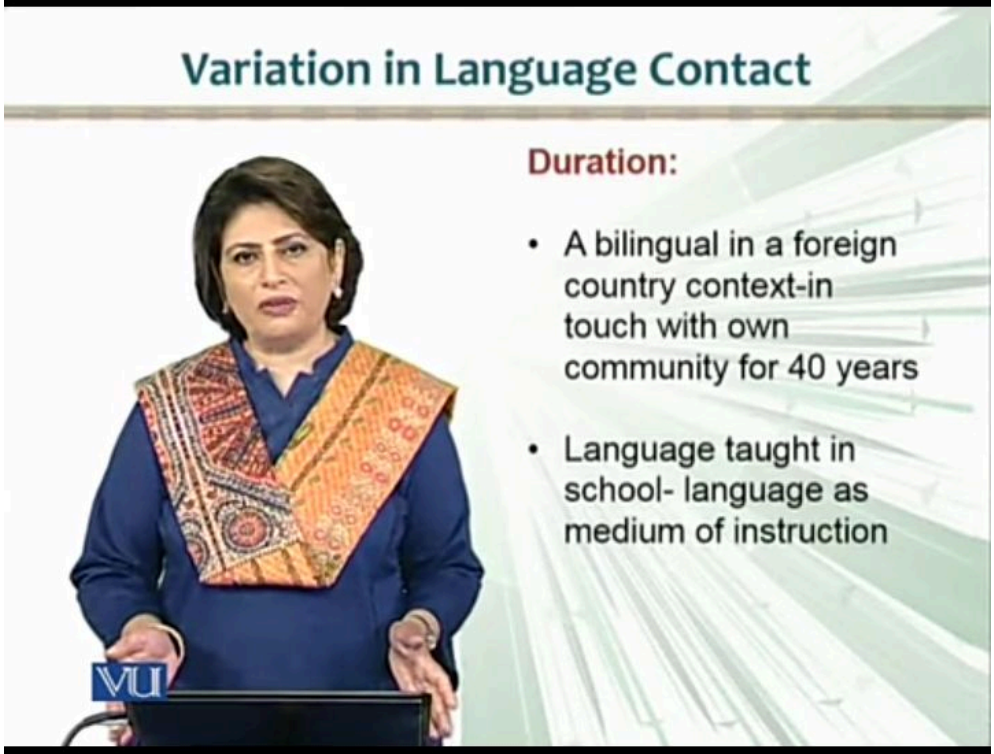

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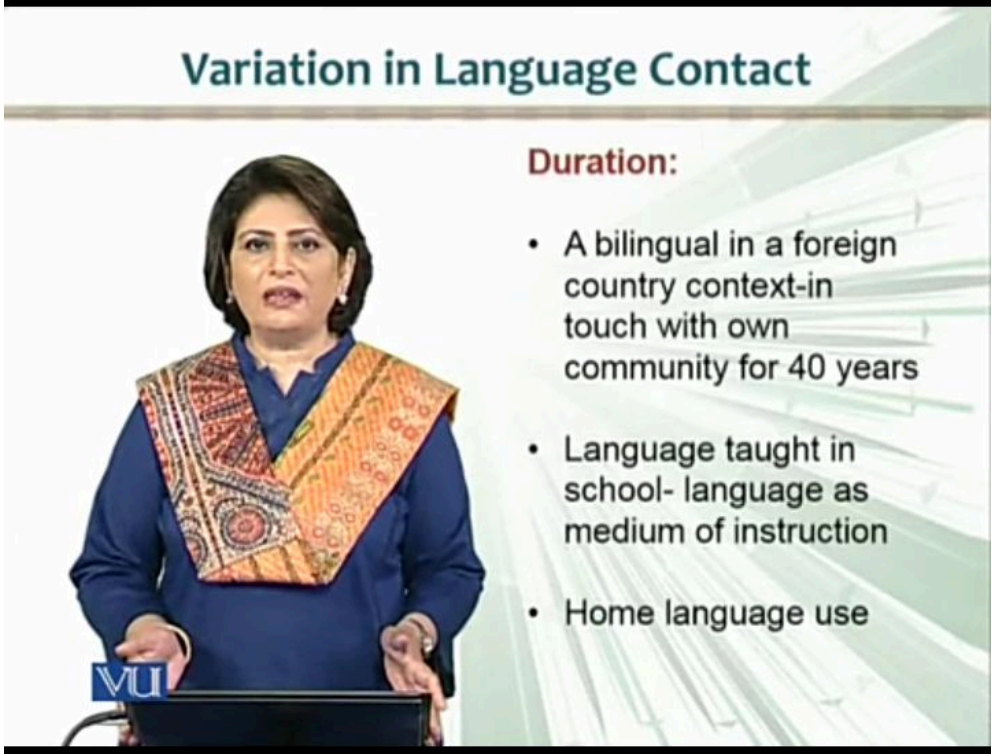

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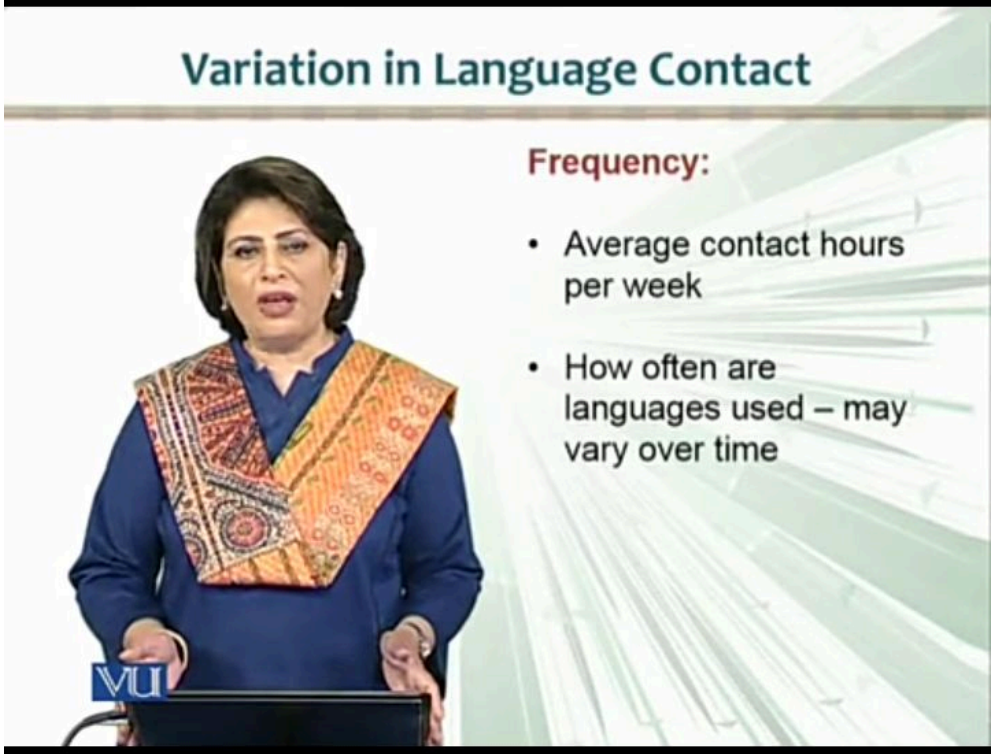

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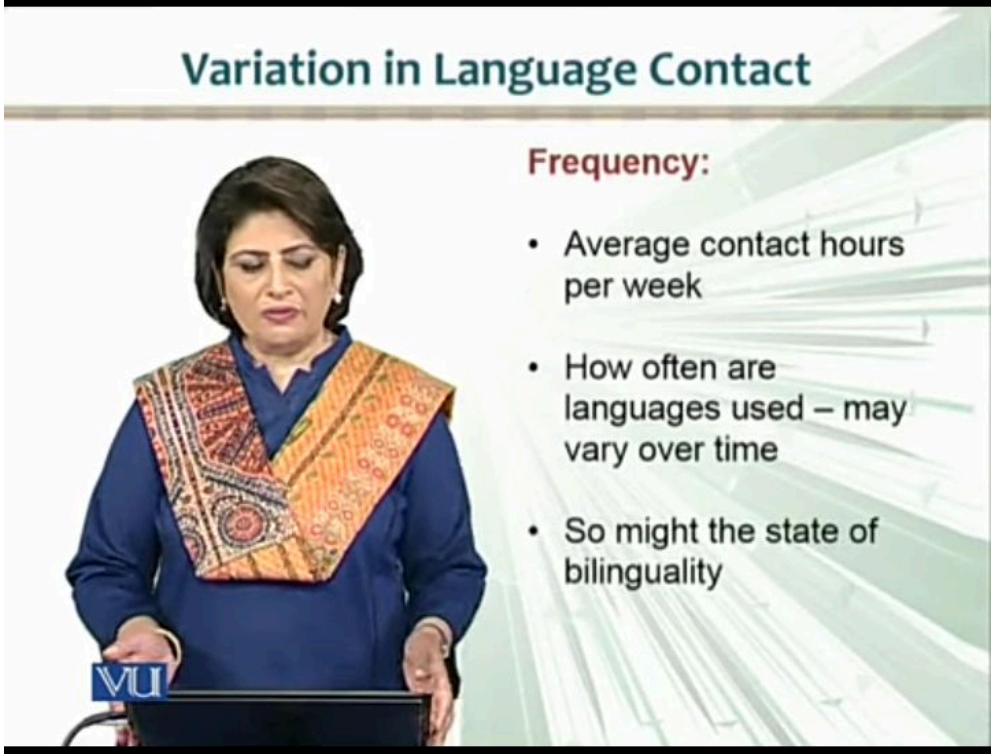

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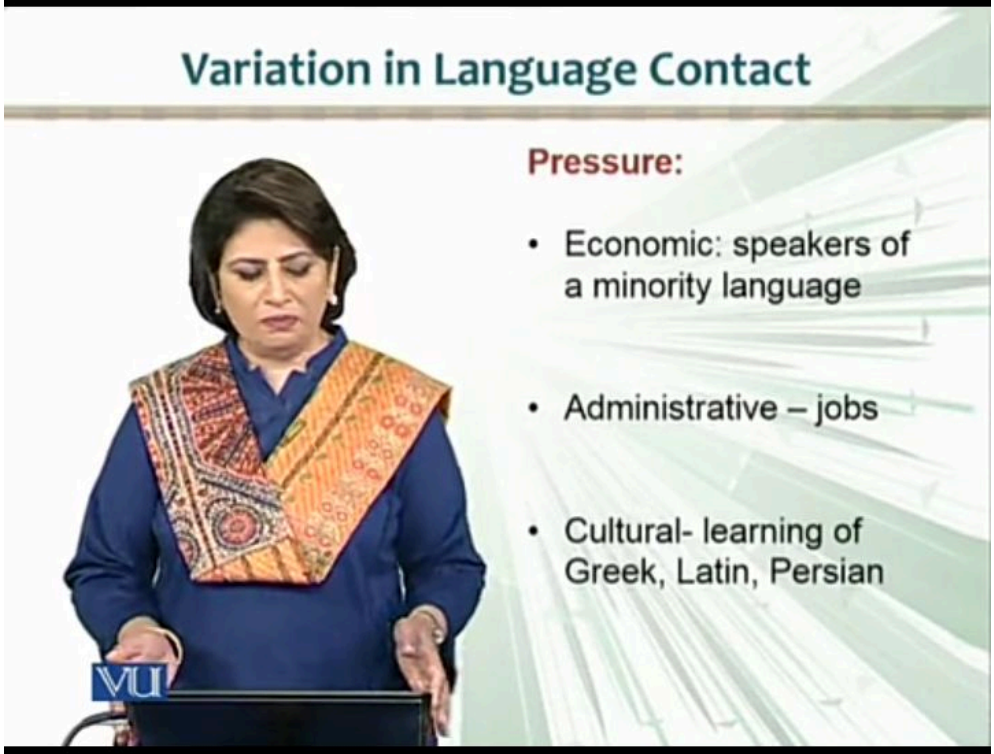

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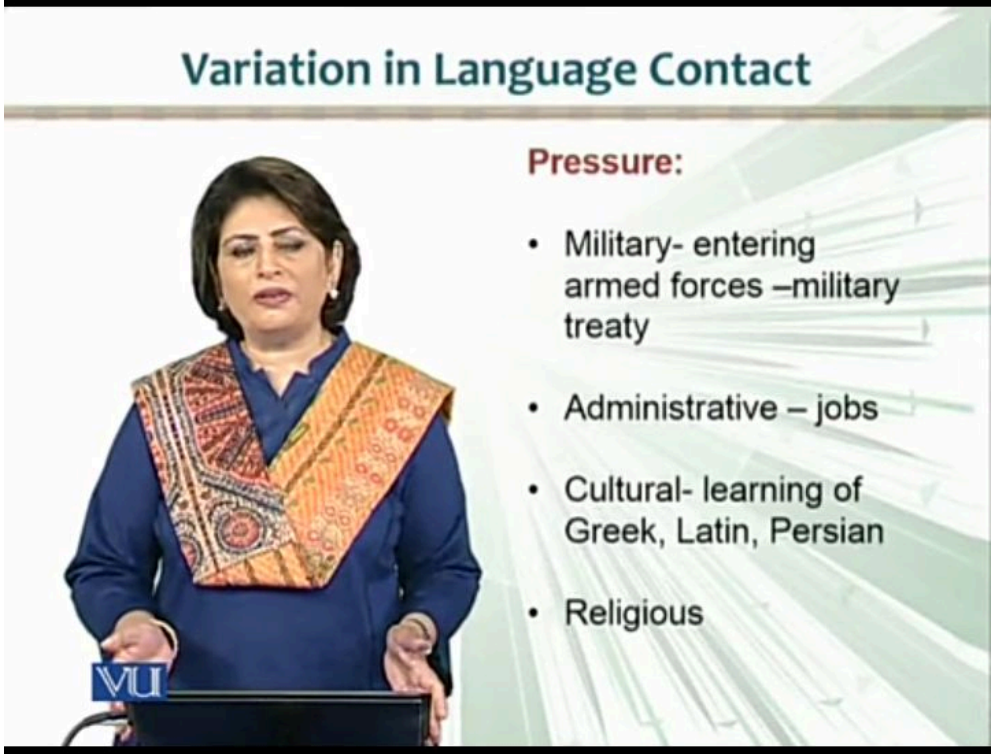

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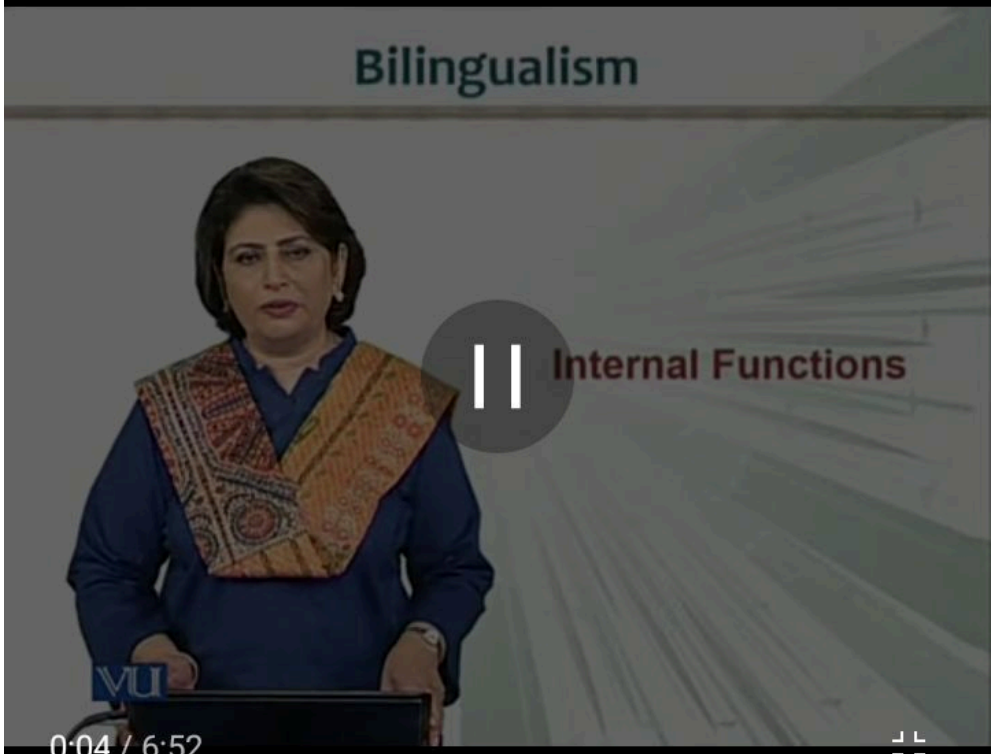

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Interference

The characteristics of degree, function, and alternation determine the interference of one language with another in the speech of bilinguals. Interference is the use of features belonging to one language while speaking or writing another. The description of interference must be distinguished from the analysis of language borrowing. The former is a feature of "parole"; the latter of "langue." The one is individual and contingent; the other is collective and systematic. In contradistinction to the consistency in use of borrowed features in the speech of the community is the vacillation in the use of foreign features by its bilingual individuals. In the speech of bilingual; interference is not the same at all times and under all circumstances. The interference may vary with the medium, the style, the register, and the context which the bilingual happens to be using. Interference also varies with the style of discourse used, e.g., descriptive, narrative, conversational, etc. The type and amount of interference noted in the recounting of an anecdote may differ considerably from that noted in the give-and- take of everyday conversation. Interference may also vary according to the social role of the speaker in any given case. This is what the Edinburgh School has called register. Within each register, there are a number of possible contexts, each of which may affect the type and amount of interference depending on the context and the interlocutor. In each of these contexts, the interference may vary from situation to situation. In the last analysis, interference varies from text to text. It is the text; therefore, within a context or situation used at a specific register in a certain style and medium of a given dialect, that is the appropriate sample for the description of interference.

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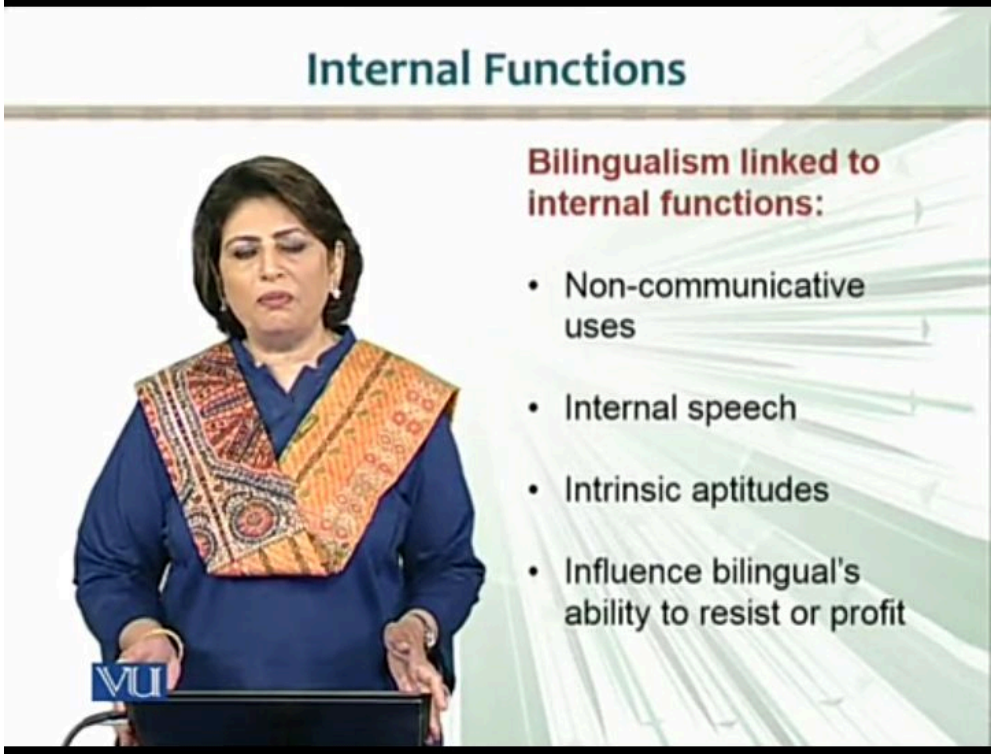

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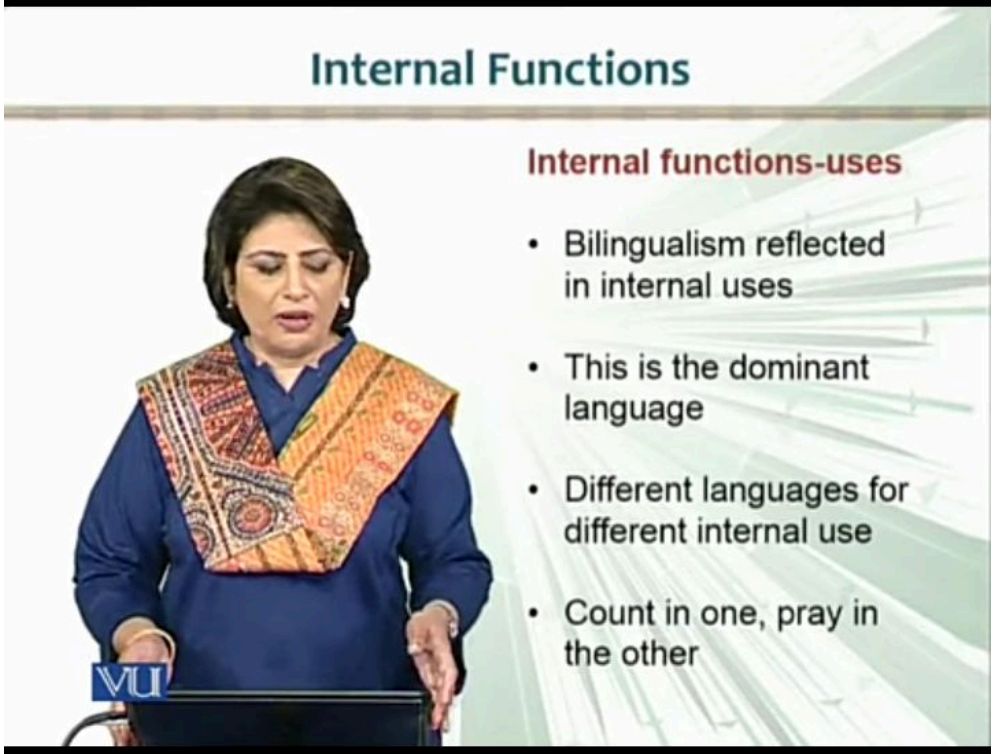

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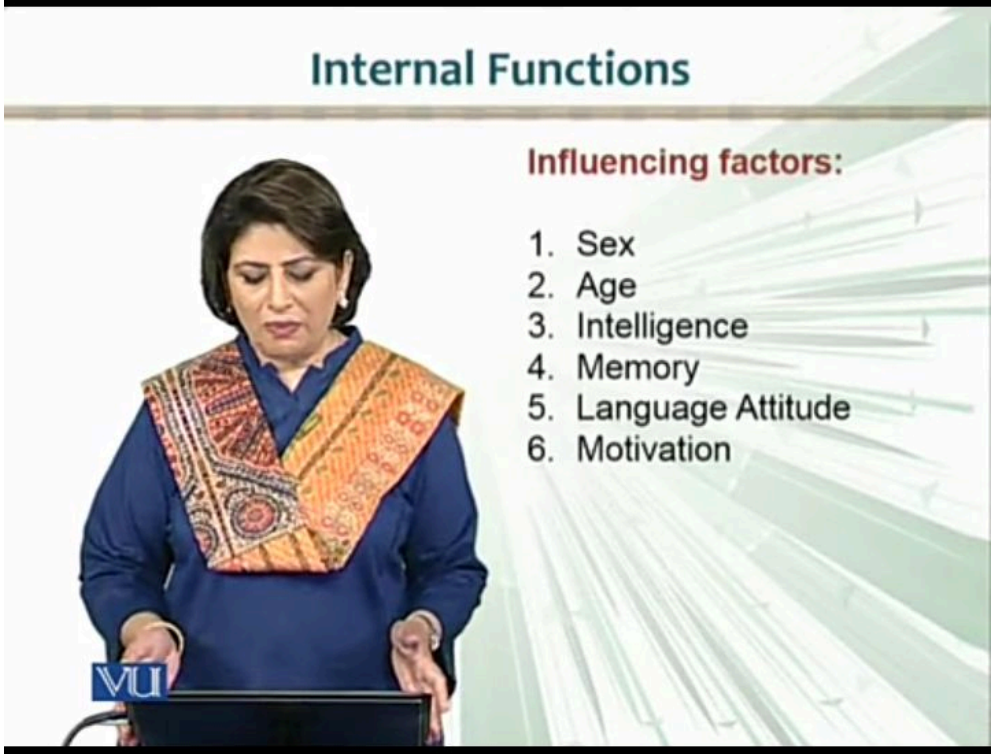

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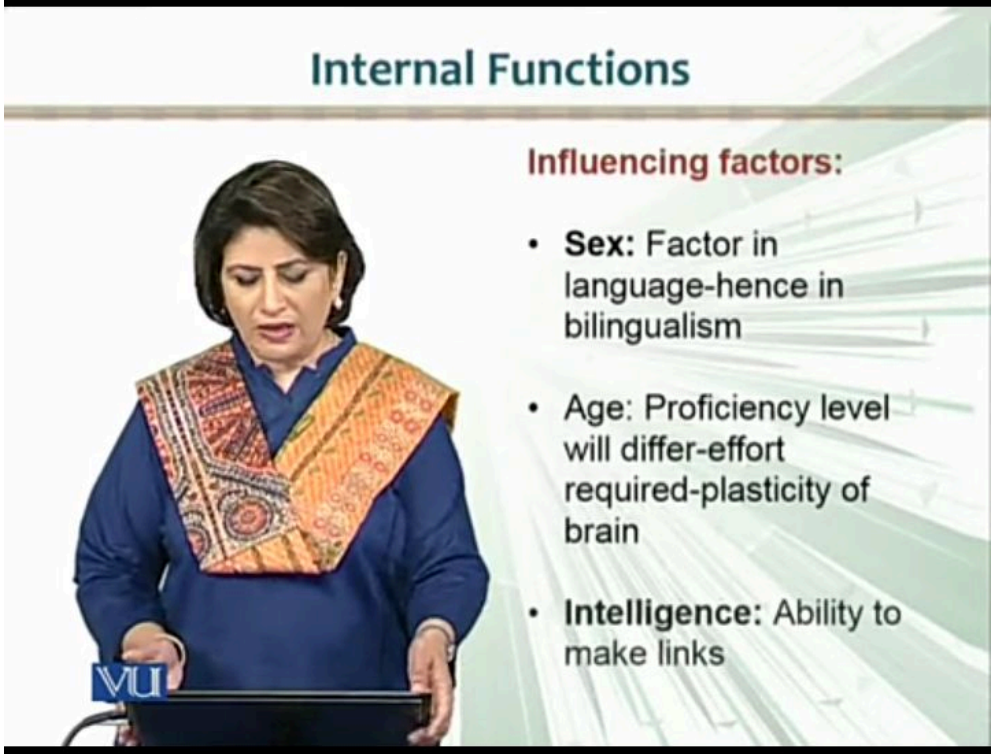

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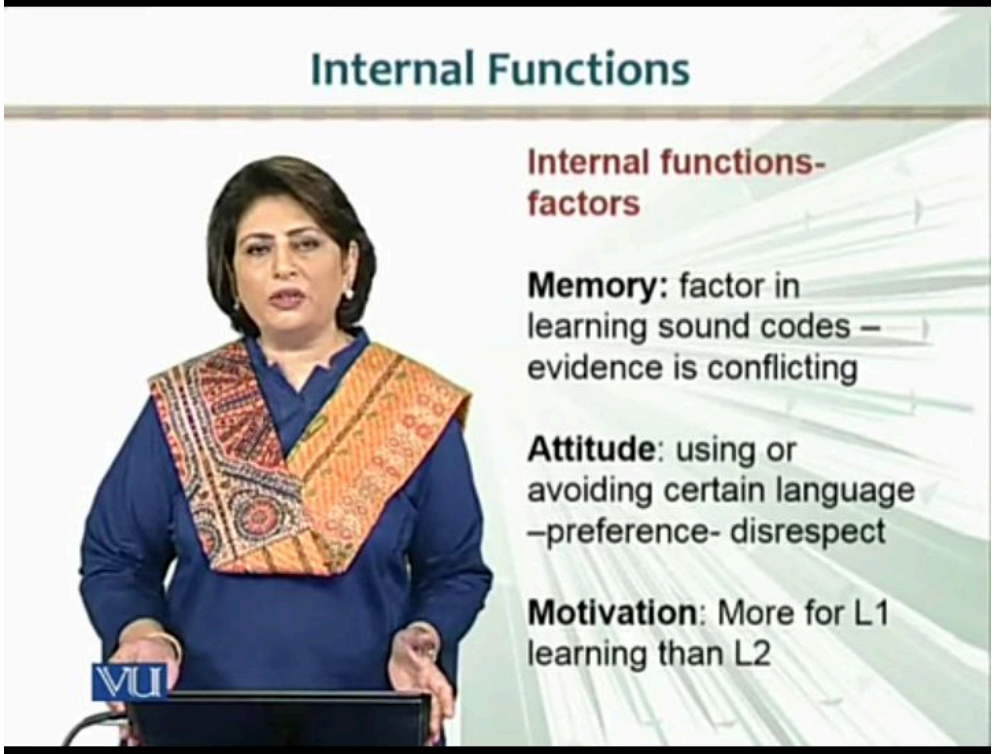

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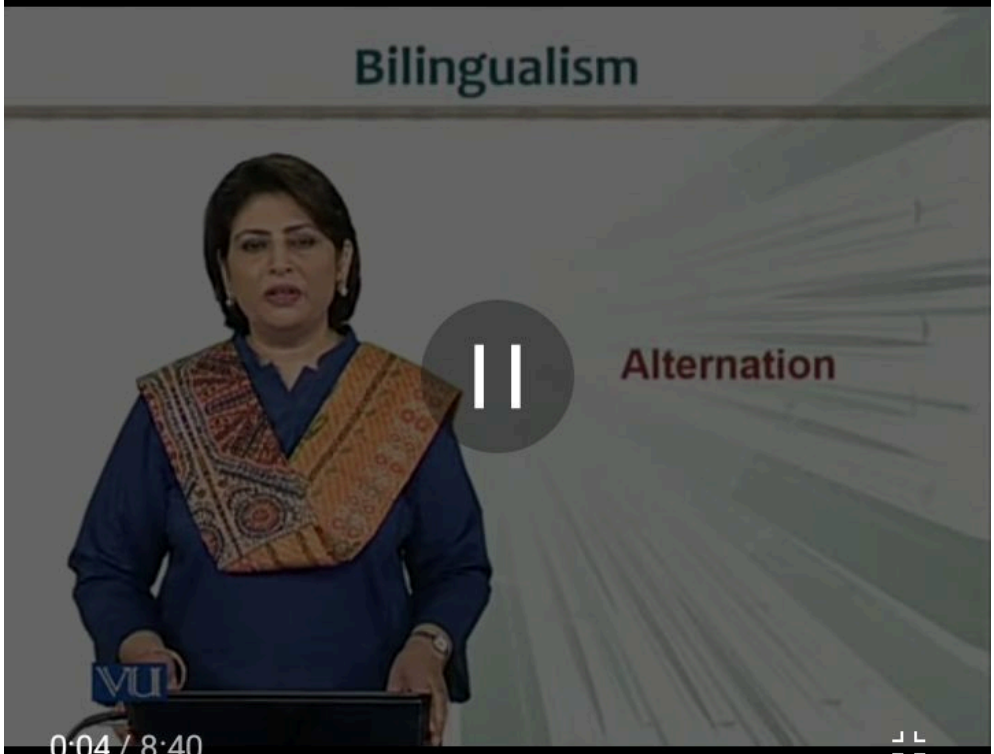

No connection

4. **Memory:** If memory is a fact or in imitation, it is also a factor in bilingualism; for the auditory memory span for sounds immediately after hearing them is related to the ability to learn languages.

5. Attitude: The attitude of a bilingual towards his languages and towards the people who speak them will influence his behavior within different areas of contact in which each language is used. The attitude of the speaker may be regarded as an important factor in the description of his bilingualism.

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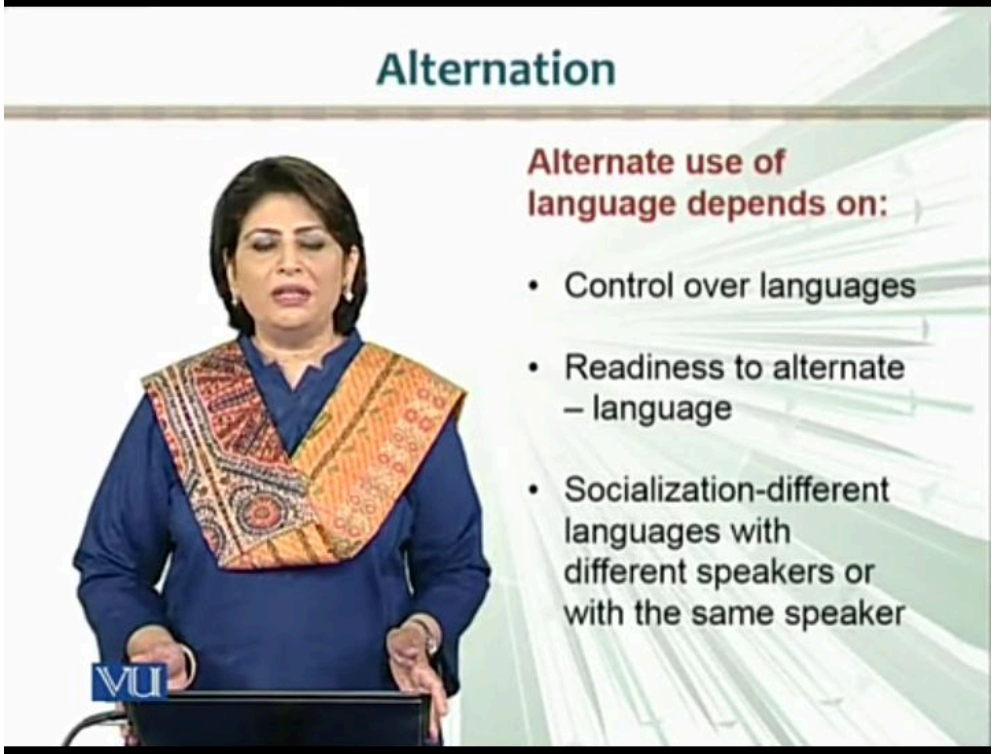

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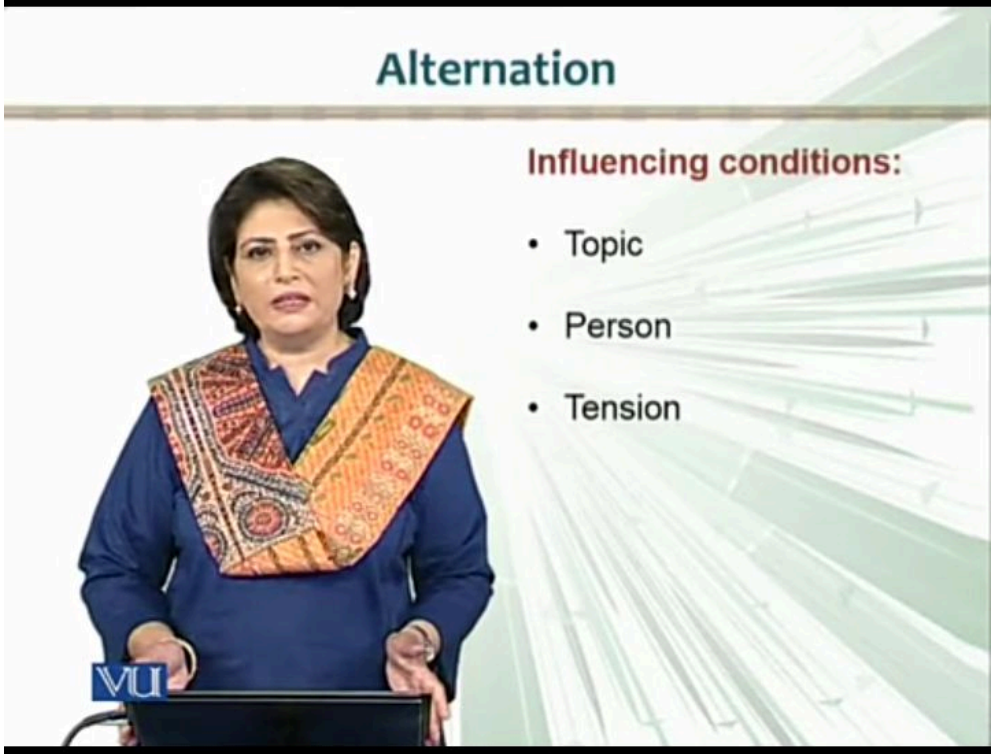

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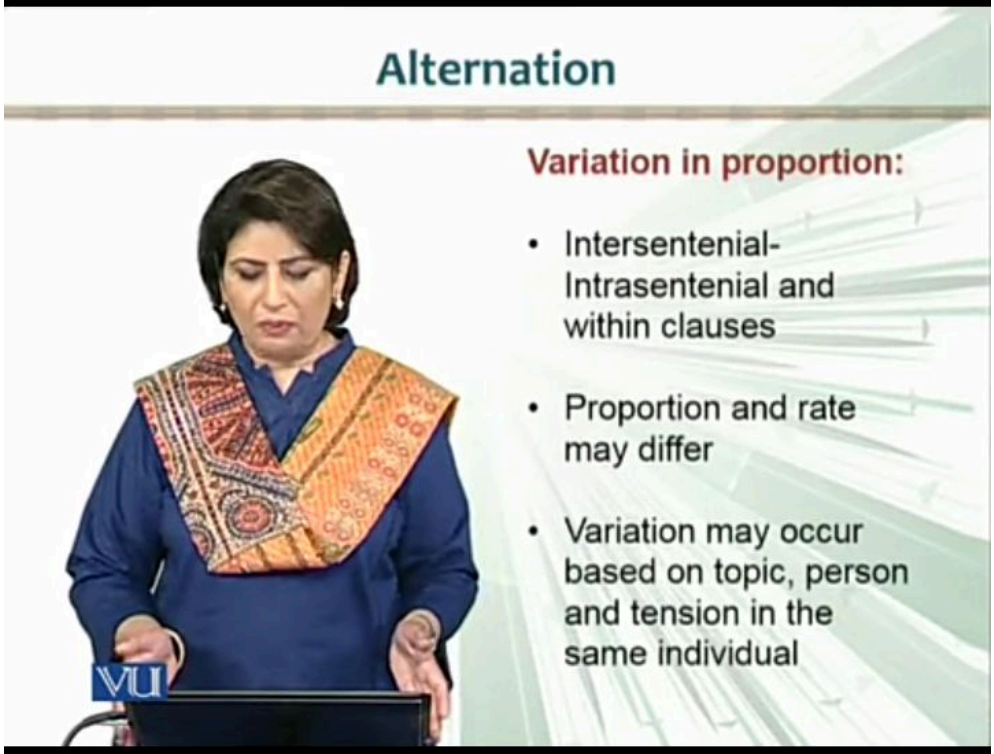

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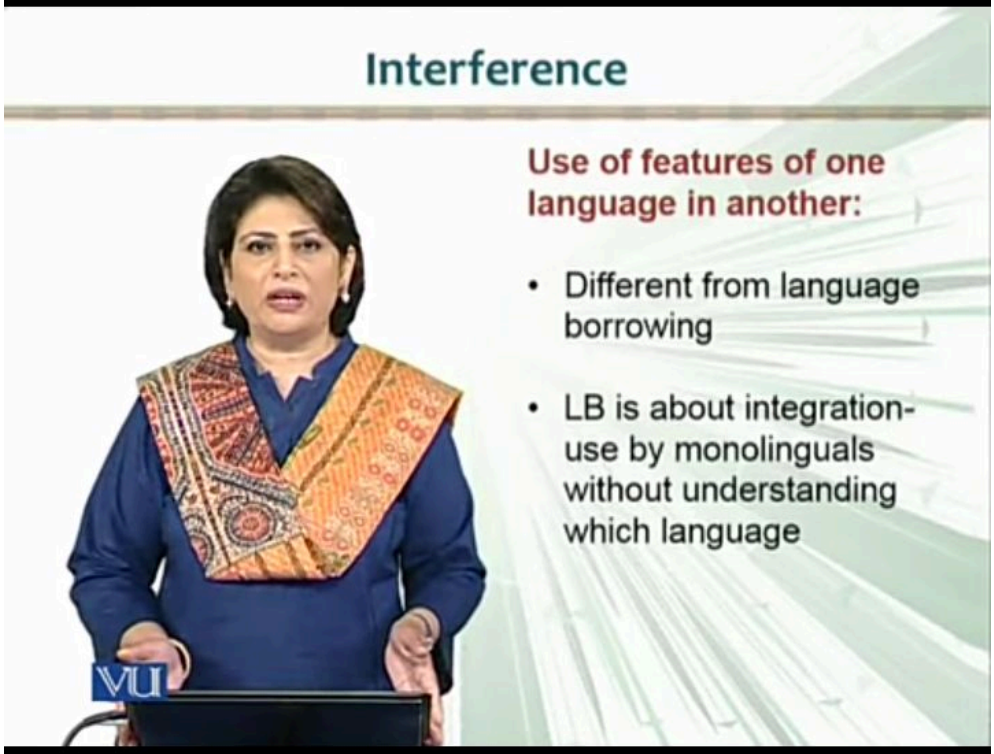

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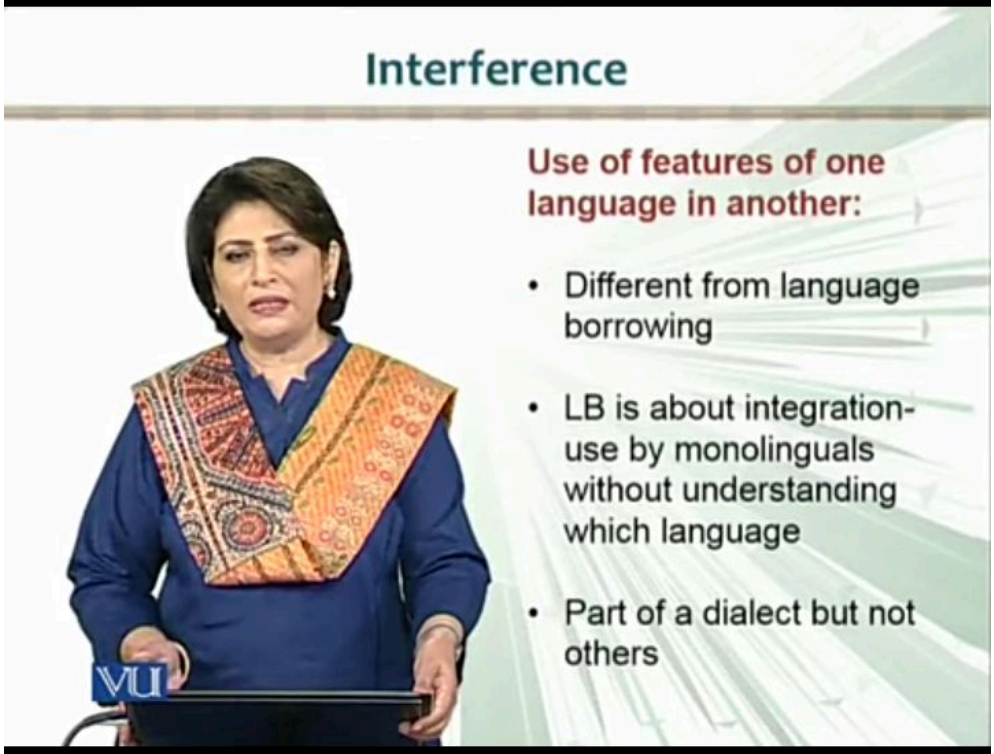

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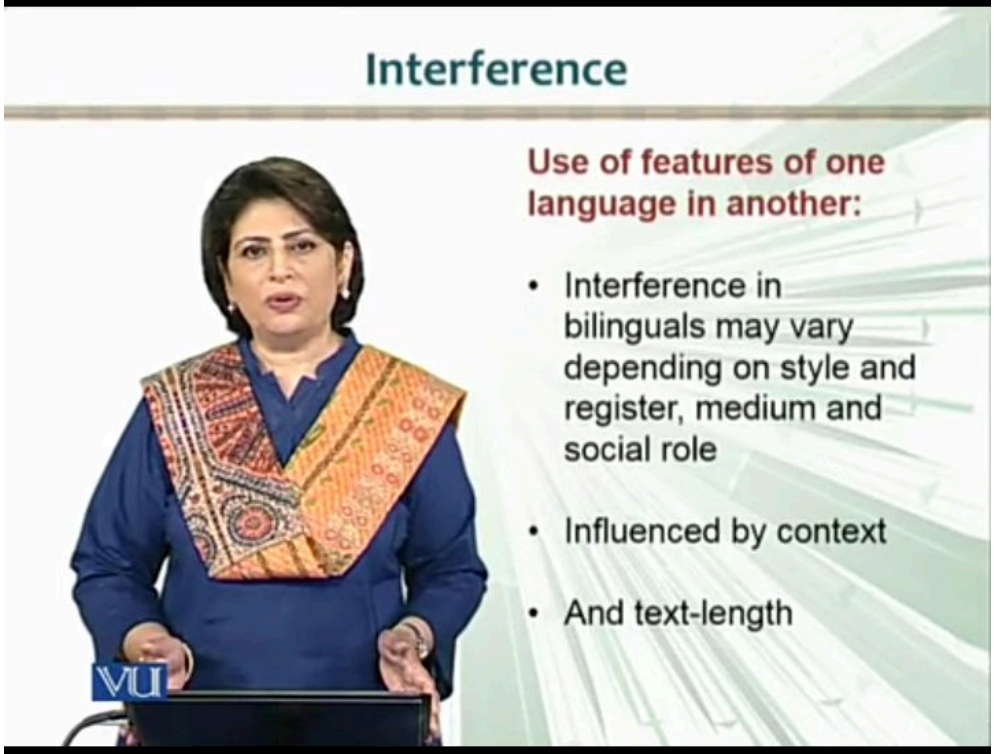

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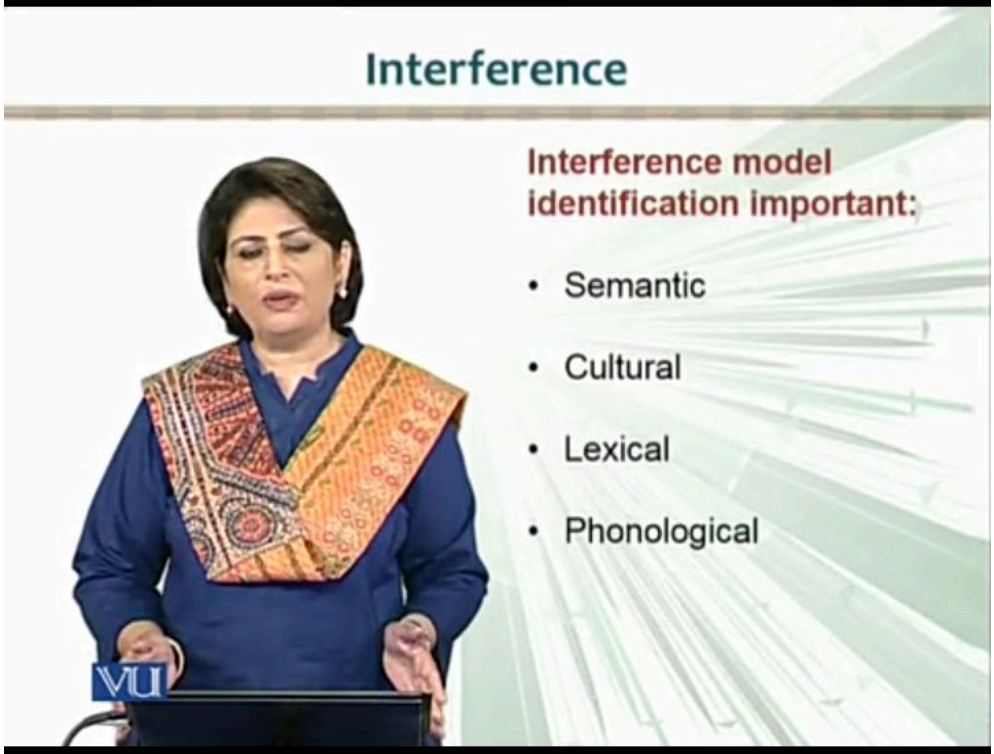

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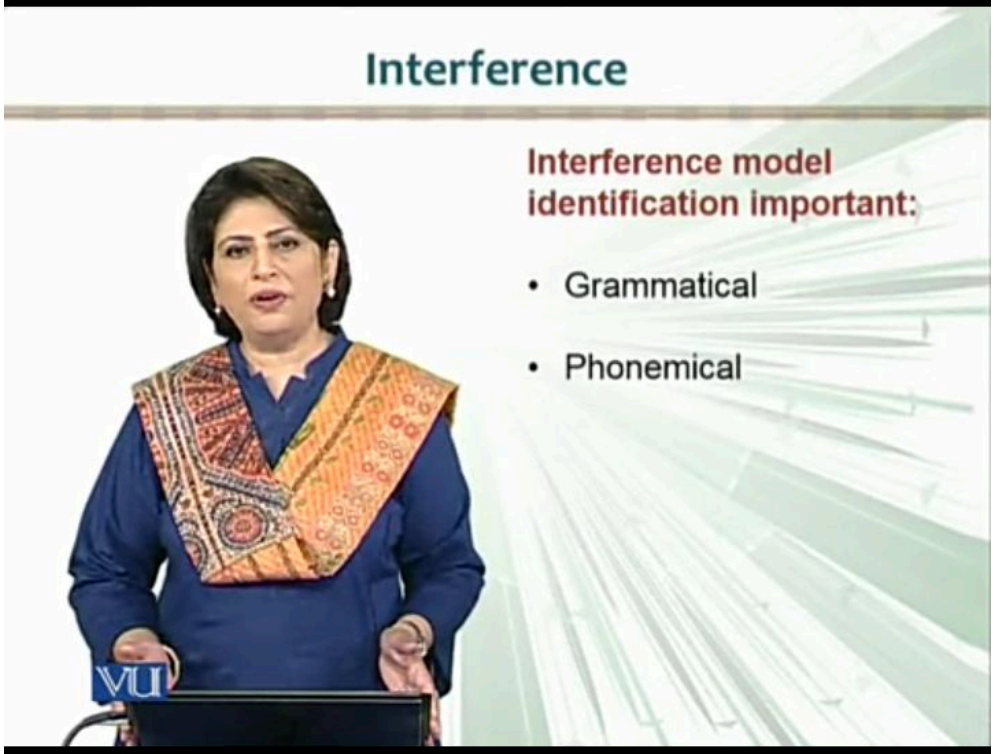

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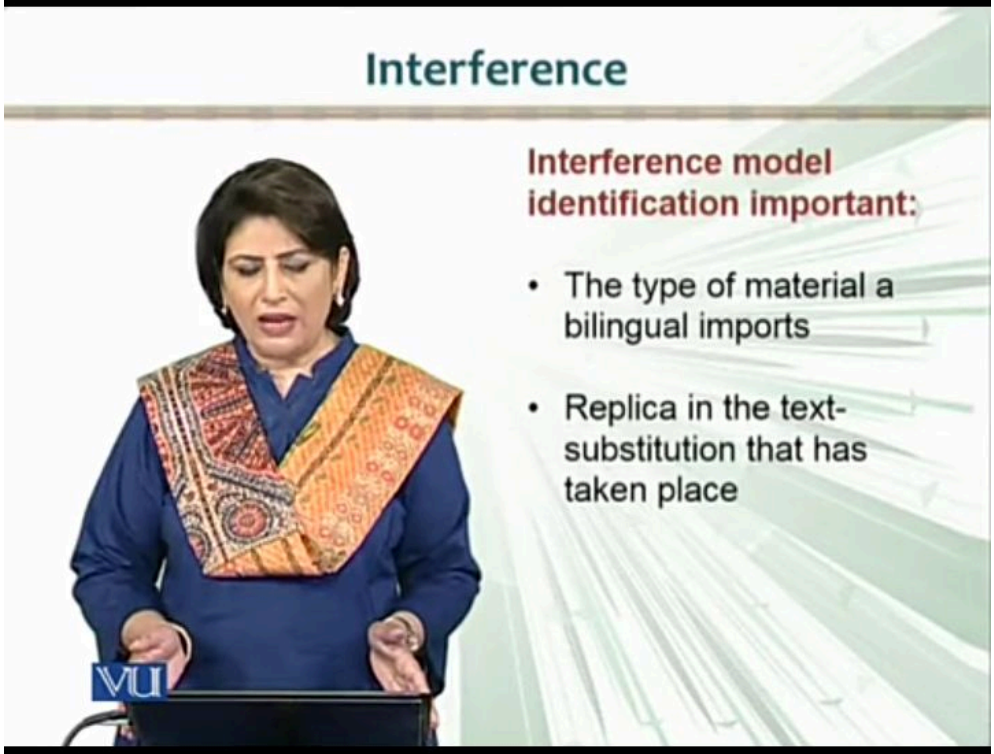

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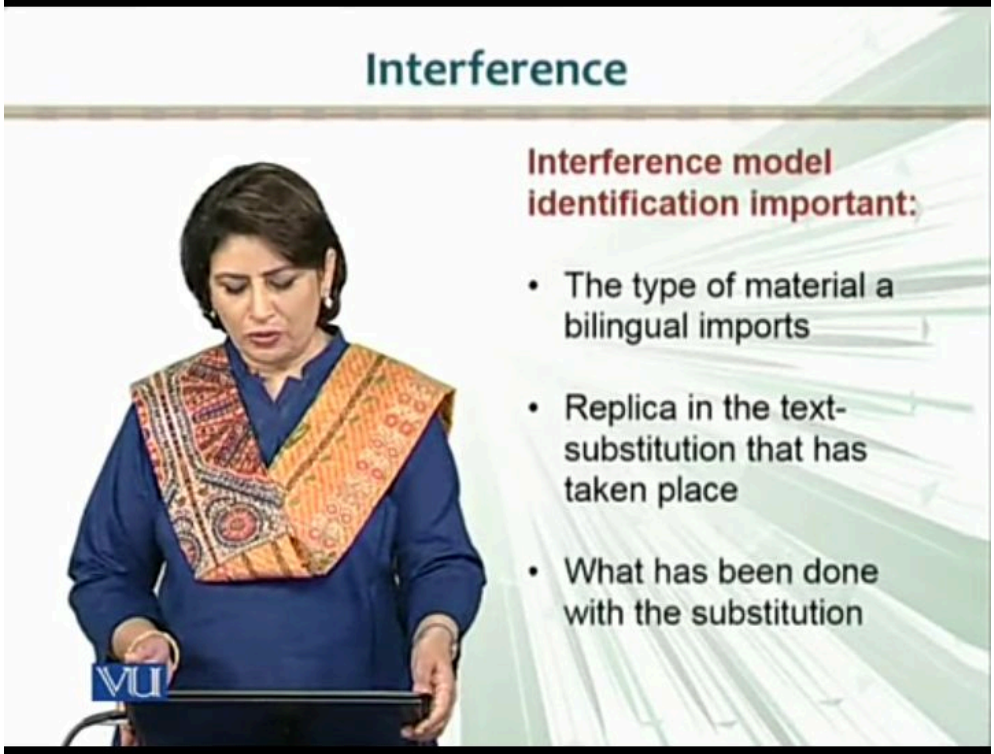

reasons for repeating the effort in another language are less urgent. In the case of simultaneous childhood bilingualism, however, the need for learning both languages may be made equally compelling. This may not be so for the person who becomes bilingual as an adult.

Alternation

Bilingualism also relates to the degree to which the bilingual and his hearers have mastered both languages determine the amount of alternation which takes place from one language to the other. This in turn depends on his fluency in each language and on its external and internal functions. Then we need to know under what conditions does alternation from one language to another take place? What are the factors involved? The three main factors seem to be topic, person, and tension. Rate and proportion of alternation may vary greatly in the same individual according to the topic about which he is speaking, the person he is speaking to, and the tension of the situation in which he speaks.

Interference

The characteristics of degree, function, and alternation determine the interference of one language with another in the speech of bilinguals. Interference is the use of features belonging to one language while speaking or writing another. The description of interference must be distinguished from the analysis of language borrowing. The former is a feature of "parole"; the latter of "langue." The one is individual and contingent; the other is collective and systematic. In contradistinction to the consistency in use of borrowed features in the speech of the community is the vacillation in the use of foreign features by its bilingual individuals. In the speech of bilingual; interference is not the same at all times and under all circumstances. The interference may vary with the medium, the style, the register, and the context which the bilingual happens to be using. Interference also varies with the style of discourse used, e.g., descriptive, narrative, conversational, etc. The type and amount of interference noted in the recounting of an anecdote may differ considerably from that noted in the give-and- take of everyday conversation. Interference may also vary according to the social role of the speaker in any given case. This is what the Edinburgh School has called register. Within each register, there are a number of possible contexts, each of which may affect the type and amount of interference depending on the context and the interlocutor. In each of these contexts, the interference may vary from situation to situation. In the last analysis, interference varies from text to text. It is the text; therefore, within a context or situation used at a specific register in a certain style and medium of a given dialect, that is the appropriate sample for the description of interference.

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